MONTHLY CURRENT AFFAIRS MAGAZINE

JUNE 2026



- Detailed release for all exams
- Static GK points included
- Category-wise Compilation
- Live Table of Content

Table of Contents

Important Days 4
Important Days (In Table) 4
Important Days With Static 5
Books 14
Books (In Table) 14
Appointments 16
Appointments (In Table)-National 16
Appointments (In Table)-International 17
Appointments With Static 17
Awards 26
Awards - National 26
Awards - International 31
Obituaries 35
National 38
Eminent Personalities In News 60
State 62
Ladakh 62
Jammu & Kashmir 64
Himachal Pradesh 65
Uttarakhand 66
Punjab 67
Haryana 67
Chandigarh 68
Delhi 68
Uttar Pradesh 70
Madhya Pradesh 71
Bihar 75
Jharkhand 76
Odisha 77
West Bengal 78
Assam 79
Arunachal Pradesh 81
Manipur 81
Mizoram 81
Tripura 81
Meghalaya 82
Rajasthan 82
Gujarat 83
Maharashtra 84
Goa 86
Telangana 86
Andhra Pradesh 87
Karnataka 88
Kerala 90
Tamil Nadu 90
Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu. 92

Defence 92
Science & Technology 101
Environment 111
Index/rankings/reports 124
International 131
Sports 145
National/ international Championships 145
Tennis 147
Hockey 148
Cricket 149
Chess 149
Football 150
Badminton 151
Race 151
Javelin 151
Volleyball 152
Miscellaneous 152
Banking / Finance 153

Important Days

Important Days (In Table)

Date	Day	Theme
1 June	World Milk Day	
1 June	Global Day of Parents	Together for Parents
2 June	Italy Republic Day	
3 June	World Bicycle Day	Theme: "Cycling for a Greener Future"
5 June	World Environment Day	Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future"
5 June	International Day for the Fight against Illegal Unreported and Unregulated Fishing	
6 June	Russian Language Day	
6 June	World Pest Day	Defending Health Across Borders: The Global Power of Pest Management The tagline - Marking 10 Years of World Pest Day- United Around the Globe
7 June	World Food Safety Day	From burden to solutions – safe food everywhere The slogan - Food safety, everyone's business
8 June	World Oceans Day	REIMAGINE: Beyond the world we know, a new relationship with our ocean
8 June	World Brain Tumor Day	
9 June	World Accreditation Day	Innovation, Trust and Sustainability: The Power of Accreditation
9 June	International Archives Day	#ArchivesForJustice: Rights, Memory & Futures
9 June	World Accreditation Day	Innovation, Trust and Sustainability: The Power of Accreditation
10 June	International Day for Dialogue among Civilizations	
11 June	International Day of Play	Protect Play, Protect Childhood
12 June	World Day Against Child Labour	Red card to child labour: Fair play for children, decent work for adults
12 June	Russia Day	
13 June	International Albinism Awareness Day	Proudly in my skin — celebrating all skin tones
14 June	World Blood Donor Day [WHO]	One Drop of Humanity. Give Blood. Save Lives
15 June	World Wind Day	Wind Energy: From Ambition to Acceleration
15 June	World Elder Abuse Awareness Day	Beyond Awareness: Making Elder Abuse Prevention Work
16 June	International Day of Family Remittances	Remittances for Rural Resilience, Entrepreneurship and Employment
16 - 22 June	Sustainable Gastronomy Week	Celebrating Food Heritage
16 June	World Sea Turtle Day	
17 June	World Day to Combat Desertification and Drought	Rangelands: Recognize. Respect. Restore.
17 June	World Crocodile Day	
18 June	Sustainable Gastronomy Day	
18 June	International Day for Countering Hate	The power of partnerships in countering speech
19 June	World Sickle Cell Awareness Day	Closing the Survival Gap: Equity in Sickle Cell Disease
19 June	International Day for the Elimination of Sexual Violence in Conflict	Conflict-Related Sexual Violence Against Children: Safeguarding Futures and Empowering Caregivers
19 June	National Reading Day	
20 June	World Refugee Day	Until Everyone Is Safe
21 June	International Day of the Celebration of the Solstice	
21 June	International Day of Yoga	Yoga for Healthy Ageing
21 June	World Music Day	
21 June	World Hydrography Day	Transforming how ocean data is shared."
22 June	World Camel Day	
22 June	World Rainforest Day	The Forest Within You
23 June	International Olympic Day	

Date	Day	Theme
23 June	International Widows' Day	
23 June	United Nations Public Service Day	Transforming Public Institutions: Advancing innovation, Participation, and Inclusion
24 June	International Day of Women in Diplomacy	Women in Diplomacy: Shaping the Future of Global Cooperation
24 June	Passport Seva Divas	
25 June	Day of the Seafarer [IMO]	Carrying world trade. Carrying the risks
25 June	Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas	
26 June	International Day against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking	World drug problem: persisting issues, new challenges, innovative responses
26 June	United Nations International Day in Support of Victims of Torture	
27 June	International Day of Deafblindness	Connected by Touch: Breaking Barriers, Building Bridges
27 June	Micro-Small and Medium-sized Enterprises Day	Empowering MSMEs through Innovation and Sustainable Industrial Development
28 June	National Insurance Awareness Day	
29 June	National Statistics Day	Unlocking the Potential of Administrative Data
29 June	International Day of the Tropics	
30 June	Hul Diwas	
30 June	International Asteroid Day	
30 June	International Day of Parliamentarism	Bring Human Rights into Focus

Important Days With Static

1 June – World Milk Day

- World Milk Day was **introduced in 2001 by** the Food and Agriculture Organisation of the United Nations **(FAO)** to recognize the importance of milk as a global food, and to celebrate the dairy sector.

1 June - Global Day of Parents

- **2026 Theme: Together for Parents**
- **In 2012, the General Assembly proclaimed** 1 June as the Global Day of Parents, to be observed annually in honour of parents throughout the world.

2 June - Italy Republic Day

- Italy Republic Day which is **also known as Festa della Repubblica**
- It honors the day **in 1946** when **Italians voted to abolish the monarchy system and establish a republic.**
- Capital: Rome
- Currency: Euro (€)b (EUR)
- To the north the **Alps separate Italy from** France, Switzerland, Austria, and Slovenia.
- Elsewhere Italy is **surrounded by the Mediterranean Sea**, in particular by the **Adriatic Sea** to the northeast,
- The **Ionian Sea** to the southeast,
- The **Tyrrhenian Sea** to the southwest, and the **Ligurian Sea** to the northwest.



3 June - World Bicycle Day

- The United Nations General Assembly declared 3rd June as International World Bicycle Day
- Theme: "Cycling for a Greener Future"
- **To recognize the uniqueness, longevity and versatility of the bicycle, which are affordable, environmentally friendly fit sustainable means of transportation.**

June 5 World Environment Day

- **2026 Theme – "Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future"**

- **In 2026, it is hosted by the Republic of Azerbaijan.**
- World Environment Day was **established in 1972 in Stockholm.**
- The **first celebration took place in 1973**
- **The 2026 campaign message is #NowForClimate**

June 5 International Day for the Fight against Illegal Unreported and Unregulated Fishing

- **In 2009 the FAO Conference** adopted the Agreement on Port State Measures to Prevent, Deter and Eliminate Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated Fishing.
- **Proclaimed** by the UN General Assembly in December **2017**
- **Celebrated for the first time** on **5 June 2018, with FAO as the lead** agency with FAO as the lead agency

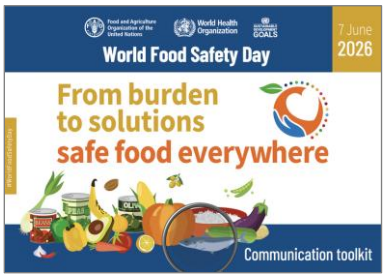
6 June Russian Language Day

- The birthdate of **Alexander Sergeyevich Pushkin**, who is considered by many to be the **greatest Russian poet**, as well as the **founder of modern Russian literature.**
- **A 2010 initiative by the UN's Department of Global Communications, establishing language days for each of the Organization's six official languages.**
- The six **official languages of the United Nations are Arabic, Chinese, English, French, Russian, and Spanish**.

6 June World Pest Day

- World Pest Day 2026 is observed globally to highlight the **importance of professional pest management in protecting public health, food safety, property, agriculture and the environment.**
- Day was established in 2017.
- **It was initiated by the Chinese Pest Control Association and supported by the Federation of Asian and Oceania Pest Managers' Association** (FAOPMA), the National Pest Management Association (NPMA) and the Confederation of European Pest Management Associations (CEPA).
- **The theme of World Pest Day 2026 is** "Defending Health Across Borders: The Global Power of Pest Management" with the tagline "Marking 10 Years of World Pest Day- United Around the Globe."

7 June – World Food Safety Day



- This year's theme: **"From burden to solutions – safe food everywhere"**.
- The slogan "Food safety, everyone's business"
- The World Health Organization **(WHO) and** the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations **(FAO) jointly facilitate** the observance of World Food Safety Day
- **First celebrated on June 7, 2019**, following its establishment by the United Nations General Assembly in December 2018

8 June - World Oceans Day



- **Theme - "REIMAGINE: Beyond the world we know, a new relationship with our ocean".**
- Global Action Theme – Strong Marine Protected Areas for Our Blue Planet
- It brings together the momentum of recent multi-year action themes – Catalyzing Ocean-Climate Action and Protecting at Least 30% of Lands, Waters, and Ocean by 2030 (30×30)
- The **concept of a 'World Oceans Day'** was **first proposed in 1992** at the Earth Summit in Rio de Janeiro.
- On 5 **December 2008**, the UN General Assembly **designated** 8 June as World Oceans Day.

8 June World Brain Tumor Day

- World Brain Tumor Day is observed annually on June 8
- A brain tumour is an unusual growth of tissue in the brain or its covering (meninges) that may disrupt proper brain function.
- Tumours are primarily based on where the tumour cells began and whether they may be cancerous (malignant) or not (benign).

9 June World Accreditation Day

- **Theme: "Innovation, Trust and Sustainability: The Power of Accreditation."**
- a global initiative **established by** International Laboratory Accreditation Cooperation **(ILAC)** and the International Accreditation Forum (**IAF**) to promote the value of accreditation.

9 June International Archives Day

- International Archives Day is celebrated globally on 9 **June to commemorate the founding of the International Council on Archives (ICA) in 1948 under the auspices of UNESCO.**
- In 2026, the global celebration is part of International Archives Week (June 8–12),
- **Theme** "#ArchivesForJustice: Rights, Memory & Futures".

10 June International Day for Dialogue among Civilizations

- On **7 June 2024 the General Assembly adopted resolution**, declaring 10 June the International Day for Dialogue among Civilizations.

11 June International Day of Play



- **THEME : Protect Play, Protect Childhood**
- In **March 2024, the United Nations General Assembly adopted a resolution** establishing 11 June as the International Day of Play to champion and protect this right.

12 June World Day Against Child Labour



- **2026 Theme: Red card to child labour: Fair play for children, decent work for adults**
- Child labour can be defined as any work that is unconstitutional for a child's age by physical or mental abilities.
- **In India**, its constitution explicitly **prohibits** minors **under the age of 14 from working in mines, factories, or dangerous occupations.**
- Similarly, the International Labour Organisation **(ILO) defines a child, under the age of 18**, as someone who should not engage in hazardous work.

12 June Russia Day

- June 12 is called the birthday of modern Russia.
- **Until 2002, Russia Day was referred to as the Day of Declaration on State Sovereignty of Russia**.
- Declaration on State Sovereignty of Russia was adopted on June 12, 1990
- It proclaimed the supremacy of the Constitution of the Russian Federation and its laws all over the country.

13 June International Albinism Awareness Day

- **THEME: Proudly in my skin — celebrating all skin tones**
- **UN General Assembly officially recognised** 13 June this day in **2014.**

What is albinism?

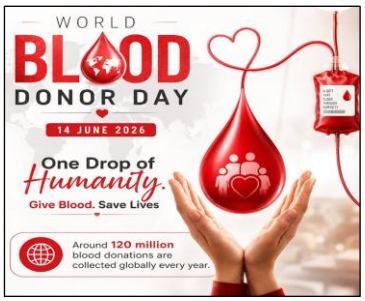
- Albinism is **a rare, non-contagious, genetically inherited** difference present at birth.
- Albinism results in a **lack of pigmentation (melanin)** in the hair, skin and eyes, causing vulnerability to the sun and bright light.
- There is no cure

9 June World Accreditation Day

- **Theme: "Innovation, Trust and Sustainability: The Power of Accreditation."**
- It is global initiative **established by** International Laboratory Accreditation Cooperation **(ILAC)** and the International Accreditation Forum (**IAF**) to promote the value of accreditation.

14 June World Blood Donor Day [WHO]

- **Theme: "One Drop of Humanity. Give Blood. Save Lives.",**
- The **first WBDD was held on 14 June 2004**.



- **Designation as** an **annual global event** by the fifty-eighth World Health Assembly **in 2005.**
- The date of **14 June is the birthday of Karl Landsteiner** (1868–1943), an Austrian biologist and physician, considered to be the **"founder" of modern blood transfusion**
- **Landsteiner discovered the ABO blood groups in 1901**

15 June - World Wind Day



- Every year on 15 June, the world unites to celebrate World Wind Day—a **day dedicated to discovering the power of wind and the transformative role it plays in reshaping global energy systems.**
- **Theme:** "Wind Energy: From Ambition to Acceleration."
- The history of Global Wind Day dates back to 2007, when it was **first organised by the European Wind Energy Association (EWEA).**
- It became a worldwide event **in 2009** with the support of the Global Wind Energy Council (GWEC).
- India will host the Global Wind Day 2026 Conference on 15 June 2026 in Goa.

16 June International Day of Family Remittances

- The International Day of Family Remittances (IDFR) is a universally-recognized observance **adopted by the United Nations General Assembly and celebrated every year on 16 June.**
- **THEME**: Remittances for Rural Resilience, Entrepreneurship and Employment

16 June World Sea Turtle Day

- **World Sea Turtle Day is celebrated globally on June 16 each year to honor these ancient marine creatures and raise awareness about their conservation.**
- This specific date commemorates the **birthday of Dr. Archie Carr,** widely celebrated as the "**father of sea turtle biology**" and the founder of the Sea Turtle Conservancy.

17th JUNE World Day to Combat Desertification and Drought

- **THEME** : Rangelands: Recognize. Respect. Restore.
- **In 2007, the UN General Assembly declared 2010-2020 the United Nations Decade for Deserts and the fight against Desertification** to mobilize global action to fight land degradation, led again by the UNCCD Secretariat.
- This year's event **aligns with the International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists,** helping to underscore the need to raise awareness, encourage responsible investment and strengthen policies that safeguard rangelands and pastoralist livelihoods.

17th June World Crocodile Day

- World Croc Day is held on June 17th every year.
- **There are 13 different crocodile species, including the Nile crocodile, the Cuban crocodile, and the saltwater crocodile.**
- The **saltwater crocodile is the largest crocodile** — and Earth's largest living reptile. Males can reach more than seven metres long and weigh up to 1,000 kilograms.

18 June Sustainable Gastronomy Day



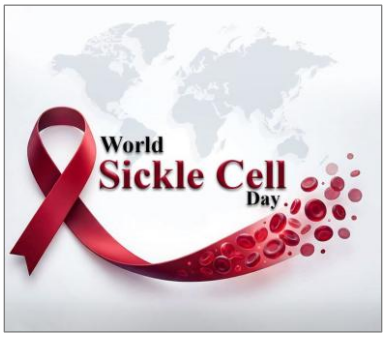
- The UN General Assembly adopted on 21 December 2016 its resolution and designated 18 June as an international observance, Sustainable Gastronomy Day.
- **The 2026 edition of Sustainable Gastronomy Week (16 - 22 June) will focus on the theme "Celebrating Food Heritage",**
- Launching the **UNESCO Creative Cities Network** , created in 2004 to share best practices and develop partnerships in 7 creative fields.
- **Gastronomy is sometimes called the art of food**.
- It can also refer to a style of cooking from a particular region.

- In other words, gastronomy often refers to local food and cuisine.
- **Lucknow has officially been declared a UNESCO Creative City of Gastronomy in 2025.**

18 June International Day for Countering Hate

- **THEME :The power of partnerships in countering speech**
- The UN Strategy and Plan of Action on Hate Speech defines **hate speech as communication that attacks or discriminates against individuals** or **groups based on identity factors like religion, ethnicity, or gender**, though a universal legal definition is still under discussion.

19 June - World Sickle Cell Awareness Day



- **World Sickle Cell Day** is an international awareness day commemorated every year on 19 June, to alert the global public about sickle cell disease.
- **Theme is** : Closing the Survival Gap: Equity in Sickle Cell Disease

About Sickle Cell Disease (SCD):

- It is an **inherited blood disorder**.
- It is marked by flawed **hemoglobin.**
- Hemoglobin is the molecule in **red blood cells (RBCs)** that carries oxygen to the tissues of the body.

How does it affect blood flow?

- Normally, RBCs are **disc-shaped** and flexible enough to move easily through the blood vessels.
- People with SCD have atypical hemoglobin molecules called **hemoglobin S,** which can distort RBCs into a sickle, or crescent, shape.
- These sickled RBCs do not bend or move easily and can block blood flow to the rest of the body.
- SCD interferes with the delivery of **oxygen to the tissues.**

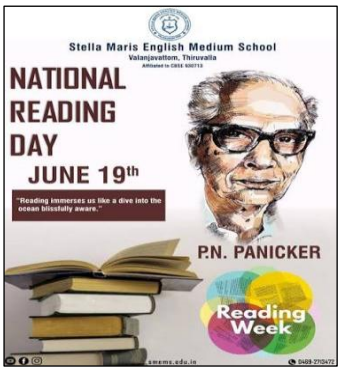
Treatments:

- A **bone marrow transplant (stem cell transplant**) can cure SCD.
- However, there are treatments that can help relieve symptoms, lessen complications, and prolong life.
- **Gene therapy is also being explored as another potential cure.**
- **The UK recently became the first country to** approve gene therapy treatment for SCD.

19 June International Day for the Elimination of Sexual Violence in Conflict

- **On 19 June 2015**, the United Nations General Assembly proclaimed 19 June of each year the International Day for the Elimination of Sexual Violence in Conflict.
- The date was chosen to commemorate the adoption on **19 June 2008** of Security Council resolution 1820 (2008).
- **THEME**: Conflict-Related Sexual Violence Against Children: Safeguarding Futures and Empowering Caregivers

19 June National Reading Day

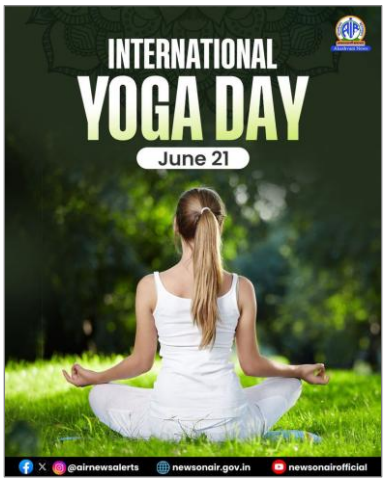


- The day is celebrated annually on this day to honour the **birth anniversary of Puthuvayil Narayana Panicker, the father of the Library Movement in Keralam**.
- Started as a Reading Day observance on June 19, 1996, by the Government of Keralam in association with the P N Panicker Foundation.
- **In 2017, Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched the National Reading Day and Reading Month celebrations** during his visit to Kochi giving national recognition to the Reading Day observance.

20 June World Refugee Day

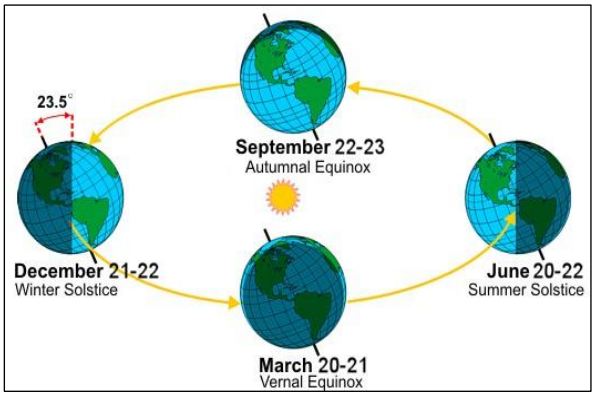
- **2026 Theme: Until Everyone Is Safe**
- Designated by the United Nations to honour refugees around the globe.
- World Refugee Day was held globally for the first time on **20 June 2001** to commemorate the **50th anniversary** of the **1951 Convention relating to the Status of Refugees.**
- It was originally known as **Africa Refugee Day,** before the United Nations General Assembly officially designated it as an international day **in December 2000.**

21 June International Day of Yoga



- **2026 Theme: Yoga for Healthy Ageing**
- Yoga is an ancient physical, mental and spiritual practice that originated in India.
- The word '**yoga' derives** from Sanskrit and means to join or to unite, symbolizing the union of body and consciousness.
- **Celebrated Since:** Officially recognised by UNGA resolution 69/131 on Dec 11, 2014.
- First celebrated globally on **June 21, 2015.**
- The Indian Navy organised a distinctive underwater yoga session at INS Satvahana to mark the International Day of Yoga 2026.
- As many as 40 submariners performed synchronised yoga postures in water.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi lead the nation in observing the 12th International Day of Yoga from Red Road in central Kolkata.

21 June International Day of the Celebration of the Solstice

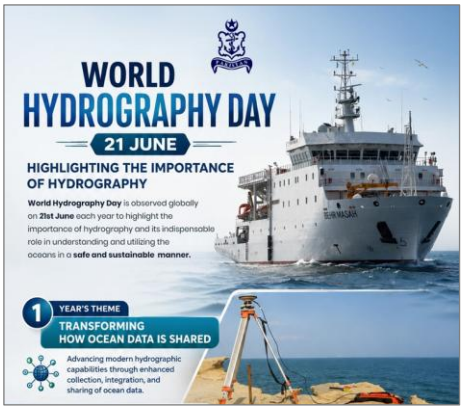


- **Solstice** is a **Latin word that means 'stalled sun'.**
- It is a natural **phenomenon that occurs twice every year,** once in the summer and again during winter, in each hemisphere of the earth - Summer and **Winter Solstice.**
- It is the **longest day and shortest night of the year in the Northern Hemisphere.**
- During this, **countries in the Northern Hemisphere are nearest to the Sun** and the Sun shines overhead on the **Tropic of Cancer (23.5° North).**
- During the solstice, **the Earth's axis — around which the planet spins, completing one turn each day** — is tilted in a way that the North Pole is tipped towards the sun and the South Pole is away from it.
- Typically, this imaginary axis passes right through the middle of the Earth from top to bottom and is always tilted at 23.5 degrees with respect to the sun.

What is the Equinox?

- Twice each year, **during the equinoxes ("equal nights"),** Earth's axis is not pointed toward our Sun, but is perpendicular to the incoming rays.
- It results in a **"nearly" equal amount of daylight and darkness** at all latitudes.
- The vernal or spring equinox occurs in the northern hemisphere **on March 20 or 21.**
- September 22 or 23 marks the northern hemisphere **autumnal or Spring equinox.**

21 June World Hydrography Day



- Celebrated on 21 June, World Hydrography Day highlights activities around the world and how they contribute to improved knowledge of the seas and oceans.
- Theme for 2026 is "Transforming how ocean data is shared."

22 June World Camel Day

- World Camel Day is observed every year on 22 June to celebrate the camel and to raise awareness of its importance to food security, climate resilience and the livelihoods of pastoral communities.
- The day was founded in 2009 by Pakistani camel scientist Dr Abdul Raziq Kakar,
- There are three main types of camel: the one-humped dromedary, the two-humped Bactrian, and the rare wild Bactrian camel of Mongolia and China.

22 June- World Rainforest Day



- **World Rainforest Day** is observed every year on June 22 to raise awareness about the importance of rainforests and the urgent need to protect them.
- **Theme:** The Forest Within You
- The day was first observed in **2017**, initiated by the Rainforest Partnership, a non-profit organization
- A rainforest is an **area densely populated** with **tall, mostly evergreen trees** and receives substantial rainfall.
- Rainforests are found on every continent except Antarctica, with the **largest being the Amazon in South America and the Congo in Africa.**

Constitutional Provisions:

- Forests are included in the **Concurrent List** in the (Seventh Schedule) of the Constitution of India.
- Through the **42nd Amendment Act**, 1976 Forests and Protection of Wild Animals and Birds were transferred from State to Concurrent List.
- **Article 51 A (g)** of the Constitution states that it shall be the **fundamental duty** of every citizen to protect and improve the natural environment including forests and Wildlife.
- **Article 48 A** in the **Directive Principles of State policy,** mandates that the State shall endeavor to protect and improve the environment and to safeguard the forests and wildlife of the country.

23 June - International Olympic Day



- The first Olympic Day was celebrated **on 23 June 1948**.
- In the **1978 edition of the Olympic Charter,** the IOC recommended for the first time that all NOCs organise an Olympic Day to promote the Olympic Movement
- The **Olympic Day Run** can be considered as the core activity of Olympic Day. **First launched in 1987,**

23 June International Widows' Day

- The United Nations **observes 23 June** as International Widows Day
- **since 2011**, to draw attention to the voices and experiences of widows and to galvanize the unique support that they need.

23 June United Nations Public Service Day

- IN **2002, the** General Assembly **designated 23 June as Public Service Day**
- **the theme** "Transforming Public Institutions: Advancing innovation, Participation, and Inclusion ".
- the United Nations established **the UN Public Service Awards** (UNPSA) programme in 2003, which was reviewed in 2016 to align with the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development.

June 24 Passport Seva Divas



- India celebrated the 14th Passport Seva Divas, marking the anniversary of the Passports Act of 1967.
- The day honors India's transition to a modern, digitalized, and citizen-centric passport issuance network

25th June Day of the Seafarer [IMO]

- On 25 June, the global maritime community comes together to celebrate **the Day of the Seafarer.**
- In 2010, the **International Maritime Organization (IMO),** designated 25 June as the International Day of the Seafarer
- Theme: “Carrying world trade. Carrying the risks”

25 June Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas

- June 25 observed annually **as “Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas”** to honor those who opposed and fought against the injustices **during the Emergency imposed by Prime Minister Indira Gandhi in 1975.**
- **Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas** will serve as a reminder of the time when the Constitution of India was trampled over.

- The Emergency ended **in 1977**



The Constitution stipulates three types of emergencies-

- National Emergency
- Constitutional Emergency
- Financial Emergency

NATIONAL EMERGENCY

- **National emergency** can be declared on the basis of war, external aggression or armed rebellion.
- The Constitution employs the expression **'proclamation of emergency'** to denote an emergency of this type.

Grounds of declaration:

- **Under Article 352**, the president can declare a national emergency when the security of India or a part of it is threatened **by war or external aggression or armed rebellion**.
- The President can declare a **national emergency** even before the **actual occurrence of war or armed rebellion or external aggression**
- When a national emergency is declared on the grounds of **'war' or 'external aggression',** it is known **as 'External Emergency'.** On the other hand, when it is declared on the grounds of **'armed rebellion',** it is known as **'Internal Emergency'.**
- This term 'armed rebellion' is inserted from the **44th amendment.** Before this term it was known as internal disturbance.

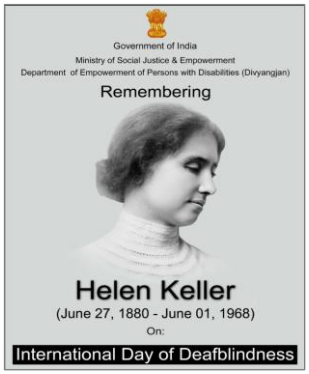
26 June International Day against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking

- **7 December 1987,** the General Assembly decided to observe 26 June as the International Day against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking
- **Theme :**World drug problem: persisting issues, new challenges, innovative responses

26 June United Nations International Day in Support of Victims of Torture

- **On 12 December 1997**, by resolution 52/149, the UN General Assembly proclaimed 26 June the United Nations International Day in Support of Victims of Torture,
- **THEME: Torture: a crime against humanity**

27 June International Day of Deafblindness



- The General Assembly adopted resolution, proclaiming 27 June of each year the **International Day of Deafblindness.**
- This day commemorates the birth of renowned author **Helen Keller (1880 – 1968),**
- On 16 June 2025, the United Nations officially recognised the 27th June as the International Day of Deafblindness.
- **Theme: "Connected by Touch: Breaking Barriers, Building Bridges."**

27 June Micro-Small and Medium-sized Enterprises Day

- **2026 Theme: Empowering MSMEs through Innovation and Sustainable Industrial Development**
- The United Nations General Assembly designated 27 June as "Micro-, Small, and Medium-sized Enterprises Day"
- The Vice President of India, Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan, will preside over the **'MSME Day 2026-Udyami Bharat'** event on 27th June 2026 at Dr. Ambedkar International Centre, New Delhi.



On the occasion, the Vice President will launch a suite of transformative digital platforms, portals, and e-books aimed at empowering MSMEs across India.

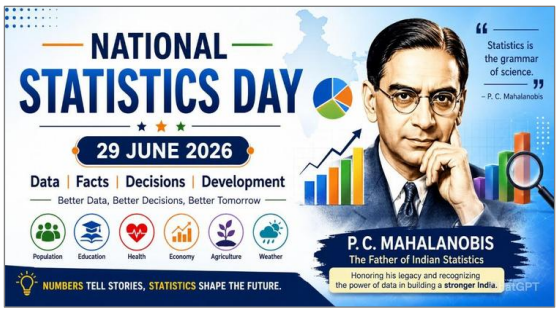
1. **PMEGP 2.0 Portal**
   - The newly developed portal introduces a range of citizen-centric, technology-driven features designed to simplify the entire lifecycle of a beneficiary with improved coordination among all stakeholders.
2. **SAMADHAAN 2.0 Portal**
   - The dedicated platform is designed to report and track outstanding dues owed to MSMEs by Central Ministries, Departments, Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSE) and other Government Agencies.
3. **PMS Portal**
   - The Procurement and Marketing Support (PMS) Portal is an integrated digital platform that connects Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs) with trade fairs and exhibitions.
4. **MSME Global Mart 2.0 Portal**
   - MSME Global Mart 2.0 is a next-generation national digital commerce and trade facilitation platform integrated with the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC) ecosystem.
5. **MSME Testing Portal**
   - The MSME Testing Portal is an initiative for the end-to-end digitisation of testing activities carried out by MSME Testing Centres and Testing Stations across the country.
   - To commemorate three years of the **PM Vishwakarma Scheme,** a Coffee Table Book showcasing the scheme's transformative impact through inspiring success stories of artisans will be launched.
   - **A Book on the Self-Reliant India (SRI) Fund** will also be released, highlighting its contribution to enterprise growth, employment generation, innovation, and women entrepreneurship under the Aatmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan.

28 June National Insurance Awareness Day

- National Insurance Day, observed on June 28 every year, aims to promote financial literacy and encourage individuals to secure their future through appropriate coverage.

29 June National Statistics Day

- The **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** will celebrate the **20th Statistics Day in Delhi.**
- To commemorate the **birth anniversary of Prof. Prasanta Chandra Mahalanobis,** a pioneering Indian statistician and planner.
- **Theme of Statistics Day 2026:** Unlocking the Potential of Administrative Data
- National Statistics Day was **first celebrated in 2007.**
- **World Statistics Day** is observed **by the United Nations every five years** on **20th October.**



About Prasanta Chandra Mahalanobis

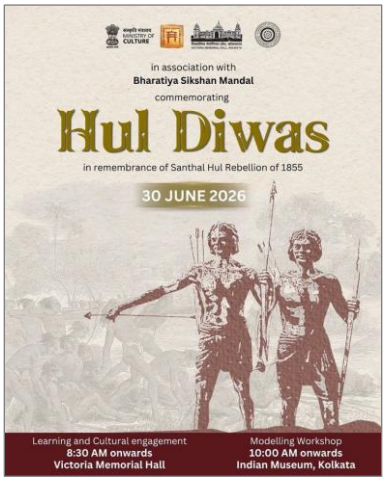
- **Birth:** 29 June 1893 Known as the **Father of Indian Statistics**.
- **Founder of** the Indian Statistical Institute **(ISI)** in 1931.
- **Established the National Sample Survey (NSS)** in 1950.
- Member of India's First Planning Commission, contributed to Five-Year Plans.
- **Awards:**
  - **Padma Vibhushan (1968)**
  - Officer of the Order of the British Empire (OBE, 1942)
  - Fellow of the Royal Society (FRS) Weldon Memorial Prize (1944)

29 June International Day of the Tropics

- **Tropics** - area **between the tropic of Cancer and the tropic of Capricorn**.
- Tropical locations are **typically warm** and experience little seasonal change in day-to-day temperature
- The inaugural **State of the Tropics Report** was launched on 29 June 2014

- Marking the anniversary of the report's launch the United Nations General Assembly **adopted resolution in 2016**, which declared that 29 June of each year is to be observed as the International Day of the Tropics.

30 June Hul Diwas



- Hul Divas is observed annually on June 30 in **memory of tribal leaders — Sidho and Kanhu Murmu** — who led the Santhal hul (rebellion) on **June 30, 1855**, at Bhognadih in Sahebganj district (now Jharkhand)
- Hul Diwas is observed to pay tribute to the sacrifices made by the Santhal people in their fight for freedom and justice against the British East India Company and Zamindari system.
- This rebellion, also known as Santhal Hul, which began on June 30, 1855, was a significant uprising against the oppressive policies of the British colonial rule and the exploitation by moneylenders.
- The Santhals, **led by Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu**, along with their **sisters Phulo and Jhano**, mobilised a large number of tribal youth to fight for their rights and against the injustices they faced.
- While the rebellion was ultimately suppressed, it led to the enactment of the Santhal Parganas Tenancy Act of 1876 and the Chotanagpur Tenancy Act of 1908, which aimed to safeguard tribal land rights and cultural autonomy.

30 June International Asteroid Day



- **Declared** in **December 2016** by the **United Nations General Assembly**
- Commemorates the **anniversary of the Tunguska impact over Siberia, Russian Federation, on 30 June 1908.**
- In 2024, the General Assembly declared **2029 the International Year of Asteroid Awareness and Planetary Defence**
- On 13 April 2029, **the asteroid 99942 Apophis will pass safely at a distance of about 32,000 kilometers above Earth's surface**

30 June International Day of Parliamentarism

- **Theme : Bring Human Rights into Focus**
- The International Day of Parliamentarism was **established in 2018** by a United Nations General Assembly Resolution.
- The day commemorates the **founding of the Inter-Parliamentary Union (IPU) on June 30, 1889.**

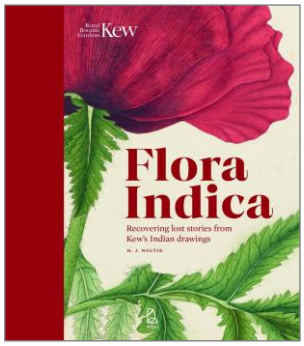
Books

Books (In Table)

Book	Author
Flora Indica: Recovering Lost Stories from Kew's Indian Drawings	Henry Noltie
Agatthiyar – The Unifier	Released by Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan , highlights the enduring legacy of Sage Agatthiyar
CBN@361 Degrees: Polymath	Authored - Shakamuri Srinivasa Prasad Translated into English by retired IAS officer K.V. Satyanarayana.
A Room in Bombay: A Memoir	Manil Suri Publication : HarperCollins
Sacred Unions and Other Stories is an anthology of five tales	Nalin Verma
The Second Orbit: Belief of a Man… Dreams of 1.4 Billion Hearts	Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla memoir
VIP Culture in India: Power, Privilege and the Distance from Democracy	Shri Nabam Rebia and co-author Shri Sandeep Kumar
My Last Autobiography	Author: Rajendra Banahatti

Book	Author
	Translator(english): Jerry Pinto
The Woman Who Wore a Hat	Author: Rajendra Banahatti Translator (english) : Shanta Gokhale
Titan: Inside India's Most Successful Consumer Brand	Vinay Kamath
Sanskritir Ratna Bhandar: Bhaowaiyar Itibritto (Bhawaiya: A Cultural Treasure and Its Historical Journey)	Dr. Jayanta Kumar Roy and Ms. Sangita Roy
Mixed Metaphors	Author : Daisy Rockwell Publisher : Bloomsbury

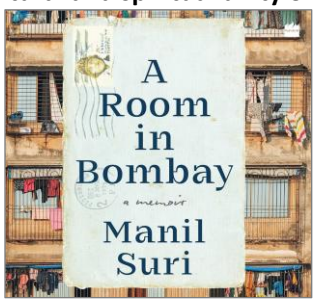
Henry Noltie's 'Flora Indica: Recovering Lost Stories from Kew's Indian Drawings'



- **A new book on the history of India's botanical art brings to light forgotten stories and rare botanical paintings from India.**
- Flora Indica: Recovering Lost Stories from Kew's Indian Drawings - **author and botanist Henry Noltie**
- Highlights the work of Indian artists commissioned by British botanists between 1790 and 1850.

Vice President releases book named Agatthiyar- The Unifier at Uprashtrapati Bhavan in New Delhi

- **Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan released the book "Agatthiyar – The Unifier" at the Vice President's House (Uprashtrapati Bhavan) in New Delhi.**
- The book highlights the enduring legacy of **Sage Agatthiyar and his role in promoting the cultural and spiritual unity of Bharat.**
- Agatthiyar (Agastya) is revered as one of the most prominent sages in Indian tradition.



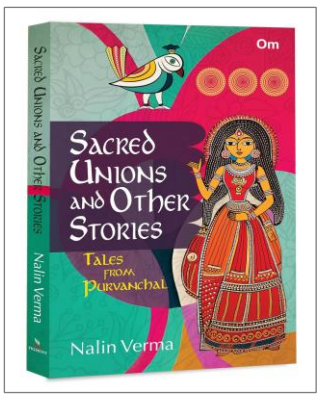
Manil Suri on his new book A Room in Bombay: A Memoir

- A Room in Bombay: A Memoir (HarperCollins India),
- **Novelist and mathematics professor, Manil Suri**

Chandrababu Naidu releases book on his leadership, 'CBN@361 Degrees', in Singapore

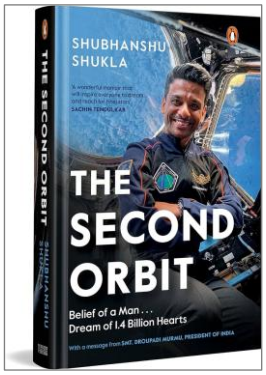
- **Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu unveiled the book 'CBN@361 Degrees: Polymath' at an event organised by the Kakatiya Cultural Association in Singapore.**
- The Chief Minister released the book and presented its first copies to India's High Commissioner to Singapore Shilpak Ambule.
- **Authored by senior journalist and Repatikosam Chief Editor Shakamuri Srinivasa Prasad**, the book has been translated into English by retired IAS officer K.V. Satyanarayana.
- The book highlighted several lesser-known aspects of Mr. Naidu's leadership and decision-making that had not been widely known outside official circles.

How Nalin Verma is preserving the soul of purvanchal through love, memory and folklore



- **Sacred Unions and Other Stories is an anthology of five tales,**
- **By** - Nalin Verma
- Preserves the fading cultural soul of the Purvanchal region (covering eastern Uttar Pradesh and rural Bihar) **by converting oral traditions, local myths, and grassroots memories into evocative English literature**
- his prominent works, includes - The Greatest Folk Tales of Bihar (2019), Lores of Love & Saint Gorakhnath (2025), and his latest fiction anthology.

Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh releases Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla's memoir in New Delhi



- Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh released the memoir of Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla, **'The Second Orbit: Belief of a Man… Dreams of 1.4 Billion Hearts**', in New Delhi.
- The book chronicles Group Captain Shukla's **journey from fighter pilot to astronaut** and his historic mission to the International Space Station as part of Axiom-4.
- The event also commemorated the **first anniversary of Group Captain Shukla's landmark Axiom-4 mission**, which was launched on 25 June last year.

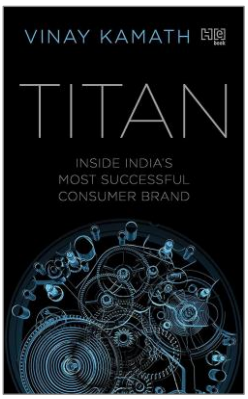
VP Radhakrishnan Releases Book "VIP Culture in India: Power, Privilege and the Distance from Democracy"

- The Vice-President of India, Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan, today released the book **"VIP Culture in India: Power, Privilege and the Distance from Democracy"** at Uprashtrapati Bhavan, New Delhi.
- authors, **former Rajya Sabha Member from Arunachal Pradesh Shri Nabam Rebia** and co-author **Shri Sandeep Kumar.**

Review of Marathi novellas 'My Last Autobiography' and 'The Woman Who Wore a Hat'

- Marathi novelist Rajendra Banahatti's **My Last Autobiography, translator (english)Jerry Pinto**
- Kamal Desai's 1975 novella The Woman Who Wore a Hat, **translated (english) by Shanta Gokhale**

Titan: Inside India's Most Successful Consumer Brand

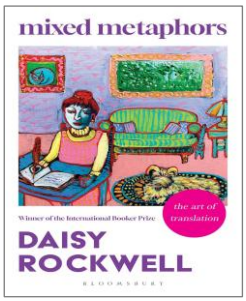


- Book: Titan: Inside India's Most Successful Consumer Brand
- Author : journalist **Vinay Kamath**
- chronicles the remarkable 30-year journey of the Tata Group's consumer goods giant Titan

VP Radhakrishnan releases book titled "Sanskritir Ratna Bhandar: Bhaowaiyar Itibritto" in New Delhi

- The Vice-President of India, Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan, today released the book **"Sanskritir Ratna Bhandar: Bhaowaiyar Itibritto" (Bhawaiya: A Cultural Treasure and Its Historical Journey**), authored by Member of Parliament (Lok Sabha) Dr. **Jayanta Kumar Roy and Ms. Sangita Roy**, at Uprashtrapati Bhavan, New Delhi.
- bringing the rich cultural heritage of the Koch Rajbanshi community and the Bhawaiya folk tradition to the mainstream.

Daisy Rockwell's Mixed Metaphors



- Book: **Mixed Metaphors**
- Author : Daisy Rockwell
- Publisher : Bloomsbury

Appointments

Appointments (In Table)-National

Person	Appointment
Tarun Kapoor	Advisor to the Prime Minister Narendra Modi
Justice Sheel Nagu, Justice Shree Chandrashekhar, Justice Sanjeev Sachdeva, Justice Arun Palli, Senior advocate Venkita Subramani Mohana	Supreme Court new judges
Ms. Nivedita Prakash Mehta, Prafulla Surendrakumar Khubalkar, Ashwin Damodar Bhobe, Rohit Wasudeo Joshi, Advait Mahendra Sethna, Pravin Sheshrao Patil	Appointed as Judges of the Bombay High Court
Justice Meenakshi Madan Rai sworn in as	Chief Justice of Patna High Court
Rajeev Krishna	Uttar Pradesh new Director General of Police
Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal	Tamil Nadu state DGP.

Person	Appointment
Sundarraj Pattilingam,	National Investigation Agency (NIA) inspector general (IG)
Lieutenant General Dhiraj Seth	Chief of the Army Staff
Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit	Vice-Chief of the Air Staff (VCAS)
Vice Admiral Vineet McCarty	20th Commander-in-Chief of the Andaman and Nicobar Command (ANC)
Air Marshal Tarun Chaudhry	Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Central Air Command
Seeram Sambasiva Rao	Kerala Excise Commissioner
Alakh N. Sharma	Chairman of a High-Level Technical Expert Committee on Labour Statistics
Saurabh Vijay	Chief Executive Officer of the IndiaAI Mission
Prashant Sitaram Lokhande	chairperson of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE)
Varun Bhardwaj	Secretary of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE)
Dr. Saibal Chattopadhyay	Chairperson National Statistical Commission
Prof. Shubhabrata Das Shri Satyendra Bahadur Singh Dr. Madhavan Mukund	Members of the National Statistical Commission
Y. Balaji Kiran	Chief Public Relations Officer (CPRO) of the South Coast Railway (SCoR) Zone
Kumar Shanker	Indraprastha Gas Ltd (IGL) Managing Director
Sanjay Lohiya	Director on the Central Board of Reserve Bank of India and State Bank of India
Brajesh Kumar Singh	Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer of the Canara Bank
Dinesh Pant and Girija Subramanian	Members (Distribution) of the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai).
Dr. Rahul Devraj	Director of the Nizam's Institute of Medical Sciences (NIMS)
Abhishek Trivedi	Executive Director In-charge of the Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited (HPCL) Visakh Refinery
Dr P L Gautam	National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) Expert Committee Co-Chair of the Committee.
Yumnam Khemchand Singh	President of the Lainingthou Sanamahi Temple Board
Ravi Prakash.	has assumed charge as the Chief Electoral Officer of Puducherry
Banwarilal Purohit	president of the Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan
Deepak Parekh	vice president of the Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan
Tushar Mehta	Solicitor General of India
Rajesh Pawar	Chairman of the senior men's selection committee in Mumbai Cricket Association
Sunil Agrawal	Resigned from Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) Chief Financial Officer (CFO)
Mahesh Dixit	Director, Intelligence Bureau (DIB)
Rajiv Kumar	Director, HDFC Bank
Justice P.S Narasimha	Member of the Supreme Court Collegium

Appointments (In Table) - International

Person	Appointment
Vinay Kumar	Ambassador of India to the Democratic Republic of São Tome and Principe
Lakshmanan Ramesh Babu	Ambassador of India to the Republic of Cote d'Ivoire
Dinesh Trivedi as	High Commissioner to Bangladesh
Rudra Gaurav Shresth	India's Ambassador to Turkiye
Khalilur Rahman	President of the UN General Assembly's 81st session
Neelkanth Mishra	India's next Executive Director at the World Bank
Maria Montserrat Alvarado	First Lay Woman to Vatican Department
Robert Abela	Prime Minister of Malta
Han Seong-sook	Prime Minister of South Korea
Nikol Pashinyan	Prime Minister of Armenia
Jay Clayton	director of the U.S. national intelligence.
Dan Jarvis	Britain Defence Minister
Shri Vivek Aggarwal	Vice-Presidency of the Financial Action Task Force (FATF)
Bimal N. Patel	Judge of the International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS)
Keir Starmer	Resign as UK Prime Minister

Appointments With Static

National

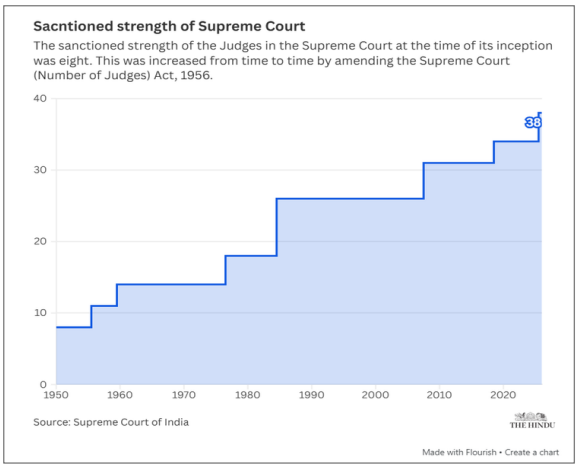


PM Modi's Advisor Tarun Kapoor Receives One-Year Extension Till 2027

- The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet has approved a one-year extension for Tarun Kapoor, a retired 1987-batch IAS officer, as Advisor to the Prime Minister Narendra Modi.
- **Extended tenure in the Prime Minister's Office takes effect on the 10th of this month for a further period of one-year.**

Supreme Court gets 5 new judges; strength to go up to 37

- Five new Judges were appointed to the Supreme Court, **which will now have 37 judges, one short of the upgraded sanctioned strength of 38.**
- Once they take oath and assume charge, the Supreme Court will formally have 37 judges.
- The Government last month promulgated an ordinance amending a law to increase the sanctioned strength of the apex court to 38 from 34, including the Chief Justice of India.
- **Chief Justice Surya Kant**



The appointees are:

- **Justice Sheel Nagu, Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana high court**
- Justice Shree Chandrashekhar, Chief Justice of the Bombay high court
- Justice Sanjeev Sachdeva, Chief Justice of the Madhya Pradesh high court
- **Justice Arun Palli, Chief Justice of the high court of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh**
- Senior advocate Venkita Subramani Mohana



Justice Meenakshi Madan Rai sworn in as Chief Justice of Patna High Court

- Justice Meenakshi Madan Rai was sworn-in on Friday (June 5) as Chief Justice of Patna High Court.
- **The oath of office was delivered by Governor Lt Gen Syed Ata Hasnain (Retd.)**
- The Supreme Court Collegium in its meeting held on 22nd May, 2026 had recommended appointment of Justice Rai as Chief Justice of Patna High Court consequent upon retirement of outgoing Chief Justice Sangam K Sahoo on June 4.

President Appoints Additional Judges as Permanent Judges of Bombay High Court

- In exercise of the powers conferred by the Constitution of India, **the President of India, after consultation with Chief Justice of India, is pleased to appoint the following 6 Additional Judges as Permanent Judges of the Bombay High Court:**

S. No.	Name of the Additional Judge	Details
	Ms. Nivedita Prakash Mehta	Appointed as Judges of the Bombay High Court
	Prafulla Surendrakumar Khubalkar	
	Ashwin Damodar Bhobe	
	Rohit Wasudeo Joshi	
	Advait Mahendra Sethna	
	Pravin Sheshrao Patil	

UP Govt appoints senior IPS officer Rajeev Krishna as new DGP



- The Uttar Pradesh government has appointed senior IPS officer Rajeev Krishna as the state's new Director General of Police. With this appointment, **he becomes the first permanent police chief of the state since 2022.**
  - The last regular DGP of Uttar Pradesh was Mukul Goel, who was removed from the post in 2022. Since then, the state has had four acting police chiefs.
- Mr. Krishna, a 1991-batch IPS officer, **had been serving as the acting DGP since May last year after succeeding Prashant Kumar.**
- He is also serving as Director General of the Vigilance Establishment.

Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal assumes charge as TN DGP

- Senior IPS officer Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal took charge as Tamil Nadu state DGP.
- **Aggarwal succeeds DGP Sandeep Rai Rathore** and will hold the post for couple of years.

Sundarraj Pattilingam Appointed NIA Inspector General



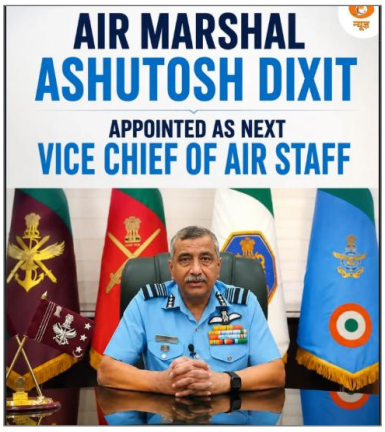
- **Indian Police Service (IPS) officer Sundarraj Pattilingam, who spearheaded the anti-Maoist operations in Chhattisgarh's Bastar, the erstwhile Left-wing insurgent stronghold, has been appointed National Investigation Agency (NIA) inspector general (IG)** nearly three months after the government declared India Maoist-free.
- Pattilingam, 46, a 2003 batch IPS officer**, served for 12 years in Bastar, where the banned Communist Party of India (Maoist)'s central guerrilla arm was headquartered**

Lt. Gen. Dhiraj Seth appointed next Army Chief



- **The Government has appointed Lieutenant General Dhiraj Seth,** PVSM, UYSM, AVSM, presently serving as the Vice Chief of the Army Staff, as the **next Chief of the Army Staff with effect from the afternoon of June 30, 2026.**
- The **present Chief of the Army Staff General Upendra Dwivedi**, PVSM, AVSM retires from service the same day.
- Lieutenant General Dhiraj Seth is an alumnus of the National Defence Academy, Khadakwasla, and was commissioned into the Armoured Corps in December 1986.
- The **next COAS has commanded the Sudarshan Chakra Corps, one of army's premier strike formations; served as General Officer Commanding, Delhi Area; and commanded South Western Command and Southern Command.**

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit to be next Vice-Chief of Air Staff

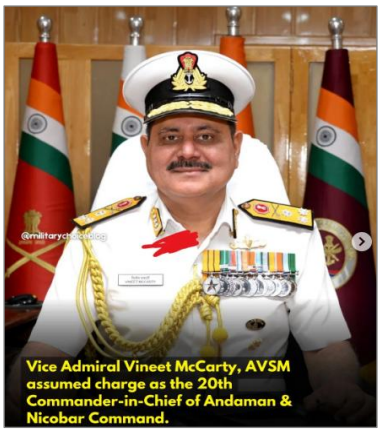


- Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit, a distinguished fighter pilot, has been appointed as the next Vice-Chief of the Air Staff (VCAS) and will assume office on July 1.
- **He succeeds Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor.**
- Commissioned into the fighter stream of the Indian Air Force on December 6, 1986,
- **A qualified flying instructor and an experimental test pilot**, he has accumulated more than 3,300 flying hours on **over 20 types of aircraft**, **including the Mirage-2000, MiG-21 and Jaguar fighter jets.**

Vice Admiral Vineet McCarty Takes Charge of ANC

- Vice Admiral Vineet McCarty assumed charge as the **20th Commander-in-Chief of the Andaman and Nicobar Command (ANC), India's only tri-service operational command, at Sri Vijaya Puram**.
- A **recipient of the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (AVSM),**
- Commissioned into the Indian Navy on July 1, 1989

- His command assignments at sea include INS Ajay, INS Khanjar and the stealth frigate INS Shivalik.
- In **2024, he became the tenth Commandant of the Indian Naval Academy.**
- He served as Deputy Chief of Integrated Defence Staff (Policy, Plans and Force Development) and later as Deputy Chief of Integrated Defence Staff (Doctrine, Organisation and Training).
- **Established in 2001, the Andaman and Nicobar Command is India's first and only integrated theatre command, bringing together personnel and assets from the Army, Navy and Air Force under a unified operational structure.**



Air Marshal Tarun Chaudhry Assumes The Appointment Of Air Officer Commanding-in-chief, Central Air Command

- Air Marshal Tarun Chaudhry, AVSM, VSM **assumed the appointment of Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Central Air Command on 01 Jun 2026.**
- He was commissioned into the Fighter stream of the Indian Air Force in December 1989.
- **Air Mshl Tarun Chaudhry succeeds Air Mshl Balakrishnan Manikantan** PVSM, AVSM, VM, who superannuated on 31 May 26,

Seeram Sambasiva Rao appointed as new Excise Commissioner

- The **Kerala government has appointed IAS officer Seeram Sambasiva Rao as the new Excise Commissioner.**
- Mr. Rao had served as the Officer on Special Duty to the former Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan.
- As a result, **Additional Director General of Police M.R. Ajith Kumar was removed from the post of Excise Commissioner.**

Govt appoints economist Professor Alakh N. Sharma as Chairman of High-Level Technical Expert Committee on Labour Statistics

- The **Government has appointed noted economist Professor Alakh N. Sharma as Chairman of a High-Level Technical Expert Committee on Labour Statistics.**
- The Committee has been constituted to strengthen and **periodically review labour market indicators** and assess the evolving structure of India's labour market.
- The Committee will focus on generating more granular, timely, and internationally comparable labour statistics.
- Professor Sharma is currently the Director of the Institute for Human Development and President of the Indian Society of Labour Economics.

UIDAI CEO Saurabh Vijay Takes Charge as CEO of IndiaAI Mission



- Saurabh Vijay CEO of the Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) **has assumed the charge as the Chief Executive Officer of the IndiaAI Mission.**
- Saurabh Vijay is the 1998-batch Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer of the Maharashtra cadre.

Before joining UIDAI, he served as the,

- Principal Secretary (Expenditure), Government of Maharashtra
- Senior administrative positions in public finance and governance
- CEO of UIDAI

What is the IndiaAI Mission?

- The IndiaAI Mission is the Government of India's flagship program which is aimed at to building a comprehensive artificial intelligence ecosystem in the country.

It was launched in the month of March 2024, the mission seeks to promote the,

- AI innovation
- Indigenous AI models
- AI infrastructure
- Talent development

- Research and development
- Responsible AI adoption
- The initiative is set to implemented by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY).

Centre names Lokhande Sitaram as CBSE chairperson, Varun Bhardwaj secretary



- The Centre appointed **senior IAS officer Prashant Sitaram Lokhande** as the new chairperson of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) **replacing Rahul Singh**, who has been transferred to the Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare as Additional Secretary.
- Named Varun Bhardwaj as the board's new Secretary, Bhardwaj succeeds Himanshu Gupta, He will serve in the position until September 19, 2027

National Statistical Commission

- Recently, the Government of India has appointed a new Chairperson and three Members to the National Statistical Commission.

The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) has approved the appointment of the Chairman and Members of the National Statistical Commission as follows:

- Dr. Saibal Chattopadhyay, Chairperson
- Prof. Shubhabrata Das, Member
- Shri Satyendra Bahadur Singh, Member
- Dr. Madhavan Mukund, Member

About National Statistical Commission

- It was set up in **2005** on the recommendations of Rangarajan Commission (2000).
- It **was established to serve as a nodal body for all core statistical activities of the country and also evolve, monitor and enforce statistical priorities and standards and to ensure statistical co-ordination.**

Composition

- It consists of a part-time Chairperson, four part-time Members having specialization and experience in areas of statistics,
- **CEO of NITI Aayog as an ex-officio Member**.
- The Chief Statistician of India is the Secretary of the Commission. (He is also the Secretary to the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation).

Balaji Kiran appointed CPRO of South Coast Railway Zone

- **A 2013-batch Indian Railway Traffic Service (IRTS) officer, Y. Balaji Kiran, has been appointed Chief Public Relations Officer (CPRO) of the newly created South Coast Railway (SCoR) Zone, headquartered in Visakhapatnam.**

Kumar Shanker appointed new MD of Indraprastha Gas Ltd

- State-owned Indraprastha Gas Ltd (IGL) announced Kumar Shanker's appointment as the Managing Director of the North India's largest city-gas distributor,
- **Succeeding Kamal Kishore Chatiwal**, who shall be repatriated back to parent Gas Authority of India Ltd (GAIL) .
- Prior to joining IGL, Mr. Shanker served at the Managing Director of Maharashtra Natural Gas Ltd (MNGL)

Government Nominates Sanjay Lohiya to RBI Central Board

- The Central government has nominated Sanjay Lohiya, Secretary, Department of Financial Services (DFS), Ministry of Finance, as a **Director on the Central Board of Reserve Bank of India and State Bank of India with immediate effect and until further orders.**
- Lohiya, who is an IAS Officer of 1994 batch (Assam Meghalaya cadre), nomination follows the superannuation of Nagaraju Maddirala on May 31, 2026, as DFS Secretary.
- **Lohiya took over as Secretary, Department of Financial Services**, with effect from June 1, 2026.

Brajesh Kumar Singh is MD & CEO of Canara Bank



- Canara Bank announced that Brajesh Kumar Singh has assumed charge as Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer of the bank.
- **As per the Government of India notification dated May 30, 2026, his appointment will be effective until April 30, 2029 (the date of his superannuation) or until further orders, whichever is earlier.**
- Mr. Singh **succeeds K. Satyanarayana Raju**, who completed his tenure as MD & CEO on December 31, 2025.
- He is also a Certified Associate of the Indian Institute of Bankers (CAIIB).

Government Appoints Dinesh Pant and Girija Subramanian as IRDAI Members

- The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) has **approved the appointment of Dinesh Pant, currently managing director of Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), as Member (Actuary), and Girija Subramanian, current chairman and managing director (CMD) of New India Assurance, as Member (Distribution) of the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai).**
- They will be **appointed for a period of five years** from the date of assuming charge of the post, or until attaining the age of 65 years, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.
- **Deepak Sood, Member (Non-Life), has been given an extension of two years** with effect from October 27, 2026, or until attaining the age of 65 years, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.
- **Rajay Kumar Sinha, Member (Finance and Investment), has also been granted a two-year extension** with effect from January 24, 2027, or until attaining the age of 65 years, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

Rahul Devraj appointed NIMS Hyderabad Director for three-year term

- Dr. Rahul Devraj has been appointed as the Director of the **Nizam's Institute of Medical Sciences (NIMS), Hyderabad**, for a term of three years.
- Dr. Devraj succeeds Dr. Nagari Bheerappa.

HPCL Visakh Refinery appoints Abhishek Trivedi as new Executive Director In-charge



- Abhishek Trivedi assumed charge as the **Executive Director In-charge of the Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited (HPCL) Visakh Refinery.**
- Originally commissioned in 1957 by Caltex Oil Refining India with a modest capacity of 0.675 million metric tonnes per annum (MMTPA), the Visakh Refinery holds the **distinction of being the first oil refinery on India's eastern coast.**

NBA Reconstitutes Agrobiodiversity Expert Committee, Dr P L Gautam Named Chair

- The **National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) has reconstituted the Expert Committee on Agrobiodiversity under Section 13(1) of the Biological Diversity Act, 2002.**
- The Committee has been reconstituted **for a period of one year** to provide expert guidance on the conservation, sustainable use, and access and benefit-sharing of agricultural biodiversity and related matters.
- **Padma Shri Dr P L Gautam** will serve as the Co-Chair of the Committee.

Centre Reappoints Tushar Mehta as Solicitor General



- The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet approved the re-appointment of **Senior Advocate Tushar Mehta** as the **Solicitor General of India** for a further term of three years on 20 June 2026.
- His fresh term begins on 1 July 2026, and it extends his tenure as the **Union Government's second-highest law officer.**
- The Solicitor General of India is the second-highest law officer in the Union Government after the Attorney General for India.

- The office is part of the Union's law officer system, which also includes Additional Solicitors General and other government counsel.
- Tushar Mehta first assumed office as Solicitor General in October 2018.

LIC CFO Sunil Agrawal resigns

- Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) Chief Financial Officer (CFO) Sunil Agrawal has resigned from the state-owned insurer after more than four years in the role, saying he is moving on to pursue better prospects.
- His resignation will take effect at the close of business on July 14, 2026.

Mahesh Dixit Appointed New Intelligence Bureau Chief



- Mahesh Dixit, **a 1993 batch Indian Police Service (IPS) officer of the Andhra Pradesh cadre** has been appointed as Director, Intelligence Bureau (DIB).
- He succeeds Tapan Kumar Deka, who held the post since 2022. His tenure ends on June 30.
- He was Deputy Director of IB in J&K from 2009-12 and from 2012-15, he was posted in Nagaland

Justice Narasimha to join SC Collegium as Justice Maheshwari retires

- Justice P S Narasimha is set to become a member of the **Supreme Court Collegium with the retirement of Justice J K Maheshwari**
- Being the fifth senior-most judge, Justice Narasimha will officially be a part of the Collegium until he retires on May 2, 2028.
- The Collegium will now comprise Chief **Justice Surya Kant, Justice Vikram Nath, Justice B V Nagarathna, Justice M M Sundresh and Justice P S Narasimha.**
- **Third Judges Case (1998):** The SC expanded the Collegium to include the CJI and the 4 most senior judges of the court after the CJI.
- Under the Collegium system, which came into existence in 1993 after a Supreme Court judgement, **five top judges of the apex court recommend the appointment, transfer and elevation of judges to the Supreme Court and 25 high courts.**

Constitutional Basis for Appointment of Judges

- **Article 124:** SC judges appointed by the President in consultation with the Chief Justice of India (CJI) and other judges.
- **Article 217:** HC judges appointed by the President in consultation with CJI, Governor, and HC Chief Justice.

HDFC Bank names ex-Finance Secretary Rajiv Kumar as part-time chairman



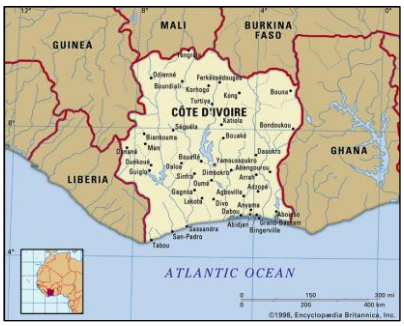
- The Board of Directors of HDFC Bank, approved the appointment of former Finance Secretary Rajiv Kumar as an Additional Director (Independent Director) of the Bank for a period of four years, with effect from June 30, 2026.
- He will replace interim part time chairman Keki Mistry who had to step in following the sudden resignation of former part time chairman Atanu Chakraborty

Short News

- **Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh took an oath as President of the Laininghou Sanamahi Temple Board** at a ceremony held at the Laininghou Sanamahi Temple Complex in Imphal.
- The **Mumbai Cricket Association (MCA) appointed former left-arm spinner Rajesh Pawar as chairman** of the senior men's selection committee, while retaining Omkar Salvi as head coach .
- **Senior IAS officer A.S.P.S Ravi Prakash has assumed charge as the Chief Electoral Officer of Puducherry.**
- Former Punjab governor Banwarilal Purohit has been elected as the president of the Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan and Finance industry veteran Deepak Parekh as its vice president.

International

India Appoints New Envoys to Côte d'Ivoire and São Tomé & Príncipe





- **Vinay Kumar, currently serving as Director in the Ministry of External Affairs, has been appointed as the next Ambassador of India to the Democratic Republic of São Tome and Principe.**
- **Capital**: São Tomé
- **Currency**: Dobra (STN)
- **Lakshmanan Ramesh Babu**, presently serving as Consul General of India in Atlanta, has been appointed as the next **Ambassador of India to the Republic of Cote d'Ivoire.**
- **Capital**: Yamoussoukro
- **Currency**: West African CFA franc (XOF)



India Appoints Dinesh Trivedi as High Commissioner to Bangladesh

- India appointed Dinesh Trivedi as High Commissioner to Bangladesh
- **He became the first political appointee to an ambassadorial post in South Asia in more than three decades.**
- The High Commissioner is the head of a diplomatic mission in a Commonwealth country

India Appoints Rudra Gaurav Shresth as Türkiye Envoy

- The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) appointed **senior diplomat Rudra Gaurav Shresth, currently India's Ambassador to Iran, as the country's next Ambassador to Turkiye**
- Shresth has been serving as India's Ambassador to the Islamic Republic of Iran since May 2023.
- **He has held assignments** in Indian missions in France, Mauritius, Afghanistan, Singapore and Bhutan and served as India's High Commissioner to Mozambique from 2016 to 2019.

Bangladesh Elected to Lead 81st UN General Assembly Session



- **Bangladeshi Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman was elected President of the UN General Assembly's 81st session**
- A total of 190 ballots were cast, with no invalid votes or abstentions.
- **The United Nations General Assembly (UNGA), established in 1945, is the primary policy-making body of the UN with equal representation for all states.** It meets annually to address global issues such as peace, climate change, and human rights.
- Formed after the **League of Nations' failure.**
- The **structure of the UN General Assembly (UNGA) consists of all 193 UN Member States, each holding one vote**
- **Presidency**: The presidency rotates annually among five geographic groups- African, Asian, Eastern European, Latin American and Caribbean, Western European and others.

Neelkanth Mishra Appointed World Bank Executive Director



- The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) has approved the appointment of economist Neelkanth Mishra as India's next Executive Director at the World Bank headquarters in Washington DC.**
- **Mishra will replace Parameswaran Iyer**, a retired IAS officer of the 1981 Uttar Pradesh cadre, who currently holds the post
- **Mishra's appointment will be for a period of three years** from the date he assumes charge, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

- The **ACC has also approved an extension in Iyer's tenure beyond June 19, 2026, until Mishra formally takes over the position**

Pope Appoints First Lay Woman to Vatican Department

- **Pope Leo XIV has appointed Mexican-American media executive Maria Montserrat Alvarado to head the Vatican's communications department**, making history as the first non-religious woman to serve as prefect of a dicastery of the Holy See.
- **Alvarado,** who currently serves as President and Chief Operating Officer of EWTN News, **will assume her new responsibilities on November 1 later this year, succeeding Paolo Ruffini**, who is retiring after leading the communications office since 2018.

Malta's Labour Party wins record fourth term in parliamentary election



- **Maltese Prime Minister Robert Abela's** governing center-left Labour Party won a historic, record-breaking fourth consecutive term.
- **Capital** Valletta
- **Currency** Euro (€) (EUR)

South Korea Nominates Han Seong-sook as Prime Minister

- **South Korean President Lee Jae Myung has chosen Han Seong-sook, the country's Minister for small and midsize businesses and startups, to be Prime Minister**
- Ms. Han would become South Korea's first female Prime Minister in 20 years.
- **Capital:** Seoul
- **Currency**: Korean Republic won

Pashinyan Claims Victory in Armenia Election



- **Armenian Prime Minister Nikol Pashinyan declared a "historic victory" after preliminary election results showed his governing Civil Contract party winning the parliamentary election with 49.82% of the vote.**
- **Capital**: Yerevan
- **Currency**: Dram

India has been elected to the Vice-Presidency of the Financial Action Task Force (FATF) for the first time.

- India has been elected to the **Vice-Presidency of the Financial Action Task Force (FATF) for the first time.**
- **Shri Vivek Aggarwal**, Secretary in the Ministry of Culture, will serve in this leadership role for the July 2026 to June 2027 term.
- It is an independent intergovernmental body that develops and promotes policies to protect the global financial system against money laundering and terrorist financing.



Origin

- It was established in **1989 during the G7 Summit in Paris in response to a growing concern about money laundering**.
- **In 2001, its mandate expanded to include terrorism financing.**
- **Headquarters: Paris, France.**
- Members: FATF members include 40 countries, including the United States, India, China, Saudi Arabia, Britain, Germany, France, and the EU as such.
- **India became a member of FATF in 2010.**
- **Democratic People's Republic of Korea (North Korea) , Iran , Myanmar are currently in Black list of FATF**

India's candidate, Professor Bimal N. Patel, has been elected as a Judge of the International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS) for the 2026–2035 term

- India's candidate, Professor Bimal N. Patel has been elected as a Judge of the International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS) for the 2026-2035 term.
- It is an **independent judicial body established by the 1982 United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea.**

Composition

- The Tribunal is composed of 21 independent members.
- Members elected by secret ballot by the States Parties to the Convention.
- Each State Party may nominate up to two candidates.
- The **seat of the Tribunal is in the City of Hamburg, Germany**.

Short News

- UK Prime Minister Keir Starmer has officially announced his resignation.
- President Donald Trump **nominated Jay Clayton,** the **U.S. a**ttorney for the Southern District of New York and a former Securities and Exchange Commission chairman, as **director of national intelligence.**
- **Former Army officer Dan Jarvis was named Britain's new Defence Minister,** hours after John Healey quit.

Awards

Awards - National

The Gallantry Awards



- **President Droupadi Murmu presented 51 Gallantry Awards** during Phase-I of the Defence Investiture Ceremony at Rashtrapati Bhavan.
- **Gallantry Awards are the highest state decorations instituted by the Government of India** to honor personnel of the Armed Forces, Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF), and State/UT Police forces.
- They recognize acts of raw courage, unparalleled bravery, and supreme self-sacrifice rendered in the line of duty.
- **The War-Time Trilogy (1950):** The first three gallantry awards—Param Vir Chakra, Maha Vir Chakra, and Vir Chakra—were instituted on January 26, 1950, with retrospective effect from August 15, 1947.
- **The Peace-Time Trilogy (1952):** The subsequent three awards were introduced on January 4, 1952, originally named Ashoka Chakra Class-I, Class-II, and Class-III.
- In **January 1967, these were officially renamed the Ashoka Chakra, Kirti Chakra, and Shaurya Chakra, respectively.**
- **Announcement Frequency**: These decorations are announced twice a year—first on Republic Day and subsequently on Independence Day.

2026 Phase-I Investiture Statistics:

- During the June 2026 ceremony, a total of 51 medals were pinned by the President, including several posthumous honors for supreme sacrifice:
- **Kirti Chakra:** 07 awarded (5 to living personnel, 2 posthumously)
- **Vir Chakra:** 15 awarded (12 to living personnel, 3 posthumously)
- **Shaurya Chakra**: 29 awarded (28 to living personnel, 1 posthumously)

Order of precedence: The order of precedence of these awards is the Param Vir Chakra, the Ashoka Chakra, the Mahavir Chakra, the Kirti Chakra, the Vir Chakra and the Shaurya Chakra.

- These awards are divided into two main categories based on whether the act of bravery occurs in the presence of the enemy or in peacetime situations.
- **Wartime Gallantry Awards**: Param Vir Chakra, Maha Vir Chakra, and Vir Chakra
- **Peacetime Gallantry Awards**: Ashoka Chakra, Kirti Chakra, and Shaurya Chakra are awarded for courageous actions during peacetime..

17 Projects/ Initiatives selected for the National Awards for e-Governance 2026 across 7 Award categories

- National Awards for e-Governance (NAeG) are presented every year to recognize and promote excellence in implementation of e-Governance initiatives.
- **The 29th NAeG 2026 awardees in seven categories include the Gram Panchayats category, recognising deepening and widening of service delivery at grassroots level through digitisation.**
- **The following is the list of 10 Gold Awardees and 6 Silver Awardees of NAeG 2026:**

S. No	Name of the Project	Organisation Name
1.	Agri Stack	Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
2.	e-jagriti	Ministry of Consumer Affairs
3.	Mahakumbh 2025	Prayagraj Mela Authority, Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh
4.	Blood Bag Traceability and Citizen Interaction portal for promoting speedy, safe and voluntary blood donation	Kerala Development and Innovation Strategic Council (K-DISC)
5.	AI-enabled Clinical Decision Support system in eSanjeevani telemedicine service	Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
6.	District Court Case Management System (DCMS)	High Court of Kerala
7.	ICMR's Multistate Implementation Research Study on Integration of Screening and Management of Mental and Substance Use Disorders with other Non-Communicable Diseases (ICMR-MINDS)	Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)
8.	Security Product for Threat Intel Distribution and DNS Filtering Service	Space Application Centre-ISRO, Ahmedabad
9.	E Nagar Palika with cyber security	Urban Development and Housing Department M.P.
10.	Integrated Cyber Security framework for a resilient Digital Banking Ecosystem	Bank of Baroda
11.	E – Aarogya Dhamni – Transforming Healthcare through E - Governance	Health Department Zilla Parishad, Nandurbar, Maharashtra
12.	Pune 360	Pune Municipal Commission, Maharashtra
13.	Kadepur Gram Panchayat	Sangli District, Maharashtra
14.	Bijoy Nagar Gram Panchayat	West Tripura District, Tripura
15.	TRINETRA – AI based Video Surveillance system for Mahakal Rudrasagar Integrated Development Area (MRIDA) including Mahakaleshwar Temple	Mahakaleshwar Temple Trust, Samrat Vikramaditya Prashasnik Sankul Bhawan, Ujjain
16.	Panchayat Advancement Index - Data Driven Governance for Viksit Bharat	Ministry of Panchayati Raj

The following is the Jury Award of NAeG 2026:

S. No.	Name of the Project	Organisation Name
1	Real Time Precise Positioning Services through CORS Network	Survey of India

The seven categories for the NAeG 2026, are:

(i) Government Process Re-engineering by Use of Technology for Digital Transformation,

(ii) Innovation by Use of AI and Other New Age Technologies for Providing Citizen Centric Services,

(iii) Best e-Gov Practices/Innovation in Cyber Security,

(iv) District Level Initiatives in e-Governance,

(v) Grassroots Level Initiatives by Gram Panchayats or equivalent Traditional Local Bodies for Deepening/Widening of Service Delivery,

(vi) Replication and Scaling of Nationally Awarded and Mission-Mode e-Governance Projects by States/UTs/Districts,

(vii) Digital transformation by Use of Data Analytics in Digital Platforms by Central Ministries/States/UTs.

5. **The NAeG Awards, 2026 consist of:**

- (i) Trophy, (ii) Certificate and (iii) an incentive of Rs 10 lakh for Gold Awardees and Rs 5 lakh for Silver Awardees to be awarded to Central Ministry/Department/State/UT/ District/Organisation/Gram Panchayat for being utilised for implementation of project/programme or bridging resources gaps in any area of public welfare.
- **The awards ceremony will be held during the 29th National Conference on e-Governance in Jaipur, Rajasthan.**

Sangeet Natak Akademi announces annual awards and fellowships

- **The Sangeet Natak Akademi selected seven eminent personalities in the field of performing arts as Akademi Fellows (Akademi Ratna) and awarded 108 artistes from the fields of music, dance and other performing arts for the year 2024-25.**
- The Akademi is the National Academy of Music, Dance and Drama is India's apex national body for the performing arts.
- **Established in 1953** and functioning under the Ministry of Culture, it is dedicated to preserving, promoting, and documenting the diverse intangible cultural heritage of India.
- **The fellowship of the Akademi is a most prestigious and rare honour, which is restricted to 40 at any given time.**

The General Council also selected 108 artists from the field of Music, Dance, Theatre and others in performing arts for the Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards (Akademi Puraskar) for the years 2024 and 2025.

- The Fellows and Awardees so selected represent the nation as a whole, and belong to different States and Union Territories of India.
- Besides, these eminent artists cover the entire gamut of the performing art **forms expressed in the form of music, dance, drama, folk and tribal art, puppetry, and allied theatre art forms, etc,**

The General Council of the Akademi has also selected 106 young artists for Sangeet Natak Akademi, Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar for the years 2024 and 2025.

- The Akademi Awards have been conferred since 1952.
- **The award of Akademi Fellow carries** a purse money of ₹3,00,000(Rupees three lakh only)
- while the **Akademi Award carries a purse money of ₹1,00,000** (Rupees one lakh only), besides a Tamrapatra and Angavastram.
- The **Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar** carries a prize money of ₹25,000 (Rupees twenty-five thousand only) besides a Tamrapatra and an Angavastram.
- The Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship and Awards will be conferred by the President of India in a special investiture ceremony.

Uttar Pradesh Sangeet Natak Akademi Honors 51 Artistes at SNA Samman Ceremony 2026

- The **Uttar Pradesh Sangeet Natak Akademi (SNA) Samman Ceremony 2026 held at Gandhi Auditorium of Jan Bhavan.**
- The event witnessed the felicitation of 51 distinguished artistes selected for the years 2021, 2022, 2023, and 2024 for their exceptional contributions to music, dance, theatre, and folk arts.
- The Uttar Pradesh Sangeet Natak Akademi has preserved more than 5,500 hours of rare audio-video recordings documenting the state's folk music and theatre traditions

The total of 51 artistes were felicitated for their outstanding contributions to the,

- Classical Music
- Folk Music

- Dance
- Theatre
- Traditional Folk Arts

Among those present were the,

- Prof. Jayant Khot, Chairman, UP Sangeet Natak Akademi
- Vibha Singh, Vice-Chairperson
- Sanjay Kumar Singh, Special Secretary (Culture)
- Dr. Shobhit Kumar Nahar, Director of the Akademi
- The Sangeet Natak Akademi was established in 1953 as India's national academy for music, dance and drama.
- The Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards are among the highest national honours in the field of performing arts in India.

Odisha Selected for PM Surya Ghar Excellence Awards



- Odisha has **emerged as a national leader in solar energy adoption and sustainable development by securing the prestigious PM Surya Ghar Excellence Awards for its performance during the 'Month of Solar' campaign last month.**
- The Month of Solar campaign was held in May 2026.
- The **campaign included applications for solar systems, solar installations, and inspections by distribution companies, commonly called DISCOMs.**
- **Odisha1st Position: Ranked first among states with a medium number of consumers across three distinct categories:**
  - Highest number of consumer applications.
  - Highest rooftop solar installations.
  - Highest DISCOM inspections/verifications.
- **3rd Position**: Earned third place in the "Maximum Vendor Registrations" category.
- **Chhattisgarh2nd Position**: Secured second place nationally in the "Solar Campaign of the Month – Highest Vendor Registration" category
- **PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana is a central government scheme for rooftop solar power generation in India.**
- The scheme aims to expand household-level solar adoption through installation-linked support and consumer participation.

Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari Initiative

- **Bidar district of Karnataka has emerged as a winner of the Centre's Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari Award given to top performing districts under the campaign, Jal Shakti Abhiyan: Catch the Rain**.
- It was **launched in 2024.**
- **Aim**: The initiative aims to enhance water recharge through rainwater harvesting/aquifer recharge/borewell recharge/ recharge shafts etc.
- **Objective**: To ensure that every drop of water is conserved through collective efforts, following a whole-of-society and whole-of-government approach.
- It is designed to foster active participation from all stakeholders, including government agencies, local communities, industries, NGOs and resident welfare associations.

J&K Bank Wins Finacle Gold Award for AI Platform

- J&K Bank won the Gold Award at the Finacle Innovation Awards 2026 in Mumbai.
- **The award was given in the category "Modern Technologies-led Innovation – Data Insights & Analytics Platform" for the bank's cloud-based enterprise data and analytics ecosystem.**
- Finacle Innovation Awards are organised by Infosys Finacle, which provides digital banking solutions to financial institutions.

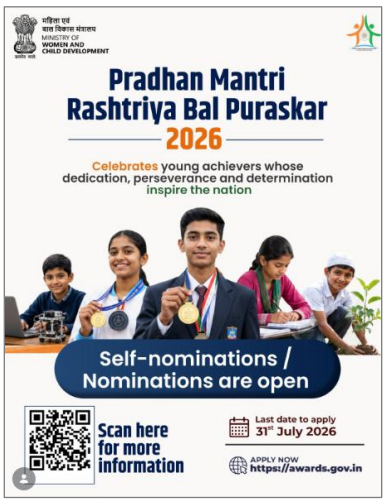
- The 2026 edition was held under the theme "Recomposing Banking, Playbook for the Next Phase of Banking Transformation".

Prime Minister Narendra Modi sets record as India's longest serving elected Prime Minister



- Prime Minister Narendra Modi has become the longest-serving elected Prime Minister of India 11th June 2026.
- **Mr Modi took the oath of office on 26th May 2014.**
- **He has surpassed the record of Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, who first took the oath as an elected Prime Minister on 13th May 1952 and served until 27th May 1964.**
- Pandit Nehru's tenure as an elected Prime Minister amounted to four thousand 398 days.
- From 26th May 2014 to today, 10th June 2026, Prime Minister Modi's continuous tenure is now four thousand 399 days, **making him the longest-serving elected Prime Minister in India's history.**

Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar



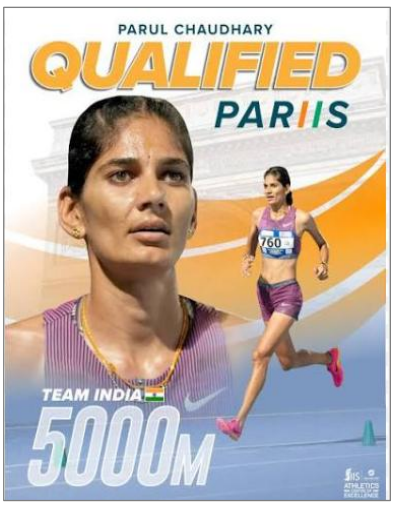
- **The Ministry of Women and Child Development** has invited nominations for the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar (PMRBP) 2026.
- It is the **nation's highest civilian honour for children.**
- It is presented annually by the President of India on **Veer Bal Diwas.**
- Veer Bal Diwas is observed annually **on December 26 in memory of Sahibzada Zorawar Singh and Sahibzada Fateh Singh.**
- It recognises exceptional achievements in six distinct categories namely: **Bravery, Social Service, Environment, Sports, Art and Culture, Science and Technology.**

Eligibility for Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar

- **Citizenship: A child should be an Indian Citizen.**
- Age: A child above the **age of 5 years and not exceeding 18 years** (as of 31st July of respective year).
- The act/incident/achievement should have been within 2 years of the last date of receipt of application/nomination for the year of consideration.
- **The number of awards will be 25**, however, any relaxation to this maximum number may be permitted at the discretion of the National Selection Committee.

The inaugural Indian Athletics Awards

- Hosted by the Athletics Federation of India (AFI), the ceremony in New Delhi celebrated outstanding achievements from the 2025 season
- The event featured 10 categories, including Best Female Athlete, Best Coach, Best Technical Official, Best State Association and Lifetime Achievement Award.





The awardees:

- **Athlete of the Year (women): Parul Chaudhary; (Rs. 10,00,000)**
- **Athlete of the Year (men): Neeraj Chopra; (Rs. 10,00,000)**
- Emerging Athlete (women): Pooja (high jump); (Rs. 2,50,000)
- Emerging Athlete (men): Shahnavaz Khan (long jump); (Rs. 2,50,000)
- **Best Coach: Parvir Singh (throws);**

- Best Sponsor: Reliance Foundation;
- Lifetime achievement: P**.T. Usha, G.S. Randhawa, Bahadur Singh Chauhan, Anju Bobby George; (Rs. 5,00,000)**
- Best State for supporting athletes: Odisha;
- Best State association: Tamil Nadu;
- Best technical official: Dr. Kuldeep Singh.

J&K Police bags Institutional Performance Award for State Police in Passport Seva 2025-26

- The Jammu and Kashmir Police has been honoured with **the Institutional Performance Award for State Police in Passport Seva 2025-26,** earning the distinction for the second consecutive year.
- The award, presented, recognises J&K Police's outstanding contribution to **speedy passport verification, citizen-centric service delivery and good governance.**
- The J&K Police was conferred with the Institutional Performance Award for State Police during the Passport Seva Divas celebrations and Regional Passport Officers' Conference held from June 17 to 19 at Sushma Swaraj Bhavan in New Delhi.

T.N. School Education Department wins SKOCH Award 2026 for 3 educational initiatives

- The School Education Department has won the SKOCH Award 2026 for three initiatives **— VETRI Palligal, TN SPARK, and Tamil Nadu Model Schools.**
- The awards honour high-impact governance innovations that deliver measurable outcomes at scale.
- VETRI Palligal is the **State's flagship talent discovery and competitive exam support programme for government school students**.
- Under the **TN SPARK initiative, government school students are equipped with AI, robotics, coding, and digital skills required for the future economy.**
- The Tamil Nadu Model Schools provides a fully **state-funded residential academic support for high-potential government school students** aspiring to be placed in premier institutions

J&K Housing & Urban Development Department wins Gold and Silver SKOCH National Awards for digital governance initiatives

- The Housing & Urban Development Department (H&UDD) of Jammu and Kashmir has achieved a significant milestone in the field of digital governance by securing two prestigious **SKOCH National Awards, Gold and Silver, for its innovative and citizen-centric digital transformation initiatives** during the SKOCH Awards Ceremony held in New Delhi.

Short News

- In Manipur, Governor Ajay Kumar Bhalla presented the 7th Governor's Art Award to noted artist Yendrembam Ibochouba Singh in recognition of his contribution to the field of fine arts.
- Belagavi-based photojournalist Pundalik K. Badiger has been chosen for the Karnataka Chhaya Ratna Award.

Awards - International

Indian Teenagers Win Earth Prize 2026 for Plas-Stick



- A **group of Indian students, Vivaan Chhawchharia, Ariana Agarwal and Avyana Mehta, has won The Earth Prize 2026 for developing a low-cost method to pull microplastics out of water.**
- The Earth Prize is an international environmental competition for young innovators.
- The teens **designed a biodegradable material derived from tamarind seed powder that can bind to tiny plastic particles in contaminated water.**
- The innovation, known as Plas-Stick, showed promise for trapping microplastics that conventional filters often miss, without adding harmful chemicals to the water.
- The collected plastic is safely turned into small useful items like tiles or coasters so it can't return to nature.

Andhra Pradesh CNF wins $1.5-million Food Planet Prize 2026 in Sweden for natural farming push

- The **Andhra Pradesh Community Managed Natural Farming (APCNF) programme, implemented by Rythu Sadhikara Samstha,** has won the Food Planet Prize 2026, worth $1.5 million, **for leading one of the world's largest transitions to natural farming.**
- The award was presented in Bastad, Sweden.
- **The prize, given by the Curt Bergfors Foundation, recognises initiatives that could contribute to resilient, equitable and environmentally sustainable food systems within the next decade.**
- The other finalists, Conscious Kitchen of the United States, NoPalm Ingredients of the Netherlands and the Savanna Institute of the United States, each received $150,000.
- **APCNF** - Launched in 2016 by the government of Andhra Pradesh, APCNF is one of the world's largest community-led transitions to agroecology and natural farming.
  - The model is being replicated in 21 States and in countries such as Sri Lanka, Indonesia and Zambia.

Virginia Evans and Lyse Doucet win Women's Prize 2026



- **American novelist** Virginia Evans won the **Women's Prize 2026 for Fiction with : The Correspondent, bestseller that made her a literary star after seven unpublished novels.**
- **Canadian journalist** Lyse Doucet won the Women's Prize **for Nonfiction with : The Finest Hotel in Kabul: A People's History of Afghanistan.**
- Both prizes come with a GBP 30,000 ($40,000) purse and are open to female English-language writers from any country.

Sudarsan Pattnaik Becomes First Indian to Win Russia Grand Sand Master Cup 2026



- **The Russia Grand Sand Master Cup 2026 was awarded to Sudarsan Pattnaik during the II International Festival of Sand Sculpture which was held in Russia.**
- He became the first Indian to receive the award
- This festival brought together 12 leading sand sculptors from the different countries to showcase their creativity and the artistic skills.
- **Pattnaik's sculpture had focused on the theme of the Global Warming and environmental conservation.**

David Beckham to Receive Star on Hollywood Walk of Fame Ahead of FIFA World Cup 2026



- **The Hollywood Chamber of Commerce has announced that David Beckham will receive a star on the Hollywood Walk of Fame.**
- This is another major achievement in Beckham's successful football career.
- The honour comes only a few months after he received a knighthood from King Charles III.
- **Beckham will receive the star in Los Angeles on 12 June 2026.**
- The date is significant because it coincides with the beginning of the 2026 FIFA World Cup, which is being hosted jointly by United States, Canada, and Mexico.

Messi Becomes First Footballer to Receive Prestigious Princess of Asturias Sports Award



- Lionel Messi got another feather on his cap as he was **felicitated with the Princess of Asturias Award for Sports – one of the most prestigious international accolades recognising careers of extraordinary significance and impact on society.**
- Messi, led Argentina to the FIFA World Cup 2022 title, became the first individual footballer to receive the award.

- The Princess of Asturias Award annually recognises distinguished individuals and institutions in fields such as the Arts, Literature, Social Sciences, Scientific and Technical Research, International Cooperation, Concord, Communication and Humanities, as well as Sports.
- Previous recipients in the Sports category include legends such as Rafael Nadal, Michael Schumacher, Serena Williams, and Eliud Kipchoge.

19th Mumbai International Film Festival concludes

- The 19th Mumbai International Film Festival (MIFF 2026) witnessed a landmark moment for independent filmmakers today as the 2nd Edition of Waves Doc Bazaar concluded its highly anticipated awards ceremony.
- The biennial festival of documentaries, short fiction, animation and AI cinema began on 15 June.
- Instituted by premier industry stalwarts including Prasad Labs, the Indian Institute of Creative Technologies (IICT), Reborn India Films, and the National Film Development Corporation (NFDC),
- **Prasad Labs Awards** : the Prasad Lab Post Production Award (offering free 4K DI services for up to 50 hours at Prasad Labs, Chennai) to filmmaker Karishma Rao for her documentary film '**On a Good Note'**
- **The Prasad Lab Post Production Award** (offering a 50% discount on DI services for up to 50 hours) to filmmaker Indrajeet More for the feature documentary film **'It takes a village'**
- **The IICT Post-Production Award** (offering a 50% discount on 50 hours of 4K DI)
  - to filmmakers **Nandan Saxena and Kavita Bahl for their documentary film 'Adieu Dilli'**
  - filmmaker Saanya Anand for her documentary film '**Do Chaar Din'**
- **The Reborn India Film Distribution Award** (ensuring a theatrical release across 10 screens with distribution support valued at ₹7 lakh) to filmmaker Karishma Rao for her documentary **film 'On a Good Note'**
- **The NFDC Cash Grant of ₹1 lakh to filmmaker**
  - **Ashok Meena** for the project '**Kunchok and His Many Moons'**
  - Madhurima Maiti for the **project 'The Girl Beneath The Sun'**
  - Asmita Pal for the project '**Tukro Tukro Prithbi'**

19th Mumbai International Film Festival : Polish documentary 'Silver' wins Golden Conch

- The festival's highest honour, **the Golden Conch for Best International Documentary Film**, was awarded to the Polish documentary **Silver.**
- While Iranian short fiction film **Under The Snow** and German animation **Maya's Song** won the Silver Conch awards in the **international short fiction and animation categories**, respectively.
- In the national competition, **Armstrong from Angaalamman Temple Street** won **the Silver Conch for Best Animation Film.**
- **Small Clouds** was adjudged Best Indian Short Fiction Film, and Waai secured the Best Indian Documentary Film award.
- Other major honours included the FIPRESCI International Critics Prize for The Hug of Emptiness, the IDPA Award for Best Student Film for The Old Bull Knows, or Once Knew,

CATEGORY	AWARD	FILM / WINNER	COUNTRY / DETAILS
International Documentary	Golden Conch (Best International Documentary Film)	*Silver*	Polish documentary
International Short Fiction	Silver Conch	*Under The Snow*	Iranian short fiction film
International Animation	Silver Conch	*Maya's Song*	German animation
National Animation	Silver Conch (Best Animation Film)	*Armstrong from Angaalamman Temple Street*	India
National Short Fiction	Best Indian Short Fiction Film	*Small Clouds*	India
National Documentary	Best Indian Documentary Film	*Waai*	India
Critics Award	FIPRESCI International Critics Prize	*The Hug of Emptiness*	—
Student Film Award	IDPA Award (Best Student Film)	*The Old Bull Knows, or Once Knew*	—
Debut Director	Dadasaheb Phalke Chitranagari Award (Best Debut Director)	Pooja Tolani for *Raaza*	—

- The **Dadasaheb Phalke Chitranagari Award for Best Debut Director**: **Pooja Tolani for Raaza.**

Six youth-led startups win Youth Co-Lab National Innovation Challenge 2026

- Six youth-led startups from across India have been recognized as winners of the 8th edition of the Youth Co:Lab National Innovation Challenge 2026 for developing innovative solutions that advance sustainability through circular economy innovations, sustainable textiles and fashion, and sustainable food systems and water conservation.
- Co-led by **the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) India and Citi Foundation**, in partnership with **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM), and implemented by T-Hub Foundation,**

The participating startups worked across three thematic areas:

- **Sustainable Textiles and Fashion**
- **Circular Economy Innovations**
- **Sustainable Food Systems and Water Conservation**

- The **three winning startups** received seed grant support of **₹3,50,000 each**, along with capacity-building opportunities and ecosystem access.
- **The three runners-up** were awarded **₹2,20,000 each** in recognition of their promising contributions and potential for scale.

About Youth Co:Lab

- Co-created in **2017** by the **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) and the Citi Foundation,**
- Youth Co:Lab aims to establish a common agenda for countries in the Asia-Pacific region **to empower and invest in youth so that they can accelerate the implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** through leadership, social innovation, and entrepreneurship

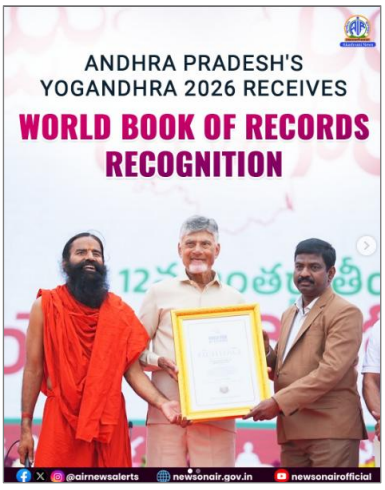
India sets record with 7 schools representation on World's Best School 2026 list

- India had **seven schools shortlisted for the World's Best School Prizes 2026** on 25 June 2026.
- The shortlist placed India at the top among all countries for the **highest number of schools selected in a single year** since the awards began in 2022.
- The World's Best School Prizes are global awards founded by T4 Education.
- The 2026 shortlist included schools **from Pune, Anantnag, Noida, Bengaluru, and Lucknow**. The awards recognise schools from different education systems and regions across the world.
- The awards cover five categories: **Innovation, Community Collaboration, Environmental Action, Supporting Healthy Lives, and Overcoming Adversity.**
- An expert Judging Academy selects the final winners, and the 2026 winners are scheduled for announcement in November 2026.

DMRC Wins UITP Achievement Award for Operational Excellence

- **The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC)** has been honoured with the Achievement Award in the Operational Excellence category by UITP, the International Association of Public Transport.
- In recognition of the DMRC's excellence in advancing sustainable urban transport, **the award celebrates DMRC's smart door-to-door travel service for commuters.**
- The service is accessible through **the DMRC Sarthi App, an AI-powered integrated platform that bridges the gap between metro and first/last-mile transport**
- The award was presented during the UITP Awards Ceremony in Brussels

AndhraPradesh's flagship mass yoga initiative, Yogandhra 2026, receives international recognition from the World Book of Records



- Andhra Pradesh's flagship mass yoga initiative, Yogandhra 2026, has received international recognition from the World Book of Records for its **large-scale public participation and successful promotion of yoga across the state.**
- The state had set a target of involving **1.05 crore yoga enthusiasts under Yogandhra 2026,** but participation surpassed expectations, with more than **1.07 crore people registering, marking a major milestone**.

Andaman Islands Set Guinness Record for Underwater Human Tower



- **The Andaman and Nicobar Islands set a Guinness World Record for the "Tallest Human Stack Underwater" at the Lighthouse dive-site on Swaraj Dweep, also known as Havelock Island.**
- The underwater formation used 14 scuba divers and reached a height of 22.3 metres.
- The human stack remained stable underwater for three minutes.
- This **record was the second Guinness World Record** achieved by the Andaman and Nicobar Islands in two consecutive days.

- **The first record was for the "Largest National Flag Unfurled Underwater"**

New Guinness World Record set by Ministry of Ayush for most viewers for YouTube Live Yoga Stream

- **The International Day of Yoga (IDY) 2026, the Ministry of Ayush created a new Guinness World Record for the Most Viewers for a YouTube Live Yoga Stream, with 4,35,831 viewers joining a special global online Yoga session streamed live through the official Ministry of Ayush YouTube channel.**
- The Ministry of Ayush recorded 4,35,831 verified viewers, **surpassing** the previous Guinness World **Record** of 2,46,252 viewers set in **2024**.

World Poha Day: Chef Vishnu Manohar sets world record by preparing 3,000 kg Tarri Poha



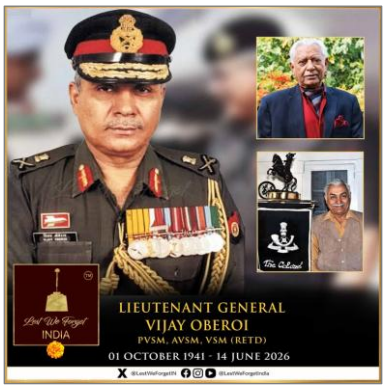
- World Poha Day (also known as Vishwa Poha Diwas) is celebrated **annually on June 7 to honor the cultural significance, health benefits, and massive popularity of India's favorite flattened rice breakfast**
- Nagpur marked the occasion with a grand celebration, as **internationally renowned chef Vishnu Manohar created a world record by preparing nearly 3,000 kilograms of the city's famous Tarri Poha**, giving the iconic dish global recognition.
- Tarri Poha, a popular Nagpur speciality, consists of flattened rice topped with a spicy **chickpea-based gravy known as "tarri"**.

Hyderabad man secures a place in Guinness World Record

- **A Hyderabad-based Goyal Veparala, head of an infotech company, has secured a place in the Guinness World Record for participating in the world's largest electronic keyboard** ensemble organised by the Hallel Music School.
- Hallel Music school is a music education organization based in Andhra Pradesh, India.
- More than 2,000 keyboard players from 22 countries participated and performed continuously for one hour.

Obituaries

Former Vice Chief of Army Staff passes away



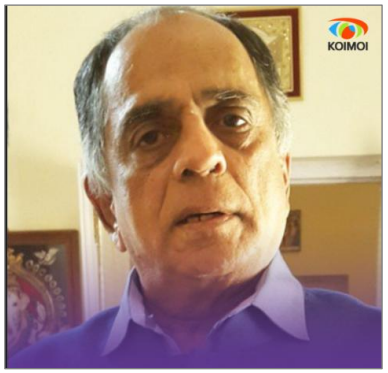
- Lieutenant General Vijay Oberoi, the former Vice Chief of Army Staff, passed away at the Chandigarh Army Hospital aged 84.
- Commissioned into the Maratha Light Infantry in June 1961.
- **Over the years, Lt Gen Oberoi held some of the Indian Army's most important appointments, including Director General Military Operations, General Officer Commanding-in-Chief Army Training Command, General Officer Commanding-in-Chief Western Command, and finally Vice Chief of Army Staff.**
- He superannuated on 30 September 2001.
- **He was the founder-president of War Wounded Foundation and Founder-Director of Centre for Land Warfare Studies (CLAWS).**

Former Lok Sabha Secretary General, constitution expert Subhash Kashyap passes away



- Subhash C Kashyap – constitutional expert, renowned author, former secretary general of the Lok Sabha, and an expert associated with crucial government committees – passed away at the age of 97.
- Born on May 10, 1929
- **His textbooks 'Our Constitution: An Introduction to India's Constitution and Constitutional Law' and 'Constitution of India: A Handbook for Students' – were among the favourites for students of political science and law,**
- **He had also been Honorary Constitutional Advisor to the Government of India on Panchayati Raj Laws and Institutions — a key initiative of the early 1990s.**

- In **2015**, **Kashyap was awarded the Padma Bhushan** by then President Pranab Mukherjee.
- He **served as Secretary General of the seventh, eighth and ninth Lok Sabha.**
- **He received the Motilal Nehru Award twice, and the Jawaharlal Nehru Fellowship of 1996-98**.
- He also received the **Vidur Samman**, the Rajiv Smriti Samman, and the Vidhi Seva Samman, among others.



Pahlaj Nihalani, producer and former CBFC chief, dies at 76

- Pahlaj Nihalani, the veteran producer and former chairperson of the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC), has passed away. He was 76.
- In January 2015, Nihalani was appointed as the chairperson of the Central Board of Film Certification.
- His tenure, which lasted until August 2017

Former Gujarat Minister and BJP MLA Yogesh Patel passes away at 79

- Gujarat's Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) MLA from Manjalpur Yogesh Patel died
- **Patel had represented the Manjalpur Assembly constituency since 2012 and was re-elected in 2017 and 2022.**
- Before shifting to Manjalpur, he was elected from the Raopura Assembly constituency in 2002 and 2007.

Gavri Devi, Rajasthani Mand Singer, Dies at 98

- **Renowned 'Maand' singer from Rajasthan, Gavri Devi, 98, passed away at her residence in Pali, Rajasthan**
- Gavri Devi remained active in the field of Maand singing for nearly eight decades
- The **most recalled song in the Maand style is the ever popular 'Kesariya Baalam'.**
- Gavri Devi was born in Koran village, Barmer district.
- **Her programmes were broadcast on Doordarshan and All India Radio**. During her lifetime, she received honors from the Jawahar Kala Kendra and Doordarshan, as well as the Veer Durgadas Rathore Lifetime Achievement Award.



Renowned singer Suman Kalyanpur passes away at 89

- **Veteran playback singer Suman Kalyanpur, a recipient of the Padma Bhushan and celebrated voice in Hindi and Marathi cinema, has died at the age of 89.**
- **Born** on 28th January 1937 in **Dhaka, Bangladesh,**
- She was honoured with the **Padma Bhushan in 2023** in recognition of her significant contribution to Indian music.
- **Some of her most famous songs include** "Aajkal Tere Mere Pyaar Ke Charche", "Na Na Karke Pyaar" and "Tumne Pukara Aur Hum Chale Aaye".



J. P. Das, Odia Litterateur and Former IAS Officer, Dies

- **Jagannath Prasad Das**, 90, passed away
- He was a former IAS officer and writer, **who was recognised with high literary honours such as the Saraswati Samman and Sarala Puraskar.**
- He earned widespread acclaim for his historical novel Desha Kala Patra.

Malayalam Poet A.C. Sreehari Passes Away at 56, Literary World Mourns the Loss

- **Poet, writer and academic A.C. Sreehari passed away**
- A noted voice in contemporary Malayalam literature, several of his poems are included in university curricula across Kerala.
- **Among his well-known works are Yuva** Kavithakkoottam (1999) and Kavithayude Noottandu (2001), which earned wide recognition among readers and scholars.

Demise of filmmaker Bharathiraja

- **Veteran Tamil filmmaker Bharathiraja passed away on June 10 at the age of 84,** leaving behind a monumental legacy in Indian cinema.

- Bharathiraja won six National Film Awards, four Filmfare Awards (South), six Tamil Nadu State Film Awards and a Nandi Award.

Marjane Satrapi Dies at 56



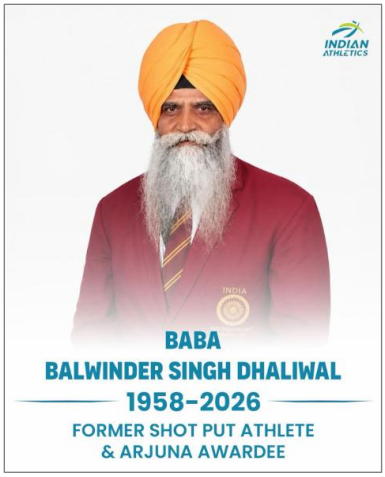
- **Marjane Satrapi, the visionary French-Iranian graphic novelist and filmmaker, has passed away at the age of 56.**
- Ms. Satrapi is best-known for her monochrome **autobiographical comic book and film "Persepolis," a coming-of-age tale set against the Islamic Revolution in her native Iran**
- **"Persepolis" won the Film Critics Grand Prix at the Cannes Festival in 2007** and the César Award for Best Adapted Screenplay in 2008, in addition to being nominated for Best Animated Feature at the 2008 Oscars.
- Ms. Satrapi was elected member of the French Academy of Fine Arts in 2024

Thailand princess Bajrakitiyabha dies at 47



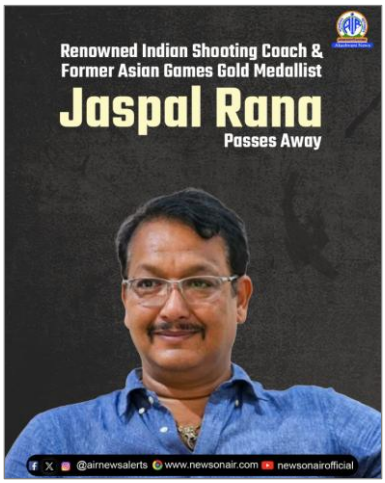
- Thailand's Princess Bajrakitiyabha Mahidol, who had been in a coma for more than three years, died.
- Born on December 7, 1978, Princess Bajrakitiyabha became the Doctor of Juridical Sciences after pursuing her studies at Cornell University in 2005.
- **She served as the Ambassador of Thailand to Austria from 2012 to 2014.**
- **Additionally, she was a General in the Thai Royal Army and the Chief of Staff of the King's Close Bodyguard Command.**
- She had also travelled to Gaya in the Indian city of Bihar on June 17, 2015.
- **In 2017, the late Princess was appointed as the Goodwill Ambassador of the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC)** — the UN's body assisting Member States in their fight against illicit drugs, organised crime, corruption, and terrorism.

Balwinder Dhaliwal, Asian Games Shot Putter, Dies at 67



- Balwinder Singh Dhaliwal was an Indian shot putter and Arjuna Award recipient who died in Chandigarh at the age of 67.
- **Dhaliwal was a 10-time national champion in shot put between 1981 and 1992.**
- He **won silver at the 1983 Asian Athletics Championships**, **gold at the 1985 Asian Athletics Championships**, and **bronze at the 1987 Asian Athletics Championships.**
- He set an Asian record of 18.71 metres in 1986 at an international meet in New Delhi.
- **Dhaliwal received the Maharaja Ranjit Singh Award in 1983 and the Arjuna Award in 1987.**
- His name was recorded in the Limca Book of Records in 1988.
- **He worked as an athletics coach at Punjab University from 2016 to 2024** and served as vice-president of the Chandigarh Athletics Association.

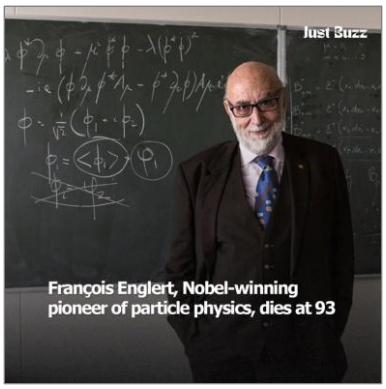
Jaspal Rana, former Asian Games gold medallist, passes away at 49



- Renowned Indian shooting coach and former Asian Games gold medallist Jaspal Rana, 49, passed away.
- **Until his death, Rana served as the high-performance coach for Indian pistol shooters.**
- Rana won numerous medals at international competitions, including the Asian Games and Commonwealth Games.
- **Jaspal Rana had a remarkable tally of 15 medals** — 9 gold, 4 silver and 2 bronze — **won across four editions of the Commonwealth Games** viz. 1994, 1998, 2002 and 2006.

- **He was conferred the Arjuna Award in 1994 and Padma Shri in 1997 for his contributions to Indian shooting.**
- Jaspal Rana was awarded Dronacharya Award in 2020.
- Jaspal Rana was credited for helping Manu Bhaker win double bronze medals at the 2024 Paris Olympics.

François Englert of Higgs boson fame passes away at 93



- The **Belgian physicist and Nobel laureate François Englert** passed away
- Englert's best known work paved the way for the **discovery of the Higgs boson in 2012.**
- The Higgs boson became popular as the "god particle" worldwide and settled a long-standing problem in physics
- He published a landmark paper titled '**Broken Symmetry and the Mass of Gauge Vector Mesons**'.
- It proposed what is now known as the Brout-Englert-Higgs (BEH) mechanism.

Prominent Lebanese turtle conservationist dies in Israeli strike: Who was Mona Khalil?

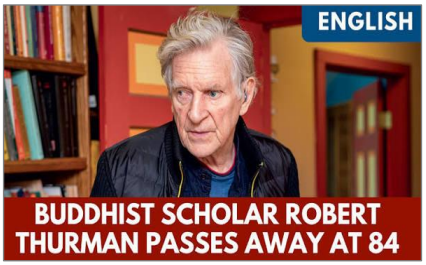


- Famous Lebanese conservationist and environmentalist Mona Khalil has succumbed to severe injuries after an Israeli strike hit her home.
- Khalil worked for the conservation of the endangered species of the green sea turtle, as well as the **vulnerable species** of the **loggerhead sea turtle**,

Poet P. Narayana Kurup is no more

- Malayalam poet and Padma Shri awardee P. Narayana Kurup dies at 92
- honoured with the Padma Shri in 2022
- Among his celebrated collections of poetry are Asthramalyam, Hamsadhwani and Nishagandhi.
- Mr. Kurup is a recipient of several prestigious awards including the Kerala Sahithya Akademi Award, the Odakkuzhal Award and the Kerala Panini Award.

Eminent Buddhist scholar, professor, and author, Mr. Robert A. F. Thurman passed away



- **Prime Minister of India expressed deep sorrow over the passing of the eminent Buddhist scholar, professor, and author, Mr. Robert A. F. Thurman.**
- Professor Robert A. F. Thurman (colloquially known as Bob Thurman) was an internationally acclaimed scholar-activist, charismatic speaker, and a **talented popularizer of the Buddha's teachings.**
- **He was the Jey Tsong Khapa Professor of Indo-Tibetan Buddhist Studies at Columbia University for 30 years** and holds the historic distinction of being the first Westerner to be ordained as a Tibetan Buddhist monk by His Holiness the Dalai Lama.
- **His intellectual search for enlightenment began during his time as a university student at Harvard University.**
- **He arrived in India**, where he first met His Holiness the Dalai Lama in 1962.
- After mastering the Tibetan language and deeply studying Buddhist philosophy, he took monastic vows and became the first Westerner ordained by the Dalai Lama.

National

Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana

- Recently, the **Parliament's Public Accounts Committee (PAC) pulled up the government over its flagship skilling programme the Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY).**
- It is a **skill development programme launched by the government of India in 2015.**
- It aims to empower the youth of India to engage in industry relevant skill training and secure a better livelihood.
- **Implementing Agency**: It is being implemented by the National Skill Development Corporations in partnership with multiple stakeholders.

Eligibility Criteria of Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana

- **Age Limit**: Candidates aged 14 to 35 years are generally eligible for PMKVY training programs.
- **Nationality**: Applicants must be Indian citizens to qualify for the scheme.
- **Educational Qualifications:** PMKVY caters to individuals from diverse educational backgrounds, including those without formal education.
- **Employment Status**: Priority is given to unemployed or underemployed individuals to enhance their employability.
- **Aadhar Card**: An Aadhar card is often a mandatory requirement for applying to PMKVY programs.

Features of Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana

- **Industry experts are consulted regularly in order to ensure that updated skill training is provided according to industry demands.**
- Short term training courses make it easy for people to acquire new skills within a short period of time.
- **Recognition to Prior Learning** is also acknowledged through certification without undergoing the same training.
- The **scheme also aims to provide placement assistance for all the candidates trained in a certain skill.**

Prime Minister Research Chair (PMRC) Scheme 2026



- **The Department of Higher Education under the Ministry of Education officially opened applications for the Prime Minister Research Chair (PMRC) Scheme 2026.**
- The PMRC Scheme is a prestigious national talent-repatriation and research architecture.
- It **establishes a direct pathway for top-tier researchers of Indian origin working in globally renowned foreign universities, private laboratories, and tech industries to take up high-level research positions within premium Indian institutions.**
- **Ministry**: The scheme is conceptualized, funded, and administered by the Department of Higher Education, Ministry of Education (MoE), Government of India.

Three Tiers of Engagement:

- The program categorizes incoming international professionals into three age and career-specific tracks:
- **Young Research Fellows**: Geared toward early-career scientists and postdoctoral scholars ready to seed innovative projects.
- **Senior Research Fellows**: Aimed at mid-career researchers and industry experts possessing deep field expertise.
- **Research Chairs**: Reserved for internationally recognized academic leaders, lab heads, and global technology pioneers.

Incoming research proposals must strictly align with thirteen core priority sectors crucial to India's developmental and security future.

Strict Institutional Eligibility

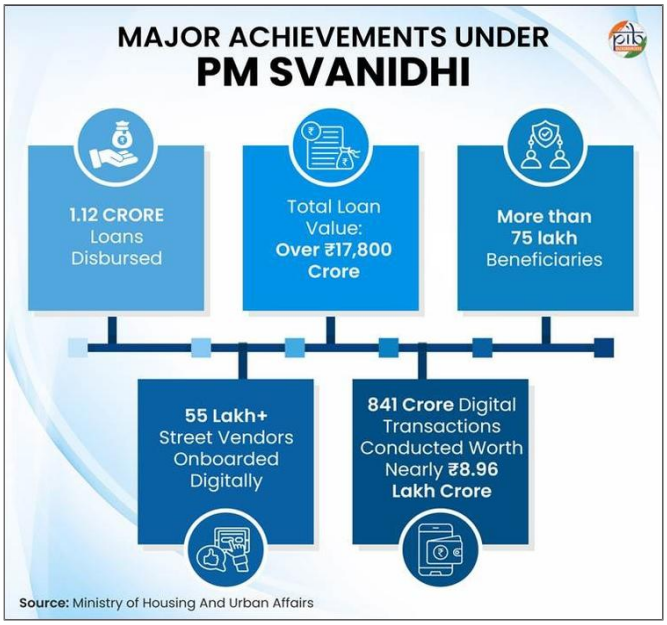
- Only government Higher Education Institutions ranked in the Top 100 of the NIRF Overall/Engineering categories, or Top 50 of the NIRF Research category are allowed to take in fellows.
- This is **complemented by select national research laboratories operating under the DST, DBT, ICMR, and CSIR.**
- **The 7 Lead Hubs**: To streamline multi-disciplinary execution, **seven premier institutions have been designated as Lead Center**s: IIT Delhi, IIT Bombay, IIT Madras, IIT Kanpur, IIT Hyderabad, IIT (ISM) Dhanbad, and IISc Bengaluru.
- **Rigorous Independent Governance**: The **evaluation and selection of both fellows and proposals are entirely managed by an Empowered Committee chaired directly by the Principal Scientific Advisor (PSA) to the Government of India**.

PM SVANidhi scheme completes six years of implementation

- **The Prime Minister Street Vendor's AtmaNirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi) scheme has completed six years** of public implementation **since its initial launch in June 2020**
- **PM SVANidhi is a pioneering, central sector micro-credit flagship scheme launched during the COVID-19 pandemic to assist urban street vendors and hawkers.**
- Managed as a joint administrative responsibility of the **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) and the Department of Financial Services (DFS),** the scheme provides formal, **collateral-free working capital loans to support** business recovery, grassroots digital onboarding, and comprehensive social security protection.

Key Features of PM SVANidhi:

- **Progressive Collateral-Free Loans**: Provides credit in three separate tranches of ₹15,000, ₹25,000, and ₹50,000. Successive higher limits are unlocked automatically upon the timely repayment of previous loans.
- Incentivizes timely or early loan repayments **by offering an interest subsidy of 7 percent per annum, which is credited directly to the vendor's account.**
- Vendors who successfully repay their second tranche become eligible for special UPI-linked RuPay Credit Cards with an operating limit of up to ₹30,000.
- **Offers an annual digital cashback incentive of up to ₹1,600 to reward and encourage retail or wholesale transactions through digital payment gateways.**
- **SVANidhi se Samriddhi (SSS):** Conducts detailed socio-economic profiling of vendors and their families to seamlessly link them with eight selected Central Government welfare schemes, creating an institutional safety net.



- **FSSAI Food Safety Training**: Collaborates directly with the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) to provide specialized capacity building in local financial literacy, digital workflows, and hygiene standards.

The Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan (PMSMA) 10th anniversary

- **The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare commenced nationwide celebrations to mark the 10th anniversary of the Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan (PMSMA) under the theme 10 Years of PMSMA – A Decade of Care.**
- The Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan (PMSMA) is a national flagship health program designed to provide assured, comprehensive, and completely free antenatal care (ANC) universally to all pregnant women across India.
- Operating through a unique single-window healthcare delivery mechanism, the scheme serves as a critical pillar of the government's Continuum of Care approach under the Reproductive, Maternal, Newborn, Child and Adolescent Health (RMNCH+A) strategy.
- **The scheme was officially launched on June 9, 2016, by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.**
- **Ministry Involved**: The program is designed, financed, and executed by the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare (MoHFW), Government of India.
- PMSMA seeks to reduce preventable maternal and infant deaths through early identification and management of high-risk pregnancies, ensuring every pregnant woman receives at least one specialist antenatal check-up in the second or third trimester.



Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions-2.0

- Recently, the Government of India has approved **extension in validity of the Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions-2.0 (CGSMFI-2.0) upto 31.8.2026.**
- It was **launched in 2026.**
- It aims to provide **guarantee cover to Banks/ FIs through National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company Limited (NCGTC).**
- It provides guarantee against expected losses on the financial assistance extended by them to Non-Banking Financial Company-Microfinance Institutions (NBFC-MFIs) and MFIs for on lending to small borrowers.
- **The Government of India has also approved an increase in maximum loan amount capped to Large Sized NBFC-MFIs/MFIs from ₹300 crores to ₹1000 crores under the overall ceiling of 20% of Assets under Management (AUM)..**

Features of the Scheme

- **Eligible borrowers**: Existing or new small borrowers within the regulatory definition of micro finance as prescribed by RBI from time to time.
- **Guarantee coverage**: 80% of amount in default for small, 75% for medium and 70% for large NBFC-MFIs/ MFIs.
- **Guarantee Fee:** 0.50% p.a., on sanctioned amount (1st year) & outstanding amount (thereafter).

Union Minister of Commerce & Industry launched the BHAVYA Portal in New Delhi.

- **The rollout marks the formal operationalisation of the ₹33,660 crore Cabinet-approved Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojana (BHAVYA), aimed at building 100 world-class, investment-ready industrial parks across India.**
- The BHAVYA Portal is an advanced, end-to-end single-window digital management platform developed to oversee the complete lifecycle of India's new industrial park It acts as the primary interface for state project submissions, real-time construction tracking, and remote investor mapping.
- **Ministry**: Ministry of Commerce & Industry.
- **Nodal Execution Body**: The National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation (NICDC).
- The framework aims to bridge the infrastructure gap for domestic and global manufacturing companies by providing fully developed, plug-and-play industrial plots.
- **By removing the traditional bottlenecks of land acquisition and environmental clearances, it aims to accelerate business setups and generate large-scale industrial employment.**



The execution model combines federal competition with a customized, tier-based land allocation strategy:

- Challenge-Based Selection Model: States do not receive funds automatically.
- They must use the portal to compete by submitting Detailed Project Reports (DPRs) that showcase their specific land availability, local industrial strengths, and investor interest.

To match regional terrain, parks are segmented into three operational scales:

- Hilly Regions, UTs & Northeast: Small-scale pockets of 25 acres.
- **Mid-sized States**: Industrial zones ranging between 100 and 500 acres.
- **Mega-parks spanning up to 1,000 acres closer to major cities**.
- **Phased Rollout Timeline** : Applications submitted between June 1 and July 31, 2026, will compete for the first batch of 20 parks, followed by an additional 30 parks based on dossiers received up to September 30.

Wind Turbine Supply Chain Management Portal (WT-MARUT)

- **Union Minister for New and Renewable Energy officially launched India's first dedicated wind turbine supply chain management portal, WT-MARUT, at the Global Wind Day Conference in Goa.**
- WT-MARUT is India's first indigenous, centralized digital platform **explicitly dedicated to managing, tracking, and optimizing the domestic wind turbine manufacturing supply chain ecosystem.**
- **Ministry:** Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)
- **Aim**: The aim of WT-MARUT is to strengthen India's domestic wind manufacturing capabilities and drive inclusion across the supply chain.

'Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra', India's First Nationwide WhatsApp AI Advisory for Oilseed Farmers

- The Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare highlighted the nationwide impact of 'Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra', India's first WhatsApp-based AI advisory service for oilseed cultivation, as farmers enter the crucial kharif sowing season.
- **Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra is a 24×7, multilingual, AI-powered digital advisory chatbot accessible directly through WhatsApp.**

- It serves as an instant, **free-of-cost scientific consulting gateway that connects traditional farmers with decades of collective agricultural research without requiring them to download external mobile applications or use complex internet browsers.**
- **Developed By:** The digital platform was developed by the ICAR-Indian Institute of Oilseeds Research (ICAR-IIOR), Hyderabad.

How to Access and How It Works?

The platform simplifies high-tech agricultural extension into three basic user steps:

- **Step 1:** The farmer saves the official dedicated contact number +91 4024598180 as 'Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra' on their smartphone.
- **Step 2:** The user opens WhatsApp and types, speaks, or sends a crop-related query in their native regional language.
- **Step 3:** The underlying AI engine instantly parses the localized text, matches it against a verified scientific repository, and beams back clear, research-validated advice.

Key Features of the Platform:

- **Comprehensive Oilseed Coverage**: Provides precise, location-specific advice across all major domestic oilseed groups—including groundnut, mustard, sesame, sunflower, soybean, and niger.
- **Full Multilingual Integration**: Features a natural language processing architecture that understands and responds instantly in all official Indian regional languages (including Hindi, Kannada, Gujarati, Telugu, and Malayalam).

Cabinet approves ₹10,000 crore ATF price stabilisation fund to shield airlines, jet fuel prices



- The Union Cabinet chaired by the Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi has approved **one-time budgetary support not exceeding Rs.10,000 crore for Oil Marketing Companies (OMCs) to provide ATF price stabilisation support to Scheduled Indian Airlines for their domestic and international operations.**
- The budgetary support shall be in the form of interest-free advances to OMCs through the Demands for Grants of the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.
- ATF price stabilisation support will be in force for a period of thirty-six months with provision for annual review or until the advance amount is fully recovered/settled, whichever is earlier.

Govt approves 22 new applicants under PLI scheme for Textiles



- **The government has approved 22 new applicants under the third round of the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for Textiles**, taking the total number of approved companies under Round-III to 96.
- The newly approved companies are expected to bring investments worth ₹2,339.14 crore, generate a projected turnover of ₹15,561.34 crore in notified products and create more than 36,000 employment opportunities across the textile value chain.
- **With the latest approvals, the total committed investment under Round-III of the Textile PLI Scheme has reached ₹12,822.67 crore,** while the projected turnover from approved projects is estimated at ₹58,294.18 crore.
- **The approved applicants span key segments identified under the scheme,** including Man-Made Fibre (MMF) apparel, MMF fabrics and technical textiles.
- These sectors have been identified as priority areas for expanding India's presence in value-added textile manufacturing and strengthening its competitiveness in global markets.
- **The Production Linked Incentive Scheme for Textiles was launched in 2021 to encourage large-scale investments in man-made fibre products and technical textiles,** sectors considered crucial for enhancing India's share in the global textile and

apparel market.

India's new Land Port Management System - Vinimay



- **To digitise and streamline cargo processing and passenger movement across India's land borders, Union Home Minister Amit Shah launched the Land Port Management System, VINIMAY.**
- The LPMS, Vinimay, is a state-of-the-art digital platform.
- It integrates operations across Land Ports into a unified system.
- The **system allows secure, real-time exchange of logistics and regulatory information**, bringing land ports at par with digital systems operational at airports and seaports.
- **LPMS will facilitate seamless coordination among various stakeholders,** including government agencies and private operators,
- The system introduces end-to-end digital workflows for cargo and passenger processing, including slot booking, payments, tracking, and single-window clearances.
- It is **fully integrated with key national platforms such as ICEGATE, ULIP, and the motor vehicle ecosystem**.
- **LPMS will enable interoperable, efficient, and transparent border management**.
- **Significance**: It reduces delays and enhances operational efficiency.

Key Facts about Land Ports Authority of India (LPAI)

- It is a statutory body **under the Department of Border Management, Ministry of Home Affairs.**
- It is responsible for developing and managing land ports to facilitate trade, connectivity, and regional cooperation.

Currently, LPAI operates 15 land ports across India's international borders:

- **India-Pakistan Border (2):** Attari (Punjab) and Dera Baba Nanak (Punjab)
- **India–Nepal Border (3):** Rupaidiha (Uttar Pradesh), Raxaul (Bihar) and Jogbani (Bihar)
- **India–Bhutan Border (1):** Darranga (Assam)
- **India–Bangladesh Border (8)** : Petrapole (West Bengal), Dawki (Meghalaya), Sutarkandi, Golakganj and Mankachar (Assam), Agartala, Srimantapur and Sabroom (Tripura)
- **India–Myanmar Border (1):** Moreh (Manipur).

Navachar Mantra Initiative



- Recently, the **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE), Government of India launched 'Navachar Mantra' Initiative.**
- It is a national initiative focused on strengthening grassroots entrepreneurship and expanding opportunities for innovators across emerging India.
- It is aimed at identifying, nurturing, and amplifying India's most promising grassroots innovators and early-stage entrepreneurs.
- **It is being implemented by the National Institute for Entrepreneurship and Small Business Development (NIESBUD), with Foundation for Innovation and Technology Transfer (FITT), IIT Delhi serving as the Technical Knowledge Partner.**

Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C R Patil launches 'Swachh Gaon, Surakshit Jalvayu' Campaign



- The Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C.R. Patil launched the 'Swachh Gaon, Surakshit Jalvayu' / स्वच्छ गांव, सुरक्षित जलवायु (SGSJ) campaign and the National level IEC Campaign for **awareness on Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026 at the Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation, Ministry of Jal Shakti, in New Delhi**
- The Swachh Gaon, Surakshit Jalvayu is a DDWS **campaign for World Environment Day 2026** launched in collaboration with the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC).
- **The campaign will be implemented from 1st June - 5th June** and is preceded by a

pre implementation phase from 25th May- 29th, 2026.

- The campaign will focus on awareness generation regarding the themes of Mission Life, behaviour change and environmental protection.
- **Swachh Bharat Mission (Grameen) 2.0 supports the vision of Mission Life** through its focus on 4Rs (Refuse, Reduce, Reuse, Recycle) of Plastic Waste Management, 3Rs (Reduce, Reuse, Recharge) of Greywater Management, promotion of circular economy and Waste to Wealth while aiming to convert villages to ODF Plus (Model).
- **Another focus of the 'Swachh Gaon, Surakshit Jalvayu' campaign is awareness generation and sensitization for Solid Waste Management** (SWM) Rules, 2026 which have come into effect from 1st April 2026.
- The campaign **will include structured activities and will culminate with "Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam" plantation drive and a Special Gram Sabha on 5th June 2026,** where achievements of the campaign and awareness on SWM Rules 2026 will be discussed by all Gram Panchayat

Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment to observe 'Nasha Mukt Bharat Saptah' under "Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan – Viksit Bharat Ki Pehchaan"

- **The Department of Social Justice & Empowerment (DoSJE) being the nodal Department for drug demand reduction is celebrating "International Day against Drug Abuse & Illicit Trafficking" on 26th June 2026.**
- DoSJE is organising 'Nasha Mukt Bharat Saptah' from 17th June to 26th June 2026 across the country under the theme "Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan – Viksit Bharat Ki Pehchaan."

MAHA Water Mission

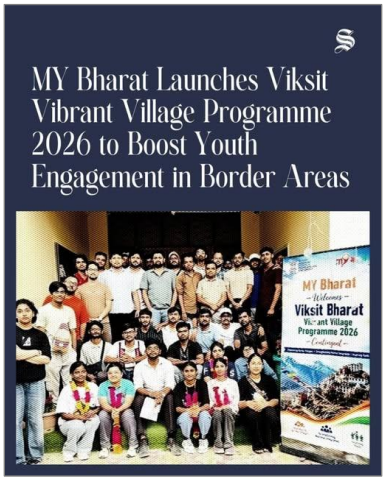


- Recently, the Union Minister of Science & Technology launched the MAHA Water Mission.
- It **has been conceived as a national platform to accelerate innovation in the water sector by connecting science, entrepreneurship, industry, academia and grassroots action.**
- It aims to support innovations from laboratory research to field deployment while generating scalable and localised solutions **for strengthening India's long-term water security.**
- It will support technology development, field validation and deployment for addressing critical water challenges.

It will focus on five priority themes:

- Water resource assessment and sustainable management;
- Drinking water;
- Water quality and ecological health;
- Water use efficiency and circular economy;
- Climate resilience and adaptation
- **A projected outlay of ₹200 crore over five years**, jointly contributed by Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF) and the Ministry of Jal Shakti.
- The programme will support multidisciplinary consortia involving universities, national laboratories, research organisations, startups, MSMEs and industry partners.

Viksit Vibrant Village Program



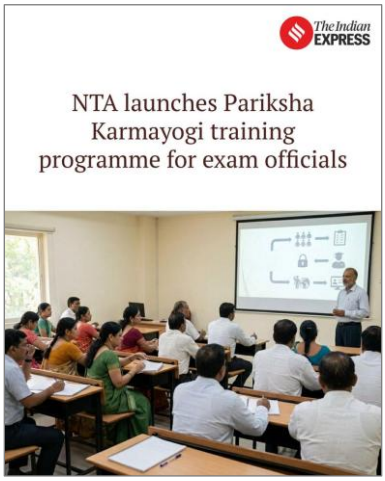
- **Recently, the Department of Youth Affairs, Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports, through Mera Yuva Bharat commenced the first phase of the Viksit Vibrant Village Program (VVVP) 2026.**
- It is a youth-led initiative aimed at strengthening grassroots engagement, fostering national integration, and promoting sustainable development in India's border villages.
- It is **being implemented in collaboration with the Ministry of Home Affairs and the Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP).**

- The programme will see 500 MY Bharat volunteers from across the country engage directly with communities in strategically important border regions of Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand and Ladakh.
- **Selection**: The volunteers were selected through a nationwide online quiz competition.
- The programme will be implemented in two phases.
- In the first phase, 250 selected volunteers will undertake immersive activities in 43 border villages, while another 250 volunteers will participate in the second phase across 50 additional villages.
- **It is designed as a seven-day residential programme, the initiative offers young participants an opportunity to live in border villages and interact closely with local communities, Panchayati Raj Institutions, district administrations and security forces.**

MY Bharat volunteers will actively advocate five key themes of the campaign:

- adoption of Swadeshi products,
- healthy cooking practices,
- public transport usage and
- fuel conservation, promotion of natural farming,
- vocal support for local tourism

NTA launches Pariksha Karmayogi programme for Examination Officials



- **The National Testing Agency (NTA) has launched Pariksha Karmayogi: Capacity-Building Programme for Examination Officials on the iGOT Karmayogi Bharat platform to strengthen the supervision, invigilation, and overall conduct of its examinations.**
- The initiative is aimed at enhancing the preparations and accountability of examination personnel involved in conducting large-scale national tests, including the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET UG).
- **The programme has been designed to build the capacity of examination functionaries and ensure the smooth, secure, transparent, and standardised conduct of offline, pen-and-paper-based examinations across the country**

DigiDukaan

- **Recently, the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), in collaboration with the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC), convened a Consumer Packaged Goods (CPG) Roundtable and discussed DigiDukaan.**
- It is an Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC's) initiative.
- It is aimed at digitising kirana stores for B2B procurement.
- It is designed to improve efficiency across the value chain.

Key Features of DigiDukaan

- **For Kirana Stores**: It enables kirana stores to improve margins through **direct procurement by offering better visibility of schemes**, improved fill rates and enhanced working capital management.

PM holds meeting with Economic Advisory Council



- It is an independent body constituted to give advice on economic and related issues to the Government of India, specifically to the Prime Minister.

The Terms of Reference of EAC-PM include:

- Analysing any issue, economic or otherwise, referred to it by the Prime Minister and advising him thereon.
- Addressing issues of macroeconomic importance and presenting views thereon to the Prime Minister.
- **These could be either suo-motu or on reference from the Prime Minister or anyone else.**
- Attending any other task as may be desired by the Prime Minister from time to time.
- **The role of EAC-PM is advisory in nature and not binding on the Government**.

- In addition to its advisory role, the EAC-PM also plays an important role in fostering greater economic understanding and awareness among the public.

Composition

- EAC-PM is **headed by a chairperson** and consists of eminent economists as members.
- It is supported in its functions by a team of officials and administrators.
- **There is no fixed definition of the exact number of members and staff of the EAC-PM.**
- For administrative, logistic, planning, and budgeting purposes, the NITI Aayog serves as the nodal agency for the EAC-PM.

Digital India BHASHINI Division

- Recently, the **Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD) has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Kathmandu University's Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure & Artificial Intelligence (DPI-AI), Nepal.**



- The partnership **seeks to advance Language AI and create a 'voice-first' language translation ecosystem for Nepal** while supporting multilingual digital public services.
- Under the agreement, the two institutions will collaborate on developing high-quality Nepali language datasets, speech corpora, speech-to-text and text-to-speech systems, machine translation tools, and multilingual conversational AI capabilities.
- **It is under Digital India Corporation (DIC), Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY).**
- It is India's national initiative for AI-driven multilingual digital inclusion and language technology.
- **Through the National Hub for Language Technology (NHLT), BHASHINI enables scalable speech and text-based AI services across Indian languages for governance, public platforms, and institutions.**
- A Bhashini Platform is making Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Natural Language Processing (NLP) resources available to MSMEs, Startups and Individual Innovators in the public domain.

India's First Flex-Fuel Passenger Vehicle

- **Union Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas launched India's first flex-fuel passenger vehicle, developed by Maruti Suzuki, in New Delhi.**
- A Flex-Fuel Vehicle (FFV) is an advanced transport solution **equipped with an internal combustion engine configured to run seamlessly on a wide range of fuel combinations**.
- Unlike traditional petrol engines that tolerate only low-level updates, **these vehicles can adapt dynamically to varying mixtures of petrol and ethanol, ranging from E20 (20% ethanol, 80% petrol) all the way up to E100 (100% pure ethanol).**

Minister of State for Commerce and Industry Shri Jitin Prasada Inaugurates Global Business Research Conference 2026 at IIFT

- Minister of State for Commerce and Industry Shri Jitin Prasada inaugurated the Global Business Research Conference (GBRC) 2026 **at the Indian Institute of Foreign Trade (IIFT), a Deemed-to-be University under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India.**
- The conference, themed "Managing Business Amidst Worldwide Turbulence",

Minister of Food Processing Industry Inaugurates SAPLING (South Asian Policy Leadership for Improved Nutrition and Growth) DIALOGUE- 2026

- Union Minister for Food Processing Industries, Chirag Paswan, on Tuesday inaugurated SAPLING (South Asian Policy Leadership for Improved Nutrition and Growth) Dialogue 2026.
- A regional high-level policy forum aimed at advancing food processing for employment generation and sustainable growth across South Asia.

- **The two-day event, titled "Unlocking Value: Advancing Food Processing for Employment Generation and Sustainable Growth in South Asia",** is being held in Ahmedabad on June 9 and 10.
- **Organised jointly by the Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI) and the World Bank Group-led SAPLING initiative,**
- An Innovation Fair has also been organised alongside the event, showcasing advancements in cold chain logistics, digital traceability, sustainable packaging, smart processing technologies and storage systems.
- **SAPLING is aligned with the World Bank Group's AgriConnect initiative**

Doctrine of Promissory Estoppel

- **The Supreme Court recently observed that the doctrine of promissory estoppel cannot be invoked to claim a benefit under a government policy which was never aimed to benefit a specific class of industrial unit.**
- It is a legal doctrine that states **that if someone reasonably relies on a promise and acts (or fails to act) in a way that causes them some harm because of that promise, the promise can be enforced**.
- Promissory estoppel prevents the promisor from arguing against the enforcement of a promise.

When is the doctrine applied?

- The doctrine applies **when the promisor has made a promise to the promisee.**
- The promisee must have relied on the promise and suffered a detriment due to the non-performance of the promise.
- The doctrine prevents the promisor or enterprise from going back on its word or promise.
- The doctrine enables the injured party or the promisee to recover on a promise.
- The doctrine seeks to protect the rights of a promisee or aggrieved party against the promisor.
- Thus, Promissory estoppel requirements include a clear promise (whether oral or in writing), reliance on that promise by the promisee, a detriment suffered, and a need to avoid injustice.

Example:

In a 1981 decision in Chhaganlal Keshavalal Mehta v. Patel Narandas Haribhai, the SC lists a checklist for when the doctrine can be applied.

- **First, there must be a clear and unambiguous promise.**
- Second, the plaintiff must have acted relying reasonably on that promise.
- Third, the plaintiff must have suffered a loss.

Doctrine Of Forum Non Conveniens

The Supreme Court recently held that where the question of pursuing a **constitutional remedy is involved, and invocation of writ jurisdiction is traceable to clause (1) of Article 226, the doctrine of forum non conveniens may rarely apply.**

About Doctrine Of Forum Non Conveniens

- It is a **common law legal principle that allows a court to dismiss or stay a case when it believes that another forum is more appropriate for hearing the case, even if the court itself has jurisdiction over the case and the parties**.
- The term "forum non conveniens" is Latin for "inconvenient forum," and the doctrine has been applied in various legal systems, particularly those with roots in English common law.
- **This doctrine plays a critical role in private international law (conflict of laws), where courts frequently deal with cross-border disputes that involve multiple jurisdictions.**
- The application of the doctrine is typically discretionary, meaning that trial courts have significant latitude in deciding whether to dismiss or stay a case based on this principle.
- **Courts are required to balance several factors in determining whether to apply the doctrine, including both private and public interests.**
- Courts consider various factors, including the convenience of the parties, the location of evidence and witnesses, the applicable law, and the availability of a fair trial in the alternative forum.
- **Generally, the doctrine is invoked by defendants who argue that the current forum is inappropriate and that a different jurisdiction would be more suitable for the case.**

Supreme Court forms high-powered expert panel to re-examine Aravalli definition

- The Supreme Court has constituted a high-powered committee to conduct an **independent review of the Centre's report on the definition and delineation of the Aravalli hill range and directed the panel to address what it described as "critical ambiguities"**
- In November 2025, the Supreme Court had accepted the definition of the Aravallis as proposed by a committee constituted by the government on its orders. According to this definition, only peaks that are 100 metres or above would be considered as Aravallis.
- The decision sparked a controversy, after which the **Supreme Court on December 29, 2025, directed that the November decision "be kept in abeyance" till an HPC of domain experts undertakes a comprehensive assessment of the report of the earlier committee and sought proposals from all stakeholders on who should be part of the committee.**
- **The committee headed by Kanchan Devi, Director General of the Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education (ICFRE),** has been directed to submit a comprehensive report by August 31, 2026.
- The newly constituted high-powered committee (HPC) will be an autonomous institution functioning under the Environment Ministry.



- The Court also appointed Professor Jagdish Krishnaswamy of the Indian Institute for Human Settlements, Bengaluru, and Prof. Laxmikant Sharma of the Central University of Haryana as special invitees .

The HPC has been tasked with examining several key questions arising from the October 2025 report.

- Whether restricting the Aravalli definition to areas within a 500-metre gap between hills reduces protected area and enables mining or other environmentally harmful activities.
- Whether Aravalli hills above 100 metres elevation form a continuous ecological system even when separated by more than 500 metres, and whether mining should be allowed in such gaps.
- **Whether the report's claim that only 1,038 of Rajasthan's 12,081 hills meet the 100-metre elevation criterion is accurate.**

FSSAI Launches Official Vegan Logo to Improve Consumer Awareness and Transparency

- **The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has introduced the standardized vegan logo for the approved vegan food products in India.**
- The new logo will become mandatory from 1st July in 2027 and it aims to provide the consumers with a clear and reliable way to identify vegan foods.
- **FSSAI was established under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006.**



Logo Design and Labelling Norms

- **The official vegan logo is a green square-framed symbol with a stylised "V",** a sprouting leaf, and the word "VEGAN" below it. FSSAI has prescribed dimensions and design specifications for the logo to ensure uniform labelling on food packages.

What Are Vegan Foods?

- Vegan foods **are that products which do not contains any ingredients, additives or processing aids which directly derived from animals.**
- Unlike the vegetarian foods, **vegan foods completely exclude the animal-origin ingredients.**
- Also a popular used distinction is the "All vegan foods are vegetarian, but not all vegetarian foods are vegan."

India Seeks Protection from US Section 301 Tariffs

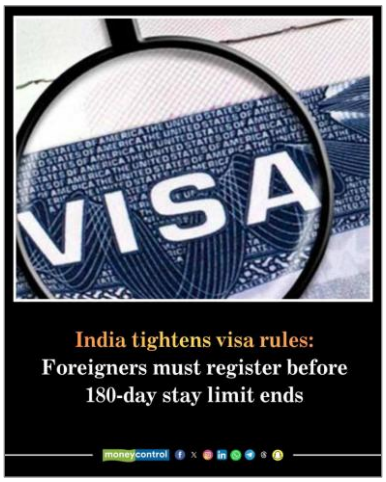
- While there has been significant progress reported on the framework of the India-United States trade deal, **New Delhi is reportedly seeking assurances that future American tariff actions under Section 301 will not undermine any concessions secured through the deal.**
- **Section 301** is a provision of the United States Trade Act of 1974.

- It **allows the United States Trade Representative to investigate foreign trade practices and to impose trade measures in response to unfair practices.**
- In March 2026, the United States Trade Representative launched new Section 301 investigations against 16 trading partners, including India.
- The **investigations covered allegations related to structural excess capacity** in manufacturing sectors and forced labour in global supply chains.

India International Institute of Democracy and Election Management

- **Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) recently congratulated the India International Institute of Democracy and Election Management (IIIIDEM) team for completing 15 years in service of electoral training and management.**
- It was **established in June 2011** by the Election Commission of India (ECI) to serve as a premier global centre for electoral training, research, and capacity building.
- It **functions under the direct supervision of the ECI** and operates from its independent campus in Dwarka, New Delhi.

New visa rules require foreigners to register before 180-day limit in India



- The **foreigners coming to India on a visa for 180 days or less will now have to register themselves "any time before the expiry of the said period of 180 days"** in case they want to stay beyond the visa period, according to changes in the Immigration and Foreigners Rules, 2025 .
- The new provision, notified, will replace the previous rule **that required the registration "within fourteen days after the expiry of one hundred and eighty days of arrival in India."**
- Previous rules stipulated that upon the birth of the child in such cases, parents had to electronically intimate the registration officer within 30 days for availing visa services, including the grant of new visa and exit permission on the designated online portal or the mobile application.
- **According to the notification, this sub-rule shall not apply in cases wherein either of the parents is an Indian citizen and such parent wishes to retain the Indian citizenship of the child.**
  - It, however, says that if the child acquires citizenship of a foreign country while in India at a later stage, either of the parents shall intimate the position to the registration officer within thirty days of acquiring the citizenship of the foreign country by the child.

The Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act, 1958 (AFSPA)

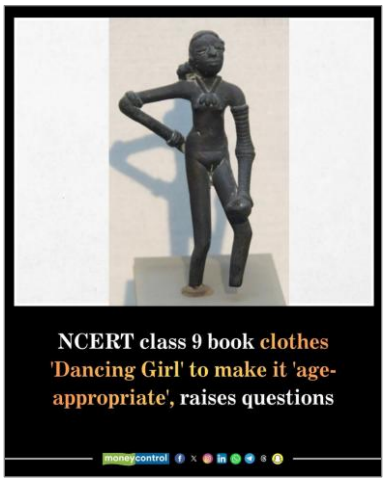


- Union Home Minister announced that the government aims to completely withdraw the Armed Forces Special Powers Act (AFSPA) from the majority of the Northeast by next year, as 80 percent of the region is already free from the act.
- **The Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act, 1958 (AFSPA) is a federal statute passed by the Indian Parliament that confers extraordinary special operational powers upon members of the Central armed forces.**
- It is deployed exclusively within designated regions categorized as disturbed areas where the local state administration is deemed incapable of maintaining internal public order against insurgencies or civil unrest.

Origin and History:

- **The Presidential Ordinance (1958):**Facing rising insurgency and internal disturbances, the President promulgated the Armed Forces (Assam and Manipur) Special Powers Ordinance on 22 May 1958. It provided emergency powers to security forces in affected areas.
- **Statutory Enactment**: After approval by both Houses of Parliament, the bill received Presidential assent on 11 September 1958. It became the Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act, 1958 (Act 28 of 1958).
- **Aim of AFSPA**: AFSPA empowers armed forces to support civil authorities in disturbed areas. It aims to curb insurgency, dismantle militant networks, and restore normal governance.

Revisiting the 'Dancing Girl': The Harappan bronze figurine and its NCERT representation



- The iconic "Dancing Girl" of Mohenjo Daro, a 4,500-year-old bronze figurine that has featured in Indian school textbooks for decades, appears to have been altered in a newly released Class 9 art education textbook published by the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT).
- **The "Dancing Girl" was one of two bronze female figurines found at Mohenjo-Daro,** discovered in a small house in the south-western quarter of the city during the 1926–27 excavations.
- The 10.8 cm figurine depicts a slender woman standing with **her right hand on the back of her hip** and her left hand resting on her left thigh, just above the knee.
- **Craftsmanship**: The figurine was created using the Lost-Wax Casting Technique, a sophisticated metallurgical process.
  - **Lost-wax casting is a process where a wax model is covered with a heat-resistant mold, the wax is melted out, molten metal is poured into the hollow cavity, and once it cools, the mold is removed to reveal the metal object.**
- **Artistic Significance**: The sculpture shows a young girl in a confident pose with tilted head and long arms, combining realism with stylized exaggeration.
  - Her posture and ornaments convey grace and rhythm, earning her the name "Dancing Girl."

BIS Releases IS 20201:2026 Standard for Community Seed Banks in India



- The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) under the Department of Consumer Affairs has released a **new Indian Standard, IS 20201:2026, aimed at strengthening the management of Community Seed Banks (CSBs) and promoting the conservation of indigenous crop varieties across the country.**
- Developed by the Biodiversity Sectional Committee under BIS's Environment and Ecology Department, the standard establishes a structured framework for the operation and management of community seed banks, which play a key role in preserving traditional seed varieties and enhancing agricultural resilience.
- The **new standard comes at a time when climate change is posing increasing challenges to agriculture through erratic rainfall, rising temperatures and prolonged droughts.**
- Indigenous seed varieties, known for traits such as drought tolerance, disease resistance and nutritional value, are considered critical resources for ensuring long-term food and nutritional security.
- **According to BIS, IS 20201:2026 provides standardised guidelines for community-led and decentralised seed banks, enabling farmers to collect, store, maintain and exchange quality seeds adapted to local conditions.**
- The framework is expected to support the conservation of agricultural biodiversity while strengthening the resilience of farming communities.
- The standard aligns with the government's efforts to promote sustainable agriculture and preserve agrobiodiversity.
- **It complements existing initiatives, including the National Food Security and Nutrition Mission (NFSNM), which provides financial assistance for establishing community seed banks, as well as provisions under the Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Act, 2001 and the Biological Diversity Act, 2002.**
- The guidelines cover the entire lifecycle of seed bank operations, including organisational arrangements, seed collection and acquisition, viability testing, cleaning, drying, storage, documentation, quality assurance, seed regeneration, risk management and continuous improvement.
- BIS said the standard will help create a reliable system for conserving traditional crop varieties and ensure that farmers continue to have access to seeds suited to local climatic and ecological conditions.

- **The standard is voluntary and certifiable.** BIS has made IS 20201:2026 available free of cost through its official portal and has encouraged community seed banks, cooperative societies and other stakeholders in the agricultural sector to adopt the guidelines.
- **Established under the BIS Act, 2016, the Bureau of Indian Standards serves as the national standards body of India and is responsible for the development of standards and quality certification systems across sectors.**

What were the key provisions of the June 3 Declaration (Mountbatten Plan)?

- **The June 3 Declaration (Mountbatten Plan), issued on June 3, 1947, laid the groundwork for the partition of British India and the transition of power away from British administration.**



Its key provisions were:

- The proposal recognised the division of British India and cleared the path for the formation of two separate states: India and Pakistan.
- The **Legislative Assemblies of Punjab and Bengal were to vote on whether their provinces should remain united or be divided.**
- The Sindh Legislative Assembly was granted the authority to decide whether Sindh should join India or Pakistan.
- **Referendums were scheduled for the North-West Frontier Province (NWFP) and the Sylhet region to determine their future membership.**
- The **plan called for the establishment of two independent dominions:** India and Pakistan, each with its own Constituent Assembly.
- The princely states were obliged to join either India or Pakistan.
- **The transfer of power, which was originally scheduled for June 1948, was moved to August 15, 1947.**

8 June Akashvani anniversary



- Motto – 'Bahujan Hitaya : Bahujan Sukhaya'.
- **On June 8, 1936, the Indian State Broadcasting Service,** started in April 1930, **became All India Radio.**
- The name Akashvani was adopted by AIR in 1956
- Fact - In June 1923 the Radio Club of Bombay made the first ever broadcast in the country.
- Akashvani organised a marathon in the national capital as part of the celebrations marking 90 years .

Doctor's Prescription Made Mandatory for Cough Syrups



- The government issued a notification mandating that **all syrups, including those used to treat coughs, will now require a doctor's prescription before they can be purchased.**
- That is, the over-the-counter sale of these syrups will no longer be allowed.
- **The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare notified the change to the Drugs Rules, 1945**, which laid out the rules and regulations pertaining to the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940.
- The word 'syrup' be removed from the list of items that had been exempted from the provisions of the Act. The rules had earlier specified that 'Syrups, lozenges, pills and tablets for cough' would be exempted.

To mark the occasion of upcoming International Yoga Day, observed on June 21, 'Khadi India' launches the 'Swadha' wellness wear collection

- The Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC), under the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises, Government of India has launched a **special wellness wear collection named 'Swadha'**
- **Created by the Centre of Excellence for Khadi (CoEK), this collection represents an innovative effort to blend the Indian concepts of yoga, health, and balanced living with modern clothing styles.**

- The launch ceremony was held at the Central Office of the Centre of Excellence for Khadi (CoEK), in collaboration with KVIC at the National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT) campus in Hauz Khas, New Delhi.

Shri Amit Shah launched NAFED's auction portal 'NAFEX.in' in New Delhi





- Shri Amit Shah launched several important digital and farmer-centric initiatives of NAFED.
- These include **NAFED-KALYAN scholarship for children of farmers,**
- DRISHTI portal for **inventory management of pulses and oilseeds**, ERP portal for strengthening enterprise resource planning, and the auction portal NAFEX.in.
- The portal is expected to provide a digital platform for streamlining auction-related activities and enhancing the overall functioning of NAFED

Green Hydrogen Certification Scheme

- Recently, the **Union Minister for New and Renewable Energy launched the Green Hydrogen Certification Portal of India (GHCI).**

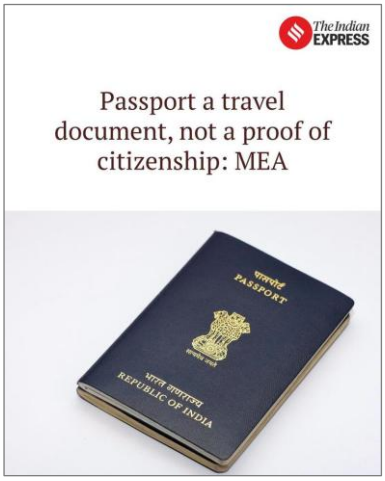


- It was launched by the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE), Government of India, under the National Green Hydrogen Mission.
- It **aims to promote the production and use of Green Hydrogen , which is generated from renewable energy sources.**
- **Green Hydrogen standard: Hydrogen can be officially recognized as "green"** only if its non-biogenic greenhouse gas emissions do not exceed 2 kg of CO_2 equivalent (CO_2e)/kg of hydrogen, averaged over 12 months.
- Eligible Hydrogen Production Pathways include Electrolysis and Conversion of Biomass.
- Producers must appoint Accredited Carbon Verification (ACV) agencies, recognized by the Bureau of Energy Efficiency ,for independent verification.
- **The GHCI operates with four types of certificates—**Concept Certificate, Facility-Level Certificate, Provisional Certificate, and Final Certificate.
- **Concept and Facility-Level certificates focus on design and operational readiness, while Provisional and Final certificates evaluate actual emissions based on production data.**
- Final certificates are mandatory for facilities benefiting from government incentives or intending to sell hydrogen domestically.
- The **certification also enables producers to access carbon credits under the Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS), subject to additional compliance requirements**

Passport is not a citizenship document: senior MEA official

- The Indian passport is a "**travel document" and not a "citizenship document"**
- The purpose of the Indian passport is to help Indians transit and travel through foreign ports and territories and it should not be compared with other documents that are used to establish citizenship rights,
- Even though while travelling abroad, passport attests to your nationality, yet it is not a document of your citizenship
- Citizenship is the status of a person who is recognized through custom or law as a legitimate member of a sovereign state or nation.

- A nation grants certain rights and privileges to its citizens. The Indian Constitution establishes a single citizenship for all of India.
- Although the **term citizenship is not officially defined in the Constitution**, Articles 5-11 outline the framework for citizenship at the time of commencement of the Constitution.
- **The Citizenship Act, of 1955** deals with matters relating to the acquisition, determination, and termination of Indian citizenship after the commencement of the Constitution
- The Constitution established a **uniform type of citizenship known as national citizenship**, eliminating the need for distinct state-based citizenship.
- Citizen of India: Every person who was domiciled in Indian territory at the time of the Constitution's commencement (January 26, 1950) and (a**) was born in India, (b) either of his or her parents was born in India, or (c) had been ordinarily resident in India for at least five years became an Indian citizen**.



- **Single Citizenship**: Despite its federal structure, India does not provide dual citizenship, unlike the U.S.A. There is only single citizenship i.e. Indian citizenship. However, the Indian Constitution does not define citizenship.
- **National Register of Citizens (NRC):** The NRC is the register containing names of Indian citizens. The only time the NRC was prepared was in 1951 by recording particulars of all the persons enumerated during the 1951 Census.
- **NRC in Assam:** At present, only Assam has such a register. The citizens' register sets out to identify foreign nationals in the state that borders Bangladesh

Supreme Court declares the right to walk carefree on footpaths a fundamental right

- A two-judge bench of Justices P.S. Narasimha and A.S. Chandurkar were acting in the case of a man named Maniyar Iliyaz, who lost his five-year-old son to an accident in which a tanker struck him from behind, crushing his lower body in the process.
- **The Supreme Court in a judgment, declared the freedom to walk on demarcated and well-maintained footpaths a fundamental right which has priority over movement by motorised vehicles.**
- This is an enforceable duty.
- The fundamental right to walk on demarcated footpaths shall override the privilege of a motorised vehicle
- "**The right to walk is a fundamental right under Part III of the Constitution**. It is integral to the right to movement guaranteed under Article 19(1)(d), read with Article 19(1)(a), Article 19(1) (b), Article 19(1) (c) and Article 21 of the Constitution of India.



- The **fundamental right to walk will take within its sweep the right to demarcated footpaths**. These rights are primary and shall have priority over movement by motorised vehicles.

Doctrine of Constructive Res Judicata

- The Supreme Court recently reiterated that the doctrine of constructive res judicata, embodied in Explanation IV to Section 11 of the Code of Civil Procedure, is aimed at **preventing parties from litigating in installments and ensuring finality in judicial proceedings.**
- The concept of res judicata has evolved from the **English Common Law System.**
- Res judicata literally means '**the thing has been judged**". It is also known as claim preclusion.
- The principle of res judicata applies when a litigant attempts to file a subsequent lawsuit on the same matter after having received a judgment in a previous case involving the same parties.
- It means that the issue before the court has already been decided by another court, between the same parties, and the courts do not allow a petition to be filed in the same court or in another court.
- **Therefore, the court will dismiss the case before it as being useless.**
- Res Judicata as a concept is applicable both in Civil as well as Criminal legal system.
- **Constructive Res Judicata is an extension of the principle of Res Judicata.**

- **It applies to matters that could have been raised in a previous suit but were not.**

SHATAYU Dashboard Expands Caregiver Network for Senior Citizens across the country



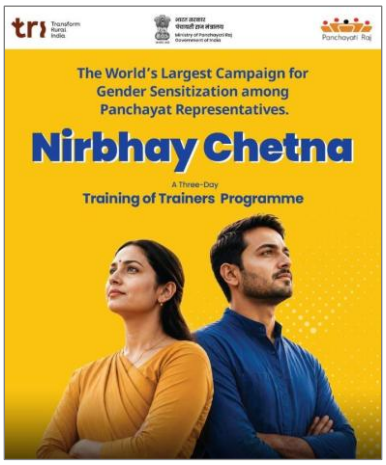
- The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment has launched SHATAYU (Senior Holistic Care Assistance and Training for Your Utility) Dashboard on 22.05.2026.
- The dashboard provides a platform to **all trained Geriatric caregivers to register themselves on the dashboard for providing their services to the needy senior citizens.**
- The SHATAYU dashboard is managed by National Institute of Social Defence (NISD), an autonomous body of **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment** which is also mandated with the training of geriatric caregivers.

BHARATI Programme



- Recently, the **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)** has successfully concluded the first cohort of BHARATI Programme.
- BHARATI (Bharat's Hub for Agritech, Resilience, Advancement and Incubation for Export Innovation) is a flagship initiative of the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA).
- Aim: **It is aimed at fostering innovation-led growth in India's agri-food export sector.**
- It has been designed to empower **100 agri-food startups**, drive innovation and boost **exports worth USD 50 billion in APEDA-scheduled products by 2030.**
- It is aligned with the **Government of India's vision of an Atmanirbhar Bharat, Vocal for Local, Digital India and Start-Up India.**
- **Focus categories**: It seeks to drive innovation in high-value categories such as **GI-tagged agri-products**, organic foods, superfoods, novel **processed Indian agri-foods, livestock products and AYUSH products.**

Nirbhay Chetna Initiative



- Recently, the central government rolled out 'Nirbhay Chetna' to sensitise 17.5 lakh male elected representatives.
- It is a key intervention under the Nirbhay Raho initiative.
- It is a first-of-its-kind national initiative implemented under the Nirbhaya Fund.
- **Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Panchayati Raj**

Components of Nirbhay Raho

- Nirbhay Chetna seeks to **sensitise elected male representatives** on gender equality and women's safety;
- Nirbhay Netri focuses on **capacity-building and legal awareness** among elected women representatives;
- Nirbhay Drishti envisages the **installation of CCTV cameras** at strategic rural locations to strengthen technology-enabled safety infrastructure in Panchayats.

The 26th All India Fingerprint Conference 2026



- Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Shri Amit Shah addressed the inaugural session of the **26th All India Fingerprint Conference 2026 in New Delhi**
- The Home Minister also launched the **National Crime Records Bureau's (NCRB) Abhigyan, CrPI, e-Prosecution 2.0 and e-Forensics 2.0 applications**
- **Abhigyan**, an app developed by the **National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)**

to implement the procedure, was launched by Home Minister Amit Shah

- The app links to the National Automated Fingerprint Identification System (NAFIS), which **stores fingerprint scans of accused, convicts, and those in prisons on a centralised platform.**

Haldia Seaport Designated as Immigration Post

- The Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has designated Haldia seaport in West Bengal as an immigration post.
- At present, there are 40 seaport immigration posts along India's coastline and **Haldia will be the 41st entry to the list.**
- Haldia Dock Complex**, built in 1968 to take load off the Kolkata port**, started international operations after a port was commissioned there in 1977.
- Earlier on May 29, three seaports in **Gujarat- Dahej, Sikka and Tuna Tekra** were designated as immigration posts.

NCERT introduces section on Emergency in Class 9 textbook, mentions Indira Gandhi

- More than five decades after the Emergency was imposed in India, NCERT has, for the first time, introduced the topic in a Class 9 textbook, presenting it as "one of the major challenges," as the majority of fundamental rights were suspended.
- The reference appears in the newly developed Social Science textbook, Understanding Society: India and Beyond, where the Emergency has been included in a chapter examining the strengths and challenges of Indian democracy.
- **In June 1975, a National Emergency was imposed by the government on the grounds of internal disturbance.**

Chennai Petroleum Corporation gets Navratna status, becomes 28th such CPSE

- Chennai Petroleum Corporation Ltd (CPCL) has been upgraded to Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE) status.
- The announcement was made by the Department of Public Enterprises (DPE) under the Ministry of Finance.
- With this, CPCL becomes the **28th Navratna among all CPSEs in India.**
- CPCL, which operates under the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, posted an annual turnover of Rs 59,400 crore in FY 2025-26.
- Prior to this upgrade, the company **held Miniratna Category-I status.**
- CPCL, formerly known as **Madras Refineries Limited**, was formed as a joint venture between the **Government of India, AMOCO, and the National Iranian Oil Company in 1965.**
- The Government of India later transferred its equity to **Indian Oil Corporation, and CPCL became a subsidiary of IndianOil in 2001.**

Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Limited (GRSE) was officially granted Navratna status

- Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE) has been granted 29th Navratna status by the Department of Public Enterprises (DPE) under the Ministry of Finance.
- **GRSE traces its origins to 1884 and was taken over by the Government of India in 1960.**
- The company delivered India's first indigenous warship, INS Ajay, in 1961

What the Navratna tag means

- The Navratna classification, introduced by the government in 1997, grants Central Public Sector Enterprises significantly enhanced financial and operational autonomy.
- **A Navratna CPSE can invest up to Rs 1,000 crore or 15% of its net worth on a single project without seeking prior government approval.**
- To qualify for the status, a CPSE must be a Miniratna-I entity with a positive net worth, **must have secured an "Excellent" or "Very Good" MoU rating in three of the last five years**, and must score **60 or more points on key financial indicators including net profit, net worth, and manpower cost.**

National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)

- The Union Cabinet recently approved an additional Government of India's investment commitment of Rs. 30,000 crore towards new and upcoming funds of the National Investment and Infrastructure Fund.
- It is a fund created by the Government of India for enhancing infrastructure financing in the country.
- It is India's first-ever sovereign wealth fund (SWF).
- NIIF got registered with SEBI as Category II Alternative Investment Fund (AIF) on December 28, 2015.

- It is a collaborative investment platform for international and Indian investors with a mandate to invest equity capital in domestic infrastructure.
- NIIF invests across asset classes such as infrastructure, private equity, and other diversified sectors in India, with the objective of generating attractive risk-adjusted returns for its investors.
- It invests in greenfield (new), brownfield (existing), and stalled projects.
- NIIF is 49% owned by the Indian government and has more than $5 billion in assets under management, making it the country's biggest infrastructure fund.



Currently, there are four funds under the NIIF Umbrella.

- NIIF Master Fund: This fund primarily invests in infra-related projects such as roads, ports, airports, and power. It is the largest infrastructure fund in India.
- NIIF Private Markets Fund: Invests in funds managed by third-party managers in infrastructure and associated sectors.
- NIIF Strategic Opportunities Fund: It invests and develops large-scale businesses and greenfield projects that are of strategic importance to the country.

Passport fees to increase from July 1: Why the government has raised charges now



- The application fee for an ordinary fresh passport containing 36 pages has been hiked from **₹1,500 to ₹2,500,** as the Union government revised the passport fee structure through an amendment to the Passports Rules, 1980.
- The new rules will come into effect from July 1.
- a tatkal application for a fresh or reissued passport will cost **₹5,000 as opposed to the current ₹3,500 rate.**
- Similarly, the application fee for an ordinary fresh passport or reissue of a passport containing 60 pages has been hiked **from ₹2,000 to ₹3,500.**
- For tatkal, the revised fee for 60-page passports will be **₹6,000 as against the current ₹4,000.**
- The revised schedule mentions two sub-categories: for applicants 18 years of age and above, and minors aged between 15 to 18 years, if applied under this category; and minor applicants below 18 years of age.

REVISED PASSPORT FEE STRUCTURE

(As per amendment to the Passports Rules, 1980)

New rules will come into effect from July 1

Passport Type	Passport Category	Ordinary Fee (₹)		Tatkal Fee (₹)		Increase in Fee (₹)	
		Existing Fee	Revised Fee (w.e.f. July 1)	Existing Fee	Revised Fee (w.e.f. July 1)	Ordinary	Tatkal
Fresh Passport / Reissue of Passport (36 Pages)	All Applicants	₹1,500	₹2,500	₹3,500	₹5,000	+₹1,000	+₹1,500
Fresh Passport / Reissue of Passport (60 Pages)	All Applicants	₹2,000	₹3,500	₹4,000	₹6,000	+₹1,500	+₹2,000

- The above fees are **application fees only.**
- Additional service charges, if any, will be applicable as per existing rules.

Union Minister for Rural Development Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan Launches AI-Enabled 'Rural Internal Audit Portal' at "Rashtriya Gramin Vikas Sammelan"



- Union Minister for Rural Development Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan launched the **'Rural Internal Audit Portal' during the Rashtriya Gramin Vikas Sammelan at Pusa Campus in New Delhi.**
- The AI-enabled portal marks a significant **step towards enhancing transparency, accountability and technology-driven governance** in the Ministry of Rural Development.
- The Rural Internal Audit Portal -a first-of-its-kind unified digital platform for end-to-end management of internal audits covering both risk-based and compliance audits.
- Conceived by the **Office of the Chief Controller of Accounts (CCA), Ministry of Rural Development,** and developed in collaboration with the **National Informatics Centre (NIC).**

National War Memorial

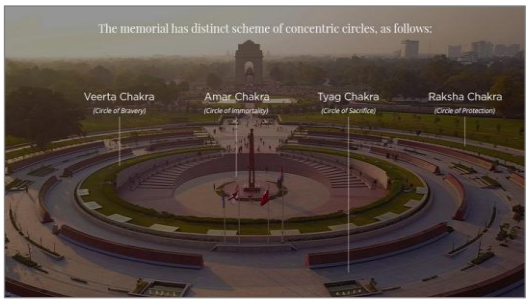


- The names of six military personnel — **five from the Indian Army and one from IAF — who died in the line of duty during Operation Sindoor** have been recently inscribed on a wall at the National War Memorial as a tribute to the fallen heroes.

About National War Memorial

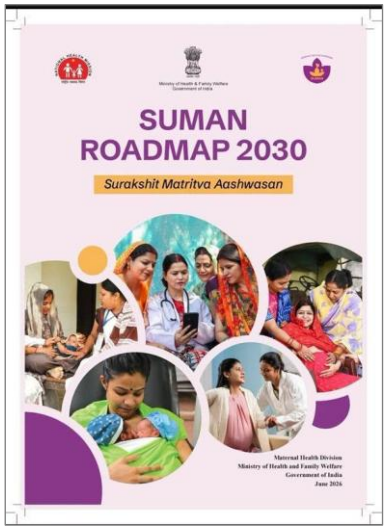
- The National War Memorial (Rashtriya Samar Smarak) was established in January 2019.
- It is a national monument built for giving honour to our brave soldiers.
- **It is located in New Delhi.**
- It is a commemoration of the sacrifices made by **Indian soldiers since Independence**.
- The main structure has been built in the form **of four chakras, each signifying different values of the armed forces,** with the eternal flame and obelisk located **in the inner-most chakra (also called Amar Chakra).**
- The obelisk stands at a height of 15.5 metres and is visible even from a distance as one enters the complex.
- Surrounding **it is Veerta Chakra** with six bronze murals depicting different battle actions.
- Each mural weighs between 600 kg and 1,000 kg.
- **Tyag Chakra which surrounds it has been made entirely of granite bricks**, each bearing the name of a fallen soldier since Independence.
- The final chakra — **Rakshak Chakra — surrounds the other three and consists of over 600 trees that will act as a wall and represent the soldiers who protect the country.**
- Adjacent to the main complex lies a tribute to the **21 Param Vir Chakra awardees.**
- Each recipient is honoured by a bronze bust surrounded by a lush green patch, complete with pathways and informative plaques on the courage they displayed during battle.

Union Health Minister Released 'SUMAN Roadmap 2030' at the 16th Conference of the Central Council of Health and Family Welfare



- Union Health and Family Welfare Minister Jagat Prakash Nadda will unveil the **SUMAN Roadmap 2030 and the Operational Guidelines on National Ambulance Services (NAS), 2026** during the 16th Conference of the Central Council of Health and Family Welfare (CCHFW)
- The SUMAN Roadmap 2030 has been designed as a comprehensive national strategy to accelerate progress toward the **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) related to maternal and newborn health.**

- The framework seeks **to reduce the Maternal Mortality Ratio (MMR) to below 70 per 100,000 live births by 2030,** while also lowering neonatal and infant mortality rates and advancing the goal of **zero preventable maternal and newborn deaths.**
- It focuses on 130 districts across 13 high-focus states, including **Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Odisha, Assam and West Bengal.**
- The strategy also promotes community participation through initiatives such as SUMAN Panchayats, aimed at ensuring universal antenatal care, institutional deliveries, full immunisation and accountability at the local level.
- Nadda will also release the **Operational Guidelines on National Ambulance Services (NAS), 2026**, a landmark framework intended to **standardise emergency medical transport services across the country.**
- They aim to strengthen pre-hospital emergency care by ensuring timely patient stabilisation, transport and referral to appropriate healthcare facilities.
- A key feature of the framework is the establishment of **Integrated Command and Dispatch Centres (ICDCs) equipped with GPS-based ambulance tracking, structured triage systems, real-time monitoring dashboards** and advanced call management systems.



DIKSHA Becomes One Nation, One Digital Platform

- **Digital Infrastructure for Knowledge Sharing (DIKSHA)** is an open-source platform that provides easy access to **high-quality, curriculum-linked digital learning materials** in multiple languages to students and teachers across the country.
- It is a key component of the **PM e-Vidya initiative of the Ministry of Education** that aims to ensure continuity of learning through online means.
- Launched in 2017, it is spearheaded **by the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT)** in collaboration with the **Central Institute of Educational Technology (CIET).**
- The platform features media-rich, interactive resources, including 2D/3D animations, AR experiences, simulations, virtual labs, and sign language videos, designed to enhance conceptual clarity and cater to diverse learning styles.
- There are **QR-coded Energised Textbooks, linking physical NCERT books to videos**, interactives, and teacher guides for seamless classroom engagement.
- For the differently-abled learners it provides inclusive features **like DAISY (Digital Accessible Information System) format, text-to-speech, and Indian Sign Language (ISL) videos**.



The Ayushman Sarathi Chatbot

- Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare, launched 'Ayushman Sarathi', an official WhatsApp chatbot for the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY).
- Ayushman Sarathi is a secure, API-based digital public health interface that operates on WhatsApp.
- Developed by the National Health Authority (NHA) under the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, it enables citizens to interact directly with PM-JAY systems through simple, automated message exchanges on their mobile phones.

Scheme for Strengthening of Medical Device Industry

- Recently, the Department of Pharmaceuticals, Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers, has invited applications from eligible entities under the Scheme for Strengthening of Medical Device Industry (SMDI) to promote domestic manufacturing.
- It is a comprehensive scheme which targets critical areas of the medical device industry.
- It covers manufacturing of key components and accessories, skill development, support for clinical studies, development of common infrastructure and industry promotion.
- It has a total outlay of 500 Crores

- Common facilities for medical devices clusters, the Central Government will provide financial assistance to medical device clusters for creating common infrastructure facilities such as R&D labs, Design and Testing Centre, Animal Labs etc.
- It offers a one-time capital subsidy of 10-20%, with a maximum cap of Rs 10 crore per project.
- It focuses on capacity building and skill development for the medical device sector. Its goal is to develop a skilled technical workforce capable of designing and developing MedTech products.
- Medical Device Clinical Studies Support Scheme: It is designed to assist both established companies and start-ups in conducting clinical studies.

Rashtriya Gramin Vikas Sammelan 2026 Charts the Roadmap for Viksit Bharat; Launches 'SARAS Shakti' Collection

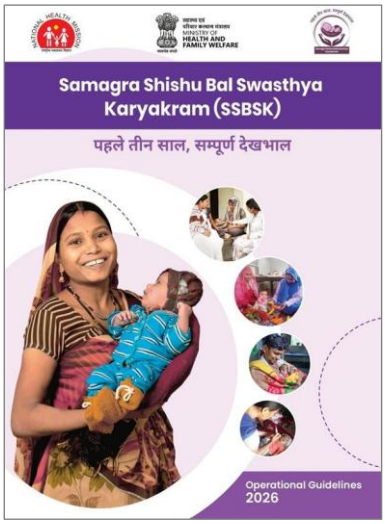
- The Rashtriya Gramin Vikas Sammelan (RGVS) 2026, organised by the Ministry of Rural Development, concluded .
- A major focus of the conference was the implementation of the VB-GRAMG Act, 2025, along with a comprehensive review of key flagship schemes, including the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana-Gramin (PMAY-G), Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY), Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM), rural skill development programmes and the National Social Assistance Programme (NSAP).
- To further promote rural entrepreneurship, the Ministry launched the 'SARAS Shakti' Collection and unveiled the 'SARAS Shakti' Coffee Table Book during the event.
- The SARAS Shakti Collection showcases a curated range of premium products created by women Self-Help Groups from across the country,
- The Sammelan also highlighted the expansion of Saras Aajeevika, the national marketing initiative under DAY-NRLM.
- Since the launch of the first Saras Mela in 1999, the initiative has evolved into a nationwide marketing platform encompassing more than 25 state brands and generating over ₹200 crore in annual business through rural fairs.

National Immunization Day Pulse Polio Programme 2026



- National Pulse Polio Immunization Day 2026 was observed nationwide on **June 28, 2026**.
- The intensive campaign targeted all children under 5 years of age to receive two drops of the oral polio vaccine (OPV) to maintain India's polio-free
- The core theme used during India's National Pulse Polio Day campaign is **"Every Child, Every Time"** (often extended as **"Every Drop, Every Time, Every Child"**),

Samagra Shishu Bal Swasthya Karyakram



- Recently, the Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare launched the Samagra Shishu Bal Swasthya Karyakram (SSBSK).
- It is a unified national programme that provides a seamless continuum of home and community-based care for every child from birth to 36 months of age.
- The programme embodies the vision of Comprehensive care during the first three years.
- It integrates the existing Home-Based Newborn Care (HBNC) and Home-Based Care for Young Child (HBYC) programmes into a single comprehensive framework
- It introduces a risk-stratified approach, providing intensified follow-up for newborns and children identified as "at-risk", due to conditions such as low birth weight, prematurity, delayed initiation of breastfeeding etc
- Under the programme, 'At-risk' newborns will receive up to nine home visits during the first 42 days of life, while 'At-risk' children will receive up to eight home visits up to the age of 36 months.
- It introduces Well-Baby Sessions at every Village Health, Sanitation and Nutrition Day (VHSND) and a monthly Shishu Shivir at Ayushman Arogya Mandirs.
- It incorporates post-partum maternal mental health screening as an integral component of community-based care.

- These digital systems will be integrated with the JANANI Portal, U-WIN Portal, MPCDSR Portal, RBSK 2.0 Portal and POSHAN Tracker, enabling seamless data exchange through ABHA and Baal-ABHA IDs.

Unified Health Interface

- Recently, the Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare launched the Unified Health Interface (UHI).
- It is an interoperable digital network under the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM).
- UHI aims to solve for information asymmetry, accessibility to health services and wider choice of verified providers across services without being tied to a single application.
- It was launched as the service layer of the ABDM

Key Objectives of Unified Health Interface

- Patients and providers can use any UHI-enabled platform to seek or offer care, removing the dependency on shared platforms that currently limits digital health access.
- Every verified healthcare provider, regardless of size, geography, or platform, has an equal opportunity to be found on the network.
- Only verified doctors and facilities credentialed through ABDM registries (HPR and HFR) are permitted to participate, ensuring citizens can trust the network.

Shastrarth Tradition



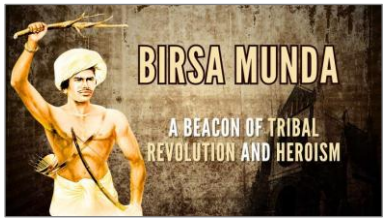
- Addressing the 135th episode of his monthly radio programme Mann Ki Baat, Prime Minister Narendra Modi lauded Nalanda University for successfully reviving the ancient Indian tradition of Shastrarth (scholarly debate).
- Shastrarth (derived from Shastra meaning scriptures/knowledge and Artha meaning meaning/interpretation) is the ancient Indian philosophical system of disciplined, structured, and open public debate.
- It is not an unmonitored argument, but a deeply formalized intellectual discourse where scholars defense-test their philosophical schools of thought, spiritual interpretations, and scientific theories against opposing ideas.
- The practice dates back thousands of years, finding deep mention in the Upanishads and early Vedic assemblies (Sabhas and Samitis).
- It served as the central pedagogical tool in India's ancient residential universities like Nalanda, Vikramashila, and Takshashila, where international scholars gathered to debate.
- Legendary Shastrarth encounters shaped Indian intellectual history, such as the historic 8th-century debate between Adi Shankaracharya and Mandana Misra on Vedic philosophy, and modern socio-religious debates like Swami Dayanand Saraswati's Kashi debate in 1869.

Short News



- The Central Bureau of Investigation launched **Operation Chakra-VI** on 25 June 2026 against digital arrest fraud networks in India.
- India has temporarily blocked the Telegram app over concerns it may be used for cheating, days before a crucial medical entrance exam is set to be reheld.
- **Khanij Bidesh India Limited (KABIL), a joint venture of three Central Public Sector Enterprises under the Ministry of Mines —** including National Aluminium Company Ltd. (NALCO) and Hindustan Copper Ltd. (HCL) — has secured five critical mineral blocks in Argentina.

Eminent Personalities In News



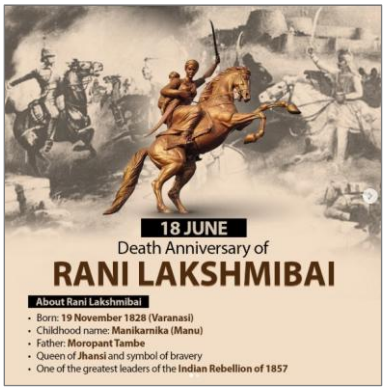
PM Modi pays tribute to tribal hero Birsa Munda on his 126th Martyr's day – Balidan Diwas (9 June)

- Birsa Munda was **born on November 15, 1875, in Khunti district, Jharkhand**, in the Munda tribe, an indigenous community of the Chotanagpur Plateau.

- The **British imposed the zamindari system**, replacing the traditional 'Khuntkatti' system, which allowed tribal communities to collectively own land.
- **Munda Rebellion (Ulgulan):** Birsa Munda **led the Munda Rebellion** (1899-1900), a major tribal uprising against British rule, **challenging exploitative policies** like land settlements and Forest Laws.
- **Formation of Munda Raj:** Birsa **unified tribal groups under the concept of 'Munda Raj**,' advocating for self-rule and organising guerrilla attacks on British forces.
- **Advocate for Tribal Rights:** Birsa strongly opposed land dispossession and advocated for tribal land rights, **influencing the Chotanagpur Tenancy Act of 1908**, which prohibited the transfer of tribal lands to non-tribals and recognised traditional community rights over land, water, and forests.
- **Religious Leadership:** Birsa **founded the 'Birsait' faith**, which blended traditional animist beliefs and social reforms. He urged his followers to reject superstitions and embrace tribal traditions, earning him the **title Dharti Aba (Father of the Earth).**
- **Death:** Birsa Munda was captured by the British in March 1900 and died under **mysterious circumstances in Ranchi Jail on June 9, 1900.** His death marked the end of the rebellion, but his legacy as a tribal leader and resistance icon endures.
- Birsa Munda is commemorated as a tribal hero, with **November 15 celebrated as 'Janjatiya Gaurav Diwas'** and Jharkhand's founding on his birth anniversary in 2000.

Rani Lakshmibai of Jhansi death anniversary

- **On June 18, 1858, Rani Lakshmibai of Jhansi was killed fighting British troops near Gwalior during the Revolt of 1857.**
- Rani Lakshmibai was the queen consort of the princely state of Jhansi and an iconic leader of the Indian Revolt of 1857.
- **She was married to Maharaja Gangadhar Rao, the ruler of the princely state of Jhansi.**



The Doctrine of Lapse:

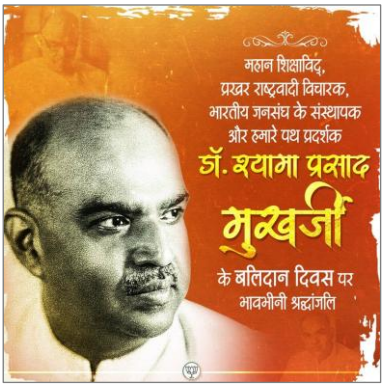
- The English East India Company (EIC), driven by expansionist policies, refused to recognize the legitimacy of the adopted prince.
- **Using the controversial Doctrine of Lapse**—which stated that any princely state under British suzerainty would be annexed into British India if the ruler died without a natural male heir—the British government annexed Jhansi.

Key Contributions to the 1857 Revolt:

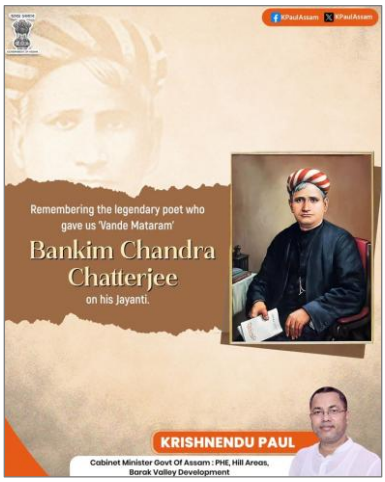
- **Refusing to yield her sovereignty to British colonial rule, the Queen took direct control of the kingdom**.
- She reorganized the armed forces of Jhansi, rallied local soldiers, and personally led them in armed resistance against the British East India Company forces.
- **Faced with an intense British assault, the Rani fought alongside her soldiers to defend her territory.**
- After the fall of Jhansi, she retreated toward Gwalior to keep the rebellion alive. On June 18, 1858, she was killed in battle while fighting British cavalry units near Gwalior.

Nation pays tribute to Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee on his martyrdom day

- Shyama Prasad Mukherjee was born in a Bengali Brahmin family on the **6th July 1901**, in Calcutta.
- He was an **Indian politician, barrister, and academician** who served as the Minister for Industry and Supply in Prime Minister **Jawaharlal Nehru's cabinet.**
- He started **"Bang Wani", a Bengali journal, in 1922** and **The Nationalist in 1940's.**
- At the age of 33, Shyama Prasad Mukherjee became the **youngest vice-chancellor of Calcutta University in 1934.**
- He **founded the Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS),** the predecessor of the modern-day Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP).
- He died in mysterious circumstances during detention **on 23rd June , 1953** while protesting against the **special status given to Kashmir.**

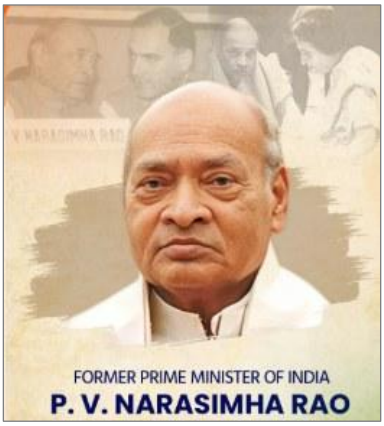


Prime Minister pays homage to Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay on his jayanti



- Born on 27th June 1838 in Naihati, West Bengal, Bankim was a brilliant student and joined British service after completing his studies.
- Nationalism and Literature: Through works like **Anandamath (banned by the British),** which narrates the **Sanyasi Rebellion**, Bankim became synonymous with India's struggle for independence.
- The national song of India, **Vande Mataram, originated from Bankim's Anandamath**, becoming a symbol of the freedom movement
- Famous Works**: Rajmohan's Wife ((1864) (first novel in English by an Indian).**
- His novels **Durgeshnandini (1865), Kapalkundala (1866), and Vishabriksha (1873)** addressed social issues like women's rights, child marriage, and caste discrimination.
- Also, his notable religious writings include Krishna Charitra.
- Role in the Bengali Renaissance: Bankim started the literary magazine **Bangadarshan (1872),** which played a key role in fostering Bengali nationalism.

PM Modi Pays tribute to former PM PV Narasimha Rao on his birth anniversary



- PV Narasimha Rao was born on **28th June 1921** in erstwhile **Nizam's Hyderabad state.**
- He was a freedom fighter, academician, and literary figure.
- He was also **the 9th Prime Minister of India** from **1991 to 1996.**
- He published **'SahasraPhan',** a Hindi translation of the famous Telugu Novel **'Veyi Padagalu'.**
- He is known for bringing the policy of **economic liberalisation** in India.
- **Foreign Policy:** In terms of foreign policy, he **established diplomatic relations with Israel.**
- The **Look East Policy of India** was also initiated during his tenure.
- He is also known for **reversing decades of unfriendly relations between India and the United States** by bringing them together.
- **Constitutional Reforms: 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments Act** empowering local bodies **were enacted during his tenure.**
- These amendments aim to empower local communities and ensure greater participation in decision-making processes.

State

Ladakh

Ladakh Gets India's First Model Border Village

- A **remote village of just 91 people near the India-China border is set to become the site of India's first Model Border Village.**
- Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh, Vinai Kumar Saxena **laid the foundation stone for the project at Chumur,** a settlement located 16,700 feet above sea level in **eastern Ladakh's Changthang region.**
- **Chumur would be developed as Ladakh's first Model Border Village under the Vibrant Village Programme**, aimed at creating "self-reliant, climate-resilient, tourism-enabled and economically vibrant border villages" in high-altitude frontier regions.
- The **initiative is part of the Vibrant Village Programme, launched by the Centre in 2023 to improve living conditions in villages located along India's northern borders.**

Ladakh Inaugurates 15 Common Facility Centres

- Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena **dedicated 15 common facility centres (CFCs) across the Union territory to strengthen micro-enterprises, generate livelihood opportunities for women and youth within their own villages and help reduce migration.**
- CFCs will function as shared workspaces for weavers, spinners, tailors, artisans and women self-help groups (SHGs), providing them with access to modern facilities for producing high-quality products.
- The newly established centres are located at Skurbuchan, Wanla, Saspol, Chuchot, Kharu, Anlay, Koyul, Korzok, Chushul, Phobrang, Sato, Panamik, Diskit, Turtuk and Digger.

Fotu La Tunnel Project Approved in Ladakh

- The **Fotu La Tunnel project on National Highway-01 in Ladakh has been approved with an estimated cost of ₹1,196.22 crore.**
- The project covers a 2.65-kilometre alignment and includes a 1.96-kilometre twin-tube tunnel and 0.69 kilometre of approach roads.
- Fotu La Pass is located at an altitude of about 4,108 metres and **is the highest point on the Uri–Srinagar–Leh highway corridor.**
- **National Highway-01 is a key road link in Ladakh** for civilian movement, essential supplies, and defence logistics.
- The **project includes a unidirectional twin-tube tunnel at Fotu La and approach roads on both sides.**
- A **twin-tube tunnel has two separate tubes for traffic movement, and unidirectional traffic flow** is used in road tunnels to improve operational control and safety.
- The existing road at Fotu La has steep gradients, sharp hairpin bends, and winter closures caused by snowfall and icy conditions. **High-altitude roads in Ladakh often face weather-related disruption because of low temperatures, snow accumulation, and difficult terrain.**
- **Fotu La Pass is one of the high-altitude passes on the Srinagar–Leh road axis in Ladakh**

Ladakh Gets Two High-Altitude Flower Fields



- Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena laid the foundation stone for **two high-altitude flower fields in Leh , first-of-its-kind high-altitude Flower Fields**.
- The two flower fields at **Choglamsar and Stakna in Leh** will be the first such high-altitude projects in the country.

Ladakh bans single-use plastics with penalties

- Ladakh has announced a ban on single-use plastics across the Union Territory, with authorities set to conduct random checks at Leh Airport and border entry points and impose strict penalties for violations.
- **Rs 10,000 Penalty For Violations, Rs 5,000 Fine For Littering**

Hemis Festival 2026 begins at historic Hemis Monastery in Ladakh

- This year, the festival will be celebrated on June 24 and 25, drawing monks, pilgrims, photographers and travellers from across the world to a remote corner of the Himalayas.
- The Hemis Festival, also known as **Hemis Tsechu**, commemorates the birth anniversary of **Guru Padmasambhava, also known as Guru Rinpoche.**



- For Buddhists, Guru Padmasambhava occupies a position comparable to that of **a great spiritual teacher and reformer.**
- He is credited with spreading **Vajrayana Buddhism** across Tibet and the Himalayan region during the eighth century.
- According to Buddhist traditions, he is believed to have subdued negative forces and transformed them into protectors of the faith.
- His teachings continue to influence Buddhist communities across **Ladakh, Tibet, Bhutan, Nepal and parts of India.**
- The festival is observed according to the **Tibetan lunar calendar and falls on the tenth day of the fifth lunar month each year.**
- The highlight is the **Cham dance**, a sacred masked dance performed by monks of the Hemis Monastery.

- Each mask, costume and movement carries religious symbolism, depicting stories of good triumphing over evil, the cycle of life and death, and the teachings of Guru Padmasambhava.

Jammu & Kashmir

What is Zojila Tunnel? All you need to know about the all weather tunnel in Ladakh

- India's ambitious, strategic, all weather Zojila Tunnel in seismic Zone IV is witnessed its final breakthrough on June 9, 2026,

What is the Zojila Tunnel?

- The 13.14 km tunnel cuts through the Himalayas at an altitude of 11,578 feet and **connects the Kashmir Valley with Kargil in Ladakh.**
- The **horseshoe shaped, single tube tunnel is 9.5 metres wide and 7.57 metres high**, and is designed as a two lane road passage at an elevation of about 11,578 feet above sea level.
- Located on the Srinagar Leh National Highway.
- It is **expected to provide all weather connectivity to Ladakh and reduce travel time from over an hour to about 15 minutes,**
- The tunnel **runs from Baltal in Jammu and Kashmir's Ganderbal district to Minimarg in the Drass sector of Ladakh**, with an 18 km approach road.
- The overall project spans 31 km, including roads and bridges, from Sonamarg to Minimarg.
- **Megha Engineering and Infrastructure Limited (MIEL) is executing the project using the New Austrian Tunnelling Method** to navigate the region's fragile geological conditions.
- The **tunnel bypasses the Zojila Pass**, which is prone to landslides and rockfall and remains inaccessible in winter.

Union Minister Dr Jitendra Singh inaugurates 4th Lavender Festival in Jammu and Kashmir



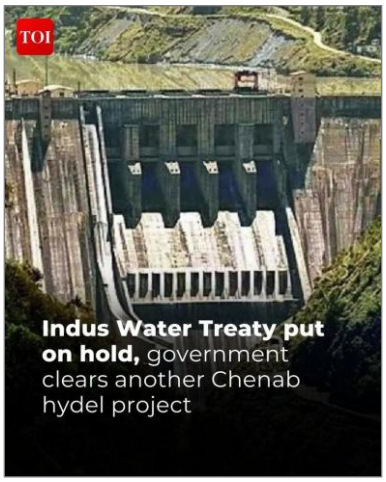
- Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh inaugurated the 4th Lavender Festival at Government Degree College in Bhaderwah town of Doda district of Jammu and Kashmir.
- **Organised by CSIR-Indian Institute of Integrative Medicine under the theme "Lavender Goes Global," the two-day festival showcases the achievements of the Purple Revolution and the expanding lavender economy in the region.**

India's 7th Regional Meteorological Centre Inaugurated in Jammu



- Union Minister for Science & Technology and Earth Sciences Dr. Jitendra Singh inaugurated the new Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC) at Jammu and **announced that a similar centre would soon be established in Lucknow, expanding India's regional weather forecasting network.**
- **The Jammu facility becomes the country's seventh Regional Meteorological Centre** and will serve Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh and Himachal Pradesh, providing specialised weather services, disaster warnings and climate support tailored to the Himalayan region.
- The new centre would strengthen weather monitoring, forecasting and early-warning systems in a region characterised by diverse terrain ranging from plains to high-altitude mountains.
- The region currently has 56 observatories, including 15 manual observatories, **25 Automatic Weather Stations** (AWSs) and 16 Automatic Rain Gauges (ARGs), compared to 13 AWSs and 14 ARGs in 2014. **Recently, AWSs have been installed at Kargil, Ukhral in Ramban district and Mata Vaishno Devi Bhawan.**
- The number of stations under the Daily Rainfall Monitoring Scheme has increased from 30 in 2014 to 85 at present.

Kirthai-II Hydroelectric Project



- A year after placing the Indus Water Treaty (IWT) in abeyance, **the government recently revived the long-stalled Kirthai Stage II Hydroelectric Project on the Chenab river in Kishtwar district of Jammu and Kashmir.**
- It is a 930 MW hydropower project planned on the Chenab River in the Kishtwar district of Jammu and Kashmir.
- The **project is being developed by Chenab Valley Power Projects.**
- **NHPC and Jammu and Kashmir State Power Development currently own the project having ownership stakes of 51% and 49%, respectively**.
- It is a **run-of-river project.** The hydro reservoir capacity is planned to be 51.26 million cubic meters.

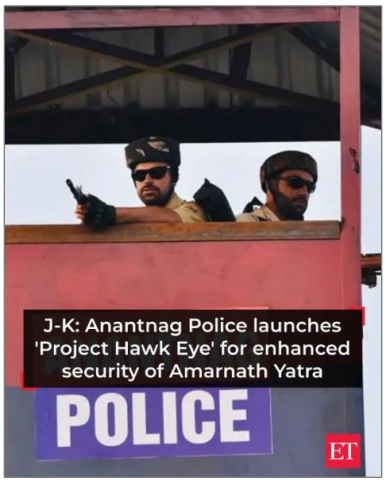
Key Facts - Chenab River

- It is a tributary of the Indus River.
- It is **formed by the confluence of two streams, Chandra and Bhaga, in the Lahaul and Spiti Districts of Himachal Pradesh.**
- In its upper reaches, it is also known as the Chandrabhaga.
- It **flows through the Jammu and Kashmir union territory, Himachal Pradesh, and after receiving the Jhelum River near Trimmu, the Chenab empties into the Sutlej River.**

Major Tributaries:

- **Left Bank**: Niru, Tawi, Neeru, and Liddrari
- **Right Bank**: Ans, Bhut Nalla, Bichleri, Kalnai Marusudar, and Miyar Nalla.
- **Major Dams on Chenab River**: Salal (rockfill dam), Aalal (concrete dam), Baglihar, and Dul.

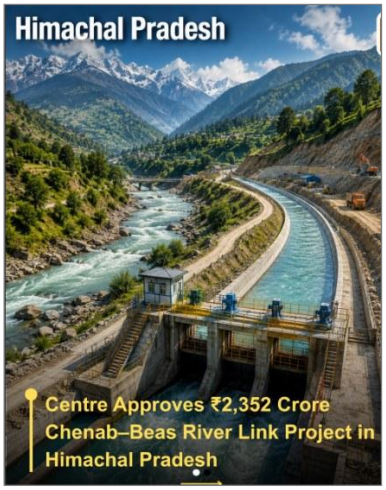
What is Project Hawk Eye Surveillance Technology?



- The Jammu and Kashmir Police in Anantnag district have launched a technology-driven security initiative named 'Project Hawk Eye' for the Shri Amarnath Ji Yatra 2026.
- Project Hawk Eye is an advanced, technology-linked security and surveillance framework deployed **to safeguard religious transit corridors.**
- It creates a seamless monitoring loop by combining high-altitude aerial tracking with ground-level biometric systems, specialized tactical units, and fortified static observation posts.
- Continuous Vigilance: Provide **24×7 surveillance across vulnerable stretches of the Yatra route.**
- Preventive Security: Enable early detection of suspicious activities for rapid response by security forces.
- Safe Pilgrimage: Ensure pilgrim safety, effective crowd management, and smooth conduct of the Yatra.

Himachal Pradesh

Chenab–Beas River-Link Project Approved in Himachal Pradesh



- The Central government of India approved the Chenab–Beas Link Tunnel project in May 2026.
- The **project is planned in Himachal Pradesh and has an estimated cost of ₹2,352 crore.**
- The project includes an 8.7-kilometre tunnel for **diverting surplus water from the Chenab basin into the Beas river system.**
- The diversion is linked to the Indus river system, which includes the Chenab, Jhelum, Ravi, Beas, and Sutlej rivers.
- **Phase 1 of the project includes a proposed 19-metre-high barrage on the Chandra**

river near Koksar village in the Lahaul valley of Himachal Pradesh.

- The Chandra river is a tributary in the upper Chenab basin in the western Himalayas.
- The **National Hydroelectric Power Corporation, or NHPC, will handle the project**.
- The project is expected to facilitate nearly 4,000 MW of additional hydropower generation in Himachal Pradesh.

Masroor Rock-Cut Temples



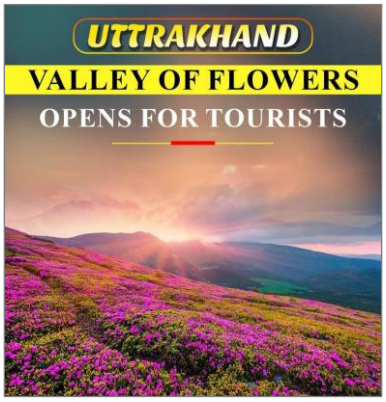
- Tucked away in the hills of **Himachal Pradesh's Kangra Valley lies Masroor Rock-Cut Temples**, an extraordinary piece of Indian heritage that is mostly ignored.
- Masroor Rock-Cut Temples, also referred to as **Masroor Temples, is an early 8th-century complex of rock-cut Hindu temples in the Kangra Valley of the Beas River in Himachal Pradesh.**
- They are often referred to as the **Ellora of Himachal and the Himalayan pyramid**
- Archaeological surveys say that they have been built around the 8th century — almost 1200 years ago — due to **their resemblance to the "Gupta style of architecture" from the same period.**
- However, there is no mention of the temple in any of the scriptures or historical records.
- **The temple complex was first reported by Henry Shuttleworth in 1913,** bringing it to the attention of archaeologists.

Architecture

- The 15-monument temple complex resembles the **North Indian Nagara architecture style** and is dedicated to Lord Shiva, Lord Ram, Goddess Sita, and Lord Lakshmana.
- **The temples were carved out of monolithic rock with a shikhara and provided with a sacred pool of water.**

Uttarakhand

Valley of Flowers National Park



- **Recently, the Valley of Flowers national park located in Chamoli district of Uttarakhand has been opened to tourists.**
- The valley is believed to have been discovered in 1931, when three British mountaineers – led by Frank S. Smythe.
- **It is a UNESCO World Heritage Site and forms one of the two core zones (the other being the Nanda Devi National Park) of the Nanda Devi Biosphere Reserve.**
- The gentle landscape of the Valley of Flowers National Park complements the rugged mountain wilderness of Nanda Devi National Park.
  - **Together they encompass a unique transition zone between the Zanskar and Great Himalayan ranges.**
- Exotic flowers (over 600 species) like orchids, poppies, primulas, marigolds, daisies, and anemones are an eye-catching spectacle.

The Kishau Multi-Purpose Dam



- **Union Home Minister chaired a crucial meeting in New Delhi where a historic consensus was reached among six stakeholder states to implement the long-pending Kishau Multi-Purpose Dam Project.**
- The six states of Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Haryana, Delhi, Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan agreed to sign a memorandum of understanding (MoU)
- **The Kishau Multi-Purpose Dam Project is a large-scale, under-construction water infrastructure and hydro-power development venture.**
- It has been designated as a project of national importance aimed at resolving inter-state water sharing issues, generating clean energy, and rejuvenating regional river ecosystems.
- **River and Site:** The dam is being constructed across the **Tons River, a primary tributary of the Yamuna River.**
- It is situated roughly 39 km (24 mi) north of Dakpathar and upstream of the existing Ichari Dam.

Key Features of the Project:

- **Engineering Specifications**: The design features a massive 236-meter-high concrete gravity dam backed by an estimated financial investment of ₹11,500 crore.
- **The structure will create a massive reservoir holding 1,324 Million Cubic Meters (MCM) of live water storage capacity.**
- **Power and Energy Generation**: The dam houses a hydroelectric power plant rated at 660 Megawatts (MW), which is projected to generate 1,379 Million Units (MU) of clean electricity annually.
- **The 90:10 Funding Framework**: Under the newly brokered agreement, the Central Government will fund 90 percent of the project's water component as a national financial assistance grant, while the six stakeholder states will split the remaining 10 percent.
- **Timeline**: Initially approved by the Ministry of Environment and Forests in 2018 after years of negotiation delays, the project is currently scheduled for full completion by 2028.

Punjab

June 6 marked the 42nd anniversary of Operation Blue Star



- **June 6 marked the 42nd anniversary of Operation Blue Star, the Army's military operation to flush out militants from the Golden Temple complex in Amritsar.**
- It was an Indian military operation in June 1984 ordered by Prime Minister Indira Gandhi to root out a group of militant Sikh separatists who had occupied the Golden Temple in Punjab's Amritsar, the Sikhs' holiest shrine.
- **The leader of the group was Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale, a Sikh fundamentalist, former head of the Sikh seminary Damdami Taksal**, and a key figure in the then-emerging separatist Khalistan movement.
- The military operation was planned to regain control of the complex while minimizing civilian casualties.
- While the army was successful in achieving its goals, some Sikhs were outraged as they saw the operation as an attack on their faith.
- According to the Indian government, about 400 people were killed, including 87 soldiers.
- **Operation Blue Star led to the assassination of Prime Minister Indira Gandhi, who was killed by her Sikh bodyguards in revenge five months after the operation**.

Nihangs launch 'Khalsa tax' drive against Himachal entry levy, warn of wider stir



- The members of the Nihang organisation Tarna Dal **launched a symbolic "Khalsa tax" collection drive on Himachal-registered vehicles entering Punjab near Kiratpur Sahib.**
- The campaign**, led by Nihang leader Achhar Singh**, was carried out along the **Kiratpur Sahib-Manali highway**, a key route connecting Punjab and Himachal Pradesh.
- Protesters described the exercise as a **symbolic response to the entry tax imposed by the Himachal Pradesh government on vehicles entering the hill state.**

Haryana

Haryana Assembly to host Commonwealth Parliamentary Association Northern Zone-II Conference from June 8



- The Haryana Legislative Assembly will host the Commonwealth Parliamentary Association (CPA) Northern Zone-II Conference of the India Region from June 8 to 10.
- **During the meeting, detailed discussions were held on delegate arrivals,**

accommodation, transportation, protocol, security, and facilities at the conference venues.

- The conference is expected to provide a platform for legislators from Northern Zone-II states to exchange views on parliamentary practices and strengthen cooperation among legislative institutions.

Chandigarh

Chandigarh University Becomes First Private University to Launch IndiaAI Data Lab with Intel

- **Chandigarh University inaugurated 'IndiaAI Data Lab' in collaboration with Intel India to improve the employability of students by equipping them with industry-relevant skills in Artificial Intelligence (AI), Data Science and emerging technologies.**
- As a dedicated space for students to learn foundational technical and career growth skills and build AI solutions, IndiaAI Data lab will provide students of computing and computer science engineering a simulated apprenticeship platform for getting practical skills, hands-on experience and opportunity to work on real-world projects.

Delhi

Ashok Leyland and Switch Mobility become the first OEMs to provide discounts under the scheme for replacement of old trucks and buses in Delhi-NCR

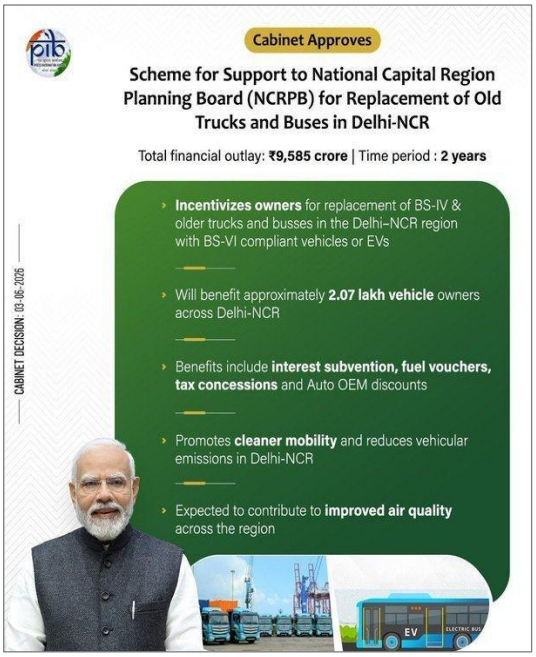


- **The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) signed the first Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) under the Government of India's vehicle replacement scheme with commercial vehicle manufacturer Ashok Leyland and its electric mobility subsidiary, Switch Mobility.**
- Ashok Leyland and Switch Mobility have become the first **Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs)** to partner with the Government for the implementation of the scheme aimed at replacing older, polluting trucks and buses operating in the Delhi-NCR region.
- The two companies will offer an 8 per cent discount on the ex-showroom price of eligible trucks and buses purchased under the scheme.
- **The scheme targets trucks and buses registered in Delhi-NCR that comply with Bharat Stage-IV (BS-IV) or earlier emission norms**.
- Vehicle owners replacing these older vehicles with Bharat Stage-VI (BS-VI) compliant vehicles or electric vehicles will be eligible to avail a range of financial incentives .
- **Apart from the 8 per cent discount being provided by participating OEMs, the Central Government will offer a 5 per cent interest subvention on vehicle financing.**
- Beneficiaries will also receive fixed monthly fuel vouchers for a period of five years.
- State Governments participating in the scheme will provide additional incentives, including up to 100 per cent concession on motor vehicle tax for a period of ten years and a complete waiver of registration fees for eligible beneficiaries.

Cabinet approves Scheme for support to NCRPB for replacement of old trucks and buses in Delhi-NCR area

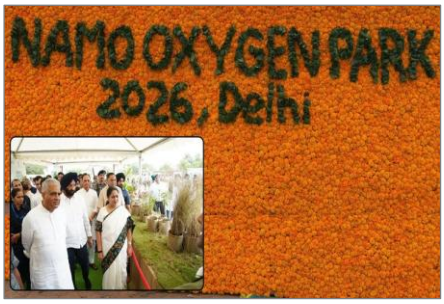
- The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved a two-year scheme aimed at replacing older trucks and buses operating in the Delhi-NCR region with cleaner BS-VI-compliant or electric vehicles.
- **The initiative will be funded through the National Capital Region Planning Board (NCRPB) under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs and will be implemented by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways and the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas in coordination with the governments of Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh.**

- The scheme has a total outlay of ₹9,585 crore, including ₹5,041 crore from the central government and an estimated ₹1,601 crore in tax concessions from participating states.
- **Owners of BS-IV and older vehicles will be encouraged to replace them with BS-VI-compliant or electric vehicles.** BS-III and older vehicles will have to be scrapped at registered vehicle scrapping facilities, while BS-IV vehicles may either be scrapped or sold outside NCR in non-NCAP cities and towns.
- To promote adoption, the Centre will provide a 5% interest subvention on loans for five years, monthly fuel vouchers of up to ₹4,800 depending on vehicle category, and lump-sum incentives for electric vehicle purchases or Certificate of Deposit trading.
- **State governments will waive registration fees, offer up to 100% motor vehicle tax concessions on new vehicles and 50% concessions on used vehicles for 10 years, and also waive pending liabilities on old vehicles enrolled under the scheme.**
- Participating automobile manufacturers will extend discounts of 8% on ex-showroom prices.



- The scheme will be implemented through a fully digital platform enabling eligibility verification, automated benefit disbursal, and monitoring of emission reduction outcomes.

Delhi Gets 18 New Namo Oxygen Parks Under 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' Campaign



- Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav and Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta inaugurated **18 Namo Oxygen Parks across the national capital and launched a series of green initiatives under the nationwide 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' campaign.**
- **The event, held at the Namo Oxygen Park in Maidangarhi, was aimed at strengthening urban greening**, improving air quality, and encouraging community participation in environmental conservation.
- The programme also included a plantation drive under the 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' campaign and an exhibition showcasing local grass and shrub species as part of the 'Dust-Free Delhi' initiative.

Delhi govt. notifies 'Proactive Winter Air Quality Management Framework'



- The Delhi government has notified the 'Proactive Winter Air Quality Management Framework' to tackle air pollution more effectively during the winter months.
- Under the notified framework, **fuel will be provided at all petrol pumps in Delhi only to vehicles possessing a valid Pollution Under Control Certificate (PUCC).**
- In addition, non-BS-VI commercial vehicles registered outside Delhi will not be allowed to enter the city between November 1 and January 31.
- **However, CNG vehicles, electric vehicles, emergency service vehicles, and those engaged in government work will be exempt from this restriction,**

Ex-Agniveers Get 20% Reservation in Delhi Government Jobs

- **Lieutenant-Governor (L-G) Taranjit Singh Sandhu instructed all departments to implement a 20% reservation for former Agniveers in direct recruitment to vacant Group C posts and set June 30 as a deadline for completing the required amendments to recruitment rules.**
- Agnipath scheme is a central government scheme launched in 2022 for recruitment to the armed forces.
- It is a recruitment process for individuals below the rank of officer, with the goal of deploying fitter, younger troops on the front lines, many of whom will be on four-year contracts.
- **The armed forces would also have the option to retain some of the best 'Agniveers.'**

Agniveers

- They will be recruited as personnel below officer (PBOR) rank in the army, air force and navy for four years, including six months of training.
- Around 45,000 to 50,000 soldiers, between age of 17.5 to 21 years (23 years for the current year's recruitment) will be recruited annually.

Permanent enrolment

- Only 25% of total recruits will be allowed to continue for another 15 years under permanent commission.

Uttar Pradesh

UP CM launches 'Project GANGA'

- Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on June 09, 2026 launched 'Project Ganga'.
- **The project will ensure last-mile digital connectivity in rural areas while expanding opportunities in digital education, telemedicine, e-governance, skill development, and technology-based employment**.
- Under Project Ganga, a comprehensive network of Digital Service Providers (DSPs) will be developed across the state.
- **Through this initiative, the government aims to provide high-speed internet connectivity to approximately 20 lakh families**, prepare 8 to 10,000 Digital Service Providers, and generate more than one lakh direct and indirect employment opportunities.
- The **project is being launched in 21 districts during its first phase.**

UPERC Approves Uttar Pradesh Power Purchase from Bhutan Project

- Uttar Pradesh Power Corporation has received UPERC approval **to source electricity from the 511-MW hydro project of Khorluchu Hydro Power in Bhutan.**
- Khorluchu Hydro Power is a joint venture between homegrown Tata Power and Druk Green Power Corporation.
- **Situated on the Kholongchhu River in Eastern Bhutan's Trashiyangtse district,** the project seeks to meet Bhutan's rising electricity demands and aid India's renewable energy transition.
- It is the **first-ever energy project to be developed through a joint venture (JV) partnership between India and Bhutan.**
- The 600 MW project the project is expected to be commissioned in September 2029.
- The project will feature a 95m-high concrete gravity dam measuring 165m in length and 6m in width.
- The electricity generated from the Kholongchhu hydroelectric project will be transmitted to the NEWNE grids of Bhutan and India via 400 kV transmission lines.

Fazil Nagar in UP renamed Pawagarh: CM Yogi Adityanath

- Fazil Nagar assembly segment in Kushinagar district of eastern UP will now be known as **Pawagarh in honour of Jain Tirthankar Lord Mahavir.**
- The proposed name, Pawagarh, is **derived from Pawapuri in Bihar, a revered Jain pilgrimage site which is believed to be the Nirvana (salvation) place of Lord Mahavir.**

Uttar Pradesh Launches Teacher Cashless Health Scheme Portal

- The Uttar Pradesh government is in the final stages of launching the Mukhyamantri Shikshak Cashless Chikitsa Yojana, **under which teachers, education department employees and their dependent family members will be eligible for cashless medical treatment of up to Rs 5 lakh annually.**
- Under the programme, beneficiaries will receive treatment at empanelled government and private hospitals using a Mukhyamantri Shikshak Cashless Chikitsa Card.



- **Medical expenses up to the prescribed limit will be covered under the scheme**, reducing the financial burden on families during serious illnesses and medical emergencies.

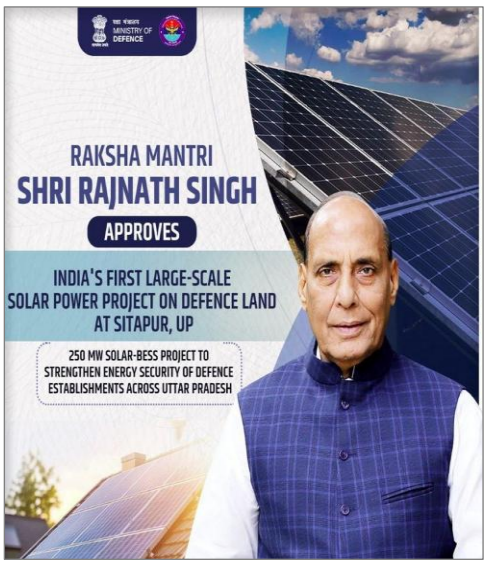
Jhansi first UP district with 'no child labour in its 496 villages'



- **In line with Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath's announcement to make Uttar Pradesh child labour-free by 2027, Jhansi is set to become the first district of the state** where all 496 of its gram panchayats would be declared child labour-free.
- **'Child labour-free' status does not imply that every household in the district was physically inspected**. Rather, it means that all identified child labourers were withdrawn from work, enrolled in schools, and their families linked with welfare schemes.
- **A working child under the age of 14 years is considered a child labour as per Indian laws.**

Sitapur Solar Project

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh has approved the establishment of a 250 MW Solar Power Project in Sitapur, Uttar Pradesh.
- **Defence Minister Rajnath Singh has approved the establishment of a 250 MW Solar Power Project with a Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) in Sitapur, Uttar Pradesh,** marking a pioneering effort among several planned projects aimed at utilising thousands of acres of unused defence land across India for various green energy initiatives.
- **This is the first-of-its-kind project undertaken by the Ministry of Defence (MoD),** involving the development of a large-scale solar power generation facility with integrated BESS support on defence land.



- The **project is expected to substantially reduce expenditure incurred on procurement of conventional grid power for defence establishments, resulting in significant savings to the government exchequer over the life cycle of the project.**
- The project will be implemented in close coordination with Integrated HQ of MoD (Army) and Directorate General Defence Estates (DGDE),"
- **Energy storage refers to systems that can store excess renewable electricity** during periods of high generation and discharge it when demand rises but power generation remains low.
- At its core, energy storage systems convert electricity from renewable sources such as solar and wind, when it is available, into forms that can be stored. Later, it converts these back into electricity when need arises.
- **A range of energy storage technologies are being deployed globally. Among them, pumped hydro storage (PHS) and battery energy storage systems (BESS) are currently the most widely used.**
- PHS uses surplus electricity to pump water from a lower reservoir to a higher one. When electricity demand peaks, it releases the stored water downhill through turbines to generate power.
- **BESS technology stores electricity chemically and discharges it when needed.**
- Lithium-ion batteries, particularly lithium iron phosphate (LFP) batteries, are currently the dominant technology for grid-scale storage because of their falling costs, high efficiency and long operational life.

Union Ministers, UP CM lay foundation stone for Amber and Ascent-K Circuits plant in Jewar, Uttar Pradesh



- Union Ministers Ashwini Vaishnaw and Bhupender Yadav, along with Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, laid the foundation stone for the **Amber and Ascent-K Circuits manufacturing plant in Jewar, Uttar Pradesh.**
- ASCENT-K Circuit, a joint venture **with Korea's KCC, and AMBER Enterprises.**
- India is now positioning itself to manufacture the very **'brain' of electronic devices - the Printed Circuit Boards, commonly known as PCBs.**

Madhya Pradesh

Rewa Sundarja Mango

- Recently, the **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)** has facilitated the first commercial export of Rewa Sundarja Mangoes from Madhya Pradesh to the **United Arab Emirates (UAE).**
- It is a highly esteemed variety of mango cultivated in Madhya Pradesh.
- It is known for **ripening only after the first monsoon showers.**
- It received the **Geographical Indication tag in 2023.`**
- Its vibrant yellow flesh is fibreless and smooth, providing a rich, creamy texture.
- The distinct **vanilla-like aroma** enhances its taste, making it ideal for both fresh consumption and culinary preparations.
- It has a **balanced sugar-acid ratio**, contributing to its unique flavour profile.
- It has **thick peel and has excellent shelf life**, ensuring suitability for transportation.
- Its **lower sugar content makes it suitable for diabetic patients** while still retaining its natural sweetness.
- It is known for its **exceptional sweetness, rich aroma, fibreless pulp and distinctive flavour**.

Key Facts about APEDA

- It is a **statutory body** established by the Government of India under the **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority Act in December, 1985.**
- Nodal Ministry: It works under the **Ministry of Commerce and Industry.**
- Objective: To develop and promote the export of scheduled products.
- APEDA is headed by a Chairman appointed by the Central Government.
- **Headquarters: New Delhi**.

New GI-Tagged Tribal Crops of Madhya Pradesh

- Four unique traditional crops of Madhya Pradesh have been recently granted the prestigious Geographical Indication (GI) Tag.
- The four crops recognised are **Sitahi Kutki** (Sitahi Minor Millet), **Nagdaman Kutki** (Nagdaman Minor Millet), **Baigani Arhar** (Baigani Pigeon Pea) and **Chhatriya Dhan** (Chhatriya Paddy).
- These crops have been traditionally preserved for generations, particularly **by the Baiga tribe** from the Dindori region of Madhya Pradesh.

Sitahi and Nagdaman Kutki:

- They are **highly nutritious minor millets**, rich in dietary fiber, minerals and antioxidants, making them health-promoting.
- These two specific varieties are inherently climate-resilient.



Baigani Arhar:

- Deeply integrated with the heritage of the Baiga tribe, this local variety of **pigeon pea (toor dal) is completely cultivated using organic, age-old tribal practices.**
- It stands out for having a notably higher natural protein content and a distinct sweet flavor compared to commercial varieties.
- It has a shorter maturation cycle (5–6 months) and requires significantly **less cooking time, retaining its high concentration of dietary fibre, iron, calcium, and B-complex vitamins.**

Chhatriya Dhan:

- Cultivated across the fertile **wetlands of Jabalpur and Katni,** this traditional rice variety is historically revered for its hardiness and culinary excellence.
- It is famous for its distinct aroma, taste, and local adaptability.

- Unlike heavily processed white rice, **Chhatriya Dhan retains its vital bran layer, providing a rich source of vitamin B1 (thiamine), essential minerals, and healthy fats.**
- It offers clean, easily digestible energy with a balanced amino acid profile, making it a wholesome staple.

The Khurasani Imli, fruit of Mandu's iconic Baobab tree, has been awarded the Geographical Indication (GI) tag

- Khurasani Imli or Tamarind is a fruit of Mandu's (Madhya Pradesh) iconic Baobab tree.
- It was brought to Mandav during the reign of Mahmud Khilji in the 14th century and its name was changed from 'Baobab' to "Khurasani Imli.
- It is known by **one more name Mandav Imli.**
- It has a light green fruit with a **tangy sweet-sour flavour,** grows across villages in the Mandu region.

Benefits

- Tribal communities have traditionally used not only the pulp but also the tree's juice and **dried bark for treating ailments such as diabetes.**
- It is packed with **Vitamin C, antioxidants, and essential minerals.**
- Tribal healers have long used it to treat digestive ailments, fever, and fatigue, while seeds and bark also hold medicinal value.

Indori Malwi Potato, Garadu and Balam kakdi from Madhya Pradesh Get GI Tag

- **Garadu tuber**, a winter delicacy from Madhya Pradesh's Malwa region, and the **juicy Balam cucumber from Sailana** have been granted the prestigious Geographical Indication (GI) tag.
- **The Indori Malwi potato** received the Geographical Indication tag
- The Malwi potato is known for low sugar and low starch content.
- **It retains a white colour after frying and is used for chips and French fries**.
- Balam cucumber, cultivated in **Ratlam's Sailana area**, is known for its large size and distinctive colour, making for a juicy summer snack,
- while Garadu, grown across the Malwa region in western MP, is a starchy tuber relished during winters.
- Garadu is usually deep-fried and served with spices and a dash of lemon juice.

Sahariya Tribe



- The President recently interacted with Cheetah Mitras and members of the Sahariya tribe at **Kuno National Park in Madhya Pradesh's Sheopur district.**
- It is one of the Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTG).
- They are also called by the names **Seher, Sair, Savar, Saonar, Sahra, etc.**
- They live on the margins — in the forests and villages of **Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan.**
- They mostly live in a **distinct settlement called 'Seharana'** which is generally a cluster of houses.
- The houses are made of some stone boulders, and the roofing is also made of stone slabs – locally called Patore.
- In some villages, mud structures are also constructed.
- Religion: They practice Hinduism infused with veneration of local deities like Bhavani, Gond Devta, and Bijasur, alongside animistic elements tied to their jungle-dwelling heritage.



- The Saharia are divided into five sub-tribes: the Jati, Arsi, Muli, Kindal, and Kumbi.
- The Jati are farmers; the Arsi are weavers; the Muli are iron workers; the Kindal are basket makers; and the Kumbi are potters.
- They are known for their dance, **the Saharia Swang, which is performed during the month of Holi.**
- The dance is performed to the beats of the dhol, nagari, and matki.
- It features a male dressed in female attire who dances around the male performers.
- They are particularly skilled in making catechu from khair trees.

Madhya Pradesh to Relaunch State Bus Service



- Madhya Pradesh Government will soon relaunch a state-wide public transport bus service, **which was discontinued in 2005, The bus service 'Mukhya Mantri Sugam Parivahan Sewa'**
- The services **will now be launched by the Madhya Pradesh Passenger Transport and Infrastructure Limited, a State-level company, and the infrastructure is being developed under the public-private partnership (PPP) model.**
- The State has been divided into seven regions — Indore, Ujjain, Bhopal, Jabalpur, Sagar, Gwalior and Rewa with one subsidiary company responsible for each region— and **the first phase will be launched from Indore in July first phase will be launched from Indore region,**

Kshipra River

- The **Kshipra riverine system in Madhya Pradesh is facing a major crisis marked by the drying up of its tributaries that fail to maintain a perennial flow.**
- The Kshipra, also known as the Shipra, is a river that flows in the state of Madhya Pradesh.
- It is a tributary of the Chambal River.
- It is a perennial river and is considered as sacred as the Ganga River by the Hindus.
- **Origin**: It originates from the Vindhya Range near Ujjain, Madhya Pradesh.
- It flows across the Malwa Plateau to join the Chambal River.
- **The river is 195 kilometers long, with a significant portion passing through Ujjain.**
- **Major Tributaries**: Khan and Gambhir.
- The Puranas, or ancient Hindu texts, put forward that the Shipra originated from the heart of Varaha, Lord Vishnu's incarnation as a boar.
- **Also on the banks of the Shipra is Sage Sandipani's ashram or hermitage, where Krishna, Lord Vishnu's eighth incarnation, had studied.**
- It finds mention not only in ancient Hindu texts but also in Buddhist and Jain scriptures.
- The holy city of Ujjain is located on the right bank of the Shipra River.
- The famous Kumbha Mela takes place in the ghats of this city, once every 12 years.
- There are hundreds of Hindu shrines along the banks of the Shipra River.

Halma Tradition

- **In Borpada village in Madhya Pradesh's Jhabua district, residents revived the Bhil tradition of Halma to clean and restore a public well.**
- Halma is an old collective tradition practiced by the Bhil tribal community of Madhya Pradesh.
- **Its direct meaning is**: to work together without wages or contract, sustained by mutual obligation and belonging.
- At its heart, Halma represents a profound tradition of voluntary collective labour.
- The roots of this tradition reach back to an era when these communities had neither large resources, nor government support, nor a marketplace.
- **There is no formal leader and no grand announcement. There is only work, done side by side.**
- No monetary compensation is expected.
- Participation arises not from obligation enforced by external authority but from ethical commitment, ancestral values, and the assurance that when needed, the favor will be returned.

In recent years, Halma has been revitalized to address common challenges such as:

- Restoration of traditional water bodies
- Afforestation of barren hills
- Construction of contour trenches for rainwater conservation
- Revitalization of biodiversity and soil health...

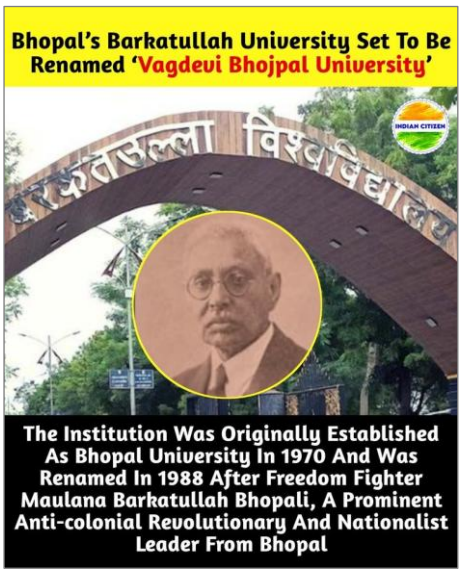
Madhya Pradesh Removes Two-Child Norm for Government Jobs



- For more than two decades, Madhya Pradesh followed a provision introduced in 2001 as part of population-control measures.
- **Under this system, a candidate having more than two living children on or after January 26, 2001, was deemed ineligible for direct recruitment and departmental appointments in government service.**
- Under the Madhya Pradesh Civil Services Conduct Rules, 1965, having more than two children was also treated as misconduct for government servants.
- **Rajasthan had lifted a similar bar during Vasundhara Raje's tenure in 2016, while Chhattisgarh removed the restriction under Raman Singh in 2017.**

Maulana Barkatullah Bhopali

- The **Executive Council of Bhopal's Barkatullah University has passed a proposal to rename the institution Vagdevi Bhojpal University.**
- Maulana Barkatullah Bhopali (July 7, 1854 – September 1927) was a **legendary anti-colonial revolutionary, scholar, and fiery journalist** who served as the Prime Minister of India's first Government in Exile, established in 1915.



- He **spent** the entirety of his adult life operating from international soil, building global anti-imperial networks to secure India's complete independence from British rule.
- Born in Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh, **he was a highly meritorious student who mastered multiple languages**
- His regular anti-British articles and fiery public speeches quickly made him a prime target for British intelligence, forcing him to flee to the United States in 1899.
- Barkatullah was a staunch believer in absolute Hindu-Muslim solidarity.

Major Contributions to the Indian Freedom Movement:

- Barkatullah's anti-colonial operations spanned a complex, global network of alliances:
- **On 1 December 1915, Barkatullah co-founded the Provisional Government of India in Kabul, the first Indian government established outside British control to seek international support for independence.**
- Raja Mahendra Pratap served as President, Maulana Barkatullah as Prime Minister, and Maulana Ubaidullah Sindhi as Home Minister, symbolizing a united nationalist front.
- **Barkatullah emerged as a key leader of the Ghadar Party (1913),** which advocated armed revolution and rejected constitutional methods for ending British rule.

Bihar

Zardalu Mangoes

- Every summer, more than 125 quintals of Bhagalpur's famed Zardalu mangoes are carefully selected, packed and dispatched to the President, the Prime Minister, and other top dignitaries, turning a regional fruit into a symbol of Bihar's agricultural heritage.
- **Zardalu mango, also called Jardalu, is a unique mango variety from Bhagalpur, Bihar.**
- It is known for its light yellow skin and distinct special aroma.
- Its **story dates back to the early 19th century when Maharaja Rahmat Ali Khan Bahadur of Haveli Kharagpur introduced its cultivation in the Bhagalpur region.**
- The first sapling, planted between 1810 and 1820, still stands in Tagepur village, serving as a living testament to this mango's enduring legacy.
- The **Jardaloo mangoes are available from mid-April through the end of June**.
- As the fruit matures, the skin of the Zardalu mango turns golden-yellow with a tinge of red across the top of the fruit.

- Jardalu mangoes are rich with fibre & enzymes; it's highly beneficial to the digestive system.
- **In 2018, the Jardalu mango received the prestigious Geographical Indication (GI) tag.**

Three Traditional Products of Bihar Receive GI Tag

- **Three traditional products of Bihar — Bawan Buti Saree and Fabric (Nalanda), Patharkatti Stone Craft (Gaya), and Pidiya Painting (Bhojpur) — have been granted the Geographical Indication (GI) Tag,** providing legal recognition and protection to these unique cultural and handicraft traditions.
- **Bawan Buti Saree and Fabric (Nalanda):** This traditional art involves hand-weaving 52 cultural motifs and symbols onto fabric and **has been preserved for generations, mainly in Baswan Bigha and its surrounding areas.**
- **Patharkatti Stone Craft (Gaya):** Gaya's nearly 300-year-old Pattharkatti stone craft is renowned across India for its intricate carvings on local black granite, depicting Lord Buddha, deities, and elements of folk culture.
- **Peedhiya Painting (Bhojpur):** This traditional art, created by women during festivals and special occasions, depicts rural life, family relationships, and religious beliefs through natural colours and traditional symbols.

Jharkhand

Jharkhand Gets GI Tags for 11 Traditional Products

- Jharkhand's rich cultural heritage has received a major boost with 11 traditional products from the state being granted Geographical Indication, or GI, tags.

The newly recognised products include :

1. Bhoya Saree and Fabric,
2. Kuchai Silk Saree,
3. Kesaria Kalakand,
4. Dokra Craft,
5. Tumka Chadar,
6. Baroni Paintings,
7. Munda Jewellery,
8. Jharkhand Bamboo Craft,
9. Tussar Silk and Sarees,
10. Jadopatia Painting,
11. Pancho Saree and Fabric.

Bhagaiya silk

- It is a hand spun silk textile **mainly woven by Santhal tribal women.**
- These silk varieties, deeply rooted in local knowledge systems and indigenous craftsmanship, represent generations of skill passed down within rural communities

Kuchai silk

- It is **produced by tussar silkworms cultivated on the trees of Asan and Arjun.**
- It is a part of ancient tradition of Jharkhand, which provides livelihood in rural areas.
- It was started in the small village of Seraikela-Kharsawan – 'Kuchai' and is now spread all over Jharkhand.



Munda Jewellery

- It is the distinctive artistic tradition of the Munda tribal community.
- It is **characterised by its unique motifs**, craftsmanship and cultural significance, the jewellery embodies the rich tribal heritage of Jharkhand.

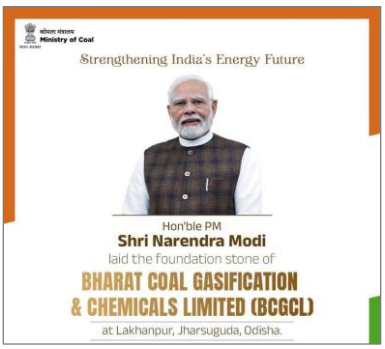
Jharkhand bamboo craft

- This product is **made from locally available bamboo and will now be accessible to a wider market.**
- It involves creativity and craftsmanship of rural artisans who transform locally available bamboo resources into a wide range of utility and decorative products.

- **Kesaria Kalakand** : The sweet is native to the Koderma district , **Recognized for its rich texture and distinct traditional preparation, Concentrated milk (khoa), sugar, alum, garnished with kesar (saffron), almonds, and pistachios.**
- **Dokra Craft** : It utilizes the "Lost-Wax Casting" (Cire Perdue) method. This non-ferrous metal technique combines clay molding with thin beeswax wires.
- **Tumka Chadar:** The textile is deep-rooted in the cultural heritage of the Dumka district (Santhal Pargana region)
- **Jadopatia Painting:** The Name: Derived from Jadu (magic painter) and Patia (scroll). **The themes of the paintings are stories from Ramayana and Mahabharata, festivals and other rituals**. But the most famous and important theme is life after death of man (of the Santhal).
- **Pancho Saree and Fabric**: It is worn predominantly by tribal women during festivals, weddings, and socio-cultural ceremonies
- **Tussar Silk and Sarees**: Known for its rich, coarse texture and natural golden-beige sheen, the semi-wild silk is woven by rural tribal communities. Tussar comes from Antheraea mylitta silkworms that feed on wild Sal, Arjun, and Asan trees.

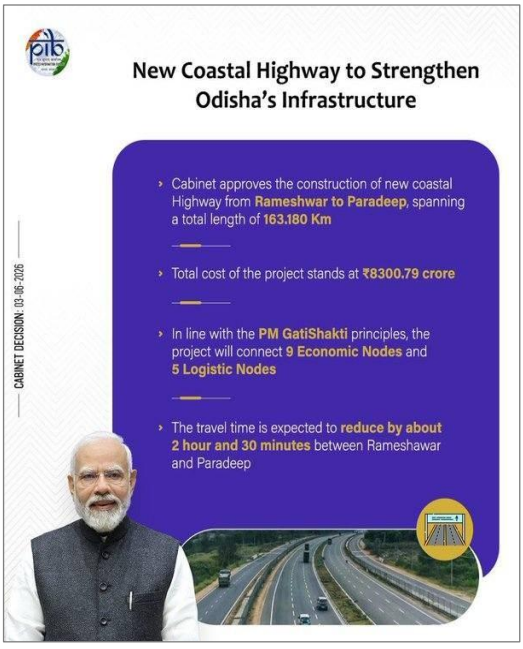
Odisha

The Coal-to-Ammonium Nitrate Project



- Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone for India's first commercial-scale **coal-to-ammonium nitrate project at Lakhanpur in Jharsuguda district, Odisha.**
- The project is **India's first commercial-scale industrial facility designed to convert raw domestic coal into ammonium nitrate.**
- The project is being developed by Bharat Coal Gasification and Chemicals Limited (BCGCL), a joint venture between Bharat Heavy Electricals (BHEL) and Coal India (CIL).
- The facility will produce 2,000 tonnes of ammonium nitrate a day using **coal gasification technology developed indigenously by BHEL**

Cabinet approves construction of new coastal Rameshwar-Paradeep highway in Odisha



- The Union Cabinet approved the construction of a new coastal highway from Rameshwar to Paradeep in Odisha at a total project cost of ₹8,300.79 crore.
- The **new coastal highway from Rameshwar to Paradeep will be constructed on a hybrid annuity model**, in two packages, with a combined total length of 160.18 km.
- upon completion, travel time is expected to reduce by about 2 hour and 30 minutes between Rameshawar and Paradeep
- **The project section of new coastal Highway from Rameshwar to Paradeep passes through Khurda, Puri, Kendrapada and Jagatsinghpur Districts of Odisha, existing road network of NH-16 is part of the Golden Quadrilateral and is already a 6-lane highway passing through major towns Khordha, Bhubaneswar, and Cuttack.**
- The existing NH-316 connects Bhubaneswar–Puri and further extends towards Satapada and Konark.

Odisha village to get crocodile warning system under 'Smart Village' plan

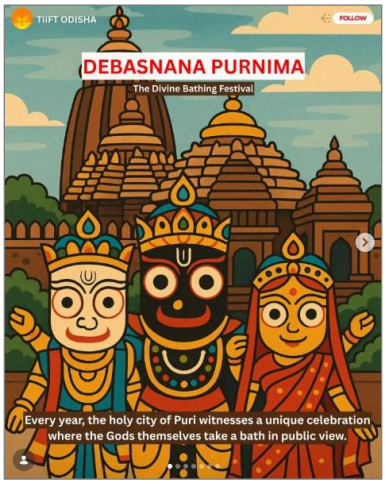
- The **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) accelerates the deployment of technologies in Kusunpur, a remote village in Odisha's Kendrapara district, as part of the 'Smart Village' initiative**, residents may soon receive alerts whenever crocodiles stray dangerously close to their homes.
- The CSIR laboratories are planning to introduce an **artificial intelligence (AI)-enabled wild animal detection** and alert system aimed at mitigating human-animal conflict.

Pahili Raja festival begins in Odisha, marking onset of monsoon and Ashadha month



- **In Odisha, the three-day Raja festival began with the celebration of Pahili Raja, ushering in the onset of the monsoon and the Odia month of Ashadha.**
- Young girls are marking the occasion by taking traditional baths, wearing new clothes, and adorning themselves with alta on their feet and mehendi on their hands
- **Raja swings hung from trees have become centres of celebration as girls sang traditional Raja songs while enjoying the festivities.**
- The festival derives its name from **Rajaswala**, reflecting the belief that the earth, like women, undergoes a period of rest and rejuvenation.

Deba Snana Jatra of Lord Jagannath Begins with Traditional Grandeur in Puri



- Deba Snana Jatra or the Snana Jatra, or the ceremonial **bathing festival of Lord Jagannath, Lord Balabhadra and Devi Subhadra**, is being observed with traditional grandeur at the Shree Jagannath Temple.
- The annual ritual, held on the auspicious occasion of Deba Snana Purnima, marks an important prelude to the world-famous Rath Yatra.
- The deities have been brought in a **ceremonial procession to the Snana Bedi, where they will be bathed with 108 pots of sanctified water drawn from the temple's sacred Golden Well**
- Following the ceremonial bath, the deities will enter the **fortnight-long Anasara period**, during which they remain out of public view before reappearing for **Nabajoubana Darshan ahead of the Rath Yatra** to be held on 16th of next month.

West Bengal

Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi participates in Paschimbanga Divas celebrations in Hooghly, West Bengal



- The Bharatiya Janata Party government, after coming to power, had announced that it would observe **June 20 as Paschim Banga Dibas.**
- On June 20, 1947 Jana Sangh founder **Syama Prasad Mookerjee moved the proposal in the Bengal Legislative Assembly for the partition of Bengal,** which paved the way for the creation of a "homeland for Hindus of Bengal"
- The theme for this year's Paschimbanga Divas: **"West Bengal: Heritage, Harmony and Development,"**

West Bengal Joins NeVA, Becomes 33rd Legislature on Digital Platform

- **The West Bengal Legislative Assembly signed a tripartite Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) for the implementation of the National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA),** becoming the 33rd legislature in the country to join the Centre's flagship initiative aimed at digitising legislative functioning.
- With West Bengal joining the initiative, 33 legislatures are now part of the NeVA platform, while 21 have already transitioned to fully digital functioning.
- **The project is a Mission Mode initiative of the Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs aimed at creating a paperless, transparent and citizen-centric legislative ecosystem in line with the Digital India vision.**
- The platform enables end-to-end digital management of legislative business, including questions, bills, notices, committee proceedings, lists of business and bulletins, while also serving as a permanent digital repository of legislative records and proceedings.

West Bengal Yuva Shakti Bharosa Card scheme



- **The newly formed Bengal BJP government led by Suvendu Adhikari has initiated the process to fulfill the party's pre-election promise of rolling out the 'Yuva Shakti Bharosa Card' – a welfare initiative for the state's unemployed youth.**
- It is a welfare initiative designed to support educated, unemployed youth across West Bengal.
- **The scheme replaces the previous administration's 'Yuvashree' initiative,** effectively doubling the monthly allowance and introducing an additional one-time grant to support career development.

Benefits under this scheme

- Beneficiaries will receive a monthly allowance of Rs 3,000 (an increase from the Rs 1,500 offered under the previous scheme).

Who is eligible?

- The state government has laid out four strict criteria for applicants. If you do not meet all of these points, your application will be rejected during verification.
- **Education**: Must have passed at least Madhyamik (Class 10) or its equivalent examination.
- **Residency**: Must be a permanent resident of West Bengal.
- **Age limit:** Must be between 21 and 40 years old.
- **Employment status**: Must be completely unemployed at the time of application.
- **The official portal for the 'Yuva Shakti Bharosa Card' has already been set up.**

Assam

Ambubachi Mela



- The annual Ambubachi Mela which is one of the largest and most significant religious gatherings in eastern India started at the revered Kamakhya Temple.
- The Ambubachi festival is held **during the monsoon, generally in June at the Kamakhya Temple in Guwahati, Assam.**
- It is a shrine to the **Goddess Kamakhya** and one of the most important centres of **Tantrik Shaktism**.
- The period of Ambubachi is believed to be the period of **the goddess's annual menstruation**, and the shrine is closed for this.

The Kamakhya Temple

- Location: It is situated on **Nilachal Hill and adjoining the southern bank of the Brahmaputra River**.
- It is one of the most revered centres of Tantric practices. It is regarded as **one of the oldest of the 51 Shakti Peethas** in India.
- It had been modelled out of a combination of two different styles namely, the traditional **nagara and Saracenic or Mughal style of architecture.**

Tezpur Litchi



- Recently, the **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) facilitated the first export consignment of GI-tagged Tezpur Litchi from Assam to Dubai.**
- It is one of Assam's most celebrated horticultural products.
- It is renowned for its exceptional sweetness, bright-red appearance, distinctive aroma and superior eating quality.
- The region cultivates several notable varieties, including Bombaya, Bilati, Elaichi, Piyaji and Sahi.

- It **received the geographical indication (GI) tag in 2015.**

Key Facts about Litchi

- It is a tropical fruit belonging to the Sapindaceae family.
- It is a sub-tropical fruit and thrives best under moist sub-tropical climate.
- It usually prefers low elevation and can be grown up to an altitude of 800 m.
- **Soil**: Deep, well drained loamy soil, rich in organic matter and having pH in the range of 5.0 to 7.0 is ideal for the crop.
- **The temperature should not go beyond 40.5 0C in summer and below freezing point in winter.**
- **India is the second largest producer of litchi in the World after China**. It is widely cultivated in India, especially in Bihar, West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh, Jharkhand, and Assam

Assam Plans One Crore Tree Plantation Drive

- Assam will launch a statewide plantation drive on World Environment Day, 5 June 2026, to plant one crore saplings across the state.
- The initiative will involve about 35 lakh women from Self-Help Groups and will be linked to community-based environmental action in rural and urban areas.

Mission Senehjori



- **Recently, the Union Minister for Development of North Eastern Region (MDoNER) together with the Hon'ble Chief Minister of Assam launched Mission "Senehjori" – Assam Muga Silk USP.**
- It is a comprehensive **cluster-based initiative aimed at transforming Assam's unique Muga silk sector** into a globally competitive, high-value luxury textile ecosystem.
- **Objective**: It seeks to strengthen the entire Muga silk value chain from host-plant cultivation and silkworm seed production to reeling, weaving, branding, export promotion, digital traceability and tourism.
- **Funding**: It has an estimated investment of ₹396–411 crore over a **three-year period.**

Assam Speaker Grants LoP Status to Wazed Ali Choudhury

- **Assam Legislative Assembly Speaker Ranjeet Kumar Dass granted Leader of Opposition status to senior Congress leader Wazed Ali Choudhury.**
- The Assam Legislative Assembly has 126 members, and the Congress secured 19 seats in the recent state assembly elections.

Majuli Island

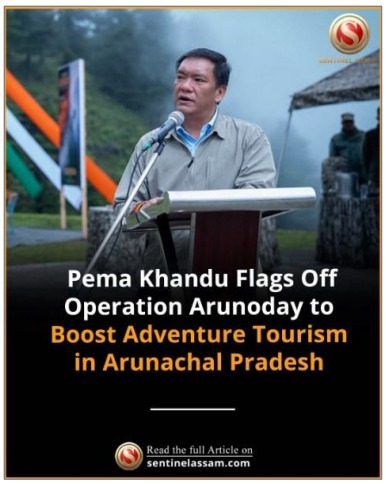
- A new study has reconstructed nearly 4,000 years of climate and vegetation history of Majuli Island in Assam.
- It is **located in the Brahmaputra river system, in Assam.**
- It is the **world's largest river island located in Assam.**
- **Formation**: It is formed by the Brahmaputra River in the south and the Kherkutia Xuti, a branch of the Brahmaputra, joined by the Subansiri River in the north.
- **Crops cultivated**: Rice cultivation is the primary livelihood for the residents of Majuli, with several unique varieties of rice, such as Komal Saul and Bao Dhan, grown in the region.
- **Tribes**: Most of the islanders belong to three tribes- Mishing, Deori, and Sonowal Kachari, with the non-tribal Assamese comprising the rest.



- **Culture**: The island has also been the hub of Assamese neo-Vaishnavite culture, initiated around the 16th century by the great Assamese saint-reformer Srimanta Sankerdeva and his disciple Madhavdeva.
- **They initiated the tradition of Satras (monastic institutions), and these Satras have preserved Sattriya dance, literature, bhaona (theatre), dance forms, mask making, and boat-making.**
- Apart from Satras or Vaishnavite monasteries, Majuli is famous for mask-making and has a tradition of pottery making

Arunachal Pradesh

Arunachal Pradesh Chief Minister flags off Operation Arunoday in Tawang



- Arunachal Pradesh Chief Minister Pema Khandu flagged off Operation Arunoday, **a unique civil-military expedition to open the trekking route from Thingbu village to Bajrang Peak in Tawang district.**
- The expedition is being jointly undertaken by the **Indian Army and the National Institute of Mountaineering and Adventure Sports (NIMAS).**

Short News

- The **Government of Nagaland has officially imposed a state-wide ban** on the manufacture, processing, packaging, storage, transportation, distribution, and sale **of all food products containing tobacco or nicotine as ingredients for a period of one year**.

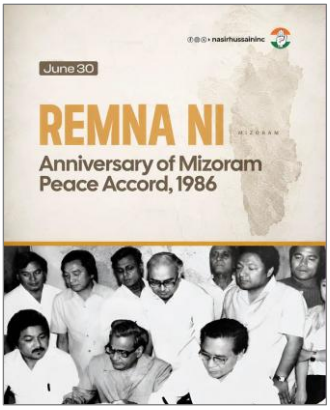
Manipur

First green pea harvest completed under Project Hinichi in Manipur

- The first harvest of green peas under Project Hinichi has been successfully completed in Manipur's Churachandpur district.
- **The project has successfully transformed 254 acres of land previously used for illicit poppy cultivation**, and more than 124 households across the district have benefited from the initiative.
- The alternative cropping initiative was launched in April this year under Project Hinichi by the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)

Mizoram

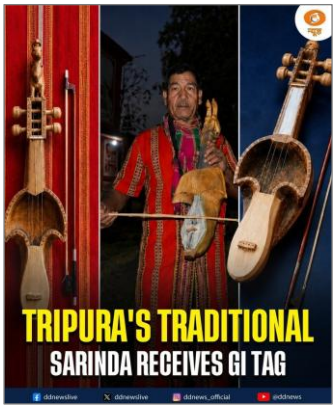
40th Peace Accord Day



- June 30, 1986 was a truly transformative day in Mizoram's history celebrated annually by the people there as Remna Ni.
- Mizoram officially became India's 23rd state on February 20, 1987
- 40 years ago, the historic Mizoram Peace Accord was signed bringing to an end years of insurgency and militancy.
- There had been protracted negotiations between the Union Government with the Mizo National Front led by Pu Laldenga for almost a decade and a half.

Tripura

Tripura's traditional Sarinda receives GI tag



- With the latest addition, Tripura now has four GI-tagged products.
- **Tripura Sarinda is the traditional bowed string musical instrument that is widely used in the folk music traditions of the state's tribal communities.**
- It is handcrafted from a single block of wood and it features a hollow resonator that produces the its distinctive sound.

Tripura's previously recognized GI products includes the,

- Tripura Queen Pineapple

- Risha/Pachra (Rignai), the traditional attire of indigenous tribal communities
- Matabari Peda ; Tripura Sarinda

Meghalaya

HM Amit Shah chairs 73rd Plenary Session of North Eastern Council in Shillong

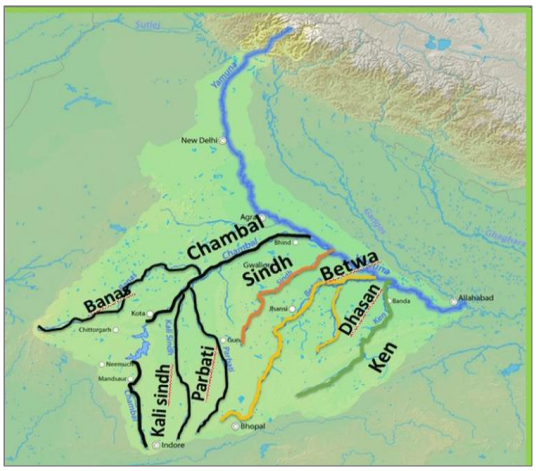


- **The 73rd Plenary Session of the North Eastern Council (NEC) commenced in Shillong**, with Union Home Minister Amit Shah chairing the high-level meeting attended by chief ministers, governors and senior officials from the eight northeastern states.
- **The session, being held at the State Convention Centre in Shillong, is focused on issues related to regional development,** connectivity, infrastructure, investment, tourism, power, education and inter-state cooperation across the Northeast.
- The meeting has brought together the chief ministers and governors of Assam, Meghalaya, Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura and Sikkim to review ongoing projects and discuss developmental priorities for the region.

Rajasthan

The governments of Rajasthan and Haryana inks an important agreement for construction and implementation of Yamuna Water Project

- Haryana and Rajasthan signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) to operationalise water-sharing as per the long-delayed 1994 Upper Yamuna River Board Agreement.
- Under the MoU, Haryana will supply 580 million cubic metres of water from the Yamuna canal to Rajasthan through three underground pipelines from July to October every year
- The Yamuna River System originates from the Yamunotri Glacier, located near Bandarpoonch Peak in the Mussoorie range of the Lower Himalayas. Situated at an altitude of approximately 6,387 meters in Uttarkashi district, Uttarakhand, this glacier marks the source of the Yamuna, one of India's most significant rivers.



- Source: Yamunotri Glacier, Uttarakhand (Lower Himalayas)
- Elevation at Source: ~3,291 meters (10,800 feet)
- Tributaries Joining Early: Tons River, Giri River, Hanuman Ganga
- Course: Flows through Uttarakhand, Haryana, Delhi, Uttar Pradesh
- Confluence: Joins the Ganga at Prayagraj (Allahabad), Uttar Pradesh
- The Yamuna River, one of the major tributaries of the Ganga, originates from the Yamunotri Glacier in Uttarakhand and flows through several northern states of India.
- It traverses Uttarakhand, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Delhi, and Uttar Pradesh before joining the Ganga at Prayagraj (Allahabad).
- Uttarakhand
- Himachal Pradesh
- Uttar Pradesh
- Haryana
- Delhi
- Several important cities and towns have developed along the banks of the Yamuna River - Yamunotri, Paonta Sahib, Delhi, Mathura, Agra, and Allahabad (Prayagraj), which are significant for religion, culture, industry, and agriculture

The Prime Minister of India presented Thewa motif cufflinks to the Slovak President in his recent visit to Slovakia

- It is a unique form of jewelry making that is completely handcrafted.

- It is an intricate and elegant form of jewelry-making that involves fusing gold onto colored glass to create intricate designs and patterns.
- It was evolved in **Pratapgarh district of Rajasthan,**
- It is a 400- year-old art work that was first crafted by **Nathu Lal Sonewal in the 18th century.**
- The word Thewa is derived from the local dialect of the region and means 'setting'.
- The Thewa Art work received its **Geographical Indication (GI) tag in 2014.**
- The core uniqueness of Thewa lies in its secret thermal bonding process; hand-carved 23-carat gold foil is permanently fused onto a base of multi-colored glass without using any glue, solder, or synthetic pasting materials.



Rajasthan Forms Panel for Uniform Civil Code Draft



- Rajasthan constituted a high-level committee to prepare the draft of The Rajasthan Uniform Civil Code, 2026.
- The panel was announced on 22 June 2026 after a Cabinet decision taken on 14 April 2026 under the chairmanship of the Chief Minister.
- The committee is headed by former Supreme Court judge **Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai.**
- Uniform civil law matters in India usually include marriage, divorce, adoption, inheritance, and maintenance.
- **Article 44 of the Constitution of India mentions the Uniform Civil Code** under the Directive Principles of State Policy.
- Goa follows a common civil code for many family law matters **under the Portuguese Civil Code, 1867.**

Gujarat

PM Family Care Tracker Launched in Gujarat

- Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah launched the pilot project of **PM Family Care Tracker at Gandhinagar in Gujarat.**
- The integrated digital platform will **track the health, nutrition and education of beneficiaries from pregnancy until the age of 18 using a unique ID** linked to Birth Registration Number or ABHA ID.
- The PM Family Care Tracker will ensure the **effective delivery of the benefits of government welfare schemes to those in need**
- The system will integrate data from multiple government platforms, generate risk alerts, and monitor key indicators including vaccination, malnutrition, school enrolment and dropout rates.

Gujarat cabinet approves 'wire-free city mission',₹500 crore allocated for first phase

- The Gujarat Cabinet granted in-principle approval to the ambitious 'Gujarat Wire-Free City Mission', a statewide initiative **aimed at shifting overhead electricity distribution lines underground across urban areas by 2030.**
- Under the mission, all 17 municipal corporations and 151 municipalities in Gujarat will be covered in a phased manner.
- The government, the project will involve the undergrounding of more than 14,600 circuit kilometres of high-tension (HT) overhead power lines and over 31,400 circuit kilometres of low-tension (LT) distribution lines across urban areas.

'Operation Mule Hunt' exposes ₹2,289 crore cyber fraud network in Gujarat; 638 arrested

- In one of Gujarat Police's biggest cybercrime crackdowns, investigators recently uncovered a staggering Rs 2,289 crore cyber fraud network by targeting mule accounts, the financial lifeline of online scammers.
- **The operation, aptly named "Operation Mule Hunt 1.0,"**
- A **mule account is a bank account used to facilitate financial crimes, including money laundering, fraud, and illicit fund transfers.**
- The person who owns the account — called a "money mule" — may or may not know their account is being used for illegal activities.

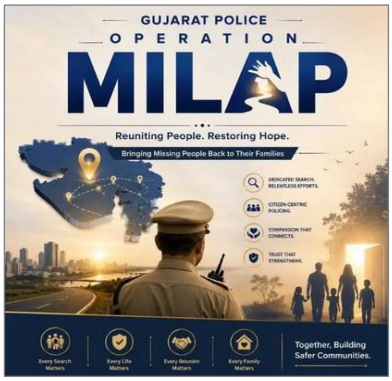
- Criminals recruit money mules to help launder proceeds derived from online scams and frauds or crimes like human trafficking and drug trafficking.
- **Some money mules know they are supporting criminal enterprises; others are unaware that they are helping criminals' profit**.
- Criminals exploit these mule accounts to move illegal money through legitimate banking channels, making it harder for law enforcement agencies to track the origin and destination of illicit funds.
- Mule accounts function as intermediaries, receiving and transferring funds on behalf of criminal networks.
- **This layering process helps criminals obscure the money trail, making it difficult for financial institutions and regulators to detect suspicious activity.**
- Moreover, these accounts are frequently utilized for swift and recurrent international transactions, further obscuring the trail of money.
- **Funds are rapidly moved through numerous accounts or converted into diverse currencies, significantly complicating the efforts of law enforcement to track the money flow.**

Gujarat Police Arrest 362 Illegal Bangladeshi Nationals Under 'Operation Delta Hunt'



- Gujarat Police has launched a strict crackdown on Bangladeshi nationals residing illegally in the state.
- Under Operation Delta Hunt, 362 Bangladeshi nationals living illegally in Gujarat have been arrested, while more than 782 suspected individuals are currently being questioned.
- **The operation was initiated against individuals considered a threat to national security.**

Gujarat police trace 1,470 missing persons under month-long 'Operation Milap'



- The Gujarat Police have traced 1,470 missing persons during a month-long statewide drive 'Operation Milap', launched to review and investigate pending missing persons cases.
- A total of 24,767 people have been reported missing in Gujarat since 2007.
- **The operation was aimed at locating missing individuals and reuniting them with their families.**

Union Cabinet approves Ahmedabad Metro link to airport ahead of Commonwealth Games 2030

- **Ahmedabad preparing to host the Commonwealth Games 2030, the Union Cabinet approved a ₹2,169-crore metro rail extension connecting Koteshwar Road to the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel International Airport** to strengthen the city's transport infrastructure ahead of the event.
- The Ahmedabad Metro Phase-2A project will cover a distance of 6 km and is expected to be completed within four years.
- The corridor will comprise four elevated stations and one underground station.

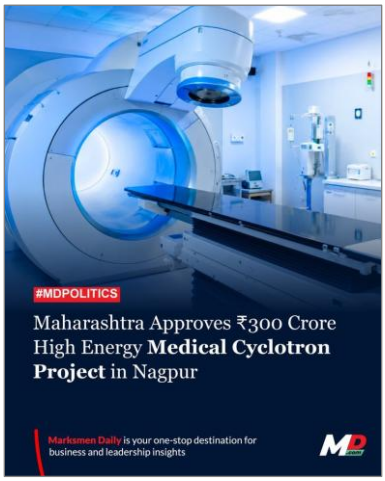
Maharashtra

Mahadev Koli Tribe

- Long before climate adaptation became a global priority, the **Mahadev Kolis of Maharashtra's Western Ghats** were tracking seasonal shifts, using **native medicinal trees,** and living by principles that kept forests and communities healthy.
- Mahadev Koli or Mahadeo Koli are a subcaste of the Koli community of the **Maharashtra and Goa states of India.**
- They derive their name from their god, **Mahadev, and live in the Mahadev hills of Maharashtra, mostly in the Pune, Ahmednagar, and Nasik districts.**
- They are classified as a Schedule Tribe.
- They **speak Marathi and use the Devanagari script**.
- There are twenty-four exogamous clans among the Mahadev Koli, and they use their clan's names as their surnames.

- They resemble the Kunbi and the Maratha communities in matters of dress and appearance. They live in nuclear families.
- Traditionally hunter-gatherers and warriors, the community today is largely engaged in agriculture.
- Their primary religion is Folk Hinduism.
- Members of each clan have their own deity.

The High-Energy Medical Cyclotron Project (HEMCP)



- The Maharashtra Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis, has officially approved the establishment of a ₹300-crore High-Energy Medical Cyclotron Project (HEMCP) in Nagpur.
- **The High-Energy Medical Cyclotron Project (HEMCP) is a state-of-the-art nuclear medicine facility centered around a high-energy particle accelerator.**
- The project is **designed to manufacture specialized, short-lived medical radioisotopes locally,** which are indispensable for advanced oncological imaging, targeted cancer therapies, and molecular research.

How It Works?

- **Particle Acceleration**: The cyclotron uses a combination of strong magnetic and alternating radio-frequency electric fields to accelerate charged subatomic particles (such as protons or deuterons) along a rapidly expanding spiral path inside a vacuum chamber.
- **Target Bombardment**: Once these particles reach extremely high kinetic energy levels, they are directed out of the spiral track as a focused beam to bombard a stable target material (like specific isotopes of oxygen, nitrogen, or liquid metals).
- **Nuclear Transformation**: The high-energy collision alters the atomic nuclei of the target material, transforming stable atoms into short-lived, unstable radioactive isotopes (such as Fluorine-18, Carbon-11, or Iodine-123).

Amid 'Operation Tiger' buzz

- **"Operation Tiger" is the codename for an alleged political maneuver by Maharashtra Chief Minister** Eknath Shinde's faction **to engineer a split within Uddhav Thackeray's Shiv Sena (UBT).**
- The operation reportedly aims to lure several Lok Sabha Members of Parliament (MPs) away from Thackeray's camp to join the ruling alliance

Powai Lake

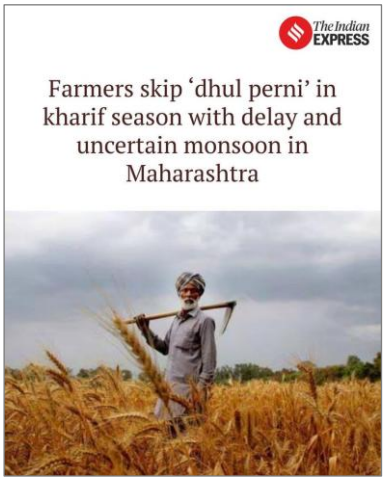
- The BMC recently proposed appointing infrastructure consultancy firm AECOM Asia Company Limited to prepare a comprehensive redevelopment plan for a stretch of Powai Lake along Adi Shankaracharya Marg at a consultancy cost of Rs 1.85 crore.
- It is an **artificial lake situated in the northern suburb of Mumbai, Maharashtra.**
- The lake was built by the British in 1890, after constructing two dams between two hillocks across Mithi River, to augment the water supply to Bombay.
- The Padmavati Devi Temple, situated on the bank of the lake inside IIT Bombay campus dates back to the 10th century AD.
- The lake is surrounded by the Powai Bird Sanctuary.

Tasgaon Lift Irrigation Scheme

- **Maharashtra Krishna Valley Development Corporation recently issued the Letter of Award (LoA) to a joint venture involving Mumbai-based infrastructure company Patel Engineering Ltd (PEL) for an irrigation project under the Tasgaon Lift Irrigation Scheme in Maharashtra.**
- It is an important irrigation infrastructure initiative in Maharashtra.
- It encompasses the construction of a **comprehensive water distribution system for a command area of 2,277 hectares across six villages in Satara Taluka in Satara district.**
- The villages included in the project scope are Tasgaon, Varne, Karandwadi, Devkarwadi, Degaon, and Nigadi.

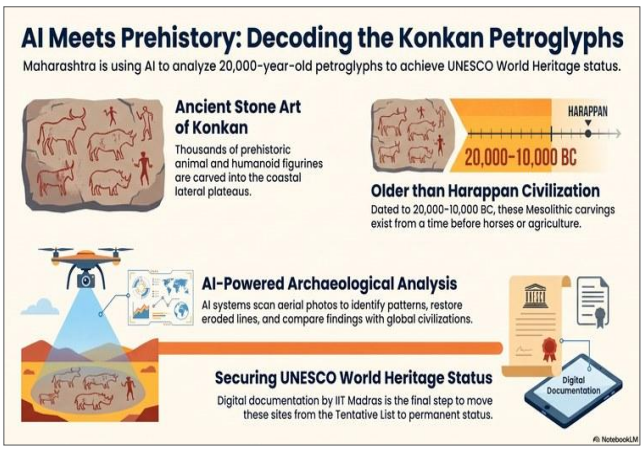
- The project is expected to **improve water availability and irrigation access across the region, supporting long-term agricultural and rural development.**
- **Lift irrigation schemes**, unlike gravity-fed canal systems, **rely on electrically powered pumping infrastructure to raise water from a source body and push it through a pressurized distribution network to farmland at higher elevations.**
- The scheme includes multiple work fronts: head works, pump houses, switch yards, rising mains, delivery chambers, and a closed-pipe distribution network.
- **The scheme falls under the Maharashtra Krishna Valley Development Corporation, Pune**

Farmers skip 'dhul perni' in kharif season with delay and uncertain monsoon in Maharashtra



- Amidst delayed monsoon farmers in Maharashtra have completely skip ' dhul perni' a traditional form of sowing during kharif season.
- **Almost 50 per cent farmers specially in Vidarbha and Marathwada adopt ' dhul perni' (dry or dust sowing) method every year.**
- The farmers start the pre-monsoon sowing using this method atleast ten days before the monsoon.
- **After mashagat (field preparation for sowing), farmers throw seed in dry soil.**
- The experienced farmers revealed the 'dhul perni' normally takes place between May 25 to June 10.
- **Once the sowing on dry soil is done, there should be rains within a week to ten days as it helps germinate the seeds which gradually grows into sapling.**

What are petroglyphs and why are they in the news?



- The Maharashtra government is making technology meet archaeology by using Artificial Intelligence (AI) to scientifically analyse, classify and interpret the origin and cultural etymology of thousands of prehistoric petroglyphs scattered across the Konkan region, a move that could significantly strengthen India's bid to secure UNESCO World Heritage status for these ancient sites.
- Petroglyphs are stone carvings of animal figures or humanoids, found in the lateral plateau regions across Ratnagiri and Sindhudurg districts of coastal Maharashtra.
- The carvings mainly comprise figurines, including turtles, elephants, peacock and rhinoceros.
- These were discovered throughout a series of expeditions and excavations carried out between 2017 and 2023.
- According to archaeologists and experts, the origin of these carvings ranges between 20,000 BC and 10,000 BC and is older than the Harappan civilization whose earliest phase dates back to 7,000 BC-5,000 BC.
- In 2025, these structures were added to the temporary list of UNESCO World Heritage Sites in India.
- A site must first be placed on India's Tentative List, which is maintained by the Government of India and submitted to UNESCO — which requires the site to be on the Tentative List before it can be formally nominated.
- The absence of horse figurines indicated that the carvings were created during the pre-historic era and the absence of bulls established that they were created during the pre-agricultural era.
- The origin of these carvings dates back to the Mesolithic era or the middle stone age period.

Goa

Ministry of New and Renewable Energy to Host Global Wind Day 2026 Conference in Goa to Boost Wind Energy Growth

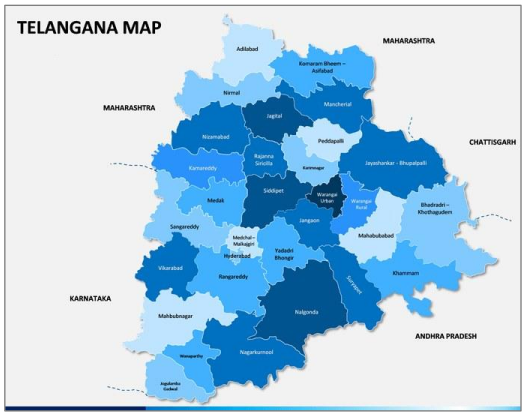
- The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) Shri Pralhad Joshi will host the Global Wind Day 2026 Conference on 15th June 2026 in Goa,

- **Themed "Wind Energy: From Ambition to Acceleration.**
- **India has become the world's fourth-largest wind power market.**
- With an aim of 100 GW by 2030 and 155 GW by 2035, wind energy remains important to India's goal of 500 GW non-fossil capacity and net-zero emissions by 2070.

Telangana

2 June – Telangana Formation Day

- **On 2nd June, 2014** the **northwestern part of Andhra Pradesh** was **separated and 29th state Telangana was created.**
- The **Andhra State Act (1953)** formed the **first linguistic state of India after independence**, known as the **state of Andhra**, by taking out the **Telugu speaking areas from the State of Madras** (now Tamil Nadu).
- The **States Reorganisation Act (1956) merged** the **Telugu-speaking areas of Hyderabad state** with the **Andhra state** to create the **enlarged Andhra Pradesh state.**
- The **Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act (2014) bifurcated Andhra Pradesh** into **two separate states,** namely, the Andhra Pradesh (residuary) and the Telangana.
- **Capital: Hyderabad**
- Telangana is surrounded by **Maharashtra and Chhattisgarh** in the North, **Karnataka** in the West and **Andhra Pradesh** in the South and East directions.
- **Official language** - Telugu (official), Urdu (second official)
- **Major rivers-** - Godavari, Krishna



Important Places

- Hyderabad – Charminar, Golconda Fort, IT hub
- Warangal – Thousand Pillar Temple, Warangal Fort

Telangana women's safety wing launches 'Stree Ride' for women's safety and mobility

- Telangana Women's Safety Wing has launched 'Stree Ride,' a unique initiative introducing an all-women fleet of cabs, autorickshaws, and electric bikes.
- **The program enables female commuters to book rides driven exclusively by women through popular aggregators like Ola, Uber, and Rapido.**

Hyderabad renames road as Donald Trump Avenue; US President expresses gratitude



- Telangana Deputy Chief Minister Bhatti Vikramarka Mallu unveiled the plaque officially renaming the **road beside the US Consulate in Hyderabad as Donald Trump Avenue.**
- The road was named in honour of America's 250th Independence anniversary.
- US President Donald Trump has **thanked India for naming a road after him in Hyderabad, Telangana.**
- he had become the first US President to have a road in India named in his honour.

Andhra Pradesh

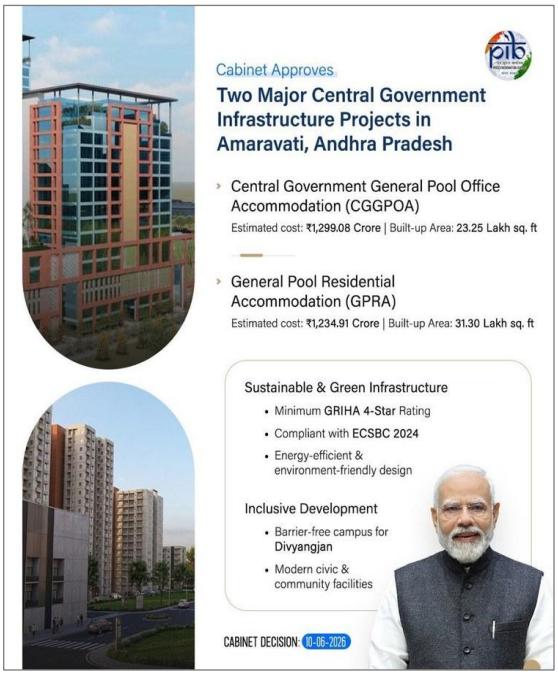
Amaravati Eye set to become India's tallest observation wheel

- Amaravati is set to get India's tallest observation wheel, **surpassing the iconic London Eye.**
- Proposed at **a height of 139 metres**, the 'Amaravati Eye' is envisioned as a landmark tourism and entertainment attraction that will strengthen the capital city's identity while **boosting tourism, economic activity and destination branding.**
- The observation wheel will have a diameter of 128 metres and feature 28 air-conditioned, mechanically stabilised capsules.
- **Each capsule will accommodate 20 passengers, with a maximum capacity of 25.**

Andhra Pradesh Plans AI Newborn Growth Monitoring System

- Andhra Pradesh is set to leverage AI to **improve neonatal healthcare, with the State government launching a pilot project to automatically assess and record health indicators of newborn babies** through smartphone-based video technology.
- AI-powered newborn health monitoring services will be integrated into the mobile application used by Accredited Social Health Activists (ASHAs).
- The **technology will enable automatic recording of critical health parameters such as weight, height, head circumference, chest circumference and arm measurements without physically touching the infant**.
- The initiative is being **implemented in partnership with Wadhwani AI, which has developed the 'Shishu Maapan' application.**
- Under an agreement with the Health Department, the application will be integrated with the existing ASHA mobile platform.

Union Cabinet approves ₹2,533 crore office and housing projects for Central staff in Amaravati



- **The Union Cabinet chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved two major Central government infrastructure projects** with a revised combined estimated cost of over ₹2,533 crore.
- The approved projects include the Central Government General Pool Office Accommodation (CGGPOA) and the General Pool Residential Accommodation (GPRA), **which are aimed at creating modern office and residential infrastructure for Central government employees in Amaravati.**
- **The buildings will have a minimum GRIHA 4-Star rating, comply with Energy Conservation and Sustainable Building Code (ECSBC) 2024** standards and incorporate energy-efficient and environmentally friendly design features.
- The **CGGPOA project** will be developed at an estimated cost of ₹1,299.08 crore with a total built-up area of 23.25 lakh square feet.
- The project is intended to provide office accommodation for various Central government departments and agencies operating in the capital region.
- The **housing complex will have a built-up area of 31.30 lakh square feet and is expected to include modern civic and community amenities.**

Banganapalle Mango



- Recently, the **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA),** under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, has facilitated the first commercial sea shipment of premium Banganapalle mangoes **from India to Singapore.**
- It is one of the most popular mango varieties cultivated in the town of Banganapalle in Andhra Pradesh, India.
- It is also known as Beneshan, Baneshan, Benishan, Chappatai and Safeda.
- It is known for its **golden-yellow colour, fibreless pulp, rich sweetness and pleasant aroma.**
- It received a **Geographical Indication (GI) tag in 2017.**

Karnataka

Virupaksha Temple

- **The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) recently removed the walls built inside the main gopuram of Virupaksha Temple, where a mantapa was converted into an office.**



- The Virupaksha, also known as the **Pampapathi** temple, is a Hindu temple dedicated to **Lord Virupaksha, a form of Lord Shiva.**
- It is located in Hampi, within the Vijayanagara district of Karnataka.
- **Situated on the southern bank of the Tungabhadra River, it is part of the Group of Monuments at Hampi, designated as a UNESCO World Heritage Site since 1986.**
- Considered the **most renowned and significant temple in Hampi,** Virupaksha Temple has been operational without interruption since its establishment in the 7th century AD.
- **Initially a modest shrine, it was later expanded during the Chalukyas and Hoysala periods**.
- The temple experienced considerable growth and enhancement during the Vijayanagara Empire (14th-16th centuries)
- **The rulers of Vijayanagara, especially King Deva Raya II and King Krishnadevaraya, played a crucial role in the temple's expansion**, contributing structures such as the eastern gopuram and the central pillared hall.
- **The temple is built in the Dravidian architectural style, featuring towering gopurams, detailed carvings, pillared halls, and expansive courtyards.**
- The temple complex includes a sanctum sanctorum, multiple pillared halls (the most elaborate being a hall with 100 pillars), antechambers, and grand gopurams (gateway towers).
- The **temple has three prominent gopurams, with the eastern gopuram being the largest, reaching a height of 160 feet and consisting of nine tiers.**

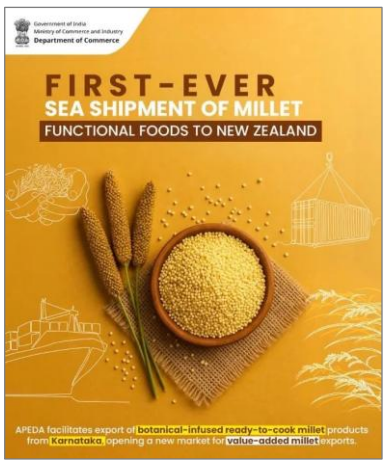
D.K. Shivakumar set to take over as Karnataka CM,

- Karnataka is set for a leadership transition on June 3, **when D.K. Shivakumar will be sworn in as the State's new Chief Minister.**
- The eight-time MLA, popularly known as "DKShi", is regarded as one of the Congress party's most resourceful leaders in Karnataka.
- Siddaramaiah stepped down as Karnataka Chief Minister on May 28

University of Liverpool Campus in Bengaluru

- **The Ministry of Education has granted approval to the University of Liverpool to establish its first branch campus in Bengaluru under the framework of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020.**
- The University of Liverpool, a leading UK higher education institution, has received official approval from the Government of India to establish a branch campus in Bengaluru, Karnataka.
- It is part of India's efforts under NEP 2020 to attract globally reputed universities and transform India into an international education hub.
- **Aim**: Provide Indian students access to internationally recognized degrees and research opportunities without leaving the country.
- **Promote India–UK cooperation in higher education, innovation, research, and skill development.**

The First Sea Shipment of Botanical-Infused Millets



- **The Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) facilitated the first-ever sea shipment of botanical-infused, ready-to-cook millet functional foods from Karnataka to New Zealand.**
- Botanical-infused millet functional foods are a new category of value-added, **ready-to-cook agricultural products** that blend highly nutritious, climate-resilient traditional Indian millets with specialized plant-based botanical extracts.
- **Developed and Shipped By**: M/s Infini Agrotek LLP, an agri-technology firm based in Bengaluru, Karnataka.
- Facilitating Nodal Agency: Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA), Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India.
- The primary aim of this initiative is to diversify India's agricultural export basket by

transitioning from raw grain shipments to premium, value-added functional food products.

Key Features:

- **Combines the natural micronutrient profiles and climate resilience of traditional millets with targeted botanical infusions to offer specialized wellness and functional health benefits.**
- Formulated into modern, consumer-friendly, ready-to-cook formats, making traditional Indian grains accessible and easy to prepare for global households.

REWARD Program

- The **National Rainfed Area Authority (NRAA) organized a meeting** on the draft National Technical Guidelines (NTG) for Improved Watershed Management under the Rejuvenating Watersheds for Agricultural Resilience through Innovative Development (REWARD) Programme.
- **REWARD (Rejuvenating Watersheds for Agricultural Resilience through Innovative Development) program is a watershed development program which is being implemented in the States of Karnataka and Odisha.**
- **Time Period**: 2021 to 2026
- The **program aims to introduce modern watershed practices in the Department of Land Resources and in the States of Karnataka and Odisha**.
- It is **assisted by the World Bank**.
- The REWARD program works on a **financial instrument called "PforR" (Program for Results)** which means the World Bank will reimburse the loan amount against the achievement of Disbursement Linked Indicators (DLIs).
- **Objective of REWARD:** To strengthen capacities of national and state institutions to adopt improved watershed management for increasing farmers' resilience and support value chains in selected watersheds of participating States".

Kerala

Kerala Approves Priyadarshini Free Travel Scheme



- The **Kerala Cabinet approved the Priyadarshini scheme for free travel for women on Kerala State Road Transport Corporation ordinary services.**
- The scheme will begin on 15 June 2026 across Kerala and will cover women of all ages and income levels, along with transgender persons.
- The **free travel facility will apply only to KSRTC ordinary bus services in the first phase**. The benefit will be available on a state-wide basis and will not be limited by income criteria or age criteria.

Kerala Forest dept. introduces India's first judiciary-integrated digital system for wildlife offences

- **The Kerala Forest Department has launched the e-court integration feature for its 'HAWK' (Hostile Activity Watch Kernel) system.** This initiative makes Kerala the first State in India to achieve a fully digitised, judiciary-integrated wildlife offence management system.
- The platform links forest enforcement records with the District Court Management System through an Application Programming Interface and stores case data in a centralised database.
- **It tracks the full lifecycle of a case file from the Preliminary Offence Report to court verdicts and witness testimonies.**
- The system removes the need for physical paperwork in wildlife crime prosecution.
- **The system was developed with the Wildlife Trust of India and supported by NTT Data.**
- The system was conceptualised in 2015 during Operation Shikar, linked to the Malayattoor elephant poaching case, developed in 2017, and inaugurated in 2019.

Short News

- The Kerala Police have placed more suspects under investigation in Kozhikode as part of Operation P-Hunt, a state-wide crackdown targeting the distribution and viewing of Child Sexual Abuse Material (CSAM) online
- Nearly 60 kg of suspected ganja was seized **from the Ernakulam Rural police limits in less than two weeks after the launch of 'Operation Toofan: The Narco Hunt', Kerala Police State-wide anti-drug mission.**

Tamil Nadu

Kadamparai Pumped Storage Hydro Power Plant



- **Kadamparai Pumped Storage Hydro Power Plant, Tamil Nadu's only facility with reversible two-way turbines**, is struggling to stay operational as it is beyond its design life, functioning at just 25% capacity.
- It is a 400 MW hydropower project located in the **Kadamparai river** basin in Tamil Nadu.
- Commissioned in 1987, it was the state's first pumped storage unit and remains **unique for its ability to operate in both generator and motor modes.**
- **When the grid needs power, water is released from the upper dam at Kadamparai to the Lower Aliyar Dam, driving the turbines to generate electricity.**
- During the night, with wind and solar creating surplus power in the grid, the **same turbines reverse into pump mode and act as motors and push water back from the lower dam to the upper dam, effectively storing energy for the next demand cycle.**

Mettur Dam

- **The probability of the Mettur dam getting opened on the scheduled date appears to be remote, in view of the poor storage and the forecast of a poor southwest monsoon (June-September) this year.**
- It is **located** at Mettur, Salem District, in Tamil **Nadu**.
- At **65 meters high and 1,700 meters long, it is one of the largest dams in India and the largest in Tamilnadu.**
- It is constructed in a gorge, **where the Kaveri River enters the plains.**
- Built in 1934, it took 9 years to complete. The entire work was supervised by the then Governor of Madras, Sir George Stanley.
- **It was constructed for the main purpose of capturing Kaveri waters for irrigation, drinking water supply, and power generation.**
- The reservoir formed by the dam is known as the Stanley Reservoir.
- The dam receives inflows from its own catchment area, Kabini Dam, and Krishna Raja Sagara Dams located in Karnataka.

Tamil Nadu govt approves 'Vetri Thamizhagam' vision document



- Tamil Nadu government has approved the "Vetri Thamizhagam" vision document.
- A key initiative under the document is the "Thaaimaaman Thanga Mothira Thittam", meaning the Maternal Uncle's Gold Ring Scheme.
- Under the scheme, **a one-gram gold ring will be presented to newborns of families permanently residing in Tamil Nadu, provided the delivery takes place in government hospitals.**
- The scheme aims to honour both the newborn and the mother after childbirth in government facilities.

T.N. DGP orders all police officers to conduct 'Open Grievance Day' every Wednesday, Saturday

- In order to ensure speedy and effective redressal of public grievances, Director General of Police/Head of Police Force (HoPF) Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal has issued instructions to all police officers to conduct 'Open Grievance Day' **every Wednesday and Saturday for 2 hours from 11 am to 1 pm.**

India launches world's first nuclear process heat-based hydrogen production facility

- Secretary, Department of Atomic Energy, Ajit Kumar Mohanty has inaugurated the **world's first Hydrogen Production Facility based on the Copper-Chlorine (Cu-Cl) Thermochemical Cycle utilizing nuclear process heat generated from the Fast Breeder Test Reactor** at the Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research (IGCAR), Kalpakkam.
- The project has been developed as a technology demonstration plant to validate hydrogen production using nuclear energy.

- **The Cu–Cl thermochemical process used in the facility was developed indigenously by the Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC), Mumbai.**

India's first 3D-Printed Artificial Reef Modules.

- Tamil Nadu is set to deploy India's first 3D-printed **artificial reef modules in coastal waters as part of an ambitious marine habitat restoration** initiative under the second phase of the **Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana.**
- It is to be deployed by Tamil Nadu in coastal waters off the **Ramanathapuram coast** under the second phase of the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana.
- The modules, each weighing about 1 tonne, were developed by **Chennai-based startup Tvasta, an IIT Madras-incubated company,** in collaboration with **Visakhapatnam Regional Centre of the ICAR-Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute.**
- These modules will be deployed about two nautical miles offshore.
- **Unlike conventional artificial reefs made from reinforced concrete structures**, the new modules feature complex geometries with multiple crevices, folds and attachment surfaces designed to enhance biodiversity.



Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu.

PM Modi Inaugurates New Airport Terminal in Daman, Boosting Regional Connectivity

- Narendra Modi inaugurated the new terminal building at NAMO Airport, marking a significant step in enhancing air connectivity and infrastructure **in Daman district within the Union Territory of Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu.**
- The project is expected to boost tourism, business travel, and regional economic growth **by improving connectivity with cities such as Mumbai, Ahmedabad, and Delhi.**
- **During his visit, the Prime Minister also inaugurated and laid foundation stones for development projects worth approximately ₹2,970 crore** across infrastructure, healthcare, tourism, connectivity, and public welfare sectors.

Defence

Military Exercises

Exercise Pitch Black

- **India will participate in Australia's Exercise Pitch Black 2026 from July 20 to August 7 alongside 18 other nations.**
- It is a biennial and multinational exercise hosted by the Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF).
- It is the **RAAF's flagship international flying exercise.**
- The **name 'Pitch Black' was derived from the emphasis on nighttime flying over large unpopulated areas.**
- It will run from July 20 to August 7, 2026, with operations based out of RAAF Bases Darwin and Tindal in the Northern Territory, as well as RAAF Base Amberley in Queensland.
- It **features a massive assembly of global air forces, providing an unparalleled platform for interoperability. 19 nations, including India, with 100+ aircraft and 4,400+ personnel are participating in the exercise.**
- The IAF has dispatched a highly capable multi-role task force to the exercise, ensuring robust participation across multiple operational spectrum.
- **Previous participation of India:** The IAF has previously participated in the 2018, 2022, and 2024 editions of this exercise..

South Korea, Japan conduct joint maritime search exercise after 9 years

- **South Korea and Japan have conducted a joint maritime search and rescue exercise (SAREX) for the first time in nine years.**
- The drill **was conducted by the South Korean Navy and Japan's Maritime Self-Defence Force in international waters southeast of Jeju Island in South Korea**
- **Launched in 1999,** the **biennial SAREX** exercise was designed to train procedures for coordinated responses between naval ships from both countries in the event of maritime incidents in waters near the Korean Peninsula.

Exercise Khaan Quest

- The Indian Army contingent is set to depart to participate in the multilateral **joint military exercise – Exercise KHAAN QUEST.**
- It is an annual, multinational joint military exercise.
- It is **hosted by the Mongolian Armed Forces and co-sponsored by the U.S. Pacific Command**.
- It aims to enhance interoperability and cooperation among participating militaries in peace support operations under Chapter VII of the United Nations Charter.
- The **exercise first started as a bilateral event between the USA and Mongolian Armed Forces in the year 2003.**
- Subsequently, from the year 2006 onwards, the exercise graduated to a multinational peacekeeping exercise.
- The last edition of Exercise KHAAN QUEST was conducted in Mongolia in 2025.
- It is **the 23rd iteration of the exercise**.
- It is scheduled to be held from 20 June to 3 July at the Five Hills Training Area in Ulaanbaatar (capital of Mongolia).



- **The Indian Army contingent comprises 40 personnel, including troops from a battalion of the JAT Regiment and personnel from other Arms and Services.**

Exercise RIMPAC

- The United States officially launched Rim of the Pacific (RIMPAC) 2026 recently, bringing together military forces from 30 countries for the **world's largest international maritime exercise.**
- Hosted by the U.S. Navy's Pacific Fleet, **it is held biennially (every two years) in and around the Hawaiian Islands in the Pacific Ocean .**
- **It first began in 1971.**
- It provides a unique training opportunity for allies and partners to strengthen their collective capabilities and promote a free and open Indo-Pacific.



2026 Edition:

- **It is the 30th edition of the exercise.**
- It is being held from June 24 to July 31, 2026.
- It brings a multinational force of 31 nations, approximately 40 surface ships, 5 submarines, 140 aircraft, and over 25,000 personnel.
- The Indian Navy is also participating in the exercise. **India first participated in RIMPAC in 2014.**
- **The theme of RIMPAC 2026 is "Partners: Integrated and Prepared."**

Exercises Valiant Shield and Resolute Dragon

- The United States has simultaneously kicked off two major Western Pacific military exercises: Valiant Shield 2026 and Resolute Dragon 26.
- Valiant Shield 2026 (VS26) is a biennial, high-intensity multinational field training exercise.
- Initially launched in 2006 as a unilateral, U.S.-only military drill, it evolved in 2024 into a major multilateral platform to seamlessly integrate allied combat forces across sea, air, land, space, and cyberspace.
- Lead Nation: United States.
- Core Participating Allies: Japan, Australia, Canada, and New Zealand.
- Conducted across Guam, the Northern Mariana Islands, Japan, and surrounding waters including the Philippine Sea and Mariana Islands Range Complex.



About Exercise Resolute Dragon 26:

- Resolute Dragon 26 is an annual, bilateral field training exercise conducted in Japan.

- It is specifically engineered to rehearse, refine, and strengthen joint command-and-control architectures and multi-domain maneuver tactics between U.S. expeditionary units and Japanese ground forces.
- Nations Involved: United States and Japan.
- Conducted across Kyushu and the Nansei Islands, integrating the U.S. Army, Navy, Air Force, and Japan Self-Defense Forces.

Indian Navy's Sea King 42B Squadron Retires



- **The Indian Naval Air Squadron 330, known as "The Harpoons", was number plated after 55 years of service.**
- The squadron was commissioned on 17 April 1971 at INS Garuda, Kochi, under Commander M. P. Wadhawan.
- **INAS 330 is a helicopter squadron of the Indian Navy.**
- It **operated the Sea King Mk 42B, a naval variant of the Westland Sea King helicopter used for maritime operations.**
- TheSea King 42 Alpha variant was deployed aboard the Nilgiri-class frigates.
- TheSea King Mk 42 and the 42 Alpha variants were retired years ago

Indian Navy Seeks Indigenous 80-mm Rockets for MiG-29K



- The Indian Navy issued an Expression of Interest through the Naval Armament Inspectorate in Goa for the design, **development and manufacture of indigenous 80-mm aero rockets for MiG-29K and MiG-29KUB carrier-based fighters.**
- The rockets are **unguided air-to-ground weapons** used by **around 42 Russian-origin MiG-29K aircraft operating from INS Vikramaditya and INS Vikrant.**
- **MiG-29K/KUB, the Russian-origin twin-engine aircraft,** currently serve as strike force on aircraft carriers INS Vikramaditya and INS Vikrant.
- The **80mm aero rocket is a dual-purpose munition, designed to neutralise armoured targets such as tanks and armoured personnel carriers as well as unarmoured targets like radar installations, parked aircraft and troop concentrations.**
- All sub-assemblies must be developed indigenously, and no dependence on foreign OEM would be permitted.
- **Tentative timeline for induction is 2026-27.**
- The weapon must remain functional in temperatures ranging from -60 degrees Celsius to +60 degrees Celsius.

C-295 Aircraft

- Recently, the **Indian Air Force (IAF) said that the first made-in-India C-295 military transport aircraft successfully completed its maiden flight.**
- It is a new-generation medium **tactical military transport aircraft.**
- It is a reliable and highly versatile tactical transport that is tailored for missions that **range from carrying troops and cargo, maritime patrol, airborne warning, surveillance and reconnaissance to signals intelligence**, armed close air support, medical evacuation, Air-to-Air refueling
- The aircraft, with a flight endurance of up to 11 hours, **can function under all weather conditions.**
- It is **capable of carrying up to nine tonnes of payload, or as many as 71 troops**, at a maximum cruise speed of 260 kts.
- The C295 is designed to provide **outstanding low-level flight characteristics for tactical missions**, flying at speeds as slow as 110 knots.



AN-32 Aircraft

- **An Indian Air Force (IAF) AN-32 transport aircraft crashed and caught fire at the Air Force Station in Assam's Jorhat recently, killing five personnel.**
- The AN-32 (Antonov AN-32) is a Sovi**et-origin twin-engine turboprop military transport aircraft.**



- Its NATO **reporting name is Cline**.
- It is **designed and manufactured by the Antonov Design Bureau of Ukraine, then part of the USSR**.
- It **was purchased by India from the USSR in 1984.** The planes were specially customised to suit the IAF's requirements.
- It is **designed to excel in extreme environments, functioning perfectly in high-altitude airfields** (up to 4500 m above sea level) and hot tropical climates
- It is powered by two single-shaft turboprop engines.
- **It can carry a maximum weight of 27 tons at a maximum speed of 530 km/h.**
- It can transport up to 7.5 tons of cargo, 50 passengers, or 42 paratroopers, and it is extensively used for supply drops in remote regions.
- **The range and service ceiling of the aircraft are 2,500 km and 9,500 m, respectively.**

Indian Army Tests Divyastra Mk-1 Loitering Munition

- The Indian Army conducted an operational demonstration of the indigenous Divyastra Mk-1 tactical loitering munition in Jodhpur on 1 June 2026.
- The **system is developed by Hoverit, a Lucknow-based defence technology startup,** and it has a reported 95% indigenous component rate.
- The **Divyastra Mk-1 is an AI-powered tactical unmanned aerial vehicle used for intelligence, surveillance, reconnaissance, and precision strike missions.**
- It has an operational range of up to 500 km, an endurance of up to 5 hours, an attack speed of 300–400 km/h, and a payload capacity of 15 kg.
- **Loitering munitions are also called suicide drones or kamikaze drones in military terminology.**
- The system was launched multiple times from a vehicle-mounted mobile launcher during the demonstration.



- It was validated for dynamic intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance missions under field conditions in desert temperatures exceeding 50°C.

INS Agray Joins Arnala-Class Anti-Submarine Fleet

- **INS Agray is the fifth ship of the Arnala class of Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW SWC) for the Indian Navy.**
- The vessel was launched on 13 March 2024 and **delivered by Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE), Kolkata, on 30 March 2026.**
- INS Agray is about 77 metres long and has a displacement of 900 tonnes. **It is one of the largest Indian Naval warships propelled by waterjets.**



INS Baaz

- **The government recently decided to build a new Rs 13,000-crore greenfield civil-military airport as part of the Great Nicobar project instead of expanding the existing naval airfield at INS Baaz.**

INS Baaz

- It is an Indian naval air station located near Campbell Bay, on Great Nicobar Island in the Andaman & Nicobar Islands.
- It **was commissioned on July 31, 2012**. It is the first **air station in the Nicobar Islands.**
- It is the southernmost air station of the Indian Armed Forces.
- It is **under the joint-services Andaman and Nicobar Command (ANC) of the Indian Armed Forces.**
- It significantly enhances India's capacity for intelligence gathering, surveillance, and reconnaissance across vast areas of the Indian Ocean.



- It **overlooks the Strait of Malacca as well as the Six Degree Channel between Great Nicobar and the Indonesian island of Sumatra.**

- It is used as a base for the **Indian Navy's Dornier Do 228 reconnaissance aircraft.**

New Airport Proposal

- The government will now build a greenfield airport at Galathea Bay. The project will cost around ₹13,000 crore and form part of the ₹81,000-crore Great Nicobar Island development plan.
- **The new facility will have a longer runway capable of handling wide-body commercial aircraft and military planes.**
- It is **expected to take five years to complete**. The airport will remain under naval control but will handle civilian flights as well.

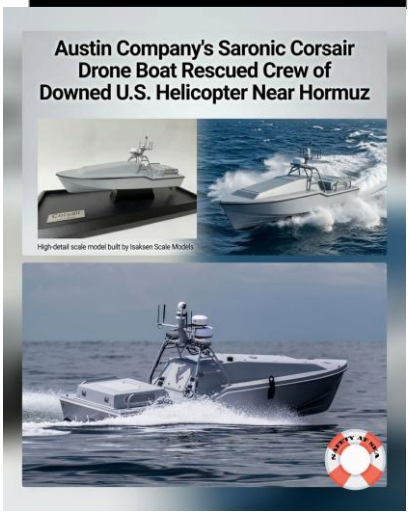
INS Tarkash



- **Indian Naval Ship Tarkash, a stealth frigate of the Indian Navy, recently arrived in Port Victoria, Seychelles, during its ongoing deployment in the South West Indian Ocean Region.**
- It is a state-of-the-art stealth frigate of the Indian Navy.
- It is the **second of three Talwar-class guided missile frigates.**
- Designed and built in Russia, the Talwar-class guided missile frigates are modified version of the Krivak III-class frigate
- It was **built by the Yantar shipyard in Kaliningrad**, Russia.
- **It was commissioned into Indian Navy service on 9 November 2012 at Kaliningrad** and joined the Western Naval Command on 27 December 2012.

INS Tarkash Features

- Displacing 3,850 tonnes, it has a **length of 124.8 m**, a beam of 15.2 m, and a draught of 4.2 m.
- With **maximum speeds in excess of 30 knots,** a range of 4,500 miles or 30 days and a complement of 253 personnel, the ship is powered by four gas turbines.
- **It can board one Ka-28 Helix-A antisubmarine helicopter or one Ka-31 Helix-B airborne early warning helicopter.**
- It carries cutting-edge weaponry, which includes advanced surface-to-air missiles, 100 mm calibre guns (artillery), close-range guns, torpedoes, rocket launchers, and associated fire control systems.
- It is **also equipped with BrahMos missiles instead of the Klub-N missiles, which makes it different from the earlier flight of Talwar-class ships**



Indian Navy to Induct Five Indigenous Naval Platforms

- The Indian Navy is set to induct five indigenously built naval platforms in June 2026, marking a significant boost to India's maritime capabilities and the government's Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiative in defence manufacturing.
- **The induction includes two Project 17A stealth frigates, one Survey Vessel Large (SVL), and two Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Crafts (ASW-SWC)**

Indian Navy to Induct Five Indigenous Naval Platforms

- **INS Dunagiri** – Project 17A Stealth Frigate built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE), Kolkata.
- **INS Mahendragiri** – Project 17A Stealth Frigate built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL), Mumbai.
- **INS Sandhayak** – Survey Vessel Large (SVL) for hydrographic and navigational surveys.
- **INS Malwan –** Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC) built by Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL).
- **INS Mangrol** – Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC) built by CSL.

What is Saronic Corsair? US sea drone rescues Apache crew in first-of-its-kind mission

- **Saronic Corsair sea drone rescued two US Army Apache helicopter crew members from the waters near the Strait of Hormuz.**
- The Corsair, a **24-foot autonomous boat built by Texas-based defence-tech firm Saronic Technologies and operated by the US Navy's Bahrain-based Task Force 59**

- It is the service's **first unit dedicated entirely to unmanned systems,** deploying both surface vessels and underwater drones across the US 5th Fleet's 2.5-million-square-mile area of responsibility, which covers the Persian Gulf, Red Sea, Gulf of Oman and parts of the Indian Ocean.
- **The Saronic Corsair carries up to 1,000 pounds (453.5 kg) over 1,000 nautical miles at a top speed of 35 knots.**

Army Clears Indigenous Production of MEPRO X6 Sights

- The Indian Army has selected Israeli firm Meprolight's MEPRO X6 telescopic sight **as the dedicated daytime optic for its in-service NEGEV 7.62×51 light machine gun (LMG).**
- The **programme involves indigenous manufacture in India under a Transfer of Technology agreement between Meprolight and RRP Defense**, with Bharat Electronics Limited as the prime contractor.
- These sights, with a range of 800 metres as specified by the Army.
- **The MEPRO X6 is a fixed 6x magnification telescopic sight designed for assault rifles, light machine guns and other weapon systems that require a combination of precision, ruggedness and high optical performance.**
- In August 2024, the Army had ordered 41,000 NEGEVs to replace the ageing 5.56x45mm INSAS light machine guns.

Bharat Forge Unveils Simha 4×4 Armoured Vehicle



- **The wholly-owned defence subsidiary of Bharat Forge Limited, Kalyani Strategic Systems Limited (KSSL), unveiled a new light armoured vehicle, the Simha 4x4, a next-generation Light Armoured Multi-Purpose Vehicle** at Eurosatory 2026, the international defence and security exhibition being held in Paris.
- The newly launched platform has been developed to cater to modern battlefield requirements and is designed to offer enhanced mobility, protection and mission flexibility across a range of defence and security operations.

India Showcases Zorawar Tank and TEJASTRA

- India showcased the indigenous Zorawar light tank and TEJASTRA **at Larsen & Toubro's Hazira facility in Gujarat**

Zorawar Light Tank: It is an indigenously designed and developed Light Tank.

- **It was jointly developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) along with Larsen & Toubro (L&T) as the lead integrator.**
- It was named after a military general, Zorawar Singh Kahluria, who had served under Jammu's Raja Gulab Singh in the 19th Century.
- It is **weighing a maximum 25 tonnes, is a key requirement of the light tank which ensures it can be transported by air.**
- The tank will be able to fire at high angles of elevation and perform the role of limited artillery and is an agile weapon platform.
- It is **designed to operate in varying terrain**, from high-altitude areas and marginal terrains to island territories.
- Unique about this tank is the weight as well as the combination of the fundamental parameters of a tank, which is the fire, power, mobility and protection.



TEJASTRA and Directed Energy Weapons

- TEJASTRA is **India's roadmap for directed energy weapon systems and laser-based defence technologies.**
- Directed energy weapons use concentrated energy, including lasers, to damage or disable targets.
- TEJASTRA begins with Phase-1 systems in the 10 to 20 kilowatt class **for counter-drone and short-range air defence.**
- **Phase-2 is planned for 2028** and covers 50 to 100 kilowatt tactical systems.
- The Defence Research and Development Organisation is also developing a **50-kilowatt laser weapon programme,** with trials expected in 2027 and induction planned for 2030.

Night Vision Devices (NVDs)

- India is aggressively scaling up its indigenous combat readiness along its contested borders by modernizing its tactical night-fighting gear.
- **Highlighted by the defense ministry's massive ₹659.47 crore contract for Netro NW 3000 night sights and the commissioning of Bharat Electronics Limited's (BEL) dedicated electro-optics facility in Andhra Pradesh.**
- A Night Vision Device (NVD) is a sophisticated **optoelectronic instrument** engineered to grant military forces an operational edge by converting near-total darkness, smoke, and camouflage into highly defined visual imagery.
- NVDs are deployed as handheld units, weapon-mounted sights, helmet goggles, or integrated sensors inside armored columns and combat aircraft.

Modern military NVDs operate using two primary scientific principles:

Image Intensification

- Amplifies weak light (moon/stars).
- Produces a bright green/white image.
- Uses light.

Thermal Imaging

- Detects heat emitted by objects.
- Works even in total darkness.
- Uses heat.

Hellfire Missile



- **The U.S. military fired a Hellfire missile at a tanker heading toward Iran** recently as part of a blockade being imposed by President Donald Trump, who is pressing Tehran to negotiate a peace agreement on his terms.
- AGM-114 **Hellfire is a short-range, air-to-ground, subsonic tactical missile.**
- Manufactured by Lockheed Martin, the Hellfire originates from the United States and entered service in 1984 as a potent anti-tank weapon.
- It **can also be used as an air-to-air weapon against helicopters or slow-moving fixed-wing aircraft.**
- The missile is compatible **with a wide array of platforms, including attack helicopters (AH-64 Apache), drones (MQ-1 Predator, MQ-9 Reaper), fighter jets, and ground launchers**.
- The Hellfire missile is capable of defeating any known tank in the world today.

Hellfire Missile Features

- The missile flies at subsonic speeds to a maximum of Mach 1.3 (450 m/s).
- It is **propelled by a single-stage solid-propellant solid-fuel rocket motor.**
- Its guidance options include laser, radar, and imaging infrared (IIR) systems, allowing for both fire-and-forget and semi-active targeting.

DRDO, IAF successfully flight-test indigenous RudraM-II air-to-surface missile


DRDO & IAF conduct successful flight-tests of indigenous RudraM-II air-to-surface missile

THE TIMES OF INDIA JUNE 03, 2026

DRDO & IAF CONDUCT SUCCESSFUL FLIGHT-TESTS OF INDIGENOUS RUDRAM-II AIR-TO-SURFACE MISSILE

In another milestone in advanced missile technology, Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO) and the Indian Air Force (IAF) have conducted the successful flight-tests of RudraM-II air-to-surface missile from an airborne platform from the Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur, the defence ministry said.

- The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and the Indian Air Force (IAF) have successfully conducted **flight-tests of the indigenous RudraM-II air-to-surface missile.**
- RudraM-II **has been developed indigenously by Research Centre Imarat (RCI), Hyderabad**, the nodal DRDO laboratory in collaboration with several other DRDO establishments, including Defence Research and Development Laboratory (DRDL), High Energy Materials Research Laboratory (HEMRL), Armament Research & Development Establishment (ARDE), and ITR.

Netra Airborne Early Warning and Control (AEW&C) system

- **The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) has granted Final Operational Clearance (FOC) to the indigenous Netra Airborne Early Warning and Control (AEW&C) system.**
- Commonly known as the Indian Air Force's (IAF) "Eye in the Sky," Netra is India's first indigenously developed **airborne surveillance, command-and-control, and battle management platform.**
- It functions as a **highly mobile, flying radar station** that scans vast areas of airspace far beyond the limits of conventional ground-based radar systems.

Defence Ministry procures 20 GNSS Jammers for Navy to enhance operational safety



- The Defence Ministry signed a contract worth 449 crore rupees for the **procurement of 20 Enhanced Capability Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS) Jammers for the Indian Navy, with a minimum indigenous content of 75 per cent.**
- The contract, under the Buy (Indian-Indigenously Designed, Developed and Manufactured) category, was signed in the presence of Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh in New Delhi.
- The **system is capable of degrading an adversary's GNSS receiver performance by disrupting satellite signal acquisition and tracking, as well as carrying out signal spoofing and deceptive jamming**.
- The induction of these systems will enhance the operational safety of Indian Navy ships in a multi-threat environment.

Indian Army unveils new uniform policy, phases out colonial-era practices

- The Indian Army has introduced Army Uniforms–2026, a **revised dress regulations pamphlet that progressively removes residual colonial-era practices, terminology and non-essential accoutrements.**
- The new policy reflects the Army's effort to **align its dress regulations with contemporary Indian values** while maintaining the service's rich traditions and professional standards.
- **The Army has retained four broad categories of uniforms—**Ceremonial Dress, Working Dress, Mess Dress and Combat Dress. Unique dress numbers have been assigned to each uniform for ease of identification and administration.
- **Among the notable reforms are the inclusion of the traditional Bandi Jacket as part of formal civil attire, removal of the pouch belt from Mess Dress Nos. 5 and 6, making sword carriage by the Reviewing Officer optional, and discontinuing outdated terminology such as "Royal".**
- The **Army has announced the phased withdrawal of legacy patterns such as Dress No. 3A, which will be discontinued by June 30, 2029.**

SPARSH service centre for defence pensioners inaugurated in Guntur

- A new System for Pension Administration Raksha (SPARSH) Service Centre of the Defence Accounts Department, Government of India, was inaugurated at the NCC Canteen premises
- The **SPARSH Service Centre has been set up under the supervision of the Defence Accounts Department, Secunderabad, to provide pension-related services to retired personnel of the Army, Navy, and Air Force.**
- Pensioners can use the services free of charge, with help from trained staff at the centre.
- The facility would help defence pensioners resolve pension issues.



First Women NDA Cadets Join Indian Military Academy

- The National Defence Academy in Pune, the first batch of 17 women cadets trained at the NDA was commissioned
- **This is the first time women officers will be joining the forces with a permanent commission.**
- This was **made possible by an interim order passed by the Supreme Court in August 2021**

- Joined the NDA in August 2022 as part of the 148th Course

29th India-US Army to Army Staff Talks held in Hawaii



- India and the United States held the 29th Army-to-Army Staff Talks in Hawaii on 6 June 2026.
- **The talks formed part of bilateral defence cooperation between the two countries and covered military coordination, professional exchanges, and interoperability.**
- Army-to-Army Staff Talks are a formal military dialogue mechanism between the Indian Army and the United States Army.
- Such staff-level talks are used to discuss training, exercises, logistics, doctrine, and operational cooperation.
- **Lieutenant General Rajiv Ghai represented India in the talks.**
- Lieutenant General Joel Vowell represented the United States in the talks.

Border Roads Organisation (BRO) celebrated the 37th Raising Day of Project UDAYAK.

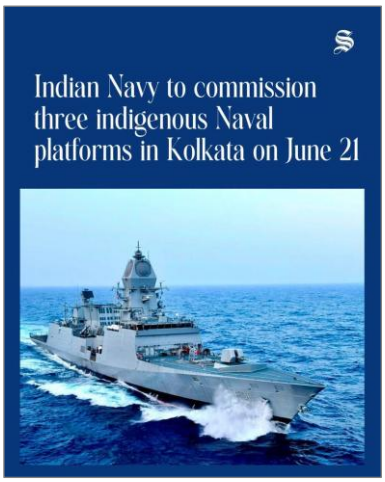
- It is an initiative of the Border Roads Organisation.
- The **Project was aptly named 'Udayak', meaning the Rising Sun as the first rays of the rising sun in the country fall in the AOR of the project.**
- It **was raised on 01 Jun 1990 at Doomdooma, Assam** as part of the restructuring undertaken to focus on the development on the far-eastern area of the country.
- **Its two task forces, 48 BRTF and 752 BRTF were carved out of Projects Vartak and Sewak respectively**, to form the two executive arms of the Project.

India Inducts First Indigenous Hovercraft into Coast Guard

- The **Indian Coast Guard inducted its first indigenous Air Cushion Vehicle, designated H-561.**
- The **hovercraft was built at Chowgule & Company Private Limited's shipyard in Goa** and is the first of six indigenous ACVs under construction for the force.
- An Air Cushion Vehicle is a hovercraft that moves on a cushion of air created by fans or lift systems.
- ACVs can operate over shallow water, mudflats, beaches, marshy terrain, and other low-support surfaces.

PM commission three indigenous naval platforms in Kolkata

- The Indian Navy commissioned three indigenously built frontline platforms—**Dunagiri, Sanshodhak, and Agray—in Kolkata.**
- Designed by the Indian Navy's Warship Design Bureau and built by **Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE),** the three vessels have indigenous content exceeding 75 per cent and involved the participation of more than 200 MSMEs.



INS Dunagiri

- It is the **fifth Project 17A stealth frigate.**
- It is equipped with advanced weapons and sensors, including BrahMos surface-to-surface missiles and the Medium Range Surface-to-Air Missile system, significantly enhancing the Navy's combat capability.

Sanshodhak

- It is the **fourth Survey Vessel (Large).**
- Function: It is designed for coastal and deep-water hydrographic surveys and collection of oceanographic and geophysical data for defence and civil applications.
- It is equipped with advanced survey systems including Autonomous Underwater Vehicles and Remotely Operated Vehicles.

Agray

- It is the fourth of the **Arnala-class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft.**

- It is equipped with lightweight torpedoes, indigenous rocket launchers, and shallow-water sonar systems to detect and engage underwater threats in littoral waters.

HELINA Missile

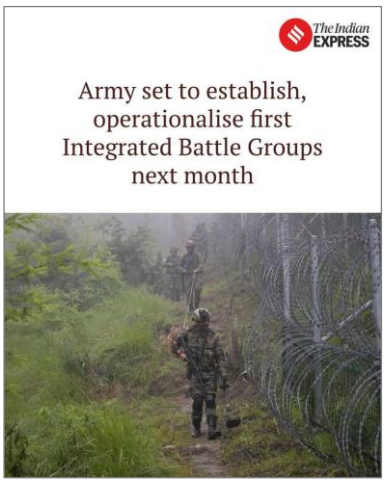


- State-owned **Bharat Dynamics Limited** recently secured an order worth Rs 1,109.37 crore from **Hindustan Aeronautics Limited to supply launchers for helicopter-launched anti-tank Nag (Helina) missiles**.
- HELINA (Helicopter-launched NAG) is an indigenous, third-generation "**fire-and-forget" anti-tank guided missile (ATGM.)**
- It is the **helicopter-based version** of the Nag Anti-Tank Guided Missile (ATGM).
- The Air Force version of the missile is **called Dhruvastra**, along with an ATGM version, which can be fired by soldiers.
- It has been developed indigenously by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).
- The Helina ATGM system measures **1.94 m in length, 150 mm in diameter, and weighs 44 kg.**
- Helina missile systems are outfitted with two twin launchers, one on each side, capable of **carrying a total of eight missiles.**
- It can cover distances **ranging between 500 m and 7,000 m and is guided by an imaging infrared (IIR) seeker with lock-on before launch capability.**
- It means the crew locks on to the target before the launch, and the missile then guides itself to the target without any further control from the helicopter.
- The missile climbs sharply after the launch and then plunges directly onto the top of the tank.

Indian Coast Guard commissions Fast Patrol Vessel ICGS Akshay in Goa

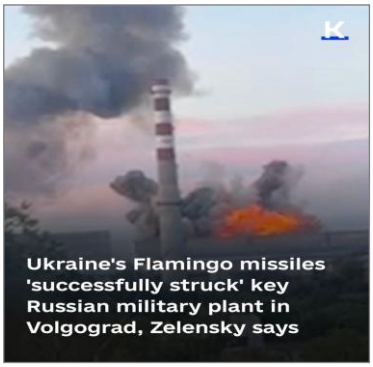
- Bharatiya Tatrakshak marked another milestone in its force modernisation with the commissioning of **ICGS Akshay, a new-generation Fast Patrol Vessel (FPV), at Goa Shipyard Limited, Goa.**
- Named Akshay, meaning Indestructible,
- Designed and constructed by Goa Shipyard Limited,

Army to Raise First Integrated Battle Groups



- The Indian Army plans to operationalise its **first Integrated Battle Groups by 1 July 2026.**
- The first formations will be raised from the **Panagarh-based XVII Corps, which is also known as the Mountain Strike Corps** and is oriented towards the China front.
- An Integrated Battle Group, or IBG, is a brigade-sized combat formation designed as a self-contained unit.
- Each IBG is planned to have more than **5,000 troops and 12 to 13 units, including infantry battalions, artillery regiments, engineers, signals, and a field hospital.**
- Under the current plan, four IBGs and one fire support group will be created under the XVII Mountain Strike Corps.
- Each of these five formations will be commanded by **a Major General-rank officer.**

FP-5 Flamingo Missile Strikes Titan-Barrikady Plant



- Ukraine recently claimed that its domestically developed FP-5 Flamingo **long-range missiles struck a key Russian defence manufacturing facility in the Volgograd region.**
- It is a long-range, ground-launched cruise missile developed by Ukrainian defense company Fire Point.
- It entered service in 2025.

- It is designed to deliver a specified combat payload of up to 1150 kg to strike ground targets with fixed topographic coordinates at **a range of up to 3000 km, both day and night.**
- It is designed for low-altitude flight to avoid detection.
- It reaches a **maximum speed of up to 950 km/h, with a cruising speed of 650 to 700 km/h.**

Project BRAHMANK of BRO Marks its 16th Raising Day

- **Project BRAHMANK of Border Roads Organisation (BRO)** celebrated its 16th Raising Day on Jun 29, 2026 at Ranaghat, Arunachal Pradesh, marking **fifteen years of dedicated service towards the development of strategic infrastructure and connectivity in the region**.
- The Project is responsible for development and maintenance of strategic road infrastructure across the **Siang, East Siang, West Siang, Upper Siang and Shi-Yomi districts of Arunachal Pradesh**, as well as parts of Dhemaji district in Assam.

Science & Technology

What makes Strawberry Moon different from Blue Moon and Micromoon?



- June's full moon, popularly known as the Strawberry Moon, is set to light up the night sky.
- **Despite its name, the moon does not appear pink or red.**
- The name 'Strawberry Moon' comes from Native American Algonquian tribes, who associated June's full moon with the brief season **when wild strawberries ripen and are ready to be harvested,** according to the Old Farmer's Almanac.
- The main attraction of June's Strawberry Moon is **how low it appears in the sky when viewed from the Northern Hemisphere.**
- Unlike a winter full moon that rises high overhead, **the Strawberry Moon follows a low path across the southern sky**, lingering close to the horizon throughout the night.
- The June Strawberry Moon will reach peak illumination at 7:57 pm. EDT (11:57 pm GMT) on June 29.

Blue moon



- Though the expression "once in a blue moon" implies a rare or unusual occurrence, a blue moon is not that rare an astronomical event.
- There are a few definitions of a blue moon — describes a **situation when a full moon is seen twice in a single month.**
- Because the new moon to new moon cycle lasts 29.5 days, a time comes when the full moon occurs at the beginning of a month, and there are days left still for another full cycle to be completed.

GPS Aided GEO Augmented Navigation



- Recently, under the watch of the **Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA)** for the first time a private jet was landed by using **GPS Aided GEO Augmented Navigation (GAGAN).**
- It is a **Satellite Based Augmentation System (SBAS)** implemented jointly with **Airport Authority of India (AAI) and ISRO.**

The main objectives of GAGAN are

- To provide Satellite-based Navigation services with accuracy and integrity required for civil aviation applications.
- To provide better Air Traffic Management over Indian Airspace.
- It is interoperable with other international SBAS systems and provides seamless navigation across regional boundaries.
- **GAGAN operates through a combination of ground-based and space-based segments to enhance the accuracy and reliability of the GPS signals**
- A network of 15 precisely surveyed ground reference stations (INdian Reference Stations) is strategically placed across India. These stations collect GPS satellite data.

Space Segment

- This segment includes the communication satellites which were flown as **GSAT-8 in 2011, GSAT-10 in 2012 and GSAT-15 in 2015.**
- **These geostationary communication satellites** carry the GAGAN payloads.
- The correction messages are broadcast through these satellites to GPS receivers on aircraft

Murchison Widefield Array

- Using the Murchison Widefield Array (MWA), astronomers recently discovered a new millisecond pulsar as part of the ongoing Southern-sky MWA Rapid Two-metre (SMART) survey.
- It is a low-frequency radio telescope located at the Murchison Radio-astronomy Observatory (MRO) in Western Australia, where the future low-frequency Square Kilometre Array (SKA) will be built.
- It is a collaboration between 20 research institutions in five countries (Australia, Canada, China, Japan, and the United States) and is led by Curtin University, Australia.
- It is made of 4,096 spider-like antennas tuned to receive signals from the sky between 70 and 300 MHz.

The MWA is used to study:

- The early Universe, particularly the Epoch of Reionization, when the first stars and galaxies formed.
- The structure and evolution of galaxies and galaxy clusters.
- The Sun and space weather, including solar flares and coronal mass ejections.
- Transient radio sources, such as pulsars and fast radio bursts.
- The interstellar medium and cosmic magnetism

Blue Micromoon

- Skywatchers will be treated to a rare sight this month: a Blue Moon that is also a “micromoon.
- **A blue moon is the second full moon in a calendar month.**
- That is unusual because the period from one full moon to another is about 29 1/2 days.
- So **when two occur in the same month, the first of these full moons is always on the first or second day of the month.**
- On average, a blue moon occurs once every 33 months or full moons, 41 times per century, or about seven times every 19 years.
- **An even rarer event is when two blue moons happen in the same calendar year, which happens about four times per century.**
- Sometimes, smoke or dust in the air can scatter red wavelengths of light, as a result of which the moon may, in certain places, appear more blue than usual.
- **But this has nothing to do with the name “blue” moon, and the association of the colour with the term is unclear.**



What is a Micro Moon?

- This **refers to the apparent size of the moon as viewed from Earth.**
- The moon is not always a constant distance away from the Earth.
- Its **orbit around the Earth is elliptical.**
- **The moon is about 363,711 km away at its closest to earth, known as perigee**. At apogee, or the furthest point, the moon is about 403,945 km away.
- **If a full moon happens to occur close to its closest point, then we call that a supermoon**. And if it’s close to its furthest point, then we call that a micromoon.
- A micromoon appears only about 14% smaller than a supermoon and about 6% smaller than a typical full moon.

How Rare is a Blue Micromoon?

- Blue moons occur every couple of years, and micromoons occur two or three times every year.
- A **blue micromoon occurs about once every couple of decades.**
- However, they aren’t regular, and two such events may occur closer together or further apart.
- **No special equipment is needed to observe this blue micromoon, and it should be clearly visible in the absence of clouds.**

Northern lights in India (Auroras on June 8, 2026)

- Recently, 'Aurora Borealis', more popularly called 'northern lights' was expected to be visible in India.
- It is popularly called 'northern lights'.
- **The phenomenon is called 'northern lights' because they are concentrated around the North Pole or the magnetic pole in Earth's northern hemisphere.**
- They are frequently seen in Norway, Sweden, Finland, Iceland, Canada, Alaska, and Greenland.
- Aurora Borealis' is the scientific name for these lights in the night sky in the northern hemisphere.
- The ones in the southern hemisphere are called 'Aurora Australis' or 'southern lights.'.

Formation of Auroras

- It is due to activity on the surface of the Sun.
- The **star continuously releases a stream of charged particles, mainly electrons and protons, and magnetic fields called the solar wind.**
- As the solar wind approaches the Earth, it **is deflected by the planet's magnetic field, which acts like a protective shield.**
- However, some of the charged particles are trapped in the magnetic field and they travel down the magnetic field lines at the north and south poles into the upper atmosphere of the Earth.
- **These particles then interact with different gases present there, resulting in tiny flashes that light up the night sky.**
- When **solar wind particles collide with oxygen, a green colour light is produced.** Interaction with nitrogen produces shades of blue and purple.
- Auroras expand to midlatitudes when the solar wind is extremely strong.
- This happens when the activity on the Sun's surface goes up, leading to solar flares and coronal mass ejections (CMEs), which are essentially extra bursts of energy in the solar wind.
- In such cases, the solar wind is so intense that it can result in a geomagnetic storm, also known as a magnetic storm — a temporary disturbance of the Earth's magnetic field.

SOLAR-1

- **The United States recently activated SOLAR-1, its first dedicated space weather monitoring satellite, designed to provide faster warnings of solar storms that can affect GPS, communications, satellites and power grids.**
- It is the first United States satellite designed exclusively for continuous operational space weather observation.
- It is **operated by the U.S. National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA).**
- **Originally named Space Weather Follow On – Lagrange 1 (SWFO-L1),** the satellite was renamed to Space Weather Observations at L1 to Advance Readiness – 1 (SOLAR-1).
- **Primary Mission**: Continuous monitoring of solar activity and space weather.
- Launch Date: 24 September 2025
- **Launch Vehicle**: SpaceX Falcon 9

Orbit:

- **Positioned at the Sun-Earth Lagrange Point 1**, about 1.6 million kilometres from Earth towards the Sun, SOLAR-1 enjoys a constant, unobstructed view of solar activity.
- **From this vantage point, it continuously measures solar wind and tracks coronal mass ejections (CMEs) before they reach Earth.**
- The location's gravitational stability allows the spacecraft to maintain position with minimal fuel use.

NASA Ends MAVEN Mars Mission

- **NASA declared the Mars Atmosphere and Volatile Evolution (MAVEN) mission concluded on 3 June 2026 after a prolonged loss of contact with the spacecraft.**
- **MAVEN was launched in November 2013** and operated for more than 11 years in orbit around Mars.
- It **was a NASA orbiter designed to study the upper atmosphere of Mars and the planet's atmospheric escape processes.**

GRAPES-3 Telescope

- Recently, **researchers from Mumbai, Kochi, and Japan used the GRAPES-3 telescope to track how the earth's upper atmosphere temperature and the sun's magnetic field affect muons — subatomic particles from space.**
- **Gamma Ray Astronomy PeV EnergieS phase-3 (GRAPES-3) is designed to study the origin, acceleration and propagation of cosmic rays through measurement of extensive air showers.**
- It is induced by primary cosmic rays or gamma rays entering the Earth's atmosphere in tera to peta electronvolt energies.
- It also studies solar and thunderstorm phenomena using cosmic ray muons.
- GRAPES-3 employs an array of plastic scintillator detectors and a large area muon detector based on proportional counters.
- **Location**: It is located in Ooty, India.
- It is operated by the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research.

Cosmic rays

- These rays were discovered more than a century ago.
- They are **considered to be the most energetic particles in the universe.**
- Our planet is constantly bombarded by them from outer space almost uniformly from all directions at a constant rate.
- The shower particles constitute electrons, photons, muons, protons, neutrons etc.
- They have been observed over a remarkably wide energy range (108 to 1020 eV).

Bellatrix Aerospace to help launch South Korean VLEO satellite mission

- **Space start-up Bellatrix Aerospace will help South Korean space company TelePIX in an upcoming Very Low Earth Orbit (VLEO) satellite mission.**
- The TelePIX and Bellatrix will custom develop a VLEO Earth observation satellite around the Choulette payload, aimed at securing high-quality geospatial data.
- The **TelePIX's high-resolution wide-swath optical payload Chouette** will be integrated with the Bellatrix Aerospace's VLEO satellite platform powered by Air-Breathing Electric Propulsion (ABEP).
- **The Bellatrix will provide the satellite bus**, including propulsion, power, thermal control and attitude control systems, **while TelePIX will supply the optical payload and support system integration**
- The **VLEO satellites operate at altitudes of approximately 150 km to 250 km, lower than conventional Low Earth Orbit (LEO) satellites.**

NASA Detects Methane on Interstellar Comet 3I/ATLAS

- **NASA and the European Space Agency announced methane detection on the interstellar comet 3I/ATLAS using the James Webb Space Telescope.**
- The observation provides the first direct detection of methane in an interstellar object and the first mid-infrared chemical fingerprint of such a body.
- **Its Mid-Infrared Instrument, or MIRI, records infrared wavelengths** that are useful for studying cold dust, gases, and icy bodies in space.

Interstellar Objects

- An interstellar object is a **natural body that originates outside the Solar System and passes through it on a hyperbolic trajectory.**
- **3I/ATLAS is the third confirmed interstellar object after 1I/'Oumuamua and 2I/Borisov.**
- 3I/ATLAS was discovered on 1 July 2025 by the NASA-funded ATLAS survey telescope in Chile.

Bolide

- The explosions and the boom sounds heard by the **residents of Boston recently could be the result of "a rather significant bolide/meteor entering the atmosphere."**
- **A bolide is a type of large, exceptionally bright meteor** that often explodes in the upper atmosphere, producing a bright flash of light and occasionally fragmented meteorites reaching the ground.
- **Bolides are distinguished from regular meteors by their greater brightness and more dramatic visual effects.**
- Bolides can also produce loud booms.

What is a Meteor?

- A space rock that has not entered the Earth's atmosphere is usually referred to as a meteoroid or asteroid.
- Once in the Earth's atmosphere, the **rock traveling at very high velocities encounters friction from the atmosphere, resulting in a fireball that is then referred to as a meteor.**
- Meteors that reach the ground are then called meteorites.

Sagittarius A*

- **Recently, after 50 years of relentless research, astronomers have finally found evidence of wind blowing from Sagittarius A*.**
- It is a supermassive black hole at the Milky Way's Center.
- It was discovered in the 1970s.
- It is mostly dormant and only occasionally absorbs gas or dust, but nonetheless has an estimated mass 4.3 million times that of the sun.
- It is **located in the constellation Sagittarius.**
- It has a diameter of around 14.6 million miles (23.5 million kilometers).
- It is a **strong source of radio waves**.

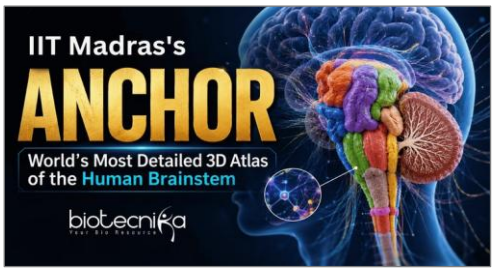
What is a Black hole?

- A black hole is a region in space where gravity pulls so much that even light cannot get out.
- The gravity is so strong because matter has been squeezed into a tiny space.
- This **can happen when a star is dying**.
- Because no light can get out, it is difficult to detect a black hole.
- The largest black holes are called "supermassive." These black holes have masses that are more than 1 million suns together.

IIT Bhubaneswar Develops 'ArsenSafe' Portable Device for Detecting Arsenic in Drinking Water

- Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bhubaneswar has innovated a device to detect arsenic that would help improve water quality monitoring and public health.
- **The team has developed a compact, portable and hand-held arsenic detection device named 'ArsenSafe' through Nano Semic Private Limited, a start-up incubated at the Research and Entrepreneurship Park, IIT Bhubaneswar**.
- ArsenSafe can accurately detect arsenic without the need for laboratory infrastructure and chemicals, making water-quality assessment faster and more accessible.
- Researchers said it was designed for rapid, cost-effective and on-site testing.

ANCHOR



- **Recently, the Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT Madras) has released the world's most detailed 3D Atlas of human brainstem called ANCHOR**.
- ANCHOR stands for Atlas of Neurochemical Characterization of the human brainstem with 3D Reconstruction.
- It is the world's most detailed 3D Atlas of human brainstem.
- It **comprises the most comprehensive, multi-modal, 3D maps and atlases of the human brainstem to date spanning from prenatal period to childhood and adult brains.**
- **Developed by**: It is developed by Sudha Gopalakrishnan Brain Centre (SGBC) at IIT Madras.

Key Features

- It encompasses more than 200 brainstem nuclei and fiber tracts, reconstructed from hundreds of serial sections.
- **Technology used**: This is a multimodal framework integrated MRI, histology and detailed chemo-architecture.
- It **has been reconstructed by eight complementary immunostains overlaid across more than 500 sections, enabling detailed mapping.**
- It allows users to zoom in nearly 1,000 times closer than MRI and allows researchers to look at cells at the micron level

RTX Spark Chip



- **Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang unveiled the RTX Spark superchip at the Computex 2026 exhibition in Taipei.**
- **The RTX Spark is a Superchip**—an integrated processor designed specifically for Windows AI laptops and compact desktops.
- **Unlike traditional computers that use separate CPUs (from Intel/AMD) and GPUs (from Nvidia), the Spark combines both into a single, high-performance unit.**
- The goal is to create a new category of Personal AI Computers where local AI agents, rather than manual clicks and types, drive the user experience.

Project Glasswing: Key cybersecurity agencies set to get access to Anthropic's Mythos

- US artificial intelligence company Anthropic is extending access to its closely guarded cybersecurity initiative, Project Glasswing, **to a select set of organisations in India, including key government entities that are responsible for safeguarding cybersecurity across sectors like banking, telecom, and power.**
- AI model Mythos can detect critical software vulnerabilities.
- This matters for India as it shields vital infrastructure like banking and power, even as Anthropic battles the US Pentagon over boundaries of AI misuse.

India AI Mission launches Indigenous Varya, a Video Story Generating AI Model Claiming to Offer Quality at Affordable Price

- Avataar, an AI-native transformation company, announced the launch of Varya, a **distilled video model built to make frontier video AI affordable, accessible and relevant for India's next generation of users.**
- Varya has been designed for India's many contexts, not a generalized idea of India.
- **The model has been built to understand and generate culturally rich visual outputs across India's regions, festivals, communities, food, clothing, public spaces and everyday life.**

NIMHANS launches endovascular innovation lab, unveils indigenous stroke device prototype 'PARICHAY'

- **The National Institute of Mental Health and Neuro Sciences (NIMHANS), Bengaluru**, marked a significant milestone in healthcare innovation **with the launch of the Endovascular Research and Innovation (EVRI) Laboratory and the unveiling of the first alpha prototype of an Indigenous Mechanical Thrombectomy Device for acute stroke.**
- The laboratory, funded by the Science and Engineering Research Board (SERB), **now the Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF), Government of India, was inaugurated by NIMHANS director Prabha S. Chandra during a workshop titled 'Atmanirbhar Bharat: Self-Reliant India in Neuroscience – Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)', held at the institute**.

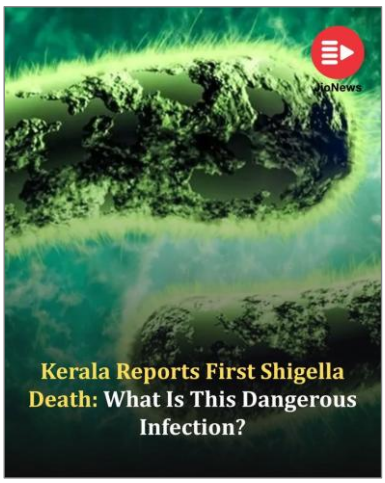
Thrombectomy device

- A key highlight of the event was the unveiling of the alpha prototype of 'PARICHAY', an indigenous mechanical thrombectomy device designed for the treatment of acute ischemic stroke.
- **Avataar was among the companies selected by the IndiaAI Mission to build indigenous foundation AI capabilities**.
- Developed with support from the IndiaAI Mission, Varya uses a **distillation technique that reduces video generation from 50 steps to 4 steps**, while maintaining comparable output quality.
- Varya can generate video at ₹0.48 per second, making it upto 10x more cost-efficient than several leading global video models.
- **The product experience is designed around a simple promise**: Idea → Video → Story.

Shigellosis

- Recently, more cases of shigellosis (bacillary dysentery) are being reported across Keralam.
- **It is a highly contagious bacterial diarrhoeal disease caused by shigella.**
- It can affect anyone, but children under five are particularly susceptible.
- It is **one of the leading bacterial causes of diarrhoea worldwide**.

- **Humans are the only natural reservoir of the Shigella bacteria.**
- The disease may be more severe in young children, older adults, immune-compromised individuals or malnourished persons.



Transmission

- The infection is transmitted through direct, close contact with infected individuals, through the faecal-oral route and through sexual contact.
- **It can also spread through contaminated food and water or contact with faeces of an infected person.**

Symptoms

- The most common symptoms is diarrhoea, which can be bloody, contain mucus and last for a prolonged period of three days or more.
- Other symptoms include stomach cramps, vomiting, fever and feeling the need to pass stool even when the bowels are empty.
- **Treatment**: Medicines, including antibiotics may be prescribed for a serious infection

Usutu Virus Detected in Scotland for First Time

- **Usutu virus (USUV), a mosquito-borne flavivirus, was identified in blackbirds in Scotland for the first time in summer.**
- Usutu virus is a mosquito-borne flavivirus **that mainly affects wild birds.**
- Blackbirds are among the most affected bird species in Usutu virus outbreaks.
- **Named after a river in southern Africa** near where it was first identified in 1959,
- The **culex pipiens mosquitoes that carry Usutu are most active and abundant in warm conditions around 25C**
- The virus is transmitted when an infected mosquito bites a person or animal.

Autoimmune Blistering Diseases (AIBDs)

- A joint study by Punjabi University, Patiala, and PGIMER, Chandigarh, **has developed artificial intelligence-based methods to aid diagnosis of Autoimmune Blistering Diseases (AIBDs).**
- Autoimmune Blistering Diseases (AIBDs), also called autoimmune bullous disorders, are a group of rare skin diseases.
- **They happen when your immune system attacks your skin and mucous membranes** — the lining inside your mouth, nose, and other parts of your body.
- This **causes blisters to form.**

Symptoms:

- The places on your body where blisters form depend on which disorder you have.
- **Some AIBDs cause blisters to grow on the skin**.
- Other types cause them to form in the mucous membranes that line the mouth, nose, throat, eyes, and genitals.
- **They can be painful or itchy**. They can break open and leave a sore.

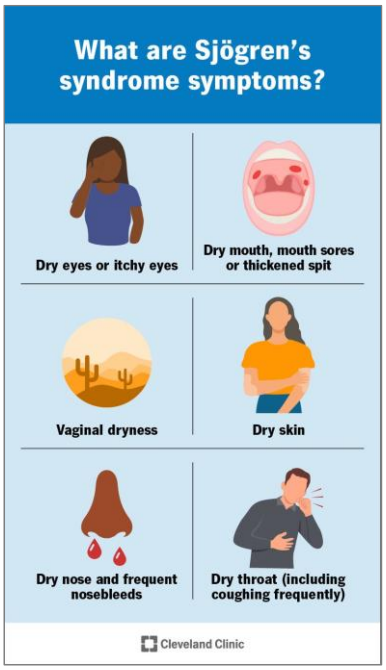
Treatment aims to suppress the abnormal immune response and prevent new blister formation:

- Corticosteroids
- Immunosuppressive drugs
- Biologic therapies such as Rituximab
- Wound care and infection prevention.

Sjogren's Disease



- **Researchers from Japan recently discovered a self-reinforcing loop between different immune cells that sustains autoimmune responses in patients with Sjögren's disease.**
- Sjögren's disease (also called Sjögren's syndrome) is a chronic autoimmune disorder **where the immune system mistakenly attacks its own moisture-producing glands.**



- It typically attacks the glands that produce tears, saliva, and sweat. Other parts of the body may also be affected.
- **The exact cause of Sjögren's syndrome is unknown, though there seems to be a genetic influence.**
- It is thought that factors such as viral infections, stress, and hormone changes can trigger symptoms of Sjögren's syndrome.
- **Sjogren syndrome can happen at any age. But most people are older than 40 at the time of diagnosis.**
- Ninety percent (90%) of adults diagnosed with Sjögren's are women.

Symptoms

- **dry eyes**, which may also feel painful, burning, itchy, or gritty
- a **dry mouth**, making it difficult to swallow, speak, or eat dry foods
- **swelling of the glands** in the face and neck areas

Some people with Sjögren's syndrome also notice:

- joint pain, swelling and stiffness
- dry skin or skin rash
- vaginal dryness
- persistent dry cough
- ongoing fatigue
- **Sometimes the liver and kidneys are affected. A few people will also develop lymphoma (cancer of the lymph nodes).**
- There is no cure for Sjögren's syndrome.

American Foulbrood (AFB)



- **Beekeepers have been warned to increase the biosecurity of their hives after an outbreak of American Foulbrood disease (AFB) was recently confirmed in Scotland.**
- It is a fatal infectious disease of honey bee larvae caused by a spore-forming bacterium called Paenibacillus larvae.
- **While it only attacks larvae, AFB weakens the colony and can quickly lead to its death in only three weeks.**

Transmission:

- Although AFB is not highly contagious, **bacterial spores can easily be spread between hives and apiaries through beekeeping practices such as the exchange of equipment and movement of infected combs.**
- Though adult bees are not affected by AFB, they can spread spores within and between infected and clean hives through robbing and drifting.
- **Treatment**: The disease is not able to be cured, meaning that destruction of infected colonies and hives or irradiation of infected material is the only way to manage AFB

Guntur's Lam Farm releases two chilli varieties to rival Teja and Byadgi

- **The Regional Horticultural Research Station (RHRS), Lam Farm, has developed two chilli varieties as alternatives to the popular Teja and Byadgi, with some pest resistance, high pungency and tolerance to weather conditions.**
- **Two chilli varieties** — LCA-625 and LCA-643
- **LCA-643 is suitable for both green and dry chilli cultivation.**
- The variety produces light green fruits measuring 13 to 14 cm in length that turn bright red after drying, resembling the popular Byadgi variety.
- **It is tolerant to moisture stress, shows moderate resistance to the Gemini virus** and performs well even under black thrips infestation with minimal pesticide use.

- **LCA-625, developed primarily for dry chilli production**, has plants with dense branching and medium-length fruits of 8 to 10 cm, **similar to the Teja variety**.
- The **variety has high pungency** of 45,000 to 50,000 Scoville Heat Units and a red colour value of 60 to 65 ASTA units.
- It is also moderately tolerant to fruit rot disease.

Kerala Agricultural University Releases KAU Thejaswini Chilli

- The Kerala Agricultural University (KAU) **has released KAU Thejaswini, a new green chilli variety developed for the State's farming conditions.**
- The new variety promises high yield, quality fruits and field tolerance to major production constraints.
- **KAU Thejaswini was developed by Sarada S., associate professor and Head of the college's Department of Vegetable Science**.
- The **variety has medium pungency with a capsaicin content of 0.45% and is suitable for cultivation throughout the year under Kerala conditions,"**
- **KAU Thejaswini will help enhance local chilli production** by providing farmers with a high-yielding, quality variety adapted to Kerala's agro-climatic conditions.
- The bush-type plants exhibit field **tolerance to bacterial wilt and viral diseases**, making them suitable for stable production under field conditions.
- The variety is also well suited for homesteads, kitchen gardens and terrace cultivation, providing an attractive option for both commercial farmers and urban gardeners
- They are rich in Vitamin C (121 mg per 100 g) and possess an oleoresin content of 15.1%,

Epichlorohydrin



- The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) has implemented strict standards for tea bags, prohibiting harmful chemicals like epichlorohydrin.
- **It is an epoxide in which one of the methyl hydrogens is substituted by chlorine**.
- It is a **volatile** and **flammable**, **clear**, **colorless**, **liquid**, chlorinated cyclic ether with an irritating, chloroform-like odor.
- It **emits toxic fumes of hydrochloric acid** and other chlorinated compounds when heated to decomposition.
- It is **soluble in water**.
- It is **used mainly for the manufacture of glycerol and unmodified epoxy resins.**
- It is **used in the manufacture of elastomers, water treatment resins, surfactants, ion exchange resins, plasticizers, dyestuffs, pharmaceutical products, oil emulsifiers, lubricants and adhesives.**

Pyroprocessing

- Pyroprocessing is being used in many sectors across the globe.
- **It is a way to change a solid material physically or chemically using high temperature.**
- It is a dry **process and very energy-intensive**.
- Three sectors that use it most are cement-making, metallurgy, and nuclear power.

Applications of Pyroprocessing

- Cement Making
- Pyroprocessing is used to extract metals from their ores in multiple stages.
- It uses pyroprocessing to reprocess spent nuclear fuel.

Bharat Climate Observation Network

- Recently, the **Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology and the Aryabhatta Research Institute of Observational Science Nainital** have signed a long-term Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to establish a climate observation station in the Himalayan region under the **Bharat Climate Observation Network (BCON).**
- It is a national observational initiative conceptualized and implemented by Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM) under the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES), Government of India,
- Objective: It is to develop a long-term, high-precision climate monitoring framework across the country.

Functions

- **Monitor Meteorological Parameters**: BCON will monitor meteorological parameters, climate-active trace gases (greenhouse gases and short-lived climate forcers), atmospheric chemistry and soil moisture observations.
- **National Database**: BCON will develop a robust national database that supports the detection of long term trends, advances climate change research, and strengthens India's capacity for climate assessment and evidence based policy development.

Smart Seed Coating Technology

- Recently, the Indian Council of Agricultural Research's Indian Institute of Oilseeds Research (ICAR-IIOR), Hyderabad, has developed Smart Seed Coating Technology.
- It is an innovative biopolymer-based technology.
- It **uses biodegradable biopolymers to form a multifunctional protective layer around seeds.**
- This coating acts as a delivery platform for beneficial microorganisms, nutrients, micronutrients, crop protection agents, and crop-protection agents directly at the seed-soil interface, improving germination rates and early plant growth,
- It **creates a favourable microenvironment that promotes faster germination, stronger seedling growth, better root development, and enhanced tolerance to both biotic and abiotic stresses during the crucial crop establishment phase.**
- The coating can be tailored for a broad range of crops, including cereals, millets, pulses, vegetables, and horticultural produce, and is particularly suited to rainfed farming,

ICAR-CIBA Demonstrates Blue Swimmer Crab Farming



- **ICAR-Central Institute of Brackishwater Aquaculture (ICAR-CIBA),** Chennai, has successfully demonstrated Blue Swimmer Crab (Portunus reticulatus) farming technology for the first time using **institute-produced hatchery seed** and a scientifically formulated pelleted feed developed by ICAR-CIBA.
- The technology offers a **promising new opportunity for farmers seeking profitable alternatives and complements to existing shrimp farming systems.**

Teplizumab Becomes First Type 1 Diabetes Delay Drug on NHS



- Teplizumab, sold as Tzield, is an **immunotherapy drug for type 1 diabetes** and is the first medicine designed to delay the onset of symptomatic stage 3 type 1 diabetes.
- **Type 1 diabetes is an autoimmune disease** in which the **immune system attacks insulin-producing beta cells** in the pancreas.
- **Teplizumab is manufactured by Sanofi** and is approved for adults and children aged eight years and above.
- The drug is given as a **one-time 14-day course of intravenous infusions,** with each infusion session lasting about 30 minutes.

Ministry of Civil Aviation & DIAL Launch AIR SUVIDHA 2.0 Portal for Ebola Health Screening at PoEs in India



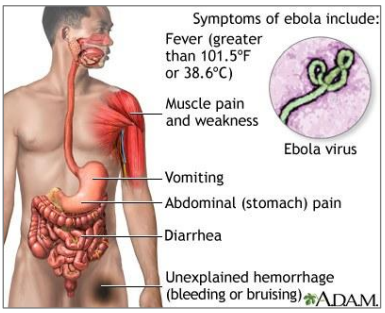
- The Ministry of Civil Aviation and Delhi International Airport Limited (DIAL) launched **AIR SUVIDHA 2.0**, an **upgraded contactless Passenger Health Self-Declaration Portal**, to strengthen public health surveillance at Points of Entry in response to the ongoing Ebola disease outbreak.
- The launch follows the **WHO's declaration of the Ebola/Bundibugyo virus disease outbreak in the Democratic Republic of the Congo and Uganda** as a Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC) on 17 May 2026 under the International Health Regulations (IHR) 2005.

Ebola Virus Disease (EVD)

- The virus was **first identified in 1976** during two simultaneous outbreaks one in Yambuku (DRC) near the **Ebola River** (from which the disease takes its name), and

the other in Nzara (South Sudan).

- **Fruit bats** of the Pteropodidae family are considered the natural hosts of the Ebola virus.
- It transmits to humans through **close contact** with the **blood, secretions, organs, or bodily fluids of infected animals** (like bats, chimpanzees, gorillas, and monkeys).



Symptoms:

- Initial: Fever, extreme fatigue, muscle pain, headache, and sore throat.
- Advanced: Vomiting, diarrhoea, rash, impaired kidney and liver function, and in some cases, severe internal and external bleeding.

- **Fatality Rate: EVD is highly lethal,**
- Treatment: Early supportive care (rehydration with oral or intravenous fluids) and symptomatic treatment significantly improve survival rates.

Short News

- **India's AI ambitions received a major boost ,as Bengaluru-based Sarvam announced a fresh $234 million funding round, pushing its valuation to $1.5 billion and making it India's newest AI unicorn.**

Environment

PM Modi welcomes designation of Surha Tal as India's 100th Ramsar site



- **India has reached a historic milestone with the designation of the Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal) in Ballia, Uttar Pradesh, as the country's 100th Ramsar Site of International Importance.**
- This wetland (the world's 2,595th Ramsar site) is a **freshwater wetland** in the middle stretch of the Ganga River basin. It was originally formed from a meander of the Ganga and receives freshwater inflow through three channels.
- Globally, there are nearly 2,595 such designated wetlands **under the 1971 Ramsar Convention.**
- **India has the highest number of such wetlands in Asia and third highest in the world after the UK (176) and Mexico (144).**
- Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary is characterized by floodplains, extensive marshes, seasonal flooded areas and rice paddies.
- "During the summer months, when many smaller wetlands in the region dry out, the Site provides an important refuge For waterbirds.
- **The diverse waterfowl species recorded at the Site include the vulnerable common pochard (Aythya ferina) and the Indian river tern (Sterna aurantia)**
- **Wetlands are areas of marsh, fen, peatland or water, whether natural or artificial, permanent or temporary, with water that is static or flowing, fresh, brackish or salt, including areas of marine water the depth of which at low tide does not exceed six metres.**
- **For example**, marine and coastal areas; Estuaries; Lakes and rivers; Marshes and peatlands; Groundwater and human-made wetlands such as rice paddies, shrimp ponds, and reservoirs.
- **Ramsar sites are wetlands** that are designated as being **of international importance** under the Ramsar Convention.
- The **Ramsar Convention** is an **Intergovernmental treaty** established by UNESCO - provides the framework for the conservation and wise use of wetlands and their resources.
- Adopted on **2nd February 1971 in Ramsar, Iran**. Came into force from 21st December, 1975.
- **India** is one of the Contracting Parties to Ramsar Convention, **signed it on 1st Feb 1982.**
- **February 2** is celebrated as the **International Wetlands Day**
- **World's first Ramsar Site** - Cobourg Peninsula in Australia, designated in 1974.
- **World's largest Ramsar Site** - Rio Negro in Brazil (1,20,000 km2)

Lakshadweep Potato Patch Coral Colony Identified

- Researchers in India have **documented a giant coral colony near Kadmat Island in Lakshadweep, spread across an estimated 4,250 sq m.**
- The Pavona clavus formation, known locally as the **"Potato Patch".**
- The colony may also represent a long-lived coral structure around 700 to 1,800 years old,
- Lakshadweep is an Indian Union Territory in the Arabian Sea and contains coral atolls, reefs and lagoons.
- **Coral reefs are vibrant underwater ecosystems built by reef-forming corals.**
- These corals are **marine invertebrates** that share a symbiotic relationship with algae known as **zooxanthellae.**
- These corals secrete calcium carbonate (limestone) exoskeletons, which over time accumulate to form the massive, colorful, and biologically rich reefs.



- **Coral reefs require precise environmental conditions to flourish, including warm water temperatures between 23°C and 29°C, shallow depths for sunlight penetration, and stable salinity levels.**
- **Coral reefs are classified into four types based on structure and location:** Fringing Reefs, Barrier Reefs, Atolls, and Patch Reefs

Bonn Climate Conference Calls for $120 Billion Adaptation Finance

- **At the Bonn Climate Conference 2026 (SB64), health advocacy groups led by the Global Climate and Health Alliance** (GCHA) urged developed countries to triple public adaptation finance to $120 billion annually by 2035.
- The Bonn Climate Conference refers to the **annual mid-year climate negotiations held under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC).**
- Officially known as the 64th Sessions of the Subsidiary Bodies (SB64), it serves as a technical and preparatory meeting ahead of the annual COP summit.
- The 2026 conference is being held in Bonn, Germany

Aim:

- To advance implementation of commitments made under the Paris Agreement and previous COP decisions.
- To facilitate negotiations on adaptation, mitigation, climate finance, loss and damage, and just transition.

Key Outcomes and Discussions

- **Adaptation Finance Push:** Health groups called for increasing public grant-based adaptation finance from the COP26 target of $40 billion to $120 billion annually by 2035.

Fossil Fuel Transition

• Developed countries were urged to publish national roadmaps for transitioning away from fossil fuels.

• Discussions stressed alignment with the 1.5°Cglobal warming pathway.

▪ **Belém Adaptation Indicators:** Technical discussions began on operationalizing the 59 Belém Adaptation Indicators adopted at COP30.

▪ **Food Systems and Agriculture:** Deliberations continued under the Sharm el-Sheikh Joint Work on Agriculture and Food Security to improve climate resilience in agriculture.

▪ **Just Transition Mechanism:** Discussions focused on operationalizing the new Just Transition Mechanism agreed at COP30 to support capacity building and technical cooperation.

Mombasa Declaration

- **15 Fifteen countries from Africa, Asia, Europe, the Caribbean, and the Pacific recently adopted the Mombasa Declaration to step up efforts to combat illegal fishing.**
- It was adopted by 15 countries from Africa, Asia, Europe, the Caribbean, and the Pacific to step up efforts to combat illegal fishing.

- It calls on governments to improve access to information on fishing vessels, ownership, and licensing, and to strengthen data sharing to better track fishing activities and enforce regulations.
- It is **named after the Kenyan city hosting the 11th Our Ocean Conference (OOC).**
- **Out of the more than 30 countries represented in the summit,** Belgium, Cameroon, Chile, the Dominican Republic, France, Gambia, Ghana, Guinea, Liberia, Panama, Papua New Guinea, Peru, the Republic of the Congo, Somalia, and South Korea signed the agreement.
- It is **intended to curb illegal, unreported, and unregulated fishing, also known as IUU fishing**, which threatens marine ecosystems and the livelihoods of millions of people who depend on fisheries.
- **The declaration builds support for the Global Charter for Fisheries Transparency**, a set of 10 policy principles aimed at improving governance through low-cost reforms, including modernizing vessel registries and publishing fishing authorizations

Key Facts about Our Ocean Conference (OOC)

- Launched in 2014 by the U.S. Department of State and former Secretary of State John Kerry, the **OOC is a major international platform that unites governments, businesses, NGOs, and academic institutions to drive ocean-related action and ambition.**
- Since its inception, it has generated over 2,600 commitments valued at more than $160 billion, making it one of the most impactful global gatherings for ocean sustainability.
- **2026 OCC**: **Mombasa (Kenya) – Marking the first time the global summit was held on African soil, themed "Our Ocean, Our Heritage, Our Future".**

SHAN Conservation Society to protect snow leopards in Ladakh

- **Ladakh Lt Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena on approved the constitution of first-of-its-kind 'Snow Leopard and High-Altitude Nature' (SHAN) Conservation Society, which will act as a dedicated institutional mechanism for wildlife conservation and community-led environmental stewardship in the Union Territory.**
- The LG of Ladakh will be the chairman of the society, while the chief secretary, Ladakh MP, chief executive councillor, LAHDC, Leh, the chief executive councillor, LAHDC, Kargil, and the principal secretary, Department of Forest, Ecology and Environment, will be the ex-officio members.
- The society will promote, assist and mobilise resources for the conservation of wildlife and their habitat, eco-development in the vicinity of areas inhabited by snow leopard, its co-existing species, and promote eco-tourism and sustainable livelihood,
- **Revered as the 'Ghost of the Mountains', the snow leopard is a keystone species whose presence reflects the health of the entire Trans-Himalayan ecosystem.**
- The snow leopard (Panthera uncia) is currently classified as **Vulnerable on the IUCN Red List of Threatened Species**.

The First Carbon Credits Under the Paris Agreement

- **The United Nations carbon market officially issued its first-ever carbon credits under Article 6.4 of the Paris Agreement for a clean-cooking project in Myanmar.**
- A carbon credit is a **tradeable certificate or permit that represents the verified reduction, avoidance, or removal of one metric tonne of carbon dioxide (CO2) or its equivalent greenhouse gas (CO2) from the atmosphere.**
- Under Article 6.4 of the Paris Agreement, these credits are designed as high-integrity assets supervised by a dedicated UN body **to funnel international finance toward genuine, sustainable climate solutions.**



Nations and Entities Involved:

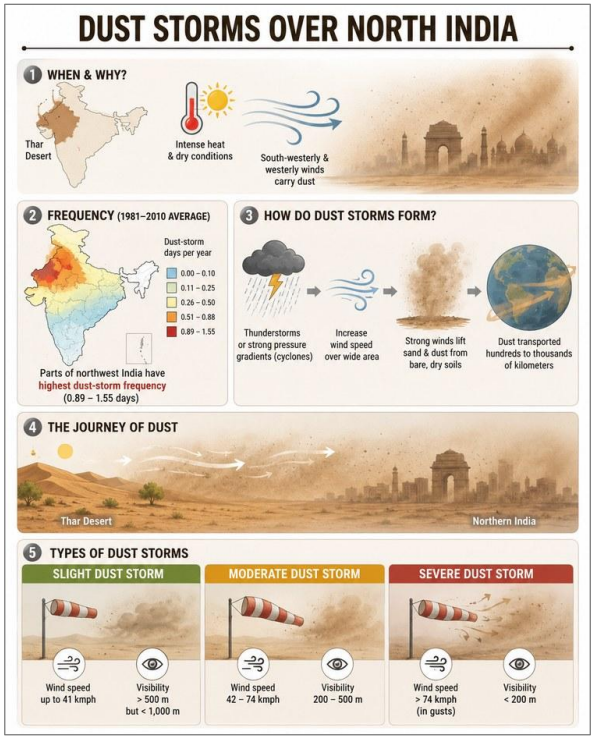
- **Host Nation**: Myanmar, specifically targeting communities in its central Dry Zone (including the conflict-heavy Sagaing Region).
- **Partner Nation**: The Republic of Korea (South Korea).
- **Governing Authority**: The Article 6.4 Supervisory Body of the UN Paris Agreement Crediting Mechanism.

The Joint Crediting Mechanism (JCM)

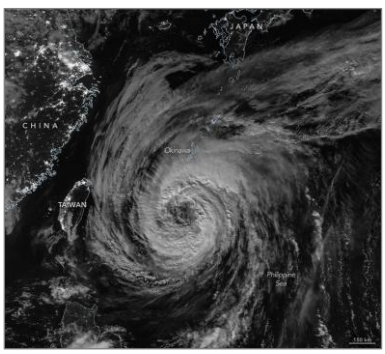
- **The governments of India and Japan officially adopted the 'Rules of Implementation' for the Joint Crediting Mechanism (JCM).**
- This operational milestone activates a bilateral carbon market framework under Article 6.2 of the Paris Agreement.
- The Joint Crediting Mechanism (JCM) is a **formal bilateral carbon crediting system established by Japan with various partner nations**.
- It encourages international cooperation to reduce greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions **by deploying advanced decarbonizing technologies, infrastructure, and mitigation systems in developing or transitioning economies.**
- The JCM is governed internationally by Article 6.2 of the Paris Agreement under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), which regulates cooperative approaches and the transfer of Internationally Transferred Mitigation Outcomes (ITMOs).
- **The JCM aims to accelerate the adoption and spread of high-performance, low-carbon technologies across partner countries.**
- By leveraging private and public capital, the mechanism seeks to reduce or remove global greenhouse gas emissions while driving sustainable development and helping both cooperating nations achieve their respective Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs).

Dust Storm

- **Visuals of a massive dust storm in Churu on May 30 have been going viral on social media.**
- The storm, which affected Churu, Hanumangarh, Sri Ganganagar, Bikaner, Nagaur, Didwana-Kuchaman, Alwar and Sikar, is common in parts of Rajasthan this time of the year.
  - **Dust storms primarily originating from the Thar Desert are not unusual over northern India in the pre-monsoon months of April to June.**
- These storms are fuelled by intense heat and dry conditions, while south-westerly and westerly winds move the dust across the region.
  - **The India Meteorological Department's (IMD) Climate Hazards and Vulnerability Atlas of India, based on 1981-2010 climatological normals, shows that parts of northwest India fall in the highest dust-storm frequency class, averaging 0.89 to 1.55 dust-storm days**.
- According to IMD, dust storms are common meteorological hazards in arid and semiarid regions.
- **It is usually caused by thunderstorms or strong pressure gradients** associated with cyclones which increase wind speed over a wide area.
  - **These strong winds lift large amounts of sand and dust from bare, dry soils into the atmosphere,** transporting them hundreds to thousands of kilometers away.



Tropical storm Jangmi injures 9 in Japan, thousands without power



- A severe tropical storm battered southwestern Japan
- The Japan Meteorological Agency warned of **high waves, landslides and flooding as storm Jangmi, which was downgraded from a typhoon, rumbles northwards after bearing down on the subtropical island of Okinawa**
- **A typhoon is a form of cyclone that has wind speeds of 119 kmph and above and develops over warm ocean waters near the equator.**
  - When warm, moist air rises from the ocean surface, it creates a low-pressure area.

- **Cyclones are rapid inward air circulation around a low-pressure area.**
  - The air circulates in an **anticlockwise direction in the Northern hemisphere** and **clockwise in the Southern hemisphere.**

Cloudbursts have emerged as a recurring climate-related hazard in India's mountainous regions.

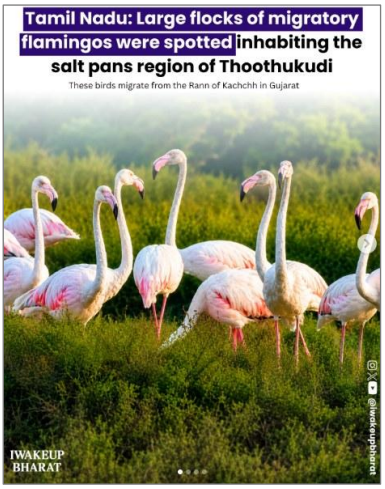
- A cloudburst is a localised but intense rainfall activity.
- **It is a short-term extreme precipitation that takes place over a small area**; it is not, as is sometimes understood, the breaking open of a cloud resulting in the release of huge amounts of water.
- The **India Meteorological Department (IMD) defines cloudburst as unexpected precipitation exceeding 100mm (or 10 cm) per hour over a geographical region of approximately 20 to 30 square** km. Significant amounts of rainfall such as this can result in floods.

— **Cloudbursts do occur on plains, but they are more likely to occur in mountainous areas, owing to three major factors:**

- the wind pattern,
- the height of the mountains,
- and the degree of moisture and humidity in the air.
- **Cloudbursts are more common in mountainous places due to a phenomena known as 'orographic lift'**, which is simply warm air rising up the side of a mountain. Warm air 'climbs' a mountain and expands due to low pressure at higher altitudes.

Flamingos

- **Large flocks of migratory flamingos have turned the coastal salt pans of Thoothukudi, Tamil Nadu, into a vibrant feeding and resting habitat.**



- Flamingos are highly gregarious, tall, pink wading **birds** belonging to the family **Phoenicopteridae,** which stands as the sole family under the specialized avian order Phoenicopteriformes.
- **Renowned for their highly social behavior**, these birds gather in **massive colonial flocks** numbering from hundreds to over a million individuals for flight formations, wading, and breeding.
- They **primarily colonize highly alkaline or saline shallow lagoons,** coastal salt pans, mangrove creeks, tidal mudflats, and inland soda lakes across tropical and subtropical regions.
- **The Indian Migration Route**: The two species commonly found in India—the Greater Flamingo (Phoenicopterus roseus) and the Lesser Flamingo (Phoeniconaias minor)—**migrate systematically from their major national breeding grounds in the Rann of Kachchh, Gujarat, to wintering coastal havens across southern Tamil Nadu (including Thoothukudi, Tirunelveli, and Kanyakumari).**

Conservation Status:

- **Lesser Flamingo (Phoeniconaias minor):** Globally classified as Near Threatened (IUCN Red List).
- **Greater Flamingo (Phoeniconaias minor):** Classified under Least Concern (IUCN Red List).

Eechathalakenda incognita



- A **team of scientists recently discovered a new fish species named Eechathalakenda incognita from Western Ghats of Kerala.**
- It is a **new species of fish** belonging to the cyprinid subfamily Torinae.
- It was discovered from various streams inside the Periyar Tiger Reserve, Kerala.
- **The genus Eechathalakenda was originally established in 1999 for a solitary, enigmatic fish species first described in 1941 from the Pamba River in Kerala.**
- Their geographic distributions are exceptionally narrow; E. ophicephala is strictly confined to Pamba river headwaters over 1,000 metres above sea level, while E. incognita is isolated to specific fast-flowing, rocky streams inside the Periyar Tiger Reserve.

- **E. incognita is the ninth point-endemic fish species** (restricted to a single location in the world) to be identified within the Periyar Tiger Reserve

Tylosaurus rex



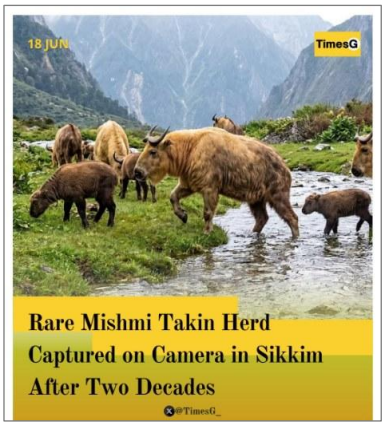
- Paleontologists have identified a new, distinct species of massive **Cretaceous-era marine reptile named Tylosaurus rex after re-examining previously misidentified fossils,** including a famous 13.2 meter specimen nicknamed Bunker.
- **Tylosaurus rex (meaning king of the tylosaurs) is a newly designated species of mosasaur**—a group of giant, carnivorous marine reptiles that dominated the oceans during the Late Cretaceous epoch.
- It was an apex predator capable of hunting large marine life, earning it a reputation as the underwater equivalent of Tyrannosaurus rex.
- Mosasaurs are unique because they evolved from small, land-living lizards that migrated into the marine environment, rapidly transitioning into fully aquatic predators during the final 30 million years of the age of dinosaurs.

Yellow-Throated Marten



- Kaziranga National Park recently recorded its first sighting of the **yellow-throated marten, highlighting Assam's conservation success.**
- The yellow-throated marten, also known as the **kharza**, is a marten species found in forested regions throughout Southern and Eastern Asia.
- **A marten is a slender-bodied mammal** belonging to the weasel family (Mustelidae), which also includes otters, badgers, ferrets, and wolverines.
- **Their range extends throughout the Himalayas, as far south as Indonesia, and as far north as the Korean Peninsula and the Chinese-Russian border.**
- They are also found in shrublands, lowland swamps, and treeless mountains.
- **It is the largest of the Old World martens** and is notable for its flexible and muscular appearance.
- It is a **fearless animal with no natural predators**, because of its powerful build, its bright coloration and unpleasant odor.
- **It is classified as 'Least Concern' under the IUCN Red List**

Mishmi Takin



- The **first-ever video footage of a herd of the elusive Mishmi Takin have been recently recorded in the Tingda Reserve Forest of North Sikkim.**
- It is a species of goat-antelope belonging to the family Bovidae (order Artiodactyla).
- It is one of 4 subspecies of Takin, which vary in coat color.
- **Scientific Name**: Budorcas taxicolor.
- It is a **native of the eastern Himalayas, including the mountainous regions of northeastern India, northern Myanmar, southeastern Tibet and parts of China**.
- The **Mishmi Hills in Arunachal Pradesh is the region that gave the Mishmi Takin its name**.
- They inhabit a wide range of environments, from forested valleys to rocky alpine zones.
- They can live at altitudes of up to 4,500 m and are well-equipped for mountain life.
- **Mishmi Takin Conservation Status:** It is classified as 'Vulnerable' under the IUCN Red List

Crotalaria phulei



- **Indian botanists recently identified a previously unknown species of flowering plant named Crotalaria phulei from forests of Nagpur.**
- It was discovered in the Khairi-Umred forest near Nagpur, Maharashtra.

- **It was named in honour of Krantijyoti Savitribai Phule, India's first woman teacher** and one of India's most influential social reformers.
- Belonging to the Fabaceae family, Crotalaria phulei is an undershrub that grows up to 1.5 metres in height.
- The species has been assigned a preliminary conservation status of Data Deficient under the IUCN criteria.

Mesalina Bishnoi Recorded in India for First Time



- A **new species of lizard, Mesalina Bishnoi, has been recently discovered in Rajasthan.**
- It has been discovered near Gajner in Bikaner district, Rajasthan.
- The species was found in an arid landscape consisting of hard, rocky soil with sparse desert vegetation.
- It **marks the first confirmed record of the genus Mesalina in India.**
- **Mesalina bishnoi is named in recognition of the Bishnoi community's enduring commitment to wildlife and nature conservation.**
- At present, Mesalina bishnoi is known only from its type locality in the Bikaner district and is considered endemic to the Thar biogeographic province.

Bascanichthys chepakakiensis



- Recently, **marine scientists have discovered a new species of snake eel and officially named Bascanichthys chepakakiensis.**
- It is a new species of snake eel discovered in **Kakinada fishing harbour** in **Andhra Pradesh.**
- The specific name, chepakakiensis, is a combination of two words from the **regional Telugu language: chepa, which means "fish," and "kaki, a shortened nickname for Kakinada**.
- It is the only second time a species of this snake-eel genus has been described from Indian waters.

What are Snake eels?

- Snake eels are members of the family Ophichthidae, and are named for their snake-like appearance
- **These eels mainly live in sandy areas in shallow seas, however some live in depths to 800m.**
- They are found in both tropical and temperate waters in oceans around the world.

Greater Hog Badger



- **Recently, the Kaziranga National Park and Tiger Reserve has released the first scientific assessment report on the greater hog badger (Arctonyx collaris).**
- It is a nocturnal small burrowing **omnivore mammal**.
- It is called 'mati gahori' in Assamese.
- **Globally, there are three extant species of this mammal**—the greater hog badger, the northern hog badger (Arctonyx albogularis), and the Sumatran hog badger (Arctonyx hoevenii). The **first two are found in India.**
- **Appearance**: It possesses an elongated pig-like snout and modified teeth which point forward and are used for turning over the soil.
- **Distribution**: It is distributed across parts of South, Central, and Southeast Asia.
- Its range extends from Bangladesh and northeastern India eastwards through Myanmar, Thailand, Lao PDR and Vietnam.
- **Habitat**: They live in tropical evergreen forests, savanna, grasslands and shrubland, hills, and mountains.

Conservation Status

- **IUCN**: Vulnerable
- **Wildlife Protection Act of 1972**: Schedule I...

Indopottia Himalayensis



- **Recently, scientists from the Botanical Survey of India have discovered a new species of moss and named it as Indopottia himalayensis.**
- It is a new moss species discovered from high-altitude forests of the Western Himalayas in **Uttarakhand state.**
- It is **only the third species of its kind ever identified globally.**
- Other two species reside far away in the Western Ghats of southern India and the mountains of Thailand.
- The research team chose the name Indopottia himalayensis as a tribute to the magnificent Himalayan mountain range.

Pseudocapritermes novus



- **Researchers recently discovered a new species of soil-dwelling termite named Pseudocapritermes novus within the lush forests of West Bengal.**
- It is a new species of soil-dwelling termite.
- It **was discovered during an exploration of the Chapramari Wildlife Sanctuary, West Bengal.**
- These soil-feeding termites play a crucial role in enriching the earth by feeding on soil and humus, making them vital indicators of an ecosystem's soil health and fertility.
- This discovery brings the total number of Pseudocapritermes species found in India to five

Key Facts about Moss



- It is a small **nonvascular** spore-bearing land plant belonging to the taxonomic division Bryophyta.
- It is **among the earliest land plants and has colonised some of the harshest environments on the planet, including Antarctica, volcanic fields, and deserts.**
- **There are three main types**: peat moss, granite moss and true moss.
- **Mosses are distributed throughout the world except in salt water.**
- It is the small plant commonly found in damp, shady spots is already known for its resilience on Earth.

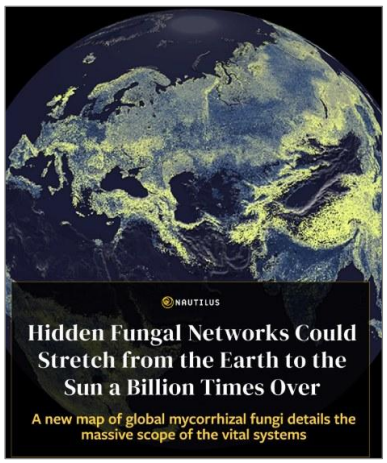
Yellow Puffball Mushroom Documented in Arunachal Pradesh



- Researchers recently documented a **rare bright yellow puffball mushroom named Bovista colorata in Arunachal Pradesh's Longding district.**
- Bovista colorata, commonly known as the yellow puffball mushroom, **is a species of puffball fungus** belonging to the family Agaricaceae.
- It is **generally found in grasslands**, open fields, meadows, and disturbed soils.
- Bovista colorata has a spherical shape and striking yellow fruiting body.
- **Unlike conventional mushrooms that produce spores through gills beneath a cap, puffball fungi develop spores inside a closed spherical fruiting body.**
- As the mushroom matures, the **internal tissue transforms into a fine powdery mass of spores,** which are dispersed through wind, raindrops, or physical disturbance, allowing the species to spread over considerable distances.
- Puffball species play an important ecological role as decomposers, aiding nutrient recycling, carbon cycling and soil formation.
- Some species are also known for their nutritional value and bioactive compounds with potential medicinal properties.

Arbuscular Mycorrhizal Fungi

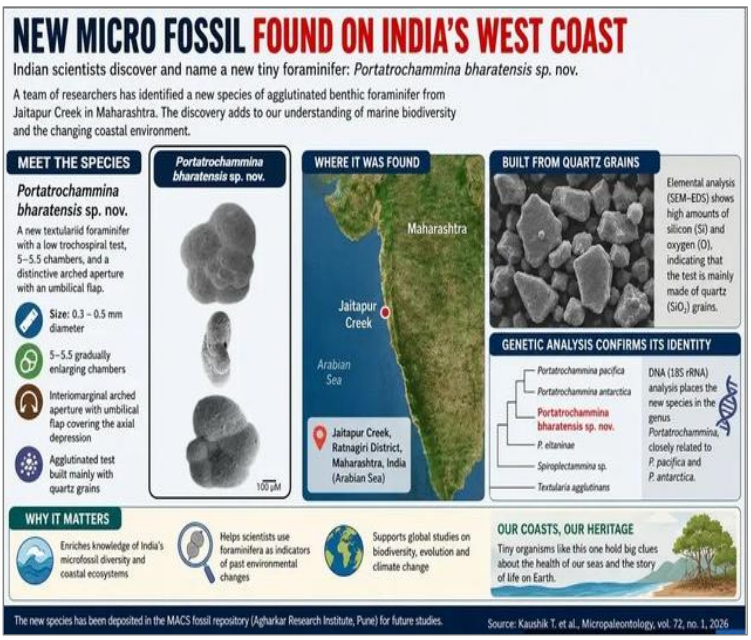
- **A new study published in Science has reported the first global map of the earth's vast underground network of arbuscular mycorrhizal (AM) fungi.**
- These are groups of root obligate biotrophs belonging to the phylum Glomeromycota.
- These are **soil-borne microorganisms that form symbiotic associations with approximately 80% of terrestrial vascular plants.**



- AMF are **primary biotic soil components** which, when missing or impoverished, can lead to a less efficient ecosystem functioning.
- **Structure**: These are made up of tiny branching threads called hyphae.
- **These hyphal networks form two-way pipes to channel nutrients and carbon to and from plants.**
- **Grassland ecosystems** like those in South Sudan, the Tibetan plateau, and India's Banni grasslands **house 40% of the world's AM fungal networks.**
- Its networks also weigh around 300 million tonnes of carbon, which is four- to six-times the weight of the entire human population.

Foraminifera

- **Recently, scientists at Agharkar Research Institute (ARI), Pune, have discovered a new species of Foraminifera and named it Portatrochammina bharatensis.**
- **Discovery Location**: Sediments of Jaitapur Creek, an estuary nestled along the Konkan coast in the Ratnagiri District, Maharashtra, in the Arabian Sea.



- It is a **group of single-celled organisms** that have inhabited the world's oceans for over 500 million years.
- The shells have hundreds of tiny holes called foramen, the Latin word for window.
- They are among the most abundant and ecologically important organisms in the ocean.
- They are **generally sand-grain size**, measuring between 500 and 50 µm.
- They live in the open ocean, along the coasts, and in estuaries.
- **Most have shells for protection and either float in the water column (planktonic) or live on the sea floor (benthic).**
- They construct their intricate shells, called "tests," **from materials they scavenge from their surroundings (agglutinating mineral grains).**
- **They don't have a wall around their cell membranes**, they are extremely flexible and can change shape.
- **The organism pushes extensions of its cytoplasm called pseudopodia (or false feet) through these holes to gather food.**
- **Foraminifera eat detritus on the sea floor and anything smaller than them**: diatoms, bacteria, algae, and even small animals such as tiny copepods.

New herbicide-tolerant mustard hybrids need diverse farming plans

- **In the 2026-27 rabi sowing season, from October to April, Indian farmers are set to begin the wide-scale cultivation of imidazolinone-resistant (IMI-resistant) mustard hybrids.**
- These hybrids are designed to overcome a parasitic weed called Orobanche.
- **Mustard is the most vital oilseed crop**
- The new IMI-resistant hybrids are a technological solution to this problem. **Unlike genetically modified (GM) crops, these hybrids were developed in a process called mutation breeding — where scientists breed crops to preserve certain natural mutations.**
- The process is based on an enzyme called acetolactate synthase (ALS), which is essential for plant growth.

Paraquat Herbicide

- **Telangana officially issued a Government Order banning the sale, distribution, manufacture, and use of the highly toxic weedicide Paraquat to protect farmers and public health.**

- Paraquat is an extremely potent, fast-acting, and highly toxic chemical compound used as a non-selective contact herbicide (weed killer).
- Because it is non-selective, **it destroys any green plant tissue it comes into contact with by killing cell structures on impact, making it highly valued by agricultural sectors for rapid field clearing despite its lethal health risks.**

Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve

- Recently, the Supreme Court has ordered the immediate removal of encroachers and demolition of illegal structures across the ecologically sensitive Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve landscape in South India.

Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve

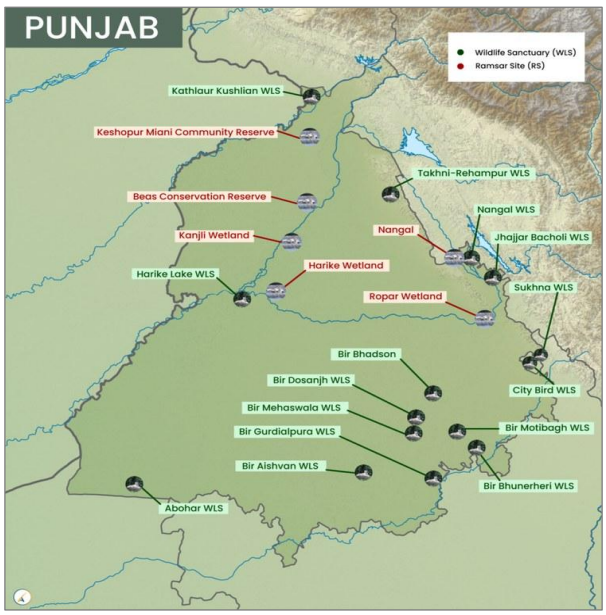
- It is located in the southern part of the Western Ghats **spanning the states of Tamil Nadu and Kerala.**
- It was **established as a Biosphere Reserve in 2001** and added into the UNESCO World Network of Biosphere Reserves list in 2016.
- The Agasthyamala Biosphere Reserve has peaks reaching 1,868 m above sea level.

It includes protected areas namely

- Shendurney Wildlife Sanctuary
- Peppara Wildlife Sanctuary
- Neyyar Wildlife Sanctuary
- Kalakkad Mundanthurai Tiger Reserve
- It **includes the Asian elephant, tiger and Nilgiri Tahr and birds like Great Indian hornbill**.
- It is home to the Kanikaran—one of the oldest surviving tribes in the world.

Jhajjar-Bachauli Wildlife Sanctuary

- **The Punjab forest department recently prepared a ₹5.36-crore development plan for the Jhajjar-Bachauli Wildlife Sanctuary in Rupnagar district**.
- Jhajjar-Bachauli Wildlife Sanctuary is located in the Rupnagar district of Punjab.
- It **lies near the Sutlej (Satluj) River** in the foothills of the Shivalik Range.
- The **sanctuary is characterized by dry deciduous forests.**
- In January 2026, the Punjab State Board for Wildlife approved **renaming the sanctuary as Sri Guru Tegh Bahadur Wildlife Sanctuary in honor of Guru Tegh Bahadur.**



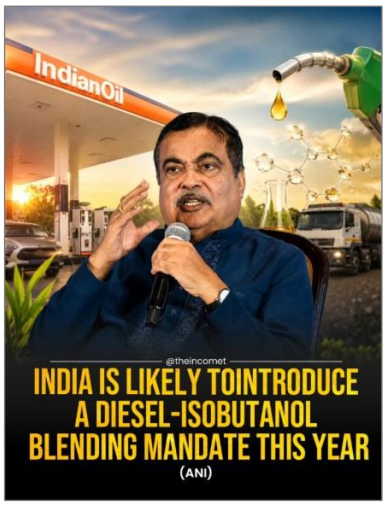
MoS Environment, Forest and Climate Change Launches "NZP Saathi App" and Inaugurates Self-ticketing Kiosks at National Zoological Park

- Union Minister of State for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Shri Kirti Vardhan Singh **launched the "NZP Saathi App", a smart digital zoo guide, and inaugurated Self-ticketing Kiosks at the National Zoological Park (NZP), New Delhi**, aimed at enhancing visitor experience through smart navigation and easing online ticket booking.
- The "NZP Saathi App", available on both Android and iOS platforms, features an interactive digital map and smart navigation system **that enables visitors to locate animal enclosures, washrooms, buggy points, exits and other facilities.**

Isobutanol

- The Indian government is likely to **introduce a mandate permitting blending isobutanol with diesel by the end of this year.**
- It is also called isobutyl alcohol, is an alcohol with the chemical formula $C_4H_{10}O$ and one of the four isomers of butanol
- It is a **clear, colorless liquid with a characteristic odor.**
- It is only moderately soluble in water.

- It is **very flammable and has a flash point that is only slightly above normal room temperatures.**
- Its vapors are heavier than air and can spread unnoticed along the ground.
- It can **be made from ethanol using fermentation processes.**



Applications of Isobutanol

- It is **used as a solvent in the flavor, fragrance, pharmaceutical, and pesticide industries and as a chemical manufacturing ingredient for products such as lacquer, paint strippers, paint primer, and craft paints.**
- It is an approved food additive and is also naturally occurring in some foods and many alcoholic beverages.
- Isobutanol may also be used as a biofuel because, **like ethanol, it can be manufactured from plants.**

Bangladesh Joins International Big Cat Alliance

- Bangladesh joined the International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) as its **27th member nation.**
- The IBCA is a treaty-based inter-governmental international organisation and legal entity headquartered in New Delhi, India.
- Big Cats Covered Under the IBCA**: Lion, Tiger, Leopard, Snow Leopard, Cheetah, Jaguar and Puma.**
- These species are ecologically important apex predators and play a crucial role in maintaining ecosystem balance and biodiversity.

New species of wild brinjal discovered in the Andamans



- A new species of wild brinjal has been discovered from one of the remote islands of the Andaman and Nicobar archipelago by a scientist from the **Botanical Survey of India (BSI).**
- The species, **Solanum pandeyi**, was recorded in the evergreen forest of **Middle Andaman** by Lal Ji Singh, head of the BSI Andaman and Nicobar regional centre.
- The plant was used by an **indigenous Negrito tribe, Great Andamanese**, for food and medicinal purposes.
- Most seeds and roots are used to treat **tooth infection.**
- The species Solanum pandeyi is named after **Arun Kumar Pandey,** professor, Department of Botany, University of Delhi, for his significant contributions to plant systematics

Mimeusemia kali



- Scientists recently discovered a new species of forester moth named Mimeusemia kali in Karnataka's Kali Tiger Reserve in the Western Ghats.
- **It is a new species of forester moth.**
- **It was discovered in Karnataka's Kali Tiger Reserve**.
- It marks the first addition to the genus Mimeusemia in nearly 30 years.
- Mimeusemia kali is distinct from closely related species because of its unique physical characteristics, reproductive structures and genetic features.

Key Facts about Kali Tiger Reserve

- Kali Tiger Reserve, earlier known as Dandeli-Anshi Tiger Reserve, is located in the Uttara Kannada (North Canara) district of Karnataka in the Western Ghats.
- It **comprises two protected areas viz., Dandeli Wildlife Sanctuary (475.018 Km²) and Anshi National Park (339.866 Km²).**
- It shares a border with Bhimghad Wildlife Sanctuary in the north, which is further connected to Radhanagari and Koyna wildlife sanctuaries in Maharashtra.
- **To the west, it shares borders with five protected areas in Goa**

Sistan sand boa



- A new study reports the first confirmed record in India of the **Sistan sand boa** (Eryx sistanensis), a species formally **described only in 2020 and previously known from Iran and Pakistan.**
- The Sistan sand boa was documented from the **northern Thar Desert in Rajasthan.**
- It is the first confirmed record in India of the Sistan sand boa, formally described only in 2020 and previously known from Iran and Pakistan.

Two new apps to identify and record Indian butterflies launched



- To help gather better data on Indian butterflies, **Kunte has collaborated with Nature's Ark to develop two mobile Android apps**, **iButterfly Explorer** and **iBiodiversity Count.** These apps are specifically targeted at Indian butterflies,
- Nature's Ark, a platform that seeks to bridge the gap between cutting-edge technologies and organisations committed to climate adaptation and biodiversity conservation.
- **This is the first Indian mobile app that identifies any Indian fauna with AI.**

The Hamburg Sustainability Conference (HSC) 2026

- The United Nations Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN) released its 2026 Sustainable Development Report during the third Hamburg Sustainability Conference (HSC).
- The Hamburg Sustainability Conference (HSC) is a prominent international, hybrid multi-stakeholder platform designed to catalyze action and rescue the unravelling United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).
- Operating as a direct counterweight to growing global military expenditures and multilateral fatigue, it focuses on building practical economic, digital, and environmental alliances between the Global North and Global South.
- The 2026 conference is convened under the official operating theme: Together we co-create sustainable development.
- India is among the fastest-improving major economies in the SDG Index, with notable gains in rural electrification (SDG 7) and digital connectivity (SDG 9).
- India's Standing in the 2026 UN SDG Index:

Metric	2015	2025	2026
Global SDG Rank	112th	99th	94th
SDG Score	—	—	68.3/100
Overall Progress	—	—	+18 ranks (since 2015)

Brachybacterium netajii

- A team of researchers recently discovered a tough, new species of bacteria named **Brachybacterium netajii in the waters of the River Ganges.**
- It is a new species of bacteria.
- It was **discovered from the Hooghly (a distributary of the Ganges) region of West Bengal.**
- Named after Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose
- It possesses a remarkable ability to **break down toxic chemicals and survive heavy metal pollution.**
- It can safely **degrade p-nitrophenol (PNP), a toxic industrial chemical, and boasts extreme resilience**, surviving high concentrations of toxic heavy metals like arsenic, cadmium, lead, and mercury.
- It is also **halotolerant, meaning it can withstand highly salty environments containing up to 9% salt.**
- Its cellular makeup is unique.
- Its genome is packed with **unique genomic islands, chunks of DNA likely absorbed from other organisms.**

Hargila Bird

- Recently, the Prime Minister of India shared about the efforts of thousands of **rural women** who stepped forward to save the **'Hargila Bird' – known as the 'Hargila Army' in Assam.**
- It is a large strikingly looking member of the stork family.
- Habitat: It inhabits **wetlands, shallow lakes, drying lake beds, and freshwater flooded forests.**

- It is residing only in the **states of Assam and Bihar of India and in Cambodia.**
- These are usually seen singly or in small groups as they stalk about in shallow water.
- These breed during winter in colonies that may include other large waterbirds.
- Diet: **These are omnivorous birds.** Although they are mainly scavengers, they also prey on frogs and large insects and will also take birds, reptiles, and rodents.
- Threats: It includes the loss of nesting and feeding habitat through the draining of wetlands, pollution.
- Conservation Status
- **IUCN: Near Threatened**
- **Indian Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972: Schedule IV.**



Aldabra Giant Tortoise

- On the first day of his Seychelles visit, Prime Minister met and fed Jonathan, the Aldabra giant tortoise estimated to be 194 years old and recognised by Guinness World Records as the world's oldest living land animal.
- It is the second-largest species of land tortoise in the world, after the Galapagos giant tortoise (Chelonoidis nigra).
- Scientific Name: Geochelone gigantea
- It is endemic to the Aldabra Atoll of the Seychelles, an archipelago nation in the western Indian Ocean about 930 miles east of Africa and northeast of Madagascar.
- These are terrestrial and occur in a wide variety of habitats, including scrub forests, mangrove swamps, and coastal dunes and beaches, each with their respective vegetation.
- The largest populations of tortoises are found on grasslands called "platins."
- Their heavy grazing has formed a special kind of grassland habitat called "tortoise turf."
- They can measure over 120 cm, reaching weights of over 250 kg.
- Males are considerably larger than females and have longer, thicker tails.
- They range in color from dark gray to black.
- Lifespan: It is among the longest-living vertebrates, with many individuals living over 100 years and some believed to exceed 150 years.
- It is classified as 'Vulnerable' under the IUCN Red List



Short News

- **Mother Dairy, one of India's largest dairy brands, unveiled what they claim to be the country's first naturally degradable milk pouches for its cow milk variant**. The degradable pouches, which decompose naturally in soil without leaving behind microplastics, will be rolled out across Delhi-NCR

Index/rankings/reports

2026 Global Peace Index (GPI)

- **Every year, the Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP) releases the Global Peace Index (GPI).**
- It ranks the 163 countries based on their safety and peace parameters, which are set by IEP.
- The **2026 data is the 20th edition** of the index that has been released, and **Iceland remains in the first rank as the safest country in the world in 2026.**
- The Global Peace Index is published by the Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP). **It measures peace using 23 different factors. These factors are grouped into three areas, which are:**
- Societal safety and security (crime rate, fear of violence, homicide rate)
- Ongoing domestic and international conflict (wars, armed conflicts)
- Militarisation (military spending, weapons imports)

- **Countries with lower GPI scores are considered more peaceful.** The index covers 99.7% of the world's population.



Key Highlights of the 2026 GPI

- Global peace has declined for the 12th year in a row.
- **Out of 163 countries, 99 became less peaceful in the past year**.
- There are now 61 active state-based conflicts in the world, the highest since World War II.
- **Russia is ranked as the least peaceful country**.
- Iceland holds the top spot as the most peaceful country for the 19th year in a row.
- **India holds the 127th rank among the 163 countries with a score of 2.409 in GPI 2026, which is down by 12 rankings compared to last year, 2025.**

Rank	Country	Score
1	Iceland	1.161
2	New Zealand	1.343
3	Switzerland	1.363
4	Slovenia	1.369
5	Ireland	1.371

QS World University Rankings 2027 Released

- The QS World University Rankings 2027 were released on June 18, 2026, **with the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) taking the top spot globally for the 15th consecutive year.**



Global Top 5 Universities

- Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) (United States)
- Imperial College London (United Kingdom) / Stanford University (United States) (Tied for 2nd)
- **University of Oxford (United Kingdom)**
- Harvard University
- **A total of 52 Indian institutions made the top 1500 list, with 13 Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs) representing a large chunk of the country's highest performers.**
- **IIT Delhi secured the top spot among Indian universities, rising to 118th globally**.
- IIT Bombay ranked 134th globally.
- IIT Madras climbed to 170th globally.

India Ranks Fifth in Military Spending, Second in Arms Imports

- India remained the world's fifth-largest military spender in 2025 and the second-largest importer of major arms, according to the latest report **released by the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (Sipri).**
- The findings, published in the Sipri Yearbook 2026, showed that India's military expenditure rose to $92.1 billion in 2025, an increase of 8.9 per cent compared to the previous year.
- **The report ranked India behind only the United States, China, Russia and Germany** in terms of defence spending.
- The world's second-largest importer of major arms during the 2021-25 period, India accounted for 8.2 per cent of global imports.



Vinod Khosla, Sundar Pichai on Forbes' list of 250 successful immigrants in US: Here's the full list



- **Marking the 250th anniversary of the United States of America, Forbes released a list of the country's 250 successful living immigrants, featuring billionaire venture capitalist Vinod Khosla, renowned entrepreneur and investor Naval Ravikant, Google CEO Sundar Pichai, among other Indians.**
- The Forbes' list features prominent figures from across the fields of technology, media, science, politics, economics, arts and culture, including Nobel Prize winners, who all have contributed significantly to the American economy and society.

The top five ranks on the list were occupied by :

- Austria-born billionaire, real estate mogul, movie star and former California governor, Arnold Schwarzenegger (#1),
- South Africa -born tech giant Elon Musk (#2),
- Russia-born Google cofounder Sergey Brin (#3),
- Nvidia's CEO Jensen Huang from Taiwan (#4),
- and Australian media mogul and owner of Wall Street Journal, the New York Post and Fox News, Rupert Murdoch (#5).
- **Here are the top Indian-origin immigrants who made it to the Forbes list:**

Rank	Indian immigrants	Designation
#14	Vinod Khosla	Cofounder of Sun Microsystems
#27	Naval Ravikant	Cofounder of investment platform AngelList, made early bets on Uber, Twitter and delivery service Postmates, acquired by Uber in 2020
#31	Hemant Taneja	Founder of General Catalyst, and investor, Stripe, Snap and defense firm Andruil
#44	Sanjay Mehrotra	CEO of Micron, and founder of memory chip giant Sandisk
#55	Sundar Pichai	Google CEO since 2015
#59	Abhijit Banerjee	Cofounder of Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL), and Nobel Prize winner in Economics (2019)
#64	Padma Lakshmi	Top Chef host
#89	Satya Nadella	CEO of Microsoft, spearheaded acquisitions of Activision Blizzard and LinkedIn
#91	Neerja Sethi	Pledged to give away $1.3 billion of $2.8 billion combined fortune in 2025, along with her husband
#93	Jay Chaudhry	Founder of cloud security firm ZScaler, and four other companies — all acquired
#98	Romesh T. Wadhwani	Founder of Aspect Development, chairman and founder of enterprise AI company Symphony AI

Smriti Mandhana only Indian among TIME magazine's 100 most influential sportspersons



- **Cricketer Smriti Mandhana has been named by TIME magazine among this year's 100 most influential people in sports, the only Indian to be featured on the list.**
- In 2024, she set the record for most international runs across formats by a woman and then beat her own record last year— "a feat that contributed to her being **crowned BBC Indian Sportswoman of 2025.**
- **TIME's list of the 100 Most Influential People in Sports 2026 features athletes, coaches, advocates and investors who are "people shaping sports today."**
- The list, headlined by American basketball legend LeBron James, includes superstars

from the world of sports such as football icon Lionel Messi, Chinese-American skier Eileen Gu, tennis star Carlos Alcaraz, basketball player Victor Wembanyama, legendary golfer Rory McIlroy among others.

MrBeast becomes first YouTuber to hit 500 mn subscribers, gets a custom Play Button



- **Jimmy Donaldson, popular as MrBeast, has become the first YouTuber to surpass 500 million subscribers on the video-streaming platform.**
- The achievement comes less than two years after he became the most-subscribed creator on YouTube, surpassing former leader PewDiePie and overtaking India's T-Series in the platform's creator rankings.

The International Institutional Ranking Framework (IIRF)

- **The International Institutional Ranking Framework (IIRF) has released its list of the top 10 government universities in India for 2026.**
- The ranking highlights the **best public-funded institutions** across the country based on various academic and research parameters.
- At the **top of the list is Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) in New Delhi,** followed by the University of Delhi (DU) at second place. Jamia Millia Islamia, also located in Delhi, holds the third position.
- This means three universities from the national capital region have taken the top three spots.
- The **fourth rank goes to the University of Hyderabad (UoH) in Telangana.**
- Banaras Hindu University (BHU) in Varanasi and Aligarh Muslim University (AMU) in Aligarh, both from Uttar Pradesh, are placed fifth and sixth, respectively.

Top 10 Government Universities in India for 2026

RANK	UNIVERSITY	CITY	STATE
1	JNU - Jawaharlal Nehru University	New Delhi	Delhi
2	DU - University of Delhi	New Delhi	Delhi
3	JMI - Jamia Millia Islamia	New Delhi	Delhi
4	UoH - University of Hyderabad	Hyderabad	Telangana
5	BHU - Banaras Hindu University	Varanasi	Uttar Pradesh
6	AMU - Aligarh Muslim University	Aligarh	Uttar Pradesh
7	CURAJ - Central University of Rajasthan	Ajmer	Rajasthan
8	CUP - Central University of Punjab	Bathinda	Punjab
9	Central University of Himachal Pradesh	Dharamshala	Himachal Pradesh
10	The Indira Gandhi National Tribal University, Amarkantak	Anuppur	Madhya Pradesh

India Leads in US Unicorn Founders

- India is the leading country of origin for immigrant founders of U.S. billion-dollar startup companies, with Indian-born entrepreneurs having founded or co-founded 96 unicorns in the United States, **according to a new report by the National Foundation for American Policy (NFAP).**

- Israel followed with 60 companies, while the United Kingdom ranked third with 47.

India's seafood exports hit record $8.46 billion in 2025-26: MPEDA


India's seafood exports hit record $8.46 bn in FY26 amid global headwinds

BUSINESS STANDARD JUNE 2ND, 2026

Overcoming global market uncertainties, India's seafood exports touched an all-time high in both volume and value as the country shipped nearly two million tonnes of seafood during 2025-26.India exported 19.72 lakh tonnes of seafood worth $8.46 billion in

- India exported a record 19,72,018 metric tonnes (MT) of seafood valued at ₹73,890.46 crore ($8.46 billion) in fiscal year 2025-26.
- **The figures mark an all-time high in terms of volume and value despite global challenges**
- Chairman of the Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA) - P. Jawahar
- The **United States and China remained the primary importers of Indian seafood**,
- The **frozen shrimp remained the leading product in seafood exports, accounted for 40.19% of the total quantity**
- Frozen fish, the second-largest exported item, generated
- In terms of overseas markets, the U.S. remained the leading importer of Indian seafood,
- China emerged as the largest destination for Indian seafood exports in terms of quantity
- **Vizag, JNPT and Kochi were the top three ports handling seafood cargo.**

Planetary Climate Vital Signs Report 2026

- **A new global climate assessment released during the Bonn Climate Change Conference (SB64), 2026 warns that all major planetary climate indicators have worsened since the last IPCC assessment cycle.**
- The **Planetary Climate Vital Signs Report 2026** is a global scientific **assessment published in Earth System Science Data by around 70 scientists from 17 countries.**
- It provides updated measurements of key climate indicators between IPCC assessment cycles, offering policymakers real-time evidence on global warming , greenhouse gas emissions, and climate extremes.

Key Findings:

- **All 11 Major Climate Indicators Worsened:** Every climate indicator assessed recorded deterioration since the IPCC Sixth Assessment Report, confirming an accelerating climate crisis.
- **Marine Heatwaves Recorded the Sharpest Increase:** Marine heatwaves increased by **1%**, making them the fastest-worsening climate indicator globally.
- **Earth's Energy Imbalance Reached Record Levels:** Earth's Energy Imbalance rose by **8%**, indicating faster accumulation of heat within the climate system.
- **Global Temperatures Continue to Rise:** Maximum daily temperatures increased by **9%**, while human-induced warming reached **1.37°C above pre-industrial levels in 2025**.
- **Land and Ocean Warming Intensifying:** Average land temperatures rose by **81°C**, while ocean temperatures increased by **1.03°C** during 2016–2025.
- **Indian Ocean Approaching Permanent Marine Heatwave State:** Studies suggest the Indian Ocean may experience **220–250 marine heatwave days annually by 2100**, compared to around 20 days historically.

UNICEF's Children's Climate Risk Report 2026

- **A new UNICEF Children's Climate Risk Report 2026 has revealed that nearly 392 million children in India (92% of all children) are exposed to extreme heat, while 89 million face recurrent heatwaves.**
- The UNICEF Children's Climate Risk Report 2026 is a global assessment that evaluates children's exposure and vulnerability to climate and environmental hazards.
- It measures how overlapping climate risks such as extreme heat, drought, floods, storms, and air pollution affect children's health, education, nutrition, and survival.

• **Around 392 million children in India (92%) are exposed to extreme heat conditions.**

India Records Very High Climate Hazard Exposure:

- India's overall hazard exposure score stands at 9.21/10, among the highest globally.

- **Only Pakistan (9.44) and Bangladesh (9.38) recorded higher scores in South Asia.**

Extreme Heat Emerges as the Highest Risk:

- India received the maximum score of 10/10 for extreme heat exposure.

Air Pollution Remains a Critical Threat:

- India's air pollution exposure score reached 9.94/10.

Drought Vulnerability is Extremely High:

- The report assigns India a drought risk score of 8.84/10.

Multiple Climate Hazards Affect Children Simultaneously:

- Globally, 1.1 billion children are exposed to at least three overlapping climate hazards.

▪ **Existing Heat Action Plans Lack Child-Centric Measures:**

▪ While India has expanded Heat Action Plans, most lack provisions for:

- Schools and Anganwadis
- Night-time heat management
- Child vulnerability mapping
- Age-specific adaptation measures

India ranks 13th globally for AI-Economy readiness: QS World Future Skills Index 2027



- India has secured the 13th position globally in the QS World Future Skills Index 2027,
- The QS World Future Skills Index measures **how well countries are prepared for the future of work.**
- **The US topped the global rankings followed by Australia and the UK.**

Indian Performance by Indicator - QS World Future Skills Index 2027		
Indicator	Score/100	Global Rank
Skills Alignment	82.7	18
Academic Readiness	85.7	22
Future of Work	96.0	5
Economic Transformation	93.3	14
Overall	89.4	13

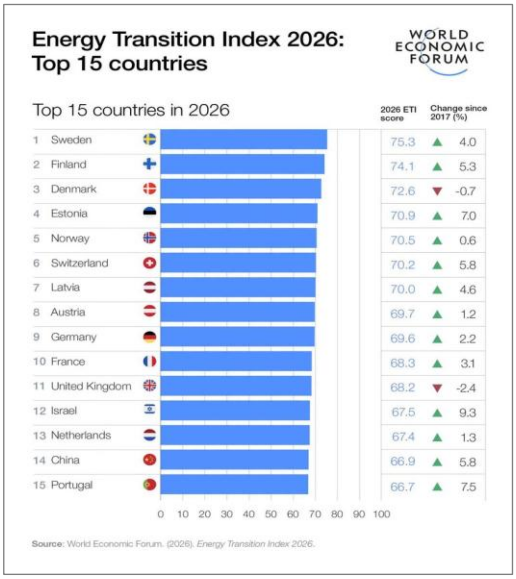
Rank	Economy	Overall Score (/100)	Balance Index	Primary Strength
1	United States	99	1	Skills Alignment
2	Australia	98	1	Academic Readiness
3	United Kingdom	97	4	Academic Readiness
4	Germany	96	4	Future of Work
5	Canada	94	3	Academic Readiness

Energy Transition Index

- India moved up two places to rank 70th in the Energy Transition Index (ETI) 2026.
- It is released by the **World Economic Forum.**
- It evaluates countries on energy security, sustainability and equity, along with the readiness of their policy, financial and infrastructure environments to support the transition.
- A country's final ETI score is a weighted composite of two sub-indices: **system performance (60%) and transition readiness (40%).**
- **ETI scores use a 0-100 scale, with 100 representing the highest global performance for each indicator and index component.**

Key Findings of Energy Transition Index

- **Sweden, Finland and Denmark retained their top three positions globally**
- **Singapore posted one of the largest improvements,** climbing 10 places to 42nd due to stronger regulations and political commitment.
- Six G20 members featured in the top 20: **Germany (9th), France (10th), the United Kingdom (11th), China (14th), Brazil (17th) and the United States (19th).**



Bengaluru's KIA named world's third most 'family-friendly' airport

- The Kempegowda International Airport (KIA) has been ranked as one of the world's most family friendly airports for 2026.
- According to a study conducted by **AttractionTickets.com,**
- KIA has been ranked among the world's best airports for transiting with children and is one of only two Indian airports to feature on the global list.
- While KIA has been ranked third in the list **of top 10 airports for families, Hyderabad's Rajiv Gandhi International Airport has been ranked fourth.**
- Helsinki-Vantaa Airport topped the list, followed by **Singapore's Changi Airport and Bahrain International Airport, with KIA ranking third.**

India Becomes World's Top Ship Recycling Nation in 2025

- According to the latest report by the **United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD),** India emerged as the **world's leading ship recycling nation in 2025**, capturing a top-ranking 35.4% global market share.
- India recycled 99 million gross tons (GT) of shipping volume in 2025, marking a sharp 60% surge from the 1.86 million GT recorded in 2024.
- The country's global market share jumped from 30.1% in 2024 to 4% in 2025, outperforming all international competitors.
- **Formulated a comprehensive master plan via the Government of Gujarat to expand the Alang Ship Recycling Yard,** aiming to nearly double capacity to 9 million light displacement tons (LDT).

Bengaluru Ranks Second in Asia's AI-Native Startup Clusters



- Government of Karnataka and Karnataka Digital Economy Mission (KDEM), in partnership with Startup Genome, **announced key findings from the Global Startup Ecosystem Report (GSER) 2026, unveiled at VivaTech Paris.**
- The rankings highlight India's growing innovation footprint, with six Indian ecosystems featured globally.
- **The GSER 2026 ecosystem rankings are based on a weighted composite index across six key success factors**: Performance (27.5%), Funding (20%), Market Reach (20%), Talent and Experience (17.5%), AI-Native Cluster (10%), and R&D Engine (5%).
- **Ranking #15 globally in the Startup Ecosystem Index, Bengaluru-Karnataka continues to strengthen its position as India's leading startup hub.**
- The ecosystem ranks among the Top 10 globally and #3 in Asia for Performance, and among the Top 15 globally and #4 in Asia by Ecosystem Value.

Chinese Supercomputer LineShine Tops TOP500 List



- China's LineShine supercomputer ranked first in the 67th edition of the TOP500 list.
- The system is installed at the National Supercomputing Center in Shenzhen and recorded a performance of **2.198 exaflops, equal to more than 2 quintillion calculations per second.**
- The TOP500 list ranks the world's 500 most powerful supercomputers using the High Performance Linpack benchmark.
- Exascale computing refers to systems capable of at least one exaflop, or **1018 floating-point operations per second.**
- **LineShine uses a CPU-only design and a custom 304-core processor.**

Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal launches PortGPT mobile app, releases V.O.C. Port Authority Sustainability Report 2026



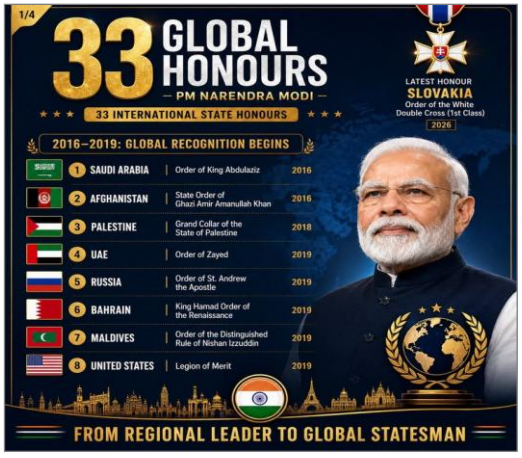
- The V.O. Chidambaranar (VOC) Port Authority in Thoothukudi launched PortGPT, a dedicated mobile application aimed at enhancing operational efficiency, knowledge management and data-driven decision-making, becoming the **VOC port the first major port in India to deploy an enterprise-grade generative Artificial Intelligence platform through a mobile app**.
- PortGPT is expected to improve access to information, streamline workflows and support the port's long-term digital transformation initiatives.
- The event also saw the release of the VOCPA Sustainability Report 2026, titled **'Towards a Green Maritime Future'.**
- The report outlines the **port's initiatives in renewable energy adoption, carbon reduction and sustainable operations.**
- VOCPA also received certification recognising it as a Scope-2 Emission-Free Port, reflecting its transition towards clean energy and low-carbon operations.

IIMB scores 9.7 in global positive impact rating, retains top pioneering school status

- In the 2026 edition of the Positive Impact Rating (PIR) for Business Schools, a global student-led assessment of societal impact, the **Indian Institute of Management Bangalore (IIMB) earned an overall score of 9.7, substantially higher than the global average of 8.0.**
- Positive Impact Rating (PIR) is governed by a **Swiss association and was initiated by a coalition of business school experts.**
- It is supported by founding endorsers, including **WWF, Oxfam International and the UN Global Compact Switzerland and Liechtenstein, with funding from VIVA Idea and the Institute for Business Sustainability (IBS).**
- The rating **evaluates business schools on the positive impact** they create for society rather than focusing solely on academic excellence or institutional reputation.

International

PM Modi Receives Slovakia's Order of the White Double Cross



- **Prime Minister of India was formally conferred with The Order of the White Double Cross, First Class, the highest state honor of the Slovak Republic.**
- The Order of the White Double Cross (Slovak: Rad Bieleho dvojkríža) is the **highest state decoration awarded by the Slovak Republic.**
- This is **Prime Minister Modi's 33rd international honour.**
- Bratislava is the capital of Slovakia and the venue of the award ceremony.
- **Peter Pellegrini is the President of Slovakia.**
- The Order of the White Double Cross was established after Slovakia became an independent republic in 1993.

- Tt is awarded by the President of Slovakia and is **primarily given to foreign citizens for their contribution to developing friendly relations with the country.**
- The award takes its name from the white double cross, a historic symbol that forms part of Slovakia's national emblem.

UPI Launches at Galeries Lafayette in France

- **India launched Unified Payments Interface (UPI) at Galeries Lafayette, a famous department store in Nice, France.**
- In 2024, UPI was launched at the Eiffel Tower in Paris.
- **UPI is now accepted in nine countries -** Singapore, the United Arab Emirates, France, Mauritius, Nepal, Bhutan, Qatar, Sri Lanka and Cambodia - enabling Indian travellers to make seamless payments abroad through familiar platforms.

The India–France ATL Bridge

- **The India–France ATL Bridge was officially established during the Bharat Innovates 2026 summit in Nice, France.**
- **Prime Minister of India Shri Narendra Modi and President of the French Republic Emmanuel Macron jointly inaugurated** the maiden edition of Bharat Innovates 2026 at the Palais des Expositions de Nice, France



- The India–France ATL Bridge is a high-level bilateral education and technology ecosystem corridor.
- It **serves as a cross-border platform that structurally links school-level innovators, educators, and technology frameworks between India and France.**
- **Stakeholders**: Established through a joint partnership between the Atal Innovation Mission (AIM), NITI Aayog (Government of India) and La Fondation Dassault Systèmes (France).
- The **initiative aims to democratize early-stage engineering, scientific temper, and design thinking among school-aged youth**.
- The initiative establishes France's first School Innovation Lab, replicating India's ATL model to promote hands-on learning and innovation.
- **Advanced Technological Focus**:The labs provide practical exposure to emerging technologies such as robotics, AI, 3D printing, microelectronics, and design thinking.
- **Bharat Innovates 2026 is the maiden edition of a high-level national deep-tech acceleration programme designed to act as a global launchpad for cutting-edge technologies emerging out of India.**
- It serves as a continuous, international collaboration framework linking Indian research laboratories, startups, and academic institutions with global corporate networks, investors, and overseas alumni.

Governance:

- The initiative is hosted and run under the Ministry of Education, Government of India.
- **2026 Year is celebrated as India-France Year of Innovation**.
- **Host**: Nice, France
- **Aim**: The primary aim of Bharat Innovates 2026 is to build a high-impact structural bridge between India's domestic innovation ecosystem and global markets.

The 52nd G7 Summit



- Prime Minister of India arrived in Evian, France, to participate in the 52nd G7 Summit at the official invitation of French President Emmanuel Macron.
- It marks India's 13th overall and seventh consecutive appearance as an invitee.
- **The G7 (Group of Seven) Summit is an annual international forum that brings together the leaders of the world's most advanced industrialized economies.**
- It serves as a critical platform for high-level political and economic coordination to shape global responses to pressing transnational challenges.

Host Details:

- **Current Host (2026):** Evian, France is hosting the 52nd iteration from June 15–17, 2026, under the presidency of Emmanuel Macron.

- **Next Year's Host (2027):** The rotating presidency will officially hand over to the United States.

Members of the G7:

- The G7 comprises seven major advanced industrialized economies, along with the European Union as a participating member: Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, United Kingdom, United States.
- The **European Union participates as a fully integrated non-enumerated member.**
- **Invited Guest Countries for 2026 summit:** India, China, South Korea, Kenya and Brazil.

BRICS adopts Indore Declaration: What are 4 priorities and 4 new initiatives?

- **India's BRICS Presidency culminated in the adoption of the BRICS Indore Declaration during the Agriculture Ministers' Meeting held in Indore in June 2026.**



- The BRICS Indore Declaration is a unanimous joint agricultural charter adopted by BRICS member countries during the 2026 Agriculture Ministers' Meeting in Indore, Madhya Pradesh.
- **India assumed the presidency of the BRICS bloc on January 1, 2026, succeeding Brazil.**
- Meanwhile, the **BRICS Urbanisation Forum concluded in Delhi,** that BRICS countries had accepted India's proposal to establish a BRICS Urban Research and Knowledge Network
- The **BRICS Agriculture Ministers and officials-level meetings held in Indore in which the 'BRICS Indore Declaration' was unanimously adopted to provide new direction to food security, farmer welfare, climate-resilient farming, agricultural trade and digital agriculture.**
- This declaration records a shared commitment to advance food security, nutrition, livelihoods, agricultural trade, innovation, investment, climate-resilient farming, and sustainable agricultural development **with the farmer at its centre.**
- **Four priorities**: The declaration has been adopted amid ongoing geopolitical tensions and focuses on **four main priorities: Farmers, food security, climate and technology.**

5. **Four Institutional initiatives**: Separately, four institutional initiatives have also been proposed. It includes:

(i) Centres of Excellence on Agro-Ecology and Regenerative Agriculture:

Establishing a BRICS Network of Centres of Excellence on Agro-Ecology and Regenerative **Agriculture will birth a platform for joint research, experience sharing and capacity building on natural, organic and regenerative agricultural practices, through which member countries will learn from each other's best practices** and promote climate-resilient and sustainable agricultural systems.

(ii) BRICS Network on Digital Agriculture: The second major initiative is the BRICS Network on Digital Agriculture, which will give new direction to **cooperation in the fields of artificial intelligence, geospatial technology, digital public infrastructure and data-based agricultural solutions.** IIT Delhi in India will coordinate this network.

(iii) Global Forum on Farmers' Rights in Seed Systems: The third announcement is related to the setting up of the Global Forum on Farmers' Rights in Seed Systems, which **will protect farmers' seed rights, the diversity of indigenous seeds and traditional knowledge**.

(iv) BRICS AgriN (Agro Input, Genetic Resources and Information Network): The fourth initiative is the BRICS AgriN. This will **strengthen cooperation among member countries in areas of agricultural inputs**, seeds and genetic resources.

BRICS Urban Research and Knowledge Network

1. The BRICS Urbanisation Forum concluded in Delhi. **The Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal said the BRICS countries had accepted India's proposal to set up a BRICS Urban Research and Knowledge Network.**

2. The Network has been designed as a Chairship-led, institutionally connected platform **to provide a practical and sustained mechanism for urban cooperation within BRICS.**

3. It will support systematic knowledge-sharing and mutual learning, while helping bridge the gap between policy and implementation through the exchange of practical solutions, city-level experiences and operational lessons.

UNESCO nominations for Xuanzang's work



- India and China are in advanced stages of discussions over a joint nomination for **'The Great Tang Records on the Western Regions'.**
- The Great Tang Records on the Western Regions is a narrative of Chinese Buddhist monk and scholar Xuanzang's travels through medieval India in the 7th century.
- The accounts of Xuanzang, also known as Hiuen Tsang, who spent 19 years travelling through India, remain a source for the study of early medieval India.
- He travelled across India from **629–645 CE in search of Buddhist manuscripts and "correct" teachings.**
- He spent roughly **five years in Nalanda**, where he studied under the mahavihara's grand abbot, **Silabhadra.**
- Xuanzang wrote that 500 merchants bought the land on which the mahavihara would eventually stand for 10 lakh pieces of gold and presented it to the Buddha, who preached there for three months.
- According to Xuanzang**, the first vihara was built at the site in the 1st century BCE**.
- India also aims at securing a place for **Panchtantra on the UNESCO list**; as also for the philosophy of **Satyagraha along with South Africa**

VivaTech 2026



- **Prime Minister of India, alongside French President Emmanuel Macron, participated in VivaTech 2026 in Paris to highlight India's vision for human-centric AI and expand bilateral digital cooperation.**
- Viva Technology (VivaTech) is Europe's largest startup and technology event and a premier global platform for digital transformation.

Host and Timeline

- **Location**: Hosted annually at the Paris Expo Porte de Versailles in Paris, France.
- **Founders & Organizers**: Co-founded and organized by French media and communications giants Publicis Groupe and Les Echos–Le Parisien.
- **Established in:** 2016

Key Features of VivaTech 2026:

- **Massive Institutional Scale**: The 2026 edition brings together approximately 180,000 attendees, 14,000 startups, 4,000 partners, and 450 global speakers spanning over 30 distinct business sectors.
- **India's Largest Ever Delegation**: India's presence features its largest pavilion footprint to date, showcasing domestic digital ecosystems across Artificial Intelligence, health-tech, clean technologies, advanced computing, and digital public infrastructure.
- **Deep-Tech Corporate Infiltration**: More than 80 Indian deep-tech companies and innovators are presenting real-world, scalable products built for industry, healthcare, green mobility, and climate sustainability.
- **Open Innovation Incubation**: Features the signature VivaTech Startup Challenges, an application framework where winning startups get incubated by elite global enterprise partners.

PM showcases India's heritage at G7 with traditional gifts

- At the 52nd G7 Summit in France, Prime Minister Narendra Modi gifted global leaders a curated selection of GI-tagged and locally sourced Indian agricultural and textile products.

RAMBAN HONEY

- Ramban Honey, sourced from the **Chenab Valley of Jammu and Kashmir**, is known for its distinct flavour and nutritional value derived from **the region's rich Himalayan flora.**

LAKADONG TURMERIC

- Lakadong Turmeric, cultivated in **Meghalaya's Jaintia Hills,** is renowned for its exceptionally **high curcumin content.**

- The Geographical Indication (GI)-tagged product has gained recognition for its quality and health benefits, including antioxidant and anti-inflammatory properties.

NAGAURI ASHWAGANDHA

- Nagauri Ashwagandha, originates from **Rajasthan's Nagaur district** and is regarded as one of the finest varieties of the medicinal herb.
- Widely used in Ayurveda, **Ashwagandha is associated with improving vitality, immunity and overall well-being.**

BANARASI SILK STOLE

- The Banarasi silk stole, woven by artisans in Varanasi(Uttar Pradesh), represented India's celebrated textile tradition.
- Known for its **intricate zari work and detailed motifs.**

THEKUA

- PM Modi also presented Thekua, a traditional delicacy from **Bihar and Jharkhand to Slovakia's Speaker Richard Rai.**
- Thekua is prepared using wheat flour, jaggery or sugar, ghee and fennel seeds. Closely **associated with the Chhath festival**, the sweet snack is known for its rustic flavour, long shelf life and deep cultural.

Bengaluru Hosts BRICS Space Agencies Meeting



- The two day BRICS Heads of Space Agencies (HOSA) 2026 meet began
- India, as Chair of BRICS for 2026, is hosting HOSA and heads and senior representatives of the space agencies of the **11 BRICS member countries — Brazil, China, Egypt, Ethiopia, India, Indonesia, Iran, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, and the United Arab Emirates**
- The theme is **'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability'.**

The Return Regulation

- The European Parliament has passed the **Return Regulation, a new anti-migration law that allows European Union (EU) countries to set up offshore deportation centers or return hubs in non-EU nations.**
- Enacted By: by the European Commission and finalized by EU lawmakers.
- Aim: The objective of the law is **to speed up the return process, increase the efficiency of deportations for individuals with no legal right to stay, and strengthen the credibility of the EU's external borders.**

Key Features of the Law:

- Establishment of Third-Party 'Return Hubs': Permits individual EU member states to form bilateral agreements with non-EU countries to set up offshore deportation centers. These third-party countries must uphold human rights, international law, and the principle of non-refoulement.
- **The hubs are designed for asylum seekers denied entry but whose identities cannot be verified or whose home countries refuse to accept them**.
- **Unaccompanied minors are strictly exempt;** however, families with children who fall into this category can be legally deported.
- **Extended Detention Windows:** The maximum legal detention period for irregular migrants waiting to be returned has been raised **from six months to two years.** Furthermore, individuals deemed a security risk can face unlimited detention.
- **Grants authorities the power to search the residences** or relevant premises of undocumented immigrants to locate individuals evading deportation orders.
- **Introduces strict entry bans,** financial fines, and criminal sanctions against irregular migrants who fail to cooperate with return procedures.

The 10th Thailand-India Defence Dialogue was held in Bangkok



- The 10th Thailand-India Defence Dialogue was held in Bangkok, to review bilateral defense ties and discuss evolving security developments in the Indo-Pacific region.
- **Capital:** Bangkok.

- **Border Nations:** The main section of the country is bordered by Myanmar (Burma) to the west, Laos to the north and east, Cambodia to the southeast, and shares a southern peninsular land border with Malaysia.

What is downblending, the process at the heart of Trump's Iran agreement?

- Under a historic Memorandum of Cooperation aimed at ending the West Asia crisis, the U.S. and Iran have agreed to downblend Iran's highly enriched uranium stockpile under strict International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) supervision.
- **Downblending is a highly regulated nuclear engineering process that acts as the exact opposite of uranium enrichment.**
- **It involves taking highly enriched uranium (HEU)—which possesses a high concentration of the fissile isotope uranium-235 (235U) capable of sustaining a nuclear bomb—and mixing it with natural or depleted uranium to lower its chemical purity to a safe, low-enriched uranium (LEU) state.**
- **Aim**: The primary aim of downblending is to eliminate the immediate threat of nuclear proliferation by systematically reducing the physical amount of 235U available to make a weapon.

The Frankenstein State



- **India strongly criticized Pakistan at the 62nd Session of the UN Human Rights Council (UNHRC), describing it as a "Frankenstein state**" for allegedly nurturing terrorism as an instrument of state policy.
- The term "Frankenstein state" is a geopolitical metaphor derived from Mary Shelley's novel Frankenstein, **where a creator loses control over the monster he created.**

Key Features:

- **State-Sponsored Proxy Actors**: Uses militant or extremist groups as instruments of foreign or security policy.
- **Blowback Effect**: The sponsored groups eventually turn against the sponsoring state, creating internal instability.
- **Dual Narrative**: Simultaneously projects itself as a victim of terrorism while facing accusations of supporting terror networks.
- **Weak Control OverNon-State Actors**: Difficulty in regulating or dismantling groups once they gain autonomy.
- **International Scrutiny**: Faces diplomatic criticism, sanctions, or reputational costs due to alleged links with terrorism.

Turquoise Nexus Initiative



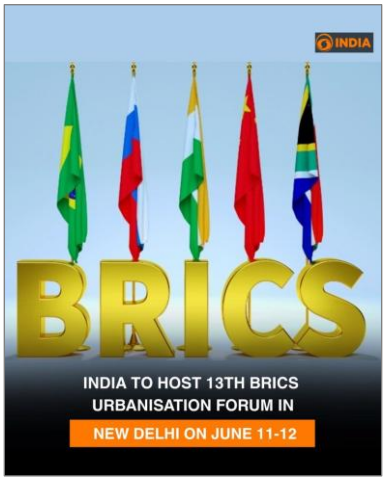
- Turkey's Presidency of 2026 UNFCCC COP31 and Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) have introduced the **Turquoise Nexus Initiative (TNI).**
- It is aimed at **integrating food security, water management and climate adaptation** into national climate plans.
- It is unveiled by Turkey's upcoming COP31 Presidency and Food and Agriculture Organization.
- It is a proposed programme under **FAO's multistakeholder Food and Agriculture for Sustainable Transformation (FAST) Partnership** which was launched by **the COP27 Presidency in 2022 in Sharm el-Sheikh, Egypt.**

Second BRICS Culture Working Group Meeting in Varanasi

- **India will host the second BRICS Culture Working Group meeting in Varanasi on June 4-5, the Ministry of Culture (MoC) announced**, with five thematic panel discussions planned across the grouping's three priority areas for 2026.
- **Themed** "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability."
- The **first working group meeting was held virtually on April 29-30, with all 11 BRICS member countries** — Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, Saudi Arabia, UAE and Indonesia
- **BRICS currently has 11 full member countries and 10 partner countries.**
- Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, Saudi Arabia and UAE joined as full members in January 2024.
- **Indonesia joined in January 2025.**

- Belarus, Bolivia, Kazakhstan, Cuba, Malaysia, Nigeria, Thailand, Uganda, Uzbekistan and Vietnam joined as Partner Countries in 2025.

India to host 13th BRICS Urbanisation Forum in New Delhi on 11–12 June 2026



- India will host the 13th BRICS Urbanisation Forum in New Delhi on June 11-12, **bringing together ministers, policymakers and urban experts from member countries to discuss strategies for building inclusive, resilient and people-centric cities amid rapid urbanisation.**
- The forum is one of the key ministerial engagements under India's BRICS Chairship in 2026
- **The broader chairship theme,** "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of "Humanity First".**
- India has played a prominent role in shaping the BRICS urban agenda since hosting the first Urbanisation Forum in New Delhi in 2013.
- The **country subsequently hosted the forum in Visakhapatnam in 2016 and virtually in 2021.**
- With the 2026 edition, India will host the forum for the fourth time.

The Prime Minister of India embarked on a three-day state visit to Seychelles.



- Location: It is an archipelagic island country located in the western Indian Ocean.
- It is located to the northeast of Madagascar and east of mainland Africa.
- Other major islands near Seychelles include Comoros and Mauritius to the south, and Maldives to the east.
- It consists of an **archipelago of 115 islands (only 8 are permanently inhabited).**
- **Capital City: Victoria**
- Climate: The climate is tropical oceanic, with little temperature variation during the year.
- It is composed of **two main island groups: the Mahé group which are mountainous granitic islands and a second group are coralline islands**.

PM Narendra Modi receives Guard of Honour at State House in Seychelles.

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi received a ceremonial Guard of Honour at the State House in Victoria
- Prime Minister Modi was welcomed by Seychelles President Patrick Herminie at the State House, where the two leaders participated in the ceremonial proceedings marking the commencement of the day's official engagements.
- During the visit, he will participate as the **Guest of Honour at the country's Golden Jubilee National Day** celebrations, **commemorating 50 years of Seychelles' independence.**
- the Prime Minister visited the Seychelles National Botanical Garden, where he and President Herminie participated in a joint **tree plantation** ceremony under the **'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' initiative.**
- Prime Minister Modi handed over the Made-in-India Fast Patrol Vessel (FPV) PS LESPWAR to Seychelles during a ceremony at the Seychelles Coast Guard Base.
- Built by Goa Shipyard Limited.



PM Modi receives Seychelles' highest environmental honour, 'Guardian of the Blue Horizon'

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred the **'Guardian of the Blue Horizon',** Seychelles' highest presidential distinction for leadership in environmental conservation and sustainable development, during his visit to the island nation.

- In May, **the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)** awarded PM Modi the **Agricola Medal for his efforts to strengthen food security,** modernise agriculture and promote sustainable farming practices.
- Earlier, in 2018, he was awarded the **Seoul Peace Prize for his contribution to sustainable economic growth,** international cooperation and inclusive development.

PM Modi Visits Navasakti Vinayagar Temple in Victoria, Seychelles



- On the final day of his visit, Mr Modi visited and offered prayers at the **Navasakti Vinayagar Temple in Victoria.**
- Later, the Prime Minister paid floral tributes at the Mahatma Gandhi statue, situated at Peace Park.

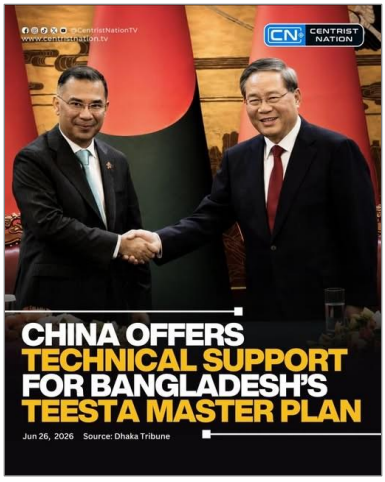
Maharishi Sushruta

- A bronze statue of Maharishi Sushruta, revered as the Father of Surgery, has been recently unveiled at the prestigious Royal College of Surgeons of Edinburgh in the United Kingdom.
- Sushruta, known as the **"father of Indian medicine" and the "father of surgery"** , was a pioneering figure in ancient Indian medicine.
- For Sushruta, the concept of **shalya tantra (surgical science) was all-encompassing.**
- His contributions have influenced the field of surgery, especially **cosmetic surgery and medical practices** within the global community.
- According to medical scholars, Sushruta lived and practiced medicine from 600 BC to 1000 BC.
- Sushruta was believed to be the **disciple of the God of Ayurveda – Lord Dhanvanthri.**
- He taught and practiced medicine in the city of Varanasi .
- He is known for his pioneering operations and techniques and for his influential treatise **Sushruta-samhita**, the main source of knowledge about surgery in ancient India.



- Though composed over 2500 years ago, it contains detailed **instructions on surgery and medicine.**
- The Sushruta Samhita comprises 184 chapters. This extensive work lists more than 300 surgical procedures.
- It describes over 120 surgical instruments and provides details on various types of **wounds, fractures, dislocations, conditions, and their treatments.**
- The Sushruta-samhita also provides details on toxicology, pediatrics, pharmacology, and other branches of the traditional system of Indian medicine known as Ayurveda.
- Furthermore, the text includes descriptions of over **100 medicinal plants, detailing their taste, usage, and effects.**
- Examples of some of his groundbreaking operations include **rhinoplasty** (the repairing or remaking of a nose), **removal of a dead fetus, and lithotomy** (surgical incision into hollow organs such as the urinary bladder to remove stones, or calculi).
- He also developed many unique and practical techniques to dissect the human body and study its structure.

What is the Teesta Project and Why Does it Matter to India?



- Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman has received assurance from China on building the **Teesta River Comprehensive Management and Restoration Project.**
- The Teesta River Comprehensive Management and Restoration Project is a river management initiative in Bangladesh that involves **dredging, embankment construction, land reclamation, and road development.**
- The Teesta River flows through India and Bangladesh and is a tributary system linked to the eastern Himalayan river network.
- The river basin has been a subject of bilateral water discussions between India and Bangladesh for several years.

Teesta River



- Origin: **Tso Lhamo Lake in North Sikkim**. Pahunri Glacier, Khangse Glacier and Chho Lhamo Lake are also considered its sources.
- Course: **Flows through Sikkim and West Bengal in India before entering Bangladesh**, where it joins the Brahmaputra River at Fulchori.
- Major Tributary: **Rangit River is the main tributary of the Teesta in Sikkim.**
- Teesta Water Treaty: In 2011, a draft agreement was proposed where **India would get 42.5% and Bangladesh 37.5% of Teesta's water during the dry season.**

Operation Amistad



- In response to the devastating back-to-back earthquakes that recently hit Venezuela, **India has officially launched 'Operation Amistad' as an emergency humanitarian mission.**
- Operation Amistad is a fast-tracked, high-capacity Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR) mission launched by the Government of India. It represents a major strategic and diplomatic deployment of emergency relief assets dispatched to aid a foreign nation dealing with a catastrophic natural disaster.

The Flamingo Revolution



- Thousands of protesters in Albania have launched the Flamingo Revolution against a US$1.6 billion luxury coastal resort project linked to Jared Kushner, son-in-law of U.S. President Donald Trump.
- The Flamingo Revolution is a mass environmental and civil society protest movement in Albania opposing a luxury tourism project in ecologically sensitive coastal areas.
- Aim: To halt the luxury resort project in ecologically sensitive zones.

Indian Pavilion marks largest-ever participation at North America's Summer Fancy Food Show 2026

- The India Pavilion at Summer Fancy Food 2026, marking India's largest-ever participation at North America's premier specialty food exhibition,
- was jointly inaugurated by Consul General of India in New York Mr. Binaya Srikanta Pradhan and internationally acclaimed chef, author and TIME100 Honoree Chef Vikas Khanna at the Jacob K. Javits Convention Center on June 28, 2026.
- The India Pavilion, jointly showcased by the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) and the India Trade Promotion Organisation (ITPO) under the Department of Commerce, Government of India,

Indonesian FM Sugiono arrives in New Delhi to co-chair 8th Joint Commission Meeting with EAM Jaishankar



- **Recently, India's External Affairs Minister (EAM) and Indonesian counterpart co-chaired the 8th Indonesia–India Joint Commission Meeting in New Delhi.**
- **Location**: It is an archipelagic nation located off the Southeast Asian mainland in the Pacific and Indian Oceans.

- **Bordering countries**: It is bordered by Malaysia, Papua New Guinea, and Timor-Leste.
- **Maritime Border**: It is surrounded by the Indian Ocean in the south; by the Pacific Ocean (South China Sea) in the north.
- **Capital City:** Jakarta.

Shangri-La Dialogue

- **The Defence Secretary recently held a series of high-level bilateral engagements on the sidelines of the Shangri-La Dialogue 2026 in Singapore,** focusing on strengthening defence partnerships, maritime security cooperation, and regional stability in the Indo-Pacific.



- **Also described as the Asia Security Summit, it is Asia's premier defence and security summit that brings together defence ministers, military chiefs, policymakers, and strategic experts across the globe.**
- The Shangri-La Dialogue was established in 2002.
- **It is held every year in Singapore's Shangri-La Hotel.**
- It is **organized by the International Institute for Strategic Studies (IISS) in London, UK, and co-organized by Singapore's Ministry of Defence.**
- The agenda of the Shangri-La Dialogue is closely related to the security situation and development trend in the Asia-Pacific region, covering traditional and non-traditional security and other fields.
- These include traditional security issues such as territorial disputes and military cooperation, as well as non-traditional security issues such as terrorism, cybersecurity, and climate change.
- **Raisina Dialogue, India's flagship conference on geopolitics and geo-economics, is modeled on the lines of the Shangri-La Dialogue**

International Labour Conference

- **Recently, the Union Minister of State for Labour and Employment Shobha Karandlaje led the Indian delegation at the 114th International Labour Conference (ILC) in Geneva, Switzerland.**
- It is the supreme deliberative and decision making body of the International Labour Organization.
- The **Conference meets annually**, bringing together tripartite delegations from the Organization's 187 Member States and a number of observers.
- **Tripartite Delegation**: Each national delegation has a minimal composition of two Government, one Employers' and one Workers' delegates (2–1–1).
- The Government, Employers' and Workers' delegates participate and vote independently.
- **Established in 1919 by the Treaty of Versailles as an affiliated agency of the League of Nations.**
- Became the first affiliated specialized agency of the United Nations in 1946.
- **Headquarters**: Geneva, Switzerland
- **Founding Mission**: social justice is essential to universal and lasting peace.
- Promotes internationally recognized human and labour rights.
- Received the Nobel Peace Prize in 1969.

Portugal, Austria among five nations elected to UN Security Council; Germany suffers setback

- **Austria, Kyrgyzstan, Portugal, Trinidad and Tobago, and Zimbabwe were elected as non-permanent members of the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) for the year 2027-28,**
- the **193-member United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) elected the five new non-permanent members** who will replace Denmark, Greece, Pakistan, Panama, and Somalia when their terms conclude at the end of 2026.
- **The powerful UN Security Council comprises 15 members, including five permanent veto-wielding members**: China, France, Russia, the United Kingdom, and the United States.
- **India last sat at the UNSC horseshoe table as a non-permanent member in 2021-22**, and Delhi has declared its candidature for the 2028-29 term.

About UNSC

- **Genesis**: Established in 1945 through the UN Charter as one of the 6 principal organs of the UN.

- **Purpose**: Maintaining international peace and security.
- **Members**: 5 permanent members (P5) and 10 non-permanent members (refer to the infographic).

AUKUS

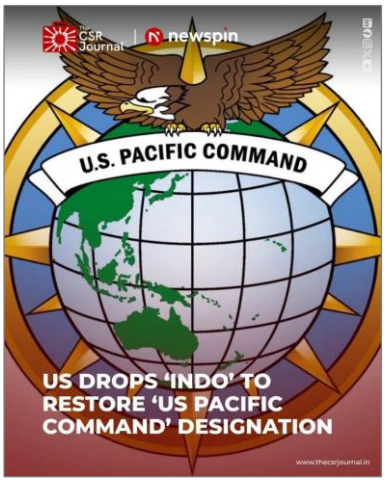


- Recently, the **Aukus alliance members said that they will develop advanced underwater drone systems and further deepen their maritime relationship.**
- It is a **trilateral security partnership between the United Kingdom, the United States of America, and Australia agreed in 2021.**
- It aims to boost defense capabilities, accelerate technological integration, and expand the industrial capacity of all three nations as a part of a collective effort to stabilize the Indo-Pacific region
- AUKUS is intended to strengthen the ability of each government to support security and defense interests, building on longstanding and ongoing bilateral ties.

It consists of two key pillars

- **Pillar 1**: It focuses on supporting Australia to acquire its first conventionally armed, nuclear-powered submarine fleet. **It does not involve the transfer of nuclear weapons to Australia.**
- **Pillar 2:** It focuses on cooperation in eight advanced military capability areas: artificial intelligence (AI), quantum technologies, innovation, information sharing, and cyber, undersea, hypersonic, counter-hypersonic, and electronic warfare domains.

US renames Indo-Pacific Command back to Pacific Command



- The **United States Department of War announced that the US Indo-Pacific Command (USINDOPACOM) will officially restore its name to the US Pacific Command (USPACOM).**
- This comes just over eight years after USPACOM had been renamed by the first Donald Trump administration (2017-21) in May 2018.
- The command would return to its historic designation of US Pacific Command, a name it had carried since 1947
- **USPACOM is one of the six geographic unified combatant commands of the US Armed Forces.**
- The command's area of responsibility "encompasses about half the earth's surface, stretching from the waters off the west coast of the US to the western border of India, and from Antarctica to the North Pole".

Why 'Indo' was added in the first place?

- The name being discarded today was itself a deliberate piece of strategic signalling.
- In **May 2018,** then-Defense Secretary Jim Mattis announced the rechristening from Pacific Command to Indo-Pacific Command, **explicitly citing the deepening connectivity between the Indian and Pacific Oceans.**

The U.S.–Iran Preliminary Peace Accord 2026



- **The United States and Iran officially announced a breakthrough preliminary peace agreement to immediately end their military conflict and completely lift the naval blockade on the strategic Strait of Hormuz and the Gulf of Oman.**
- The U.S.–Iran Preliminary Peace Accord of 2026 is an emergency geopolitical memorandum of understanding (MoU) designed to halt an active hot war and avert a global energy collapse.
- Rather than acting as a final treaty, this **preliminary pact serves as a 60-day de-escalation mechanism.**

Key Highlights of the Preliminary Agreement:

- Mandates the absolute and permanent termination of all direct and proxy military operations across all active war fronts, **explicitly including the theater of operations in Lebanon.**

- **The Toll-Free Re-Opening of the Strait:** The U.S. completely terminates its naval blockade in the Gulf of Oman, while Iran authorizes the open, toll-free passage of international commercial shipping through the Strait of Hormuz, commencing immediate mine-removal operations.
- **60-Day Technical Standstill Window**: Establishes a strict 60-day timeline during which the primary ceasefire holds while diplomats prepare for **final, core negotiations regarding Iran's nuclear enrichment and long-term Western trade sanctions.**
- **Unfreezing ofIranian Sovereign Capital**: The preliminary text lays out the phased unfreezing and release of $24 billion in frozen Iranian assets during the 60-day negotiation timeline.
- **Bilateral Commitment to Financial Reparations**: Washington formally commits to developing a financial mechanism to pay **war reparations to Tehran for damage suffered during the 2025–2026 campaigns.**
- **Permitted Navigation Service Charges**: While explicit transit tolls are banned, **Iran retains the legal right to collect standard maritime fees for navigation services**, environmental protection, coastal upkeep, and vessel insurance within the Strait.

Pentagon Launches Project Patriot Pipeline

- **Project Patriot Pipeline is a workforce development initiative of the United States Department of War, announced by Secretary of War Pete Hegseth.**
- The programme consolidates multiple training and personnel development efforts for service members, military spouses, and federal civilians.
- Project Patriot Pipeline is **designed to support defence manufacturing and related industrial requirements in the United States.**
- The initiative covers civilian workforce needs in aviation, healthcare, cybersecurity, engineering, manufacturing, and aviation maintenance.

Important Facts for Exams

- The **Department of War is the current name used in the United States for the Pentagon in this context.**
- **SkillBridge** is a United States military transition programme for service members leaving active duty.
- The **Senate Armed Services Committee is a standing committee of the United States Senate**.
- Shipbuilding and missile defence are listed among the priority areas linked to the initiative.

U.S. considers buying Chagos Islands: reports



- The White House is considering a plan to buy the Chagos Islands from Mauritius, U**.S. officials have drawn up a proposal to bypass the U.K. and make their own deal to take control of Diego Garcia.**
- **Chagos Islands Location**: It is an island group located in the central Indian Ocean.
- It is about 1,000 miles (1,600 km) south of the southern tip of the Indian subcontinent.
- It is an **overseas territory of the United Kingdom** that was established on November 8, 1965.
- The **largest island, Diego Garcia**, hosts a key US-UK military base.
- **The principal islands in the archipelago include the Diego** Garcia atoll, Danger Island, Egmont Islands, Eagle Islands, Nelsons Island, Peros Banhos atoll, Three Brothers Islands, and the Solomon Islands.
- **Diego Garcia is the largest and the most southerly island of the Chagos Archipelago.**



Previous Control:

- The islands were under British rule since 1814, ceded by France.
- In **1965, the UK separated Chagos from Mauritius**, forming the British Indian Ocean Territory (BIOT) before Mauritius gained independence in 1968.
- Diego Garcia has served as a critical logistics and intelligence

base for US military operations in West Asia, South Asia, and East Africa.

About UK–Mauritius Chagos Sovereignty Deal (2025):

- After a **UK High Court ruling, England Prime Minister signed a treaty handing sovereignty of the Chagos Islands to Mauritius.**
- The deal includes a **99-year lease of Diego Garcia to the UK and US for continued military use.**

India and Myanmar discuss trade, security, connectivity and border management



- **Myanmar President U Min Aung Hlaing has assured Prime Minister Narendra Modi that Myanmar's territory will not be allowed to be used against India's security interests.**
- The two leaders held wide-ranging talks to boost bilateral ties in trade, defence, energy, and connectivity in New Delhi.
- Mr Aung Hlaing is on a five-day visit to India.

About Myanmar



- It is the northernmost country of Southeast Asia.
- **Bordering Countries**: It is bordered by India in the west, Bangladesh in the northwest; China in the north and northeast; by Laos in the east and by Thailand in the southeast.
- **Maritime Borders**: It is bounded by the Andaman Sea in the south and by the Bay of Bengal in the southwest.
- **Capital City**: Naypyidaw
- It has **a Tropical monsoon.**
- Mountain ranges: It consists of Bago Yoma, Rakhine Yoma, and Shan Hills.
- **Highest Point**: Hkakabo Razi.
- **Rivers**: It is drained by Mekong, Irrawaddy, Salween and Chindwin.

Mongolia



- In a significant milestone in India-Mongolia cultural and spiritual relations, the **Holy Relics of Arhat Sariputra and Arhat Mahamoggallana were ceremonially enshrined at the Gandantegchenling Monastery in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia**
- It is a landlocked country in north-central Asia.
- **Bordering Countries:** Mongolia is bordered by two nations: China in the south and Russia in the north.
- **Capital City:** Ulaanbaatar
- Mongolia has a pronounced continental climate because of its high latitude and elevation and distance from oceans.
- It has **four main vegetation zones that run from north to south and from mountains to basins: forest-steppe, steppe, semidesert, and desert.**
- **Mountains**: Khentii Mountains, Khangai Mountains, and the Altay Mountains.
- **Highest Point**: The highest point of Mongolia is Nayramadlin Orgil at 14,350 ft. (4,374 m)
- **River**: Orkhon River (Orkhon River valley was inscribed by UNESCO in the World Heritage List).
- **Lake**: Hovsgol Nuur, one of Asia's largest freshwater lakes, is located on its border with the Russian Federation.

Iran launches 'Operation Nasr', targets 2 Israeli airbases

- Iran confirmed that it struck **two military bases in Israel and described the attack as a part of 'Operation Nasr' or 'Victory'**.
- The Iranian Revolutionary Guard or the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) said it launched the missile fire, retaliating against Israel's strikes in three areas of Iran.

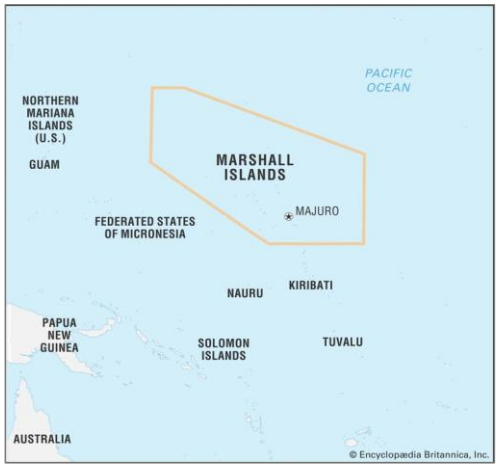
- **The launch of the operation comes on the 100th day of the war, which broke out on February 28** when Israel and the United States jointly attacked Iran and killed Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei and other senior Iranian leaders.

Ukraine struck five ships carrying illegal cargo in the Sea of Azov



- **Sea of Azov**: It is bordered by Ukraine in the northwest and by Russia in the southeast.
- It is connected to the Black Sea in the south via the Strait of Kerch.
- The **Kerch Strait is located between the Crimean Peninsula in the west and the Taman Peninsula in the east.**
- It is linked with the Atlantic Ocean via the Black Sea, the Sea of Marmara, the Aegean Sea, and the Mediterranean Sea.
- **Rivers**: The Don and Kuban rivers contribute over 90% of freshwater inflow, reducing salinity and bringing nutrients.
- **Chief Ports**: Taganrog in Russia, and Mariupol and Berdyans'k in Ukraine.
- **Coastal Features**: The coastline is low and flat with extensive vegetation, lagoons like Syvash and long sand spits including Arabat, Fedotov and Berdyansk.
- **Climate Conditions:** It has a continental climate with cold winters (-1 to -5°C, sometimes -30°C) and warm summers (23-25°C), with frequent storms and seasonal ice formation.

Marshall Islands



- **The World Bank recently approved an additional US$9 million in financing to help the Republic of the Marshall Islands** manage sharply higher energy costs that are affecting households, businesses, public services and the national budget.
- The **Republic of the Marshall Islands (RMI) is a country located in the central Pacific Ocean.**
- It lies northeast of Papua New Guinea and southeast of the Federated States of Micronesia.
- **These atolls and islands form two parallel chains referred to as the Ratak (Sunrise) chain and Ralik (Sunset) chain** that are both oriented in a northwest-southeast direction.
- **Capital**: Majuro **Official languages**: English and Marshallese

Beaufort Castle



- **Amid the West Asia conflict, Israel has pushed itself deeper into Lebanon recently, capturing the historic Beaufort Castle and the surrounding strategic ridge.**
- Beaufort Castle — known locally as Qalaat al-Shaqif or the "**Castle of the High Rock**", is a medieval fortress situated atop a commanding hill **near the city of Nabatieh in southern Lebanon.**
- It is located just 14.5 km from the Israeli border.
- **Originally built by Crusaders in the 12th century**, the castle has changed hands multiple times throughout history, passing through Crusader, Muslim, Mamluk, and Ottoman control.
- It **overlooks vast stretches of southern Lebanon, the Litani River valley, and parts of northern Israel, making it a position of considerable strategic value.**
- In 1982, amid the Lebanon War, Israel captured Beaufort Castle from the Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO) and **held it until it withdrew from Lebanon in 2000**

Mtkvari River



- Authorities in **Georgia** recently found a body in the Mtkvari River, **believed to be missing Indian medical student, pending DNA confirmation.**
- The Mtkvari River, also known as the **Kura River,** is a significant watercourse in the **South Caucasus mountains.**
- It is the longest river in the Caucasus region.
- It flows through the countries of Turkey, Georgia, and Azerbaijan.
- The river has a total length of 1515 kilometers, **with the longest portion in Azerbaijan** (906 kilometers), followed by 270 kilometers in Georgia, and 174 kilometers in Turkey.
- The Araxes (Aras) River is the largest tributary of the Mtkvari.
- **Tbilisi, the capital of Georgia, is the largest city located along the river.**
- The **Mtkvari River has been a cradle of civilization for millennia**.
- Ancient settlements along its banks date back to the Bronze Age.
- Historically, the river served as a vital trade route, connecting the Caucasus with the larger Eurasian trade networks

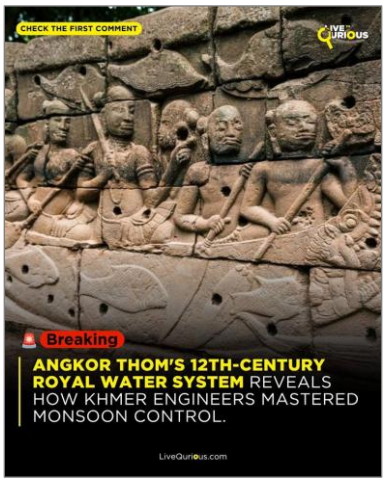
Scientists Discover Jian changmaensis in China

- **A new feathered gliding dinosaur named Jian changmaensis was announced in a study published in Annals of Carnegie Museum.**
- The **120-million-year-old fossil** was found in the Changma Basin in Gansu province, northwestern China.
- Jian changmaensis belongs to Microraptoria. **Microraptors are known from the Early Cretaceous period and are closely related to Velociraptor.**

14,000-Year-Old Footprints Found in Italy Cave

- **Footprints and handprints dated to around 14,000 to 14,400 years ago were identified in Grotta della Bàsura in Toirano, northern Italy.**
- The traces belong to a group of five early humans, including two adults, one adolescent of about 11 years, and two children aged about three and six years.
- **Grotta della Bàsura is a cave in Liguria, a region in north-western Italy.**
- The footprints were left on a clay-rich cave floor during a single exploration event by Epigravettian hunter-gatherers of the Late Upper Palaeolithic.
- **Epigravettian culture belongs to the Late Upper Palaeolithic in Europe.**

Angkor Thom



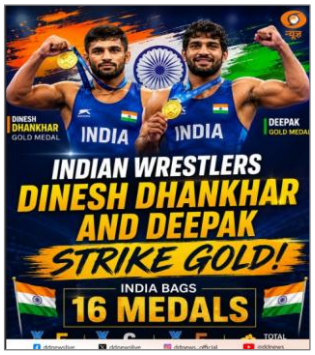
- **Archaeologists recently uncovered significant remains of a 12th-century hydraulic system and architectural features within the ancient royal palace complex of Angkor Thom.**
- **Angkor Thom, located in present-day Cambodia**, was the last and **longest-lasting capital of the ancient Khmer Empire.**
- **Angkor Thom translates into English as the "Great City".**
- It was established after Jayavarman VII reclaimed the Khmer capital from the Cham invaders in 1181.
- **Unlike earlier Hindu temples, Angkor Thom was designed as a Buddhist city, reflecting the king's devotion to Mahayana Buddhism.**

Short News

- The 2nd edition of "Mango Magic Festival: Promotion and Tasting Event of Indian Mangoes" **was hosted in Seattle, United States**

Sports

National/ international Championships



India Finishes Ulaanbaatar Open 2026 with 16 Medals

- Indian wrestlers finished the Ulaanbaatar Open 2026 wrestling tournament strongly with Dinesh Dhankhar (125kg) and Deepak (61kg) winning gold medals in their respective men's freestyle categories , get top 3 finish
- India's overall tally at the Ulaanbaatar Open - **16 Medals included eight golds** - three each in men's and women's freestyle and two in Greco-Roman wrestling.

India secure 19 medals, finish runner-up at Asian U-20 Athletics Championships in Hong Kong



- **India delivered a historic campaign at the Asian U20 Athletics Championships 2026 in Hong Kong China, finishing second in the standings with 19 medals - 10 gold, five silver and four bronze.**
- The runner-up finish marked India's best-ever performance at the continental track and field championships outside home soil.
- **China topped the medal standings** with 25 medals, including 14 gold, while India finished ahead of Japan, which placed third with 18 medals.
- **India had previously finished second only twice before - in 1992 and 1996 - when the championships were hosted in New Delhi.**
- **A total of 48 Indian athletes (30 men and 18 women) competed in Hong Kong China from May 28 to 31.**
- Nipam becoming the first Indian medallist of the meet after winning bronze in the women's 100m.
- Nitin Gupta secured India's first gold by clinching the men's 5000m race walk title,

Asian U20 Athletics Championships 2026: India's medal winners

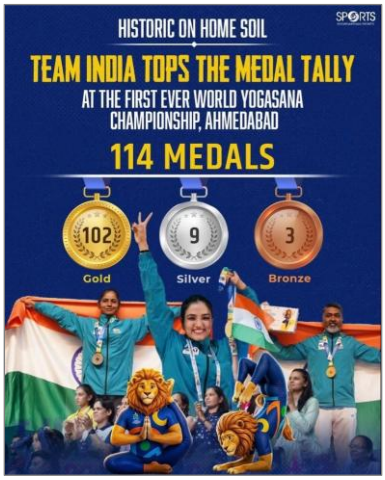
Medal winners for India			
Medal	Athlete (medal)	Event	Mark
Gold	Nitin Gupta	Men's 5000m race walk	19:47.49s
Gold	Amanat Kamboj	Women's discus throw	52.24m
Gold	Rahul Jakhar	Decathlon	7185 points
Gold	Pooja Singh	Women's high jump	1.93m
Gold	Nikhil Chandrashekar	Men's 3000m steeplechase	9:25.44s
Gold	Shahnavaz Khan	Men's long jump	7.84m
Gold	Basant	Men's high jump	2.20m
Gold	Muskan	Women's 5000m	16:53.08s
Gold	Mogali Venkatram	Men's 800m	1:48.27
Gold	Team India	Women's 4x400m relay	3.38.07s
Silver	Sadhana Ravi	Women's triple jump	12.84m
Silver	Upkar	Decathlon	6854 points
Silver	Jithin Arjunan	Men's long jump	7.66m
Silver	Nischay	Men's discus throw	60.10m
Silver	Team India	Women's 4x100m relay	45.05s
Bronze	Nipam	Women's 100m	11.62s
Bronze	Neeru Pathak	Women's 400m	53.23s
Bronze	Aarti	Women's 200m	24.12s
Bronze	Team India	Men's 4x400m relay	3.05.54s

Asian U20 Athletics Championships 2026 medals tally

Rank	Country	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
1	China	14	9	2	25
2	India	10	5	4	19

Rank	Country	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
3	Japan	5	5	8	18
4	United Arab Emirates	5	0	1	6
5	Qatar	3	4	3	10
6	Chinese Taipei	2	6	4	12

India Wins 114 Medals at World Yogasana Championships



- **Hosts India completed a clean sweep at the inaugural World Yogasana Championship 2026, finishing with 114 medals, including 102 gold, at the EKA Arena in Ahmedabad , Gujarat.**
- **Japan finished a distant second** in the medal standings with three gold, three silver and five bronze medals.
- Argentina claimed third place
- A total of 31 nations won at least one medal, while 10 countries secured at least one gold.

India fielded a 122-member contingent across six age categories –

- sub-Junior (10-14 years),
- junior (14-18 years),
- senior (18-28 years),
- senior A (28-35 years),
- senior B (35-45 years) and
- senior C (45-55 years).
- **The championships were held from June 4 to 8** and featured competitions in traditional yogasana, artistic single, artistic pair, artistic group and rhythmic pair disciplines

Rank	Country	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Medals
1	India	102	9	3	114
2	Japan	3	3	5	11
3	Argentina	2	3	0	5
4	Singapore	2	2	3	7
5	Nepal	1	36	15	52
6	Uzbekistan	1	13	11	25
7	Zambia	1	5	8	14
8	Indonesia	1	2	4	7
9	Russia	1	1	2	4
10	USA	1	0	4	5

Savitha Shri Baskar wins 2026 Women's Asian Individual Chess Championship



- **Nineteen-year-old Savitha Shri Baskar has won the 2026 Women's Asian Individual Chess Championship in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia**.
- With the win, she also secured qualification for the 2027 FIDE Women's World Cup.
- **Silver** - Afruza Khamdamovauz Uzbekistan
- **Song Yuxin from China took bronze**
- The triumph is the biggest achievement of Savitha's career and gives India its 13th Women's Asian Championship title.

India Wins Women's 4x100m Relay Gold



- The **Indian women's 4x100m** team won the gold medal on the final day of the **Asian Relays Championships 2026 in Shangyu, the People's Republic of China,**
- India's overall tally **to three - one gold, one silver and a bronze.**
- Olympian **Srabani Nanda, Sneha Shanuvalli, Sudeshna Shivankar and Tamanna** clocked a season's best time of 43.85 seconds to secure the **top spot in the women's 4x100m relay final.**
- **Indian mixed 4x400m** relay team added **silver to the medal tally** with Theerthesh Shetty, Poovamma MR, Bharath Sridhar and Neeru Pathak clocking 3:17.06 seconds.

- Earlier, the Indian **mixed 4x100m** team bagged bronze
- **India will host the Asian Relays Championships 2027** - the third edition of the athletics meet - in **Chandigarh next year.**

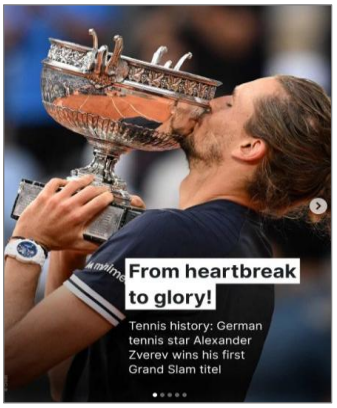
India finish atop standings with 25 medals at ISSF Junior World Championships



- In shooting, India finished the ISSF Junior World Championships 2026 in **Suhl, Germany, with 25 medals** .
- **India's overall tally to 25**, comprising **seven gold, eight silver and ten bronze medals,**
- India had also finished at the top of the medal standings in the **previous edition in Lima, Peru, with 24 medals.**

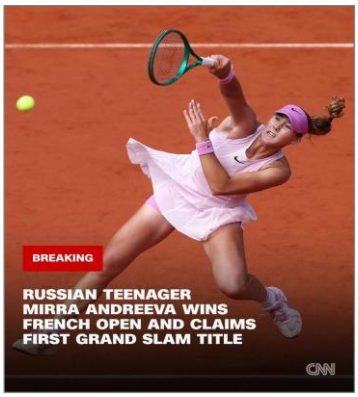
Tennis

French Open 2026 Winners List: Zverev, Andreeva Shine in Historic Paris Triumph



- **In tennis, Germany's Alexander Zverev clinched his maiden Grand Slam title, defeating Italy's Flavio Cobolli** in a thrilling five-set final to win the French Open crown at Roland Garros.
- The 29-year-old became the first German man to win the French Open since Henner Henkel in 1937.
- He has also become the first German man to capture a Grand Slam title since Boris Becker's Australian Open triumph in 1996.

Mirra Andreeva wins first Grand Slam title at French Open



- **Mirra Andreeva's (Russian) defeated Poland's Maja Chwalińska** to capture the **Suzanne-Lenglen Cup and the first tennis Grand Slam title of her career**.
- At **19 years old, Andreeva becomes the youngest Roland-Garros women's singles champion** since Iga Świątek lifted the title as a teenager in 2020.
- **She is also the youngest women's champion in Paris since Monica Seles won her third consecutive French Open crown in 1992 at the age of 18.**
- Andreeva also became the first player born after 2005 to play in a Grand Slam singles final, men's or women's.

Grand Slam tournaments, **also called majors**, are the four most important annual tennis events.

The **Grand Slam itinerary consists of** :

1. The Australian Open in mid-January,
2. The French Open in May - June,
3. Wimbledon in June–July
4. The US Open in August–September.

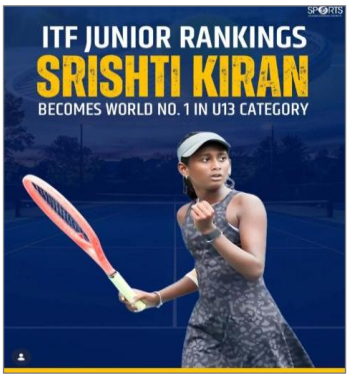
- The **Australian and United States** tournaments are played on **hard courts**, the **French on clay**, and **Wimbledon on grass.**
- **Wimbledon is the oldest,** founded **in 1877**, followed by the **US in 1881**, the **French in 1891**, and the **Australian in 1905**.

Category	Winner Name	Runners-Up
Men's Singles	Alexander Zverev (Germany)	Flavio Cobolli (Italy)
Women's Singles	Mirra Andreeva (Russia)	Maja Chwalińska (Poland)
Men's Doubles	Marcel Granollers/Horacio Zeballos	Henry Patten/Harri Heliovaara
Women's Doubles	Katerina Siniakova/Taylor Townsend	Anna Danilina/Aleksandra Krunic
Mixed Doubles	Sara Errani/Andrea Vavassori	Gabriela Dabrowski/Evan King

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Srishti Kiran tops global Under-13 tennis rankings after five ITF titles



- **Bengaluru's Srishti Kiran has become the world's No 1 in the Under-13 tennis player after winning five straight ITF junior titles and finishing runner-up at the ITF World Tennis Tour Juniors J100 Guatemala.**
- The 13-year-old climbed to a career-high ITF junior ranking of No. 357, the highest among Under-13 players globally.
- **She achieved the feat despite competing in only eight ranking events, two fewer than the maximum 10 tournaments used for rankings**, making her ascent to the top of the Under-13 rankings even more noteworthy.

Hockey

India beat New Zealand to win FIH women's Nations Cup, title secure Pro League return



- In Hockey, **India defeated hosts New Zealand 2-0 in the final in Auckland** to win the Cup title and secured promotion to the FIH Women's Pro League.
- **Lalremsiami won the 'Player of the Match' award**
- **Deepika finished as the joint-top scorer** in the tournament with six goals to her name – sharing the honours with USA's Ashley Sessa.
- This is India's second Nations Cup title, having won the inaugural edition of the tournament in 2022.

Indian Men's team lifts the Under-18 Asia Cup for the third time, thrashing hosts Japan in the finals



- **The Indian U-18 Men's Hockey Team was crowned champion of the Men's U-18 Asia Cup 2026 after defeating host Japan in the final in Kakamigahara, Japan.**
- Meanwhile, Indian Women's team clinched bronze after beating South Korea 3-0.
- **Ashish Tani Purti earned the Player of the Match award**
- Ayush Rajak being named the Best Goalkeeper of the tournament.
- In the women's competition, India's Nausheen Naz emerged as the Top Scorer with 12 goals.

Cricket

Royal Challengers Bengaluru win IPL 2026 title



- **Royal Challengers Bengaluru became only the third team in history to successfully defend the Indian Premier League title as they beat Gujarat Titans by five wickets in the IPL 2026 final at th Ahmedabad.**
- Royal Challengers Bengaluru clinched its **second consecutive IPL title**
- **Only two teams** - MS Dhoni's Chennai Super Kings (2010 and 2011) and Rohit Sharma's Mumbai Indians (2019 and 2020) - had successfully defended the IPL title before this.

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, who won five awards -- Emerging Player, Most Valuable Player, Orange Cap, and the awards for the best strike rate and most sixes.

- **IPL 2026 Prize Winners**
- **Orange Cap**: Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (RR) - 776 runs
- **Purple Cap**: Kagiso Rabada (GT) - 29 wickets
- **Most Valuable Player**: Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (RR)
- **Emerging Player**: Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (RR)
- **Most sixes**: Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (RR) - 71 sixes
- **Most fours**: Sai Sudharsan (GT) - 75 fours

- **Best strike rate**: Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (RR) - 237.31
- **Most dot balls**: Mohammed Siraj (GT) - 172 dot balls
- **Best catch**: Manish Pandey (KKR)
- **Fair Play Award**: Punjab Kings
- **Pitch and Grounds Award (Four matches or less):** Himachal Pradesh Cricket Association
- **Pitch and Grounds Award**: Cricket Association of Bengal

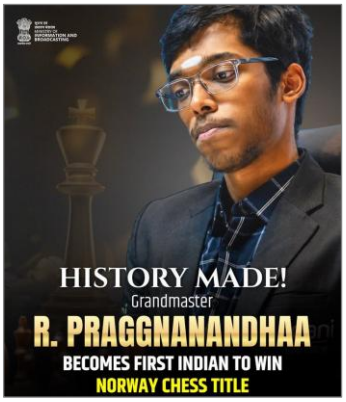
KS Bharat announces retirement from international cricket

- Wicketkeeper-batter KS Bharat announced his retirement from international cricket
- **His last appearance for India came against England in Visakhapatnam in February 2024**,
- He has enjoyed a prolific domestic career, featuring in **116 first-class matches** and scoring 6,102 runs, including **a triple century**, with a career-best score of 308
- **The 32-year-old retires** with a total of 221 runs for India and 19 dismissals as keeper, **with his highest score of 44 coming against Australia in Ahmedabad in 2023.**

Kane Williamson Retires from International Cricket After 16-Year Career

- **New Zealand icon and former skipper Kane Williamson has announced his retirement from international cricket,**
- Williamson was part of the New Zealand team that reached successive ICC Men's Cricket World Cup Finals, including in 2019 when he captained the team.
- He also led the Black Caps to the maiden ICC World Test Championship glory in 2021.

Chess



Praggnanandhaa Becomes First Indian to Win Norway Chess 2026 Title

- In chess, Grandmaster R. Praggnanandhaa has created history by **becoming the first Indian to win the Norway Chess title in Oslo, with a final-round victory over Germany's Vincent Keymer.**
- **Norway Chess is an elite classical chess tournament held in Oslo, Norway**. The 2026 edition ran from 25 May to 5 June and included Magnus Carlsen, D Gukesh, Alireza Firouzja, Wesley So, and Vincent Keymer.
- Classical chess is a standard time-control format used in top-level tournaments and world championship events.



Goa's Ethan Vaz becomes India's 96th Grandmaster

- Goa's 14-year-old International Master Ethan Vaz has become India's 96th Chess Grandmaster after securing his third and final Grandmaster norm at the Sarajevo GM Mix tournament in Bosnia and Herzegovina.
- With the achievement, Ethan becomes **the third Grandmaster from Goa after Anurag Mhamal and Leon Mendonca.**
- Born on September 3, 2011, he currently has a live FIDE rating of 2522.

Pranav V becomes first Indian to qualify for 2027 FIDE Freestyle World Championship

- Pranav V became the first Indian to qualify for the 2027 FIDE Freestyle Chess World Championship.
- The former World Junior Champion Pranav joins Magnus Carlsen, Fabiano Caruana, Nodirbek Abdusattorov, and Vincent Keymer in the Open category, as five names are confirmed for the eight-player championship.

Football

The FIFA World Cup 2026

- **The 23rd edition of the FIFA World Cup—the 2026 tournament—officially kicked off on June 11, 2026, marking the start of a historic 39-day international men's soccer championship.**

- The FIFA World Cup is a quadrennial international men's football championship contested by the senior national teams of the member associations of FIFA.



Host Nations:

- **The 2026 tournament is jointly hosted by three nations across sixteen multi-national host cities:**
- **United States**: 11 host cities (previously hosted in 1994).
- **Mexico**: 3 host cities (making Mexico the first country to host or co-host a World Cup three times, following 1970 and 1986).
- **Canada**: 2 host cities (marking Canada's debut as a World Cup host nation).

Key Facts on the 2026 Edition:

- The tournament field has expanded from 32 teams to 48 teams for the first time.
- The **total number of tournament matches has jumped from 64 to 104 matches.** Teams reaching the final four will now play eight matches instead of seven.
- **Debut Formations**: Four countries are making their historic World Cup debuts in this edition: Cape Verde, Curaçao, Jordan, and Uzbekistan.
- **Maximum Winners So Far**: Brazil (5),Germany (4), Italy (4), and Argentina (3).
- **Hosts automatically qualify for world cup**: Canada, Mexico, and the United States.

India thrash Bangladesh to clinch a record-extending sixth SAFF Women's Championship 2026 title at Margao, Goa



- The Indian football team beat Bangladesh 3-1 in the SAFF Women's Championship 2026 **final at the Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium in Margao, Goa, on Saturday and clinched their sixth title in the South Asian tournament.**
- **The victory marked a record-extending sixth SAFF Women's Championship crown for India but the first since 2019.**
- Bangladesh had claimed the last two editions played in 2022 and 2024.
- **Aveka finished top-scorer with four goals,**
- Sanfida was named Most Valuable Player,
- while Panthoi collected the Best Goalkeeper award.
- Nepal won the Fair Play award.

Premier League record-breaker Milner retires

- Former England midfielder James Milner has announced his retirement from football at the age of 40 after 24 seasons in the Premier League.

Ronaldo becomes first player to score in six World Cups



- Cristiano Ronaldo became the first player to score in six different World Cup tournaments
- **Ronaldo and Argentina captain Lionel Messi became the only men in history to play in six World Cup tournaments this year.**
- Ronaldo's scoring streak started in his debut in 2006 and he also netted goals in 2010, 2014, 2018 and 2022.
- While he shares the record for most tournaments with Messi, he stands alone in scoring a goal in each edition after **Messi failed to score a goal at the 2010 World Cup in South Africa.**

FIFA World Cup 2026: Lionel Messi becomes first to score in 7 straight World Cup games



- Lionel Messi made football history by becoming the **first player ever to score in seven consecutive FIFA World Cup matches,** while simultaneously extending his all-time tournament record to 19 goals.

Badminton



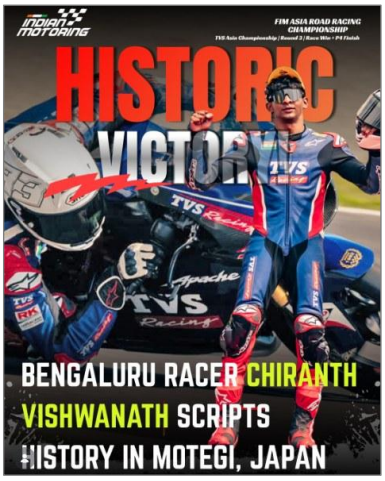
Kidambi Srikanth wins silver at US Open badminton tournament

- In Badminton, Indian shuttler Kidambi Srikanth secured the silver medal in the men's singles event at the US Open 2026.
- his last international title came at the French Open in 2017

Satwik Chirag end title drought with maiden Singapore Open crown

- **Former world No. 1 pair Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty clinch their maiden Singapore Open title**, defeating Indonesia's Fajar Alfian and Muhammad Shohibul Fikri **in the men's doubles final of the Badminton World Federation (BWF) Super 750 tournament, in Singapore**

Race



Mercedes driver Kimi Antonelli Wins Monaco Grand Prix 2026.

Lewis Hamilton secured his historic first victory for Scuderia Ferrari at the 2026 Barcelona-Catalunya Grand Prix .

George Russell won Austrian Grand Prix 2026.

Chiranth becomes first Indian to win a race in Motegi

- Chiranth Vishwanath from Bengaluru became the first Indian to win a **race at the iconic Mobility Resort Motegi racetrack in Japan**
- He finished the third round of the FIM Asia Road Racing Championship

Javelin

Sri Lanka's Rumesh Tharanga becomes fourth Asian to break 90m mark in Javelin; sets new national record



- **Sri Lanka's Rumesh Tharanga Pathirage produced a stunning performance at the Rome Diamond League**, becoming the fourth Asian athlete to breach the 90 metre mark as he won the men's javelin event with a world-leading throw of 92.62 metres.
- The 23-year-old's effort placed him second on the Asian all-time list, behind Pakistan's Olympic champion Arshad Nadeem, whose 92.97m throw at the Paris Olympics remains the continental record.
- India's Olympic gold medallist Neeraj Chopra is also among the elite Asian throwers to have crossed the 90m barrier, alongside Chinese Taipei's Cheng Chao-Tsun.

Javelin Throw: India's Neeraj Chopra finishes fourth at 2026 Doha Diamond League



- Star Indian javelin thrower Neeraj Chopra finished fourth at the Doha Diamond League in his first competition of the season, recorded a **best throw of 85.69 metres in his third attempt.**
- **Sri Lanka's Rumesh Tharanga Pathirage won the event with a throw of 88.68 metres**. Two-time world champion Andersen Peters of Grenada finished second with 86.38 metres,
- **American Curtis Thompson** took third place with 85.99 metres.
- Chopra has been named in India's 32-member squad for the Commonwealth Games, which will be held in Glasgow from July 23 to August 2.

Volleyball



India Wins Bronze at AVC Men's Volleyball Cup 2026

- India claimed a bronze medal at the AVC Men's Volleyball Cup 2026, beating defending champion Bahrain at the Veer Savarkar Sports Complex in Ahmedabad
- The AVC Men's Volleyball Cup is a men's volleyball competition organised under the Asian Volleyball Confederation.

Miscellaneous

Chennai's A Krishnan becomes first Indian to win Causeway Challenge 2026 title

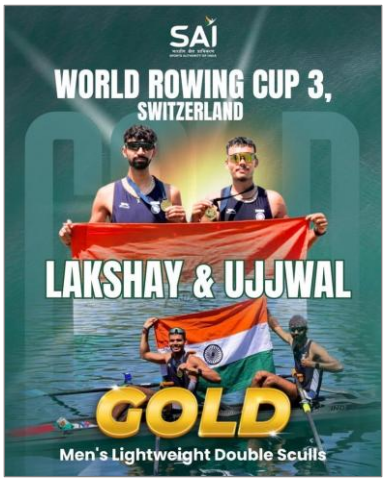
- **A Krishnan wins the first-place title in Division 1 at the Causeway Challenge 2026, held in Bangkok, Thailand, between May 29 to June 1.**
- He is also the only Indian to have won a Causeway Challenge title in any division.
- **The multi-talented Scrabble player and theatre teacher secured the division championship** and a USD 5,000 prize after outlasting a competitive international field in the event.
- **Krishnan is a master-level player recognised by the World English-language Scrabble Players' Association (WESPA),** with a current rating of 1,887.
- **The tournament field was divided into five divisions**—Premier, Division 1, Division 2, Division 3 and Division 4—based on players' skill levels and WESPA ratings.

India Finish with 12 Medals, Including Eight Golds, at Grand Prix Usti nad Labem



- India's Commonwealth Games-bound boxers finished with a haul of 12 medals, **including eight golds,** at the invitational 56th Grand Prix Usti nad Labem in Czechia.
- The five-member women's team led the charge by winning **four gold medals and one silver.**
- Olympic medallist **Lovlina Borgohain** in 75 kilogram, reigning Asian champion **Preeti Pawar** in 54 kilogram, **Sakshi Chaudhary** in 51 kilogram and **Priya Ghanghas** in 60 kilogram **all struck gold.**
- **India's men matched the women's four-gold haul**. Jadumani Singh Mandengbam (55kg), Sachin Siwach (60kg), Ankush (80kg) and Narender Berwal (+90kg) all emerged victorious in their finals.

Lakshay and Ujjwal Kumar Singh script history by winning India's first-ever Gold Medal at World Rowing Cup.



- Lakshay and Ujjwal Kumar Singh scripted history by winning the country's first-ever gold medal at the **World Rowing Cup III in Switzerland.**
- The Indian duo clinched the Men's Lightweight Double Sculls title with a time of 6:26.09, finishing ahead of Hong Kong and the Netherlands

Global Skills Challenge 2026 India Wins Five Medals

- India won five medals at the Global Skills Challenge Australia 2026, which was held from 23 June to 29 June 2026.
- The medal tally included three gold, one silver, and one bronze, and
- the event served as a preparatory competition for the 48th WorldSkills Competition in Shanghai later in 2026.
- The Global Skills Challenge is an international skills competition linked to the WorldSkills movement.

Banking / Finance

Zero Coupon Zero Principal Instrument



- Recently, the **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) has allowed companies to deploy a portion of their Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) spending through Zero Coupon Zero Principal (ZCZP) instruments.**
- It is a financial instrument issued by a not-for-profit organization which carries neither interest payments nor repayment of principal.
- These financial instruments allow non-profit organizations (NPOs) to raise funds that are listed on the social stock exchange.
- This instrument effectively makes it a philanthropic funding mechanism routed through a market framework.
- **ZCZP instruments from NPOs are designated for specific projects or activities and must be completed within the timeframe outlined in the fundraising documents.**
- This instrument shall be issued in dematerialized form only.
- It shall not be transferable from the original subscriber/ holder till the expiry of the tenure of the said instrument.

What is Corporate Social Responsibility?

- It is a business model by which companies make a concerted effort to operate in ways that enhance rather than degrade society and the environment.
- It helps both improve various aspects of society as well as promote a positive brand image of companies.
- **CSR is mandatory for eligible companies under Section 135 of the Companies Act, 2013**. Companies must spend at least 2% of average net profits of the preceding three years on CSR activities.
- CSR activities are governed by Schedule VII of the Companies Act..

Meesho, BSE Launch Project Shikhar for SME Listings

- **E-commerce platform Meesho has partnered with the BSE to launch a new initiative aimed at helping micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and digital businesses transition into publicly-listed companies.**
- The initiative, named **'Project Shikhar'**, aims to facilitate the listing of high-performing independent e-commerce sellers on the BSE SME platform, addressing their need for growth capital.
- The **SME platform to give dynamic, job-creating businesses a direct route to capital markets.**

New WPI series out on June 15, but to be replaced by Producer Price Index in 2031

- **The Ministry of Commerce will release a new Wholesale Price Index (WPI) series with 2022–23 as the base year on June 15.**
- However, this new year series will in all likelihood be discontinued after five years in 2031 and the Producer Price Index (PPI) based on output prices will become the main measure of non-retail inflation.

What is Producer Price Index (PPI)?

- **PPI measures changes in prices received by producers for goods and services before they reach consumers.**
- Unlike WPI, which mainly tracks goods, PPI covers both goods and services.
- It includes prices at different stages of production and distribution, making it a more comprehensive indicator of inflation.

Services Producer Price Index (SPPI)

India will also release a Services Producer Price Index (SPPI) **covering sectors such as:**

- Transport
- Insurance
- Passenger transport
- Pension fund management
- Telecom services

- SPPI **will be published on a quarterly basis, with the first data set covering January–March 2025.**

- Like the new WPI and PPI series, SPPI will also use 2022–23 as the base year.

Why is India Moving Towards PPI?

- Economists and institutions such as the International Monetary Fund (IMF) have long recommended adopting PPI.
- **PPI is considered more aligned with modern economic structures and international practices.**
- It helps estimate real GDP more accurately and provides a **better measure of producer-side inflation**.
- International organisations such as the International Monetary Fund (IMF) have recommended adopting PPI as a modern inflation indicator.

Items to weights: How the WPI is going to change

	WPI-2011/12 series		WPI-2022/23 series	
	No. of items	Weight	No. of items	Weight
Primary Articles items	115	22.62%	129	22.76%
Fuel & Power items	18	13.15%	25	14.11%
Manufactured items	564	64.23%	803	63.13%
TOTAL ITEMS	697	100%	957	100%

Source: Ministry of Commerce & Industry • Get the data • Created with Datawrapper

Key Changes in the New Series

- The **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) has updated the base years for both CPI and GDP, while also improving calculation methods.**
- **Along with the new WPI, the government will introduce:**
  - Monthly Output PPI
  - Monthly Input PPI
  - Monthly Manufacturing PPI
- Initially, the Input PPI will be released for experimental purposes and refined after feedback from users and stakeholders.

RBI Monetary Policy Meeting June 2026 Highlights: RBI keeps repo rate unchanged, revises GDP growth forecast to 6.6% from 6.9%



- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced its monetary policy decision on , 5 June 2026, .
- **The RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra-led Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) held its second bi-monthly policy meeting for FY27**

RBI Monetary Policy Decision

- RBI MPC **decided to keep the policy repo rate unchanged at 5.25% and maintain a 'neutral' stance.**
- The MPC keep the policy repo rate unchanged
- **RBI lowered its GDP growth projections for the financial year 2026-27 (FY27) to 6.6% from 6.9% earlier also raised India's CPI inflation projections for FY27 to 5.1% from 4.6% earlier.**

Policy Measures

- Repo rate unchanged 5.25%
- Policy stance maintained at 'Neutral'
- CRR at 3%
- SDF rate at 5.00%
- MSF rate at 5.50%
- Bank Rate at 5.50%

India Launches UPI Payments in Cambodia Through NPCI–ACLEDA Bank Partnership

- **National Payments Corporation of India has officially partnered with ACLEDA Bank to launch Unified Payments Interface (UPI) acceptance in Cambodia.**
- UPI is accepted in nine countries including Singapore, the United Arab Emirates, France, Mauritius, Nepal, Bhutan, Qatar, Sri Lanka and **Cambodia**.

- Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has been actively pursuing interlinking of Unified Payments Interface (UPI) with fast payment systems of other jurisdictions to promote cross-border payments.



About UPI

- **Launched: April 2016** by **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** under Regulatory Oversight of **Reserve Bank of India (RBI).**
- **Meaning:** System that powers multiple bank accounts i**nto a single mobile application** (of any participating bank), merging several banking features, seamless fund routing & merchant payments into one hood.

Bloomberg Global Aggregate Bond Index

- **India is currently executing major capital market reforms to secure the inclusion of its government bonds within the prestigious Bloomberg Global Aggregate Bond Index.**
- The Bloomberg Global Aggregate Bond Index is a **flagship international fixed-income benchmark that tracks the performance of investment-grade, fixed-rate bonds globally.**
- Just as the Nifty 50 or Sensex benchmarks monitor the equity performance of listed corporate entities, **this index acts as the definitive global tracking ledger for the multi-trillion-dollar sovereign and corporate debt markets.**
- **Developed By:** The index is constructed, maintained, and managed by Bloomberg Index Services Limited.
- The objective of the index is to provide institutional fund managers with a highly transparent, multicurrency, and comprehensive macro-measurement tool.
- **The index is one of the world's largest bond benchmarks, covering sovereign and supranational debt across multiple currencies.**
- It is widely tracked by sovereign wealth funds, pension funds, insurers, and global asset managers.
- **India's inclusion is based on FAR-designated Government Securities (G-Secs).**
- **Under the Fully Accessible Route (2020), FPIs, NRIs, and OCIs can invest in these bonds without investment caps.**
- has already entered the JPMorgan EM Index (2024), Bloomberg EM Local Currency Index (2025), and FTSE Russell EM Index (2025).



RBI Launches Reelathon 2026 on Cyber Fraud

- In a first-of-its-kind initiative Reserve Bank of India (RBI), has launched RBI Reelathon 2026, a state-wide mass awareness campaign targeting college students to combat the growing menace of cyber-enabled financial frauds.
- RBI Reelathon 2026 is designed as a three-phase state-wide awareness initiative.

World Gold Council

- Recently, the World Gold Council's (WGC) 2026 Central Bank Gold Reserves (CBGR) survey indicated that the central banks around the world would accumulate more gold in the future.
- **It is a nonprofit association of the world's leading gold producers formed in 1987**.
- It is a market development organization for the gold industry which includes 29 major gold mining companies.
- It **aims to maximize the industry's potential growth by monitoring and defending existing gold consumption.**
- It achieves this by setting up gold standards, proposing policies, ensuring fairness and sustainability in the gold mining industry, and promoting the usage and demand for gold for individuals, industries, and institutions.
- **The WGC is also the global authority on gold, and they offer comprehensive analyses of the industry.**



- It also co-sponsors researching the development of new uses of gold, or of new products containing gold.
- It covers the markets which comprise about three-quarters of the world's annual gold consumption.
- **The WGC was the creator of the first gold exchange-traded fund.**

- **Headquarters**: London, UK

Recently, the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) rolled out the Drunix platform



- It is an enterprise-grade distributed ledger technology designed to help organizations build and scale tokenization platforms, digital asset ecosystems, and multi-organization networks.
- **Drunix is a custom-built private blockchain framework designed to deliver high scalability and optimized performance.**
- It enables blockchain deployment at scale and is engineered for enterprise and public infrastructure adoption.
- It is a high-performance distributed ledger platform built as an enhanced fork of Hyperledger Fabric.
- Hyperledger Fabric is an open-source enterprise blockchain framework developed under the umbrella of the Linux Foundation

Uzbekistan officially joined the New Development Bank (NDB)

- Recently, Uzbekistan officially joined the New Development Bank (NDB) as its 11th member, becoming the **first country from Central Asia to become part of this BRICS-led multilateral development institution.**
- The New Development Bank is a multilateral development bank established by the five BRICS countries – Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- The decision to establish the bank was taken at the **6th BRICS Summit held in Fortaleza, Brazil in 2014**
- It became operational **in 2015**
- **Headquarters: Shanghai, China**



The current membership includes:

- Founding BRICS members: Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa
- **Bangladesh (joined in 2021)**
- **United Arab Emirates (joined in 2021)**
- **Egypt (joined in 2023)**
- **Algeria (joined in 2025)**
- **Colombia(joined in 2025)**
- **Uzbekistan (joined in 2026)**
- In addition, **Uruguay, and Ethiopia have been approved for membership by the Board of Governors**. They will become full members once they complete the formal accession process..

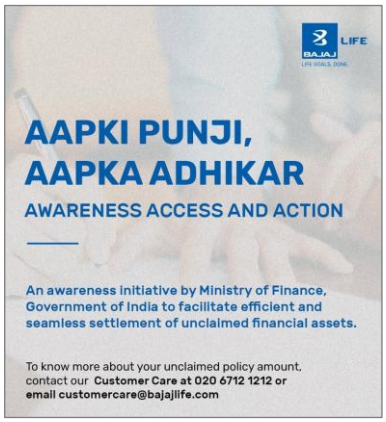
SEBI Approves GARUDA Green-Channel Framework for AIFs



- The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has approved the GARUDA (Green-Channel: **AIF Rollout Upon Document Acknowledgement**) mechanism, transitioning the Alternative Investment Fund (AIF) framework from a traditional pre-clearance model to a fast-track, accountability-driven disclosure model.
- SEBI aims to eliminate bureaucratic friction and accelerate time-to-market for fund managers, allowing private capital to flow into the economy much faster.
- Under GARUDA, the launch timeline for Regular Schemes of AIFs has been **reduced to 10 working days from the earlier waiting period of about 30 days.**

- Accredited Investor-only schemes and Angel Funds can launch immediately after SEBI acknowledges their documents.

IEPFA Organises panel discusion on "Aapki Poonji Aapka Adhikaar – Learning and Way Forward"; Launches book: "Claiming the Unclaimed: Unlocking the Potential of Idle Financial Assets in India"



- The Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (IEPFA), under the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, Government of India, organised a panel discussion on **"Aapki Poonji Aapka Adhikaar – Learning and Way Forward" in New Delhi.**
- A publication named "**Claiming the Unclaimed: Unlocking the Potential of Idle Financial Assets in India**" unveiled by Ms. Deepti Gaur Mukerjee, Chairperson, IEPFA and Secretary, Ministry of Corporate Affairs

Index of Services Production

- The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) is preparing to launch **Index of Services Production (ISP) in July, 2026.**
- It is a short-term indicator designed to measure **changes over time in the volume of output produced by the services sector relative to a specified base period.**
- It measures changes in the real output of service-producing industries over time.
- It is being developed **with 2024-25 as the proposed base year** and will primarily use Goods and Services Tax (GST) data to track activity.

Principal Data Sources

- Administrative data for sectors such as **air transport, railways, banking, and insurance**
- **GST data** for wholesale and retail trade, hospitality, road and water transport, warehousing, telecommunications, real estate, information technology services, professional services, and entertainment
- **Annual Survey of Incorporated Services Sector Enterprises (ASISSE) data** for health and education services, which are expected to be incorporated into the framework at a later stage.
- It will primarily reflect the formal sector as it is compiled using outward supply of enterprises registered under GST.
- Weights assigned in ISP: Weights are based on sectoral contributions to Gross Value Added (GVA) available from National Account Statistics

Eurobank launches UPI-based remittance service for cross-border transfers from Greece to India

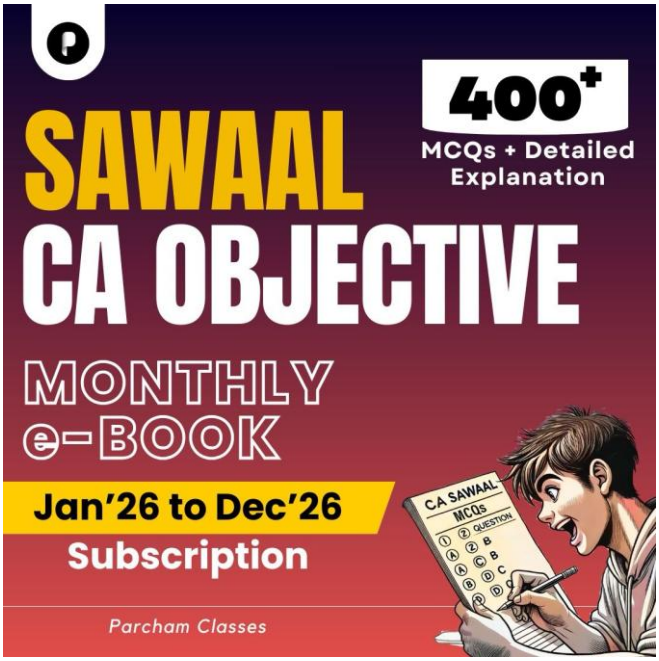
- Indian travellers can now use the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) in Greece, with the country becoming the latest to join India's growing cross-border digital payments network.
- These collaborations allow Indian travellers to make QR code-based payments abroad using their existing UPI apps.
- France was among the first European countries to introduce UPI.
- Developed by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), UPI enables users to transfer money instantly by linking their bank accounts to mobile payment apps.



UPI is currently available through partner banks and merchant networks in the following countries:

- Singapore
- United Arab Emirates (UAE)
- France
- Mauritius
- Nepal
- Bhutan
- Qatar
- Sri Lanka
- Cambodia
- Greece


CURRENT AFFAIRS
COMPLETE KIT
2026-27
JULY'26 TO JUNE'27
PARCHAM CLASSES
DAILY, WEEKLY, MONTHLY
Daily
• English CA PDFs
• Hindi CA PDFs
Weekly
• Weekly CA PDFs
• Banking CA PDFs
• CA Booster PDFs
Monthly
• Monthly CA E-Magazines
• Sawaal CA Objective e-Books
• Raftaar CA Headliner e-Books
• Youtube Revision PDFs
6 MONTHLY & ANNUALLY
6 Monthly
• July-Dec 2025 CA Magazine
• Jan-June 2026 CA Magazine
• July-Dec 2026 CA Magazine
• Jan-June 2027 CA Magazine
• Youtube Revision PDFs
Annually
• Yearbook (2027 Edition)
• Youtube Revision PDFs (2026)
Covers 2 Years' Current Affairs

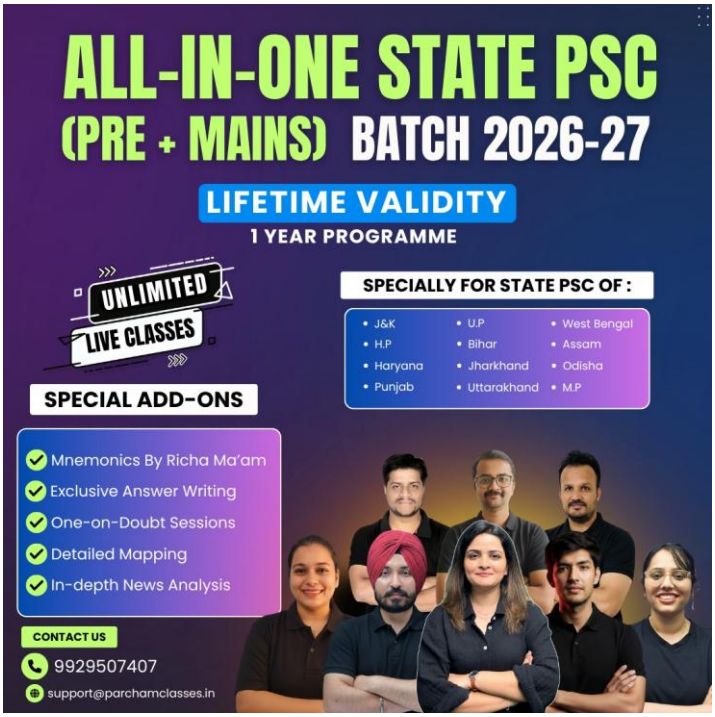

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• Computer Based Test
• Detailed PYQs Discussion
• World Mapping


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